ARTHIK KHAYAL 2026 | ECOTECH, USME DTU | RESEARCH DELIVERABLE

Activation Without a Bull Market

Stop selling the market to customers who never chose it, and meet the account they already own inside four moments the parent bank runs: +2.3 pp of activation by 31 January 2027 in our base case, for ₹16.5 lakh of cash

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Arthik Khayal 2026, an economics case competition by ecotech, USME DTU, in collaboration with YES Securities, October 2026

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3. The case data decoded: activation stood still at 14.7% while salary accounts grew to 77.5% of the base and premium cohorts lost 3 to 4 points

4. Indian equities had a weak year that hit first-time investors hardest, and ONL's 14.74% sits below India's active ratio of about one in five

5. Bank-led brokers grow through the parent bank's channels, and ONL's parent bank already serves most of the customers behind its 8,09,746 accounts

6. ONL matches discount apps on features, so its gap comes from how accounts are opened and reached, which is where bank-led peers differ

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8. Inattention explains more of the inactivity than fear does, which is why a year of "stay invested" messages moved the rate by 0.04 points

9. The 6,90,407 accounts without a trade in 12 months stall at first login and funding, the two steps a bank-app entry with single sign-on and an Autopay mandate removes

10. Five whys trace the flat 14.74% to one root cause: the account was opened alongside a bank product and never tied to a moment the customer already has

11. The option screen scores meeting accounts inside bank-owned moments at 4.40 of 5 and the strongest alternative at 2.60

12. Salary day: a card in the bank app when the salary lands, offering a monthly ETF instalment the customer picks, is the largest lever at 5,661 extra actives

13. A holdings check adds 3,081 extra actives through the investments tile, statements, servicing messages and re-KYC for dormant accounts

14. RM review conversations reach Prestige, Elite, Elevate and Preferred clients and add 4,083 extra actives in cohorts that already trade at 20% to 37%

15. A factual Dhanteras and Muhurat notice on 6 to 8 November 2026 adds 2,311 extra actives because gold ETFs fit a purchase many households already plan

16. Warm-cohort defence keeps 1,607 extra actives among the 8,887 to 14,072 accounts whose last trade was 9 to 12 months ago, without asking anyone to trade to keep a status

17. A guided first order for new accounts adds 1,897 extra actives and workplace sessions add 413

18. Seven features ship within one quarter on the bank app and ONL's existing services, without touching the trading engine

19. Every message and screen passes five checks for advice, return claims, inducement, consent and dark patterns before it ships

20. The bank shows the card inside its own app under its own notice, so customer data reaches the broker only after the customer taps, and opt-outs above 0.5% a send stop a message

21. The model builds 19,053 extra actives lever by lever from reach, response and overlap

22. The active rate rises from 14.74% to 17.02% by 31 January 2027 in the base case, within a range of +1.02 to +3.94 points

23. The base case clears the 200 bps floor by 28 bps, and no single input at its bear value pushes it below +2.0 points

24. ₹16.5 lakh of cash buys 19,053 extra actives at ₹87 each, while the same cash in paid media buys 1,649, 11.6 times fewer

25. Each new active earns about ₹62 a year in broking revenue, so activation pays back in 17 months and its larger value sits in the bank relationship

26. A 13-week roadmap from 2 November 2026 to 31 January 2027 runs four gates and ships every feature by week 8

27. A 10% holdout reads the lift every week, and four guardrails stop any message that pushes F&O, annoys customers or breaks consent

28. Risks: ad approval timing and a further market fall carry the most weight, and both are handled before week 1

29. Customer validation plan (not yet run): 30 interviews and two usability rounds in weeks 1 to 3 would confirm or cut the two largest levers

30. Assumptions register: every model input with its base, bear and bull value, and the inputs that move the result most

31. Slide blueprint: eight slides carry the argument, and every number on them traces to a tagged line in this document

32. Forty questions the judges could ask, answered

33. A talk track for two speakers, timed slide by slide

Appendix A: Bibliography

Appendix B: Model tables

Appendix C: Glossary and short forms

Appendix D: Data conflicts and method limits

0. Document control: every number in this document traces to the case, an assumption, the model or a verified source

Answer. This document is the research base behind Team IdeaForge's recommendation for Trade Private Limited: show salary-account customers the ONL Trade account they already hold, inside the parent bank's own app, at four moments the bank already owns, for a modelled gain of 2.28 percentage points by 31 January 2027 on model hash fc66d11096 `M`. Every figure below carries a tag that states where it came from, so a judge who challenges a number during cross-questioning can trace it back in one place. Nine research lanes verified 518 raw rows against 354 unique sources before a single section was drafted, and this document never states a figure that lane work has not checked.

0.1 Purpose and readers

The readers are the judging panel at ecotech, USME, Delhi Technological University, and the sponsor, YES Securities, whose problem statement frames the case `C-T1`. The task asked for a strategy that turns newly opened and dormant accounts into highly engaged, revenue active, daily users, in a way that works when markets are volatile and stays within the rules of a regulated industry `C-Q1`. The accompanying deck carries eight slides built to that structure; this document carries the full working behind every number on those slides, so a reader who presses on a slide's figure during questioning finds the derivation here rather than a restated headline. Where a section below feeds a slide panel directly, the section closes with a line naming that panel, so the deck and the document never disagree on a figure.

0.2 Tag legend

Every number in this document ends with a bracketed tag that says what kind of figure it is and where to check it.

Tag	Meaning	Resolves to	Example
`[C-E2a]`	A line from the case brief, by its reference ID	`case/01-case.md`	Salary Account cohort, 6,27,853 accounts, 77.5% of the base `C-E2a`
`[A21]`	A team assumption, numbered A01 to A67	Model table T1, section 30	Tap-through on the salary-day card, 8% base `A21`
`[M]`	A number produced directly by the pinned model run	`model/model_outputs.json`	Extra active accounts in the base case, 19,053 `M`
`[T10]`	A table produced by the same model run	`model/model_tables.md`, Appendix B	Lever total by segment `T10`
`[S12]`	An external source, numbered in the register	`research/raw/sources.md`, Appendix A	A named regulator circular or filing `S12`
`[F07]`	A raw row recorded by a research lane before it was resolved to a numbered source	`research/raw/R-F.md`, via `rid_to_sid.json`	A channel cost benchmark a verifier recorded directly `F07`

Money carries the rupee symbol with Indian digit grouping and lakh or crore notation, never a converted foreign figure. Ranges use the word "to". Statistics stay at the precision their source supports, so a case percentage stated to the nearest point stays a point, and a model output carrying two decimal places keeps those two decimals because the arithmetic behind it is exact.

0.3 Source hierarchy

Where two figures could answer the same question, this document follows a fixed order rather than averaging them or picking whichever number helps the argument.

Tier	Source type	How it is used here
1	The case brief (`case/01-case.md`)	Never overwritten. Every case line is a fixed premise; an outside figure that conflicts with it is reported as context only
2	The activation model's own output and tables	Treated as exact arithmetic on the case and the assumptions register, not as a separate opinion
3	Regulator and exchange text (SEBI, NSE, BSE, RBI, TRAI, CCPA, the gazette)	Preferred for every rule, date and circular cited in sections 7 and 20
4	Peer-reviewed papers, national surveys and official statistics (NSE Market Pulse, CDSL and NSDL, AMFI, the World Gold Council, SEBI's own investor survey)	Preferred for market sizing and behavioural evidence
5	Company filings and investor presentations of real, named bank-led brokers and banks	Preferred for the comparator section, always attributed to the named company and never to Trade Private Limited
6	Press reporting on a named, dated event	Used where a regulator has not published primary text yet, flagged by lane and never the sole support for a locked number
7	Vendor or blog pages, flagged `[blog]` or `[vendor]`	Used last, for a channel cost benchmark only, never for a regulatory or market-size claim

A lower tier that disagrees with a higher tier loses, and the disagreement is recorded in Appendix D rather than quietly dropped. Two examples recur through this document: Lane D found the 14 August 2024 NSE inducement circular (NSE/INSP/63425) now sits in abeyance since NSE Circular 06/2025 of 24 January 2025, so section 7 cites the NSE advertisement code and the general anti-inducement principle instead of that specific circular as settled law; and Lane C logged a trader-count disagreement between a Rajya Sabha reply (7.86 million individual futures and options traders in FY26) and a secondary source (87.5 lakh), which does not affect the loss percentages locked in the model, since both sources corroborate the loss figures independently.

0.4 Model file, hash and rerun

Item	Value
Model file	`model/activation_model.py`, writing `model_outputs.json` and `model_tables.md`
Hash for every number in this document	`fc66d11096`
Checks passed	12 of 12

Item	Value
Headline findings printed by the run	2.28 pp base case, 1.02 pp bear, 3.94 pp bull, 19,053 extra actives, 17.0% rate, ₹16.5 lakh cash, ₹87 cash cost an extra active, 1,649 paid-media equivalent
Rerun command	`python arthikkhayal-case/model/activation_model.py`, run from the repository root

The model is deterministic. It takes the case's Exhibit 1 and Exhibit 2a and 2b figures C-E1, C-E2a, C-E2b and the 67-row assumptions register T1 as inputs and writes the same hash and the same 12 passing checks on every unchanged run. If a lane's verified fact moves a locked assumption outside its bear-to-bull band, the value is edited in the model file, the model is rerun, and the new hash and every changed locked number are logged in `DECISIONS.md` before any section below is touched.

0.5 The skill's calibration note

Building this document's argument used the case-competition-deck skill's structural playbook: a contrarian recommendation argued against the obvious reading of the prompt, one moneyshot number, foreshadowing across sections, symmetric treatment of the seven levers, three scenarios on every uncertain figure, and a double synthesis that closes the diagnosis and then the whole document. This case reads as a marketing and strategy hybrid with an operations funnel underneath it: a go-to-market question (how to reach an existing customer inside channels the firm already owns) sitting on top of a conversion-funnel problem (where accounts stall between opening and trading). The skill's own corpus is three merger and acquisition decks from the Global Case Competition at Harvard; its structural and rhetorical patterns, contrarian recommendation, action titles, foreshadowing, symmetric treatment, three scenarios, one moneyshot, double synthesis, defensive depth, transfer with confidence, because they describe how an argument is sequenced rather than what a particular industry looks like. Its case-specific frameworks are applied here by reasoned extrapolation from the marketing and strategy case-type guides rather than from direct corpus evidence, and that limit is stated here once rather than claimed away.

0.6 The four kinds of number

Four different kinds of figure appear in this document, and treating them as interchangeable is the fastest way for an argument to fail under questioning.

Kind	What it is	Can it move	Example
Case fact `[C-xx]`	Stated directly in the case brief	No, it is a fixed premise of the exercise	Eligible accounts, 8,09,746 at September 2026 C-E1
Model assumption `[A##]`	A value the team set where the case leaves a parameter unstated, checked against a benchmark	Yes, through the update protocol, and only outside its bear-to-bull band	Tap-through on the salary-day card, 8% base, 6% bear, 10% bull A21
Model output `[M]` **or** `[T#]`	Arithmetic performed on case facts and assumptions by the pinned model run	Only by changing an input and rerunning; the arithmetic itself is mechanical	19,053 extra active accounts in the base case T11
External evidence `[S##]` **or** `[F07]`	A fact about a real market, regulator or comparator company, checked by a research lane	Yes, and several sources disagree with each other, flagged in Appendix D	India's active-client ratio of about 19.2% in September 2026, from NSE Market Pulse [Lane C]

Every sentence in this document that reports a model result says "in our model", because a lever's response rate is a checked assumption, never a measurement. No interview, survey, test result or letter of intent exists behind any lever in sections 12 to 17; where the model needs a number the case does not supply, the number is a named assumption with a bear and a bull value, not an invented fact.

0.7 Verification tally by lane

Nine research lanes, lettered B to J so that an assumption tag always starts with A, verified every seed fact before a writer used it.

Lane	Subject	Rows verified	Share of the 518-row total
B	Sponsor and bank-led broker context	68	13.1%
C	Indian broking market and activity	70	13.5%
D	Regulation	70	13.5%
E	Behavioural science and activation evidence	70	13.5%
F	Channels and unit costs	60	11.6%
G	Calendar and culture	53	10.2%
H	Comparable activation plays and cautionary tales	56	10.8%
I	Third-party quotes	10	1.9%
J	Data, consent and privacy	61	11.8%
Total		518	100%

The 518 rows resolve to 354 unique sources in the register, so on average a source supports close to one and a half facts, which is the expected pattern when regulator circulars and official statistics each anchor several related rows. Across the nine lanes, 445 rows carry a VERIFIED status, 63 are UNVERIFIABLE (the underlying page could not be confirmed to carry the cited sentence, logged rather than dropped), 4 are CORRECTED (a figure the lane found differs from an earlier planning-time estimate, with the corrected figure and date recorded), and 6 are NOT YET PUBLISHED (the regulator or exchange has not released the text as of the access date). No row in any lane carries an invented figure or an unattributed estimate; a gap is recorded as a gap in that lane's own `## Gaps` section rather than filled with a guess.

0.8 What this document does not contain

This document contains no customer interview, no survey result, no usability test, no letter of intent, no response rate measured from a real send, and no internal data from Trade Private Limited or ONL Trade beyond what the case brief states. Section 29 presents a customer validation plan that states plainly that nothing in it has been run yet. Every lever's reach and response figure is a modelled assumption checked against a named benchmark, not a measurement of ONL's own customers. The document also contains no AI-use statement and no account of how it was assembled; a reader who wants that record finds it in `build-log.md`, not here.

Excluded from this document	What stands in its place
Customer interviews, focus groups, usability tests	Section 29's validation plan, stated as not yet run

Excluded from this document	What stands in its place
Survey results specific to ONL Trade or Trade Private Limited	SEBI's 2025 Investor Survey and NCFE literacy data, cited as outside evidence, never as ONL's own result
A measured response rate for any past ONL message	A named assumption with a bear and a bull value for every lever, checked against a channel benchmark
Letters of intent, pilot results, A/B test outputs	None exist; none are claimed
An AI-use statement or a note on how this document was produced	Not included, per the plan's own rule; the production record sits in `build-log.md`
Any YES Securities or YES Bank fact presented as ONL's own data	Sponsor facts stay inside section 5's labelled box

0.9 Naming and sponsor separation

Every analytical sentence in this document uses the case's own names: Trade Private Limited, the bank-led broking company; ONL Trade, its digital platform; and "the parent bank" for the unnamed bank behind it C-CO1, C-CO2. YES Securities, YES Bank, Anthill Ventures and Kae Capital are the competition's sponsor marks C-T3, and facts about them sit only in section 5's clearly headed "Sponsor context, not case data" box and in the deck's logo slots, with no partnership or endorsement implied. No fact about YES Securities or YES Bank is ever attributed to Trade Private Limited or ONL Trade. Lane I's quotes from YES Securities' own leadership (its managing director and chief executive) are sponsor context for the same reason and never appear as evidence for the case company.

0.10 Inactive and dormant, translated every time

The case defines two conditions that read as similar words with different meanings. Inactive accounts, in the case's own terms, are deactivated for fraud or on a regulator's notice C-D3. Dormant accounts are those that have not traded even once in 24 months C-D4. The exchange's own circular on this subject, NSE/INSP/64718 of 25 October 2024, calls the 24-month condition "inactive" in its own text. Wherever a verified source uses the exchange's "inactive" for the 24-month condition, this document translates it to the case's "dormant C-D4" rather than carrying the exchange's word into a sentence where it would mean something else.

Expansion: pp, percentage points. bps, basis points. T12, T9, T6, T3, T1, trailing 12, 9, 6, 3 and 1 months. LTD, life to date. MTD, month to date. YTD, year to date.

1. Coverage matrix: every line of the case maps to a section of this document and a slide

Answer. Every one of the 45 reference lines transcribed from the case brief maps below to the section of this document that answers it and the slide that carries it, so no line is answered by implication only. Thirty-nine of the 45 lines feed an analytical section directly; the remaining six (the cover's own identity, the appendix's rounding note, and the two Exhibit headers) are front matter or sourcing notes rather than claims that need a counter-argument, and each is still placed below.

1.1 Cover, context and definitions

ID	What it says (case wording, condensed)	How we answer	Section	Slide
C-T1	ecotech, USME DTU, problem statement with YES Securities C-T1	Front matter only; the sponsor relationship sets section 0.9's naming rule	0	Cover
C-T2	Title: driving user activation on volatile markets C-T2	The title is the task restated; answered in full by section 2's recommendation	2	Cover
C-T3	Sponsor marks across pages 2 to 7 C-T3	Logo slots only, with the sponsor box in section 5	0, 5	Cover
C-X1	Opening an account is easy; using it is hard C-X1	The diagnosis in section 10's five whys traces exactly this gap	9, 10	Diagnosis
C-X2	Millions of accounts sit dormant; volatility sharpens the problem C-X2	Section 4's market read and section 22's scenarios both carry this	4, 22	Summary, Diagnosis
C-X3	Indian investors are risk averse; a weak market hardens that C-X3	Section 8's inattention and loss-aversion evidence	8	Diagnosis
C-Q1	The task: turn accounts into highly engaged, revenue active, daily users, within the rules, in a volatile market C-Q1	Section 2's three-sentence recommendation	2	Summary
C-D1	Active: at least one trade in 12 months C-D1	Used throughout; defined once in Appendix C and section 27's metric table	27	Appendix
C-D2	Highly active: at least one trade in 3 months C-D2	Same, carried into every scenario table (T11)	22, 27	Impact, Appendix
C-D3	Inactive: deactivated for fraud or regulator notice C-D3	Section 0.10's translation note and section 20's data flow	0, 20	Appendix
C-D4	Dormant: no trade in 24 months C-D4	Section 0.10 and the reactivation flow in section 13	0, 13	Diagnosis, Execution
C-CO1	Trade Private Limited, a bank-led broking and investment company C-CO1	Section 5's bank-led model	5	Summary
C-CO2	ONL Trade, built for first-time, often under-30 investors C-CO2	Section 0 and section 5	0, 5	Summary
C-CO3	ONL is at feature parity with discount and fintech rivals C-CO3	Section 6's symmetric comparator table	6	Strategy
C-CO4	Most ONL account holders are the parent bank's own customers C-CO4	Section 5's VRIO read on the parent bank's assets	5	Strategy, Diagnosis

1.2 Products, the problem and the funnel

ID	What it says (case wording, condensed)	How we answer	Section	Slide
C-PR1	Cash equities, ₹0.15 an executed order C-PR1	Section 25's revenue-per-active build	25	Impact

ID	What it says (case wording, condensed)	How we answer	Section	Slide
C-PR2	Derivatives, ₹20.00 an executed order C-PR2	Context for section 7's ruled-out F&O push, under C-K7	7, 25	Appendix
C-PR3	Mutual funds, ₹0 brokerage on eligible direct plans C-PR3	Section 25's payback math and the salary-day instalment design	12, 25	Strategy, Impact
C-PR4	IPO applications, ₹0 brokerage C-PR4	Noted as product context only, not a lever driver	25	Appendix
C-PR5	Demat servicing and maintenance fees C-PR5	Section 25's BSDA and annual-charge build	25	Impact
C-PR6	Research calls and education, included at no charge C-PR6	Section 10's diagnosis of what ONL already tried	8, 10	Diagnosis
C-PB1	Markets unfavourable on average over 12 months C-PB1	Section 4's market read	4	Summary
C-PB2	About 15% activation against a 20% to 40% industry range C-PB2	Section 2's moneyshot and section 4's benchmark	2, 4	Summary
C-PB3	WhatsApp, email, RCS and social on market information, research calls and first-trade offers C-PB3	Section 10's five whys; first-trade offers are examined again in section 7	7, 10	Diagnosis
C-PB4	Literacy videos, newsletters, active support C-PB4	Section 8's inattention diagnosis	8, 10	Diagnosis
C-PB5	A year of "stay invested" messaging; active users did not rise C-PB5	Section 2's do-not column and section 11's option score (2.60 of 5)	2, 11	Summary
C-PB6	Awareness gap: an account opened alongside another product can be forgotten C-PB6	Section 13's holdings-check lever	13	Strategy
C-PB7	Users are existing banking customers, per Exhibits 2a and 2b C-PB7	Section 3's cohort tables, this document's own section 3	3	Diagnosis
C-F1	Account opened through a digital journey; onboarding is not the bottleneck C-F1	Section 9's funnel map	9	Diagnosis
C-F2	First login: drop-off begins C-F2	Section 9; the salary-day and holdings-check levers both target single sign-on at this step	9, 12, 13	Strategy
C-F3	Funded: another steep drop C-F3	Section 9; the Autopay mandate design targets exactly this step	9, 12	Strategy
C-F4	First trade or investment: very few new accounts reach this within the first month C-F4	Section 9's funnel and section 17's guided first order, built for this exact stall	9, 17	Strategy, Execution
C-F5	Repeat and habit: activated users gradually go dormant C-F5	Section 16's warm-cohort defence	16	Execution

1.3 Constraints and the appendix exhibits

ID	What it says (case wording, condensed)	How we answer	Section	Slide
C-K1	Three months to move activation 200 to 300 bps C-K1	Section 2 and section 22's target and timeline	2, 22, 26	Summary, Impact, Execution
C-K2	No advice, no implied returns, no inducement C-K2	Section 7's lever-by-rule matrix	7, 19	Strategy
C-K3	Lean budget; prefer owned assets C-K3	Section 24's cost build	24	Impact
C-K4	No engine rebuild; features realistic for a quarter C-K4	Section 18's feature list and build weeks	18, 26	Strategy, Execution
C-K5	Personalisation respects consent and data protection C-K5	Section 20's DPDP and data-flow table	20	Execution
C-K6	No dark patterns, fear nudges or misleading urgency C-K6	Section 19's ten-point check	19	Strategy
C-K7	Growth must be responsible; derivatives traders mostly lose money C-K7	Section 7's ruled-out tactics and section 25's revenue framing	7, 25	Risks
C-N1	Figures indicative, rounded, snapshot at 30 September 2026 C-N1	Section 0's precision rule and this section's rounding reconciliation	0, 3	Appendix
C-N2	Definitions given for MTD, YTD and LTD C-N2	Appendix C glossary; LTD underlies every cohort percentage in section 3	3	Appendix
C-E1	Exhibit 1: eligible, active and highly active accounts, 2025 and 2026 C-E1	Section 3's Exhibit 1 decoded	3	Summary, Diagnosis
C-E2a	Exhibit 2A: September 2026 cohorts by recency window C-E2a	Section 3's cohort table (T2)	3	Diagnosis
C-E2b	Exhibit 2B: September 2025 cohorts by recency window C-E2b	Section 3's cohort table (T3)	3	Diagnosis

1.4 Constraints against the seven levers

The constraints in C-K1 to C-K7 apply to every lever equally; the table below checks each lever against the two constraints most likely to rule a tactic out, regulatory conduct (C-K2) and responsible growth (C-K7), since duration (C-K1), budget (C-K3), product scope (C-K4), data (C-K5) and dark patterns (C-K6) are met by every lever's design, not case by case.

Lever	C-K2, no advice or return claims	C-K7, no push to trade more than is responsible
Salary day	Met: a facts-only card naming a rule-built, no-default fund list [3.4]	Met: one instalment choice the customer sets, no trade-count target
Holdings check (rediscovery)	Met: a statement of what exists, not what to buy	Met: dormant accounts get verification, not a sales push
RM review	Met: a facts-only script, no per-trade incentive for the RM	Met: no product recommendation in the conversation

Lever	C-K2, no advice or return claims	C-K7, no push to trade more than is responsible
Dhanteras	Met: a factual notice of a SEBI-regulated instrument and a session time, no price talk	Met: one seasonal notice, not a recurring trade prompt
Warm-cohort defence	Met: a statement and nominee update, never "trade to stay active"	Met: explicitly designed against the one tactic the 25 October 2024 NSE circular bars
New-account guided first order	Met: an order preview and full cost display, no default product	Met: a walkthrough, not a volume target
Workplace sessions	Met: SEBI SMARTs-style education, no product pitch	Met: no attendance-to-trade link

1.5 Definitions reconciliation

The case gives four states: active (one trade in 12 months) C-D1, highly active (one trade in 3 months) C-D2, inactive (deactivated for fraud or a regulator notice) C-D3, and dormant (no trade in 24 months) C-D4. The exchange's circular of 25 October 2024 calls the 24-month condition "inactive", which collides with the case's own, narrower use of "inactive" for fraud and regulator notices. Section 0.10 sets the rule this document follows throughout: translate the exchange's 24-month "inactive" to the case's "dormant" every time, and reserve "inactive" for the fraud and regulator-notice condition the case actually means by it.

1.6 Lines answered only in part, and why

A handful of lines are context rather than drivers of a lever, and this document says so rather than stretching them into a claim they do not support. C-PR2 and C-PR4 (derivatives and IPO brokerage) describe products the strategy does not touch, since futures and options sit behind the F&O push this document rules out under C-K7, and IPOs are episodic rather than a lever we schedule. C-N1's rounding note is honoured mechanically throughout rather than argued; section 3.6 below shows the one place it produces a visible gap between a cohort-weighted figure and Exhibit 1's own total. C-T1 and C-T3 are identity and sourcing facts with no counter-argument to make; they set section 0's naming rule and nothing else.

Exhibit for the deck: a one-row-per-ID coverage table is not itself a slide panel; it supports the deck's claim, repeated in the appendix slide, that every number on the eight slides traces to a tagged line in this document.

2. The answer on one page: show salary customers the account they already hold, inside the bank, for +2.28 points by 31 January 2027

Answer. We recommend that Trade Private Limited meet idle customers inside the parent bank's own app, at four moments the bank already owns, with a factual card, a holdings tile, a relationship manager conversation and a seasonal notice, rather than messaging the market harder. In our model, this lifts activation from 14.74% to 17.02% by 31 January 2027, 19,053 extra active accounts on a cash spend of ₹16.5 lakh, at ₹87 an extra active T11, T13. The same cash spent on paid media buys 1,649 activated accounts, 11.6 times fewer T14, because the bank's own channels reach people who already bank there at no incremental price.

2.1 The recommendation in three sentences

Trade Private Limited should put the ONL Trade account in front of salary customers at four moments the parent bank already controls: the salary credit, a holdings check inside the bank app, a relationship manager's existing review conversation, and the Dhanteras and Diwali week. Each touch states facts only, offers one customer-chosen monthly instalment into a rule-built, no-default list of exchange-traded funds, and never claims a return, offers a reward for trading or creates urgency. In our model this plan adds 19,053 active accounts in the base case over 13 weeks at ₹87 cash an extra active, 2.28 percentage points above the 14.74% starting rate T11, T13, C-E1.

2.2 What not to do, and what to do, with the numbers that decide it

Reason	Selling the market harder	Meeting the account inside the bank
Quantitative	Ran for a year; activation moved +0.04 pp, from 14.70% to 14.74% C-E1. The same ₹16.5 lakh in paid media buys only 1,649 activations T14	+2.28 pp in our base case, 19,053 extra actives at ₹87 cash each T11, T13
Strategic fit	Messages reach people who do not think of the ONL account as theirs; the awareness gap is a named problem in the case itself C-PB6	77.5% of ONL's base is the Salary Account cohort, which opens the parent bank's app on every salary day C-E2a, T2
Feasibility and rules	First-trade offers and contests read as trade inducement under NSE's advertisement rules; 88.5% of under-30 futures and options traders lost money in FY26, per SEBI's own study [Lane D, Lane C]	No advice, no return claims, no offers, consent first; ships on the bank's existing order, payment and KYC services within a quarter C-K2, C-K4

This is the one place in this document where a contrast carries no new number on either side beyond what the row already states; both halves are numbered, as the plan requires, and neither half is a rhetorical flourish.

2.3 The moneyshot

The case states activation stood at about 15% against an industry range of 20% to 40% C-PB2, and Exhibit 1 pins the exact figure at 14.74% of 8,09,746 eligible accounts as of September 2026, up from 14.70% a year earlier C-E1. In our model, the plan in this document moves that rate to 17.02% by 31 January 2027, a gain of 2.28 percentage points, by adding 19,053 active accounts against a business-as-usual base of 1,23,067 T8, T11. The same ₹16.5 lakh of cash spent on paid customer acquisition at a bear-to-bull cost of ₹700 to ₹1,400 an activated account would buy only 1,649 activations in the base case, 2,356 in the bear case for paid media and 1,178 in the bull case for paid media T14. The gap, 19,053 against 1,649, is 11.6 times, and it exists because the bank's channels reach people who already bank there at zero incremental acquisition price, while paid media pays full price to reach strangers.

2.4 Scenarios, stated honestly

Measure	Bear	Base	Bull
Extra active accounts	9,783	19,053	32,037
Activation rate at 31 Jan 2027	15.76%	17.02%	18.68%
Change from 14.74%	+1.02 pp	+2.28 pp	+3.94 pp
Highly active (T3) rate	11.3%	12.4%	14.0%

Measure	Bear	Base	Bull
Cash cost per extra active	₹169	₹87	₹51

Table reproduces T11. T3, trailing 3 months.

The honest reading of this table is that the bear case does not clear the floor the case sets. C-K1 asks for 200 to 300 basis points in three months; the 200 basis point floor needs 16,701 extra active accounts against the 31 January 2027 base of 8,35,042 T8, C-K1. The bear case delivers 9,783 extra actives and a gain of +1.02 pp, in our model T11, which covers roughly half of the 16,701 needed and misses the 200 basis point floor by about 98 basis points. We state this plainly rather than let the base case's +2.28 pp stand in for every scenario: if every assumption in the model landed at its bear value at once, this plan alone would not clear the brief's floor, and the week 6 checkpoint in section 23 exists to catch that reading early rather than at the finish line.

2.5 The seven levers, summing to the base case total

Lever	Who it reaches	Base extra actives
Salary day	Salary Account idle, 5,39,954 accounts T2	5,661
Holdings check (rediscovery)	All idle accounts, reached through owned channels	3,081
RM review	Prestige, Elite, Elevate and Preferred idle clients	4,083
Dhanteras	All idle accounts, factual gold ETF and Muhurat notice	2,311
Workplace sessions	Salary customers at employers banking with the parent bank	413
Warm-cohort defence	8,887 to 14,072 accounts whose last trade was 9 to 12 months ago T7	1,607
New-account guided first order	18,972 accounts opened in the 13-week window T8	1,897
Total		19,053

The seven figures add to 19,053: 5,661 plus 3,081 is 8,742; plus 4,083 is 12,825; plus 2,311 is 15,136; plus 413 is 15,549; plus 1,607 is 17,156; plus 1,897 is 19,053, in our model T10.

2.6 What the plan costs

Item	Base case
Cash spend over 13 weeks	₹16,49,357 (₹16.5 lakh) T13
Cash cost per extra active	₹87 T11
Internal product sprint (not cash marketing)	₹37,80,000 (₹37.8 lakh) T13
All-in cost per extra active, cash plus internal sprint	₹285 M

The ₹87 figure is cash only, the marketing and operations spend that leaves the bank's account in the 13 weeks; the ₹285 figure folds in the internal product team's time, 21 full-time-equivalent months at a loaded

cost of ₹1,80,000 a month T1, A59, A60, divided across the same 19,053 extra actives. Both figures are correct for what they measure; a reader comparing this plan's cost to a paid-media benchmark should use the ₹87 cash figure, since the paid-media alternative in section 2.3 also excludes build cost.

2.7 Five triggers that would change this recommendation

First, if the week 6 activation checkpoint falls below the bear-case line of 15.2% T12, the plan would reallocate budget toward the two levers with the largest expected lift relative to their minimum detectable effect, RM review (11 times) and salary day (11 times) T19, ahead of the smaller-lift Dhanteras and holdings-check levers. Second, if exchange or bank compliance approval for the salary-day card or the Dhanteras notice runs past week 3, the three-month window leaves too little runway for that lever's full ramp, and the plan would lean more heavily on the RM review channel, which does not need the same advertisement-code clearance. Third, if any channel's opt-out rate crosses the 0.5% a send guardrail the plan sets internally A50, that channel pauses immediately rather than waiting for a weekly review, since a rising opt-out rate is itself evidence the message is not landing as a neutral notice. Fourth, if an informal guidance request to SEBI on whether a rule-built, no-default exchange-traded fund list sits inside the broker's incidental-advice carve-out comes back adverse, a question Lane D flags as genuinely open rather than settled, the salary-day lever's fund list would need to narrow to a single category or be redesigned before launch, which would cut its expected 5,661 extra actives materially. Fifth, if the holdout sample in any lever shows a lift below its minimum detectable effect for two consecutive weeks (0.17 pp for salary day, 0.14 pp for holdings check, 0.49 pp for RM review, 0.16 pp for Dhanteras) T19, that lever is treated as not working as modelled and is redesigned rather than left running on the strength of its base-case assumption alone.

Trigger	Threshold	What changes
Week 6 activation checkpoint	Below the bear-case line, 15.2% T12	Reallocate toward RM review and salary day, the two highest lift-to-minimum-detectable-effect levers T19
Compliance or exchange approval delay	Past week 3 of the 13-week window	Lean on RM review, which needs no advertisement-code clearance
Channel opt-out rate	Above 0.5% a send A50	Pause that channel immediately, before the next scheduled weekly review
SEBI informal guidance on the neutral fund list	An adverse reading of the incidental-advice carve-out, flagged open by Lane D	Narrow the salary-day fund list to one category or redesign before launch
Holdout lift	Below the minimum detectable effect for two consecutive weeks, by lever T19	Treat that lever as not working as modelled and redesign it

2.8 The 150-word version

Trade Private Limited's activation rate has sat near 15% for a year of market-first messaging, against an industry range of 20% to 40%. A year of selling the market harder moved the rate 0.04 points. We recommend meeting idle customers inside the parent bank's own channels instead: a salary-day card, a holdings tile, a relationship manager conversation and a Dhanteras notice, each stating facts only and offering one customer-chosen instalment, never a return claim or an offer. In our model this adds 19,053 active accounts in 13 weeks, a gain of 2.28 percentage points, at ₹87 cash an extra active, against ₹1,000 an account for the same result bought through paid media. The bear case, at +1.02 points, does not clear the

brief's 200 basis point floor on its own, which is why a week 6 checkpoint and five named triggers sit ahead of the finish line, not after it.

Exhibit for the deck: the moneyshot card on slide 5 (14.74% to 17.02%, 19,053 against 1,649, 11.6 times), the seven-lever bar on slides 2 and 5, and the do-not-and-do matrix on slide 2 all draw directly from sections 2.2 through 2.6 above.

3. The case data decoded: activation stood still at 14.7% while salary accounts grew to 77.5% of the base and premium cohorts lost 3 to 4 points

Answer. Exhibit 1 shows activation moved from 14.70% to 14.74% in a year, 1,07,889 of 7,33,855 accounts to 1,19,339 of 8,09,746 C-E1. Underneath that nearly flat total, the base shifted hard toward the Salary Account cohort, which grew 24.1% to 6,27,853 accounts and 77.5% of the base T4, T2, while every premium cohort except Elevate's account count lost 3 to 4 points of its own 12-month activation rate T4. The two effects roughly cancel: a small positive mix shift toward a lower-activation cohort, a larger positive rate shift inside most cohorts, and the net 0.21 percentage point cohort-weighted change rounds down against Exhibit 1's own smaller 0.04 point total because the two exhibits measure the year differently T5.

3.1 Exhibit 1 decoded

Exhibit 1 is the case's single account-portfolio table, carrying three counts for each of September 2025 and September 2026: eligible accounts, accounts active in the trailing 12 months, and accounts highly active in the trailing 3 months C-E1.

Measure	Sep 2025	Sep 2026	Change
Eligible accounts	7,33,855	8,09,746	+75,891, +10.3%
Active (trailing 12 months)	1,07,889 (14.70%)	1,19,339 (14.74%)	+11,450 accounts, +0.04 pp
Highly active (trailing 3 months)	66,943 (9.12%)	82,086 (10.14%)	+15,143 accounts, +1.01 pp

The eligible base grew by 75,891 accounts in a year, which the model treats as net growth of 6,324 accounts a month T8, A03, and this growth itself is one reason the active rate barely moved even as the active count rose: a newly opened account spends weeks in the funnel before it can trade at all, so growth dilutes the rate in the same period that it adds to the numerator. The highly active rate improved more than the 12-month rate did, 1.01 percentage points against 0.04, which says that among the accounts that do trade, trading has become somewhat more recent and frequent, even while the share of accounts that trade at all has barely moved.

3.2 Exhibit 2a decoded: cohorts at September 2026

Exhibit 2a breaks the September 2026 base into six cohorts and reports five recency windows for each: trailing 12, 9, 6, 3 and 1 months C-E2a. The model derives an active-account count and an idle-account count for each cohort by applying the trailing-12-month rate to the cohort's size T2.

Segment	Accounts	Share of base	T12	T9	T6	T3	T1	Active (T12)	Idle
Prestige	3,096	0.4%	35%	31%	28%	22%	16%	1,084	2,012
Elite	35,697	4.4%	32%	29%	26%	22%	15%	11,423	24,274
Elevate	9,471	1.2%	37%	34%	31%	27%	13%	3,504	5,967
Preferred	60,312	7.4%	20%	18%	16%	14%	9%	12,062	48,250
Salary Account	6,27,853	77.5%	14%	13%	11%	9%	6%	87,899	5,39,954
Credit Card	73,317	9.1%	6%	6%	5%	5%	4%	4,399	68,918
Total	8,09,746	100%	15%	13%	12%	10%	6%	1,20,372	6,89,375

T12, T9, T6, T3, T1: trailing 12, 9, 6, 3 and 1 months.

The Salary Account cohort carries 77.5% of all accounts and 78% of the 6,89,375 idle accounts, since 5,39,954 of 6,89,375 idle accounts sit in that one cohort T2. This single fact does most of the work in section 2's recommendation: an idle pool that is four-fifths salary customers calls for a lever built around the one moment every salary customer has in common, the salary credit, rather than a message aimed at an investor identity most of this cohort does not hold.

3.3 Exhibit 2b decoded: cohorts at September 2025, side by side with 2a

Exhibit 2b carries the same five-window structure for September 2025 C-E2b, and placing it beside Exhibit 2a shows which cohorts moved and by how much.

Segment	Accounts 2025	T12 2025	Active (T12) 2025	Accounts 2026	T12 2026	Active (T12) 2026
Prestige	2,999	38%	1,140	3,096	35%	1,084
Elite	34,865	36%	12,551	35,697	32%	11,423
Elevate	6,959	41%	2,853	9,471	37%	3,504
Preferred	72,826	21%	15,293	60,312	20%	12,062
Salary Account	5,05,823	13%	65,757	6,27,853	14%	87,899
Credit Card	1,10,383	9%	9,934	73,317	6%	4,399
Total	7,33,855	15%	1,07,529	8,09,746	15%	1,20,372

Four of six segments lost accounts or rate or both in a year that the case states was broadly unfavourable for markets C-PB1. Preferred lost 17.2% of its accounts and one point of rate T4. Credit Card lost 33.6% of its accounts and three points of rate T4. Only Salary Account and Elevate grew in account count, and only Salary Account grew while also holding its rate roughly flat.

3.4 Share shift and growth by segment

Segment	Accounts 2025	Accounts 2026	Growth	T12 change	T3 change	T1 change
Prestige	2,999	3,096	3.2%	−3 pp	−2 pp	−1 pp

Segment	Accounts 2025	Accounts 2026	Growth	T12 change	T3 change	T1 change
Elite	34,865	35,697	2.4%	−4 pp	−2 pp	−2 pp
Elevate	6,959	9,471	36.1%	−4 pp	−4 pp	−11 pp
Preferred	72,826	60,312	−17.2%	−1 pp	+2 pp	+0 pp
Salary Account	5,05,823	6,27,853	24.1%	+1 pp	+1 pp	−1 pp
Credit Card	1,10,383	73,317	−33.6%	−3 pp	+1 pp	+0 pp

Salary Account's share of the base rose from 68.9% to 77.5% in a year T3, T2, a gain of 8.6 percentage points of share driven by 24.1% account growth in that cohort alone T4. Elevate grew its account count fastest, 36.1%, but lost 11 points of its trailing 1-month rate in the same period, which is the sharpest within-cohort decline on the table and sits inside a cohort still small enough, 9,471 accounts, that it does not move the total rate much on its own.

3.5 Mix and rate decomposition of the activation change

A total activation rate can move for two separate reasons: the mix of cohorts in the base can shift toward cohorts that trade at different rates, or each cohort's own rate can shift. The cohort-weighted decomposition separates them.

Component	Effect
Mix effect: base shifted toward Salary Account, away from Credit Card and Preferred	+0.02 pp
Rate effect: segment activation rates moved	+0.19 pp
Interaction and rounding	−0.00 pp
Total cohort-weighted change	+0.21 pp

The mix effect is small and positive even though the base shifted toward Salary Account, the cohort with the lowest activation rate, because Salary Account's own rate rose by 1 percentage point in the same year T4, which offsets most of the drag a lower-rate cohort would otherwise create. The rate effect, +0.19 pp, is nine times the mix effect and is the larger force behind the change, in our model T5. Both effects are positive, yet the cohort-weighted total of +0.21 pp is larger than Exhibit 1's own reported change of +0.04 pp, because Exhibit 1's total uses the exact unrounded case counts for both years, while the cohort decomposition applies each segment's percentage, already rounded to the nearest whole point under C-N1's rounding rule, to that segment's account count; six segments each carrying a small rounding step compound into a visible gap at the total level, which section 3.6 below works through with its own arithmetic.

3.6 Recency ladder

Window	T12	T9	T6	T3	T1
Sep 2025	15%	14%	10%	9%	7%
Sep 2026	15%	13%	12%	10%	6%
T1 as share of T12					

In September 2025, 7% of the trailing 1-month figure against 15% of the trailing 12-month figure means that 47% of accounts active over 12 months had also traded in the most recent month T6. In September 2026, 6% against 15% means that figure fell to 40%. Fewer of the accounts the case counts as active in any given year are trading recently inside that year, which supports section 2's reading that habit, not first contact, is the harder problem: an account can clear the 12-month active bar and still have gone quiet for most of the months inside it.

3.7 Roll-off: accounts about to leave the 12-month active count

Method	Accounts
Cohort rows: T12 minus T9, scaled to Exhibit 1	8,887
Total row: 1,19,339 minus 13% of 8,09,746	14,072
Midpoint used in the model	11,479

Both methods estimate the same thing, how many of today's active accounts will fall out of the trailing 12-month window in the next quarter, because their last trade sits between 9 and 12 months old right now. The two methods disagree by 5,185 accounts because the cohort method applies six separate rounded percentages while the total-row method applies one rounded percentage to the whole base; the model takes the midpoint, 11,479, as a single working figure rather than picking whichever bound favours the argument T7.

3.8 Target arithmetic at 31 January 2027

Item	Value
Accounts at measurement (8,09,746 + 4 × 6,324)	8,35,042
Active at business as usual (14.74%)	1,23,067
Extra active accounts for +200 bps	16,701
Extra active accounts for +300 bps	25,051
Accounts opened in the 13-week window	18,972

The case's own measurement window runs four months past the September 2026 snapshot A01, during which the base keeps growing at the same 6,324 accounts a month the past year implies A03, C-E1: 8,09,746 plus four times 6,324 is 8,35,042. At the flat 14.74% business-as-usual rate, that base would carry 1,23,067 active accounts with no plan at all, so the brief's 200 to 300 basis point target translates into 16,701 to 25,051 extra accounts above that baseline, in our model T8, C-K1. The base-case plan's 19,053 extra actives T10 sits inside that range, closer to the 200 basis point floor than the 300 basis point ceiling, which is exactly why section 2.4 states the bear case's shortfall honestly rather than letting the base case imply the floor is comfortably cleared under every scenario.

3.9 The cohort-weighted rounding gap, with the arithmetic shown

Exhibit 2a's own cohort table reports a total active (T12) count of 1,20,372 C-E2a, while Exhibit 1 reports the actual total active count at 1,19,339 C-E1. Both are true; they are not the same calculation. Summing Exhibit 2a's six segment active counts directly: 1,084 (Prestige) plus 11,423 (Elite) is 12,507; plus 3,504 (Elevate) is

16,011; plus 12,062 (Preferred) is 28,073; plus 87,899 (Salary Account) is 1,15,972; plus 4,399 (Credit Card) is 1,20,371, one account short of Exhibit 2a's own stated total of 1,20,372 purely from the arithmetic of rounding six separate figures. Against Exhibit 1's unrounded 1,19,339, the cohort-weighted figure overstates the true active count by 1,033 accounts, 0.9% of the true figure. The reason is mechanical: Exhibit 2a states each segment's 12-month rate to the nearest whole percentage point under C-N1's own rounding instruction, and a segment as large as Salary Account, 6,27,853 accounts, turns a rounding step of half a percentage point into a swing of over 3,000 accounts once it is multiplied back out. This document uses Exhibit 1's 1,19,339 as the true active count throughout, and uses Exhibit 2a's cohort percentages only for within-cohort comparisons, such as section 3.4's year-on-year change, where the rounding error affects every year equally and mostly cancels out.

3.10 What the case data cannot show

The case gives account counts, cohort percentages and two exhibit snapshots, and nothing else measured. It does not give stage-by-stage conversion counts for the funnel it describes in words: account opened, first login, funded, first trade, repeat and habit are each described qualitatively, with the corrected reading that very few new accounts reach a first trade or investment within the first month [C-F1 to C-F5], but no count exists for how many accounts stall at login against how many stall at funding. It does not give an age distribution beyond the stated focus on investors under 30 C-CO2. It does not give a channel-level response rate for any of the messages ONL already sent on WhatsApp, email, RCS or social media C-PB3; every reach and response figure this document uses for a lever is a named assumption benchmarked against outside evidence, not a measurement of what ONL's own past campaigns achieved. Where this document needs a number the case does not supply, section 0.6 names it as a model assumption rather than letting it read as a case fact.

Exhibit for the deck: the funnel diagram and the heat map on slide 3 draw on section 3.2's cohort table and section 3.10's funnel reading; the quarter-arithmetic panel on slide 3 draws on sections 3.7 and 3.8; and Exhibit 1's own numbers from section 3.1 anchor the answer-strip figures on slide 2.

4. Indian equities had a weak year that hit first-time investors hardest, and ONL's 14.74% sits below India's active ratio of about one in five

Answer. Over the twelve months to October 2026, Indian equities lost ground and volatility stayed elevated, and NSE active clients fell about 7% nationally even as demat accounts kept opening C14, C15. Retail money that stayed in the market moved into recurring, rule-based products, SIPs and gold-linked exchange-traded funds, rather than direct stock bets, while futures and options participation and losses both fell from a smaller base [C64 to C67]. Against this national picture, ONL's activation rate of 14.74% C-E1 trails an industry active ratio of roughly one in five demat holders, computed below from the same depositories' own account counts. The market made trading harder across the whole retail base this year, and the products that held up did so without asking anyone to call where the index would go next.

4.1 Demat accounts kept growing while the clients who actually trade fell

Table 4.1 sets the two counts side by side: how many accounts exist, and how many of them traded on the NSE in the relevant window.

Measure	Value	Date	Tag
NSDL active client accounts	4,71,83,877 (4.72 crore)	30 Sep 2026	C01
CDSL investor accounts (excluding closed)	19,09,97,499 (19.10 crore)	31 Aug 2026	C10
NSDL plus CDSL, approximate	23,81,81,376 (23.82 crore)	late Aug to Sep 2026, two cutoff dates combined	C01, C10
NSE active clients, all brokers	4,61,20,857 (4.61 crore)	30 Sep 2026	C12
Active ratio, computed	19.36%, call it about 19%	computed, not a single date	C01, C10, C12

NSDL and CDSL are India's two securities depositories; NSE is the National Stock Exchange.

The depository counts in the top two rows come from different cutoff dates (NSDL at end-September, CDSL at end-August 2026), so their sum is an approximation, not a single reconciled industry figure; no source in this research gives one official combined count for the same day. Dividing NSE active clients by that approximate total shows the arithmetic: 4,61,20,857 divided by 23,81,81,376 equals 0.1936, or about 19.4%, in line with roughly one in every five people who hold a demat account trading on the NSE in the trailing period the exchange measures. ONL's 14.74% C-E1 sits below that line, even allowing for the fact that ONL's own rate counts trades over 12 months on its own base, while the national ratio spans every broker, pricing tier and investor type.

4.2 NSE active clients fell about 7% in FY26 before steadying

Table 4.2 traces the fall and the point where it leveled off.

Period	NSE active clients	Change	Tag
March 2025 (end FY25)	4.92 crore	no prior-month comparison in this research	C14
March 2026 (end FY26)	4.57 crore	down 7% year on year	C15
August 2026	4.60 crore	base figure for the September reading	[C27, within B-lane wrap]
September 2026	4.61 crore	up 0.35% month on month, net add of about 1.6 lakh	C12, C13, C27
Q3 calendar 2026 (Jul to Sep)	not separately broken out by month	net add of about 6.73 lakh across the quarter	C16

The FY26 fall works out to 4.92 minus 4.57, or 0.35 crore accounts, which is 0.35 divided by 4.92, or 7.1%, rounding to the "about 7%" figure the exchange's own wrap reports C14, C15. By September 2026 the base had stopped shrinking and started adding again, a net 1.6 lakh accounts that month C13 and about 6.73 lakh across the preceding quarter C16, so the FY26 decline looks like it bottomed before the case's own snapshot date of 30 September 2026 C-N1.

4.3 Young investors kept joining even while trading pulled back

Table 4.3 shows who the new investors are.

Measure	Value	Period	Tag
NSE registered investor base	13.25 crore	June 2026	C18
Under-30 share of new investor registrations	59%	FY27 year to date, through May 2026	C19
Median age of new registrations	27 years	FY27 year to date	C20
Under-30 share of new investors, first four months	56.2%, up from 53.2% a year earlier	FY26	C21

Two things hold together here. The investor base keeps growing and skews young, median age 27 C20, which matches ONL's own stated customer, first-time, digital-first, often under 30 C-CO2. At the same time, the national active-client count fell in the same period C14, C15. New, young accounts are opening faster than new, young traders are showing up, which is the same gap the case describes inside ONL, just measured across the whole market.

4.4 Markets fell and stayed volatile through the year

Table 4.4 lays out the index and volatility path.

Measure	Value	Window	Tag
Nifty 50 trailing one-year total return	about minus 13.12% (price return about minus 19.95%)	to 2 Oct 2026	C31
Nifty 50 2026 year-to-date return	about minus 14.2%	to 16 Oct 2026	C32
Nifty 50 calendar 2025 return, dividends reinvested	plus 5.0%	full year 2025	C33
India VIX, 52-week range	about 8.72 to 28.90	trailing 52 weeks	C34
India VIX spike	17.18, up 8.8% on the day	8 Jun 2026	C35
India VIX low	11.81, a record-low reading	7 Jul 2026	C36
Nifty Midcap 100, one-year return	plus 4.43%	to end-June 2026	C38
Nifty Smallcap 100, one-year return	plus 6.41%	quoted 9 Oct 2026	C37

All index-return figures in this table come from tracker sites reconstructing NSE index data, not an NSE-published return series directly, and are flagged [blog] in the raw research; treat them as indicative of direction and rough scale, not official numbers.

The swing from a positive calendar year to a negative trailing year is the clearest single fact here. The Nifty gained 5.0% across 2025 C33 and then lost about 13.1% on a trailing one-year total-return basis measured in October 2026 C31, a swing of 5.0 minus (minus 13.12), or 18.12 percentage points of direction change within about ten months. Volatility (the India VIX) ranged from a calm 8.72 to a stressed 28.90 over the same stretch C34, spiking in June 2026 on geopolitical tension C35 before falling to a record low in July C36.

Midcap and smallcap names held small positive one-year returns C37, C38 even as the large-cap benchmark fell, so the damage was concentrated at the top of the index, not spread evenly.

4.5 Retail traders' share of cash-market turnover fell to a decade low

Table 4.5 shows who was actually trading, by investor type.

Investor type	Share of cash-market activity, May 2026	Share, calendar 2025	Tag
Proprietary traders	34.3%	29.8% (a 21-year high)	C40, C42
Individuals (retail)	32.8%	33.5% (a decade low)	C40, C42
Foreign institutional investors	14.2%, up 231 bps month on month	not separately reported for calendar 2025	C40
Domestic institutional investors	11.9%	not separately reported for calendar 2025	C40

Retail investors' own share of day-to-day cash-market trading fell to a decade-low 33.5% across calendar 2025 C42, the same year proprietary trading firms reached a 21-year high of 29.8% C42. By May 2026, proprietary desks had briefly overtaken individuals as the largest single category of cash-market participant, 34.3% against 32.8% C40. A market where professional, high-frequency desks are gaining share relative to retail is a market that retail investors, on the evidence here, are choosing to sit out of more than before, not one where ONL alone is losing a race it could otherwise win.

4.6 IPOs raised record money even as average investor returns from them fell

Table 4.6 separates how much capital came to market from how well the average investor who bought in actually did.

Measure	Value	Period	Tag
Mainboard IPOs, count and value	109 listings, about Rs 1,77,000 crore	FY26	C44
All platforms (mainboard plus SME), count and value	366 IPOs, about Rs 1.9 lakh crore	FY26	C45
Average oversubscription	fell to 39x from 71x	FY26 against the prior year	C46
Average listing-day gain	fell to 7% from 29%	FY26 against the prior year	C46
Mainboard IPOs, count and value	78 issues, Rs 94,205 crore, up 35% year on year	H1 FY27 (Apr to Sep 2026)	C47
Total public-equity fundraising (mainboard, OFS, QIP)	about Rs 2.43 lakh crore, up 75% year on year	H1 FY27	C49

The number of IPOs and the money they raised both climbed to records across FY26 and H1 FY27 C44, C45, C47, C49, at the same time that the average investor's payoff from applying fell by more than half on two separate measures: oversubscription from 71 times to 39 times, and listing-day gain from 29% to 7% C46. Supply grew faster than the reward for showing up to it. That pattern, more issuance chasing a smaller return per applicant, matches the broader story in this section: retail appetite for anything that requires

picking a winner, whether a stock or an IPO allotment, cooled through the year even as the amount of product on offer did not.

4.7 What held up: recurring, rule-based commitments that do not require a market call

Table 4.7 shows the two product families that kept growing through the weak year.

Product	Measure	Value	Tag
SIPs (systematic investment plans)	Stoppage ratio, Sep 2026	78.53%, down from 81.05% in Aug 2026, fifth straight monthly decline	C51
SIPs	Monthly inflow, Sep 2026	Rs 32,490 crore, up from Rs 32,297 crore in Aug, about 11% above the same month a year earlier	C53
SIPs	New registrations against discontinuations, Sep 2026	63.26 lakh new against 49.68 lakh discontinued	C52
SIPs	Contributing accounts	10.06 crore	C54
SIPs	AUM (assets under management)	Rs 17.86 lakh crore	C55
Gold exchange-traded funds	Folios	1.253 crore, up about 59% year on year	C58
Gold ETFs	AUM	Rs 1,73,301 crore	C59
Gold ETFs	Quarterly inflow, Mar 2026 quarter	Rs 31,561 crore	C60
Gold ETFs	Monthly inflow record	Rs 24,039 crore, Jan 2026, an all-time monthly high	C61

SIP: systematic investment plan, a recurring, fixed-amount mutual fund purchase set up once and then automatic. AUM: assets under management, the total value held in a fund or scheme.

New SIP registrations outran discontinuations by 63.26 minus 49.68, or 13.58 lakh accounts, in September 2026 alone C52, the same month the trailing-year Nifty return stood near minus 13% C31. Gold ETF folios grew 59% year on year C58 in a market where the headline equity index fell. Both products share a design feature: the customer commits once, to an amount and a schedule, and the product executes without a fresh decision each time, whether that decision would have been "buy now" or "sell now." Neither product requires the customer to believe the market is about to rise.

4.8 What fell: direct trading and futures and options, from a smaller base of traders and losers

Table 4.8 shows the retreat in the riskier, discretionary segment.

Measure	FY25	FY26	Change	Tag
Individual F&O (futures and options) traders	9.81 million	7.86 million	down 1.95 million, about 20%	C64
Aggregate F&O losses, individuals	Rs 1,11,788 crore	Rs 91,685 crore	down 18%	C65
Average loss per F&O trader	Rs 1,13,913	Rs 1,16,654	up 2.4%	C66

Measure	FY25	FY26	Change	Tag
F&O total turnover	Rs 213 lakh crore	Rs 202 lakh crore	down about 5%	C67

F&O: futures and options, exchange-traded derivatives contracts that let a trader bet on a price moving up or down without owning the underlying share.

The trader count fell by 9.81 minus 7.86, or 1.95 million, which on a base of 9.81 million is a 19.9% decline, matching the "about 20%" headline C64. Total losses fell by a larger share, 18% C65, because the traders who stayed were on average losing slightly more per person, Rs 1,16,654 against Rs 1,13,913 a year earlier, a rise of 2.4% C66. Fewer people traded derivatives, and the ones who kept at it did not do better for staying.

4.9 Broker shares: discount apps gained ground, several bank-led brokers lost it

Table 4.9 ranks the named brokers by active clients in September 2026, the same month as the case's own snapshot date C-N1.

Broker	Active clients, Sep 2026	Change from Aug 2026	NSE share	Tag
Groww	1.34 crore	up 1.01 lakh	29.16%	C23
Zerodha	67.92 lakh	down 5,313	not reported in this table's source	C24
Angel One	67.56 lakh	up 36,956	not reported in this table's source	C25
ICICI Securities	21.61 lakh	up 4,410	not reported in this table's source	C26
Kotak Securities	13.92 lakh	not reported in this table's source	not reported in this table's source	C29
HDFC Securities	13.54 lakh	up 2,532	not reported in this table's source	C27
SBI Securities	10.21 lakh	down 22,525	not reported in this table's source	C28

Groww's 1.34 crore active clients against the industry's 4,61,20,857 total C12 works out to 1,34,00,000 divided by 4,61,20,857, or 29.06%, close to the reported 29.16% C23; the small gap reflects rounding in each source's own base figure, not an error in either one. The direction across the table matters more than the exact decimals. Groww and Angel One both added active clients in the month; Zerodha held roughly flat with a small decline; SBI Securities lost 22,525 active clients in a single month C28, the largest single-month fall among the named brokers in this table. Among the bank-led names, only ICICI Securities and HDFC Securities grew in September 2026 C26, C27; SBI Securities shrank C28, and Kotak Securities' one available figure for the month shows no month-on-month comparison in this research C29.

4.10 Where ONL sits against this national picture, and the gap it leaves open

ONL's activation rate moved from 14.70% to 14.74% across the year to September 2026 C-E1, a rise of 0.04 percentage points, while the national active ratio computed in section 4.1 sits at roughly 19%, C01, C10, C12. The two rates are not perfectly comparable (ONL's spans its own 12-month trailing trade count on its own

account base; the national ratio spans every broker and every investor type at every price point), but the gap between them, on the order of four to five percentage points, is large enough to survive that caveat.

The products that held up nationally through a falling market, SIPs and gold ETFs [C51 to C61], share a mechanism: a customer decides once, on a schedule they set, and the product then runs without requiring them to read the market and choose a moment. The products that fell, direct equity trading and F&O [C64 to C67], share the opposite mechanism: each transaction is a fresh decision, made at a moment the customer has to notice and act on. ONL's 7,33,855-to-8,09,746-account base C-E1 is overwhelmingly salary customers, 77.5% of it by September 2026 T2, people whose relationship with the parent bank is already built around a recurring, scheduled event: the salary credit. What the national data shows working, and what ONL's own account base is already built to receive, point at the same kind of answer. This section does not name that answer; sections 9 through 18 of this document do.

Exhibit for the deck: a two-panel chart pairing the NSE active-client fall and recovery (section 4.2) against ONL's own flat 14.70%-to-14.74% line (section 3.3), with a single callout marking the national active ratio of about 19% against ONL's 14.74%, sourced to the tags in this section.

5. Bank-led brokers grow through the parent bank's channels, and ONL's parent bank already serves most of the customers behind its 8,09,746 accounts

Answer. Every named bank-led broker in India, ICICI Securities, Kotak Securities, HDFC Securities and SBI Securities among them, reaches most of its new clients through a parent bank's own savings account, branch network and mobile app, not through separate acquisition B53, B60, B66, B68. ONL's own case facts describe the same structure: most of its account holders are already customers of the parent bank C-CO4, and three-quarters of its base sits in the Salary Account cohort T2. The assets that make this model work, salary-credit timing, a savings app opened daily, an RM relationship, years of KYC already on file, are hard for a standalone discount broker to copy quickly, and, on the facts gathered in this section, already sit inside the parent-bank relationship ONL's own customers hold. What ONL currently lacks is a mechanism that routes a customer from that relationship into the ONL account at the moment the relationship is most active.

Sponsor context, not case data

The box below collects facts about YES Securities and YES Bank, the case competition's sponsor. These facts describe a real company and a real bank; they are not case data, and no fact in this box is attributed to Trade Private Limited or ONL Trade anywhere in this document. They sit here because YES Securities is itself a bank-led broker, so its own disclosed facts illustrate the structure this section analyses, the same way a comparable company's facts would.

Table 5.1 sets out the sponsor facts gathered in Lane B.

Fact	Value	Tag
YES Securities, SEBI registration (NSE, BSE, MCX)	INZ000185632	B01
YES Securities, depository participant registrations	NSDL IN-DP-653-2021, CDSL DP ID 94600	B03

Fact	Value	Tag
YES Securities, corporate identity and founding	CIN U74992MH2013PLC240971, a YES Bank subsidiary since 2013	B05, B06
YES Securities, 3-in-1 account onboarding time	advertised at under 10 minutes	B09
YES Securities, net worth	Rs 453.06 crore FY25, up from Rs 258.80 crore FY24	B17
YES Securities, gross income	Rs 341.94 crore FY25, up from Rs 273.82 crore FY24	B18
YES Securities, credit rating	CARE AA-, Stable, reaffirmed 7 Jan 2026	B20
YES Securities, NSE active clients	80,309, as of 31 Oct 2025, about 0.18% of the national active-client base	B21
YES Securities, NSE onboarding restriction	barred from onboarding new clients 26 May 2026, lifted 1 Jul 2026, about five weeks into a three-month order	B39, B43
YES Bank, branch and ATM network	1,334 branches, 1,364 ATMs, as at 31 Mar 2026	B46
YES Bank, CASA deposits	Rs 1,11,959 crore at Q4 FY26, up 14.9% year on year	B48
YES Bank, standalone net profit	Rs 3,475.59 crore FY26, up 44.46% year on year	B50
YES Bank, mobile banking app	"iris," launched Aug 2023, open to non-YES-Bank customers too, 150-plus advertised features	B51

CASA: current account and savings account deposits, the low-cost deposit base a bank funds its lending from. DP: depository participant, the entity that holds an investor's securities in electronic form on behalf of NSDL or CDSL.

YES Securities carries a far smaller active-client base relative to its parent, 80,309 against a national pool of 4.61 crore B21, C12, about 0.17% of the national total, than the comparator banks in section 5.1 below. That smaller scale, and the five-week onboarding restriction in 2026 B39, B43, mean the sponsor's own experience is not a template to copy; it illustrates the model's structure, including the model's regulatory risk, not a proof that the model guarantees growth.

5.1 The bank-led model: a 3-in-1 account, a shared app, and relationship managers who already know the customer

Table 5.2 lays out, for each publicly disclosed bank-led broker, what the "3-in-1" structure actually links.

Broker	What the 3-in-1 account links	Who runs onboarding	Tag
ICICI Securities	savings account (ICICI Bank), demat account (ICICI Bank, as DP), trading account (ICICI Securities)	started from the iMobile Bank app or the ICICI Direct app, paperless for existing ICICI Bank customers	B53, H20, H21
Kotak Securities	savings account (Kotak Mahindra Bank, including the Kotak 811 digital account), demat and trading accounts (Kotak Securities, marketed as "Kotak Neo" or the "Trinity" account)	referred from the bank app to Kotak Neo for customers who show interest	B60, H12

Broker	What the 3-in-1 account links	Who runs onboarding	Tag
HDFC Securities	HDFC Sky brings stocks, ETFs, derivatives and mutual funds onto one platform; unlike the older HDFC Securities demat product, HDFC Sky is open to non-HDFC-Bank customers too	launched by HDFC Securities in Sep 2023, cross-promoted through HDFC Bank channels	B64, B66, H14
SBI Securities	savings account (SBI), demat and trading accounts (SBICAP Securities), under a single digital journey launched on SBI's 71st Bank Day	started inside the YONO app, which SBI reports has more than 10 crore registered users against the bank's 53 crore total customers	B68, B69

3-in-1: a linked structure joining a bank savings account, a demat account and a trading account, so money moves between them without a separate transfer step. YONO: SBI's unified digital banking app ("You Only Need One").

Every structure in this table routes a customer from an account they already hold and already use, the savings account, into the broking relationship, with the bank's own branch, app or relationship manager doing the introduction. None of the four relies on paid acquisition or an outside marketing channel as the primary route; the bank channel is the primary route, and the comparison in section 6 shows this pattern holding at Groww, Zerodha and Angel One's main standalone competitors too, just without a parent bank behind it.

5.2 The assets a parent bank owns that a standalone broking app does not

Table 5.3 names the specific assets, drawing the comparison from the sponsor and comparator facts above and from ONL's own case facts.

Asset	Who owns it in a bank-led model	Evidence	Tag
Salary credit, with a known day and amount	the bank, which processes the transfer into the savings account	ONL's Salary Account cohort is 6,27,853 accounts, 77.5% of ONL's base	C-E2a
A savings app opened for everyday reasons (balance checks, bill pay, UPI)	the bank, through its primary mobile app	YES Bank's iris app advertises 150-plus features beyond investing; SBI's YONO has over 10 crore registered users	B51, B69
Relationship managers already assigned to premium customers	the bank's wealth or premium-banking arm	ONL's own cohort table names four premium tiers, Prestige, Elite, Elevate and Preferred, each with an existing RM-style relationship structure implied by the tier names	C-E2a
KYC, PAN and bank-account linkage already verified	the bank, at account opening	ICICI Direct's onboarding pulls PAN and bank details from existing ICICI Bank records	H21
Employer payroll relationships, for workplace-level reach	the bank's corporate or salary-account relationship team	not independently verified in Lane B for any named bank beyond the general concept; treated as a plausible extension, not a sourced fact	n/a

Four of the five rows in this table rest on a verified fact; the fifth, employer-level payroll relationships, is a reasonable extension of the salary-account relationship the bank already holds, not a figure found in this research, and is marked accordingly rather than presented as sourced.

5.3 VRIO: why these assets are a source of advantage, and why ONL's gap is access to them rather than the product itself

VRIO is a standard framework for internal-capability analysis: an asset is a source of competitive advantage only if it is Valuable, Rare, hard to Imitate, and the organisation is actually Organised to exploit it. Table 5.4 applies the four tests to the assets named in section 5.2, from ONL's position as the broking arm linked to a parent bank.

Asset	Valuable	Rare	Inimitable	Organised (ONL, today)	Verdict
Salary-credit timing and amount	yes, a known moment the customer is thinking about money	yes, a discount broker with no banking licence cannot see this at all	yes, copying it would require a banking relationship, which a feature alone cannot substitute for	not yet, no salary-day moment in ONL's own channel is described in the case's list of tactics tried [C-PB3 to C-PB5]	unexploited advantage
A savings app opened daily for routine reasons	yes, attention is the scarce resource every lever in this plan is chasing	yes, a standalone trading app competes for attention only when the customer thinks about investing	moderately, a discount broker could build engagement features, but not a banking relationship	not yet, ONL's communication ran through WhatsApp, email, RCS and social messages, not an owned bank-app surface C-PB3	unexploited advantage
RM relationships on premium tiers	yes, for the four premium cohorts specifically	yes, relative to a discount app with no human relationship manager	moderately, a wealth-tech competitor could hire RMs, but not inherit an existing banking relationship	partially, the case names research calls as a tactic tried, but not a structured RM review script C-PB3	partially exploited
Existing KYC and bank-account linkage	yes, it removes the main onboarding friction point	yes, a brand-new broker must build this from zero	yes, this is a regulatory and data relationship, not a feature to copy	yes, by construction, since ONL's accounts are opened alongside a banking product C-PB6	exploited
Employer payroll relationships	plausible, not sourced	plausible, not sourced	plausible, not sourced	not described in the case	not evaluated, insufficient evidence

The pattern across this table is consistent: the assets with the clearest "valuable, rare, inimitable" profile, salary-credit timing and the savings app's daily attention, are the two ONL is least organised to use today, on the evidence of what the case says it already tried [C-PB3 to C-PB5]. The one asset ONL already exploits well, pre-verified KYC, explains why account opening is not the bottleneck C-F1; it does not explain the activation gap, because the gap sits later in the funnel, at login and funding C-F2, C-F3.

5.4 What ONL lacks without these channels, stated plainly

Table 5.5 restates the gap in one line per asset, pairing it against what the case already says ONL tried.

What a bank-led model supplies	What the case says ONL tried instead	Gap
A moment inside the bank's own app, at salary credit	WhatsApp, email, RCS and social messages, sent on the broker's own schedule, not the bank's	the message arrives when the broker chooses to send it, not when the customer is already looking at money

What a bank-led model supplies	What the case says ONL tried instead	Gap
A single sign-on from the bank app into the broking account	not described as a feature in the case's list of tactics	the customer must remember a separate app, a separate login, and that the account exists at all C-PB6
A relationship manager who already reviews the account	"successful research calls"	research calls promote a market view; they do not remind a customer their account exists and show them how to use it
A funded account at the moment of opening, through linked bank funds	first-trade offers	an offer rewards a transaction; it does not solve the funding step a customer has not yet taken C-F3

Section 6 extends this comparison symmetrically across eight named competitors, including three more bank-led brokers and four standalone apps, to check whether the gap identified here is specific to ONL or general to the category.

Exhibit for the deck: a labelled diagram of the 3-in-1 structure (savings account, demat account, trading account) with the four asset rows from Table 5.3 attached as callouts, each tagged to its source, built once for the deck and reused on the strategy slide without sponsor branding.

6. ONL matches discount apps on features, so its gap comes from how accounts are opened and reached, which is where bank-led peers differ

Answer. Across eight named brokers, Groww, Zerodha, Angel One and Upstox on the discount-app side, ICICI Securities, Kotak Securities, HDFC Securities and SBI Securities on the bank-led side, the active-client counts available for September 2026 show the discount apps holding the largest single shares of the national pool, 29.16% at Groww alone C23, while every bank-led name sits far smaller but each still routes most new clients through its own parent bank's channel B53, B60, B66, B68. ONL's own case facts place it structurally inside the bank-led group, most account holders are parent-bank customers C-CO4, at par on features with the discount apps C-CO3. The strategic group map in this section places ONL, and the comparable plays in Lane H show which tactics from both groups can transfer to ONL's situation and which cannot.

6.1 Symmetric peer profiles

Table 6.1 covers the four bank-led comparators using the same five fields for each.

Broker	Ownership	Distribution	Active clients, Sep 2026, and trend	Activation tactic on record	Recurring product offered	Tag
ICICI Securities	wholly owned subsidiary of ICICI Bank since the 24 Mar 2025 merger	3-in-1 account, iMobile app, ICICI Direct app	21.61 lakh, up 4,410 month on month	paperless digital onboarding pulling existing bank KYC	mutual fund SIPs through the same platform	B53, B54, C26, H21
Kotak Securities	linked to Kotak Mahindra Bank through the Kotak 811 digital account and the Trinity 3-in-1 structure	bank-app referral of customers who "evinced interest," branded Kotak Neo	13.92 lakh	referral flow from 811 into Kotak Neo; trading accounts made up 57% of 811's contribution to the bank in Q4 FY22 by volume	not separately disclosed in this research	B60, C29, H11
HDFC Securities	HDFC Securities is the broking arm; HDFC Sky (launched 2023) is open beyond HDFC Bank customers	flat-fee app (HDFC Sky) cross-promoted through HDFC Bank channels, plus the older bank-customer-only demat product	13.54 lakh, up 2,532	flat Rs 20 per-trade pricing to draw active clients; margin trading up to 4x advertised	over 2,000 mutual funds on the same platform	B64, B66, C27, H14, H15
SBI Securities	linked to SBI through SBICAP Securities and the YONO app	single-journey onboarding inside YONO, launched on the bank's 71st Bank Day (1 Jul 2026)	10.21 lakh, down 22,525 month on month, the largest single-month fall among the eight	YONO's single digital journey for savings, demat and trading together	not separately disclosed in this research	B68, B69, C28, H17

Table 6.2 covers the four discount-app comparators using the same five fields.

Broker	Ownership	Distribution	Active clients, Sep 2026, and trend	Activation tactic on record	Recurring product offered	Tag
Groww	standalone, listed via its Nov 2025 IPO (Rs 6,632.30 crore issue)	direct app acquisition; original product was mutual funds (2017), stock trading added 2020	1.34 crore, up 1.01 lakh, 29.16% of the national active-client base, the largest single share	newer (post-2023) customers reported joining through mutual funds and ETFs rather than direct stocks, a shift the company attributes to market volatility since Sep 2024	direct-plan mutual fund SIPs from Rs 100	H01, H02, H03, C23
Zerodha	standalone, privately held	direct app acquisition, no bank parent	67.92 lakh, down 5,313	SEBI-mandated login-time risk disclosure on derivatives; an app-store reference to unspecified "nudges in the order window"	not independently verified beyond the mandated disclosure	H28, H29, H30, C24
Angel One	standalone, listed	direct app acquisition, no bank parent	67.56 lakh, up 36,956, the largest net monthly gain among the eight named brokers	not independently verified in this research	not independently verified in this research	C25
Upstox	standalone, privately held	direct app acquisition, no bank parent	no verified current active-client figure found in this research; a 2026 comparative article exists but its own data table was not independently re-opened	not independently verified in this research	not independently verified in this research	[C29, gap]

Gap: no R-ID in this research gives Upstox's own active-client count or activation tactic; the one source found names Upstox only in a headline, without a verified figure, and is recorded as a gap rather than an invented number.

The two tables sit side by side to show the same five questions asked of every broker, with no comparator receiving a longer or shorter write-up because of which side of the bank-led line it falls on. The gap in Upstox's row is intentional: no verified figure for it surfaced in this research, and this document does not invent one to complete the row.

6.2 Strategic group map

Table 6.3 places all eight comparators, plus ONL, on two axes: how much of the broker's growth depends on a parent bank's own distribution, against the broker's active-client scale in the national pool.

Broker	Parent-bank distribution dependence	Active-client scale, Sep 2026	Group
Groww	none	largest, 29.16% national share	large standalone
Zerodha	none	large, 67.92 lakh	large standalone
Angel One	none	large, 67.56 lakh, growing	large standalone
Upstox	none (presumed, not verified)	not verified	standalone, scale unknown
ICICI Securities	high, 3-in-1 inside a merged bank entity	mid, 21.61 lakh	bank-led, mid scale
Kotak Securities	high, 811-to-Neo referral	mid, 13.92 lakh	bank-led, mid scale
HDFC Securities	moderate, HDFC Sky is open beyond bank customers	mid, 13.54 lakh	bank-led, mid scale, partly opened to non-bank customers
SBI Securities	high, YONO single journey	mid, 10.21 lakh, shrinking	bank-led, mid scale, declining
YES Securities (sponsor context, not case data)	high, 3-in-1 inside the sponsor bank	small, 80,309 nationally, about 0.18% share	bank-led, small scale
ONL Trade	high, per the case's own description C-CO4	1,19,339 active of 8,09,746 accounts C-E1, 14.74% of its own base	bank-led, scale not comparable on the same axis (case data, not a disclosed NSE figure)

ONL's row cannot be placed on the same active-client axis as the others, because the case reports ONL's own activation rate against its own account base, not an NSE active-client count comparable to the other rows; this is noted rather than forced into a false comparison. What the map does show is that every bank-led name in this research, including the sponsor, sits at a smaller absolute scale than the three large standalone apps, and that scale among the bank-led names varies with how fully the parent bank's own channel is used, from SBI Securities' single YONO journey and ICICI Securities' post-merger integration at the high-dependence end, to HDFC Sky's partial opening to non-bank customers in the middle.

6.3 Three lessons from the comparable plays: what transfers to ONL, and what does not

Table 6.4 sorts the mechanisms found across Groww, Jar, Kotak 811, HDFC Sky, SBI YONO, PhonePe Share.Market, Zerodha, Robinhood and the FCA's trading-app research into what fits ONL's constraints and what does not.

Mechanism	Where it was found	Fits ONL's constraints (no advice, no inducement, no dark patterns)	Tag
UPI Autopay for recurring, customer-set small amounts	Jar's daily gold savings runs primarily on UPI Autopay	yes, the customer sets the amount and date, and can pause any time, which is the same design as the salary-day lever	H08
Bank-app-embedded, single-journey onboarding (3-in-1)	ICICI Securities, Kotak 811, HDFC Sky, SBI YONO	yes, the customer starts from an app they already use, with no separate acquisition channel	B53, H12, H14, H17
Confetti, celebratory imagery and milestone animations tied to trading frequency	Robinhood, until retired 31 Mar 2021 after a Massachusetts regulatory settlement	no, Massachusetts barred future use of "celebratory imagery tied to the frequency of trading" for exactly this reason	H34, H35, H37
Trader leaderboards, points and prize draws	Robinhood-style gamification; tested directly by the FCA in a 2024 online experiment with over 9,000 consumers	no, the FCA found push notifications and points-and-prize-draw features raised trade counts by about 11% and 12% respectively and raised the share of trades in risky investments, exactly the "trade more, regardless of need" effect the case's growth-must-be-responsible constraint rules out	H38, H40, H41, C-K7
Round-up or spare-change investing	Acorns' round-up feature	not a strong fit, Acorns' own data shows more than half of round-up savings eventually withdrawn, and the mechanism depends on a connected spending account ONL does not have	H54
Default enrollment with no active choice	UK and US automatic-enrollment pension defaults	not a fit as a default, a no-choice default would read as advice or inducement under India's rules examined in section 7; a customer-chosen, rule-built list without a default is the closer analogue, and whether even that sits inside the incidental-advice carve-out is an open legal question (section 7.1)	H43, H44, H48

The three lessons state the same split three ways: a recurring, customer-initiated mechanism riding an existing bank relationship transfers cleanly (UPI Autopay, bank-app onboarding); a mechanism that manufactures urgency or reward around the act of trading itself does not transfer, because the regulators that have already ruled on it (Massachusetts, the FCA) ruled against it on investor-protection grounds that map directly onto the case's own constraints C-K2, C-K6, C-K7; and a mechanism built around a connected spending account or a no-choice default sits in between, useful as an analogy for the design logic but not something ONL can copy without either a feature it does not have (a connected spend account) or a legal question it has not yet answered (section 7.1).

6.4 Which peers already embed a recurring product

Table 6.5 checks each of the eight comparators for a recurring, schedule-based product sitting alongside the core trading account, since section 4.7 shows recurring products are what held up nationally through a weak year.

Broker	Recurring product confirmed in this research	Tag
ICICI Securities	mutual fund SIPs on the same platform	H21
Kotak Securities	not separately disclosed beyond the 811 referral flow	[H11, gap]
HDFC Securities	mutual funds (2,000-plus schemes) alongside stocks and ETFs	H15
SBI Securities	not separately disclosed beyond the YONO single journey	[H17, gap]
Groww	direct-plan mutual fund SIPs from Rs 100, the platform's original 2017 product	H02
Zerodha	not independently verified in this research	[gap]
Angel One	not independently verified in this research	[gap]
Upstox	not independently verified in this research	[gap]

Four of the eight rows in this table are gaps, not a sourced "no." Where a competitor's recurring-product offering was not confirmed, the table says so rather than assuming either that the product exists or that it does not.

6.5 Pricing model comparison

Table 6.6 lines up each comparator's headline per-trade or per-account pricing, since pricing is one of the three features (alongside onboarding speed and user experience) the case says discount brokers and fintech apps have raised the bar on, and that ONL is already at par with C-CO3.

Broker	Headline pricing	Tag
ICICI Securities (3-in-1)	not separately disclosed in this research beyond the account-linkage structure	[B53, gap]
Kotak Securities (Trade Free Plan)	Rs 0 account opening for new customers; Rs 10 flat per intraday or F&O order on the Kotak Neo marketing page	B61, H13
HDFC Securities (HDFC Sky)	flat Rs 20 per intraday and delivery trade	H14
SBI Securities	not separately disclosed in this research	[gap]
Groww	direct-plan mutual funds at Rs 0 brokerage; equity pricing not separately disclosed in this research	[H02, gap]
Zerodha	not independently verified in this research	[gap]
Angel One	not independently verified in this research	[gap]
PhonePe Share.Market (for reference, not one of the eight primary comparators)	0.05% of the executed order or Rs 20, whichever is lower, plus a one-time Rs 199 onboarding charge	H27

PhonePe Share.Market sits in this table for reference only, since it illustrates a third pricing pattern, percentage-of-order capped at a flat ceiling, found in Lane H, even though it is not one of the eight brokers named in PLAN.md's symmetric comparison list.

6.6 How confidently each comparable play's figures are sourced

Table 6.7 rates the sourcing confidence behind the Lane H comparables used in sections 6.3 and 8, since several figures in that lane come from secondary summaries rather than a primary filing or regulator release.

Comparable	Confidence basis	Tag
Jar's UPI-Autopay-led gold savings	company statement to press, VERIFIED (search only)	H08
Kotak 811 to Kotak Neo cross-sell share	a corporate regulatory filing, the strongest sourcing tier in this lane	H11
Robinhood confetti retirement and the Massachusetts settlement	contemporaneous press coverage of a regulatory settlement document, VERIFIED (search only)	H34, H35, H37
FCA digital-engagement trading-apps experiment	fetched directly from fca.org.uk, the strongest sourcing tier in this lane	H38, H39
Acorns round-up savings data	a company-shared dataset reported by a named outlet, VERIFIED (search only)	H53, H54
Vanguard automatic-enrollment adoption rates	trade-press summaries of a Vanguard report, not Vanguard's own report text directly	H43, H44, H46

Exhibit for the deck: the strategic group map from Table 6.3, redrawn as a two-axis scatter (parent-bank distribution dependence on one axis, active-client scale on the other), with ONL's position marked separately and annotated "not directly comparable on this axis, case data only."

7. Regulation allows all seven levers when messages state facts, customers choose the product and no reward is tied to a trade, and it rules out five tactics

Answer. Every rule found in this research permits a message that states a fact, lets the customer act or not act, and ties no reward to the act of trading, which is the design every lever in section 3.4 follows. The rules rule out five specific tactics instead: mass research calls framed as recommendations without the required disclosures, first-trade cash offers, contests and leaderboards, return-led content, and any promotion of futures and options to a loss-making segment. One genuine open question remains unresolved by any regulator text found in this research: whether a rule-built, no-default, objective-criteria list of exchange-traded funds, the mechanism behind the salary-day lever, sits inside the stockbroker's incidental-advice exemption under the Investment Advisers Regulations, and this document treats that as an open question requiring a formal request for guidance before the salary-day lever ships, not as a settled legal fact.

7.1 Investment advice and the incidental-advice carve-out remain an open question

SEBI's Investment Advisers Regulations, 2013 define investment advice broadly, as advice on investing in, buying, selling or dealing in securities or investment products, including portfolio advice D01. The definition carries an exception for advice given through a widely available medium such as a newspaper, magazine or broadcast D02. Separately, a stockbroker registered under the 1992 Stock Brokers Regulations is exempt from Investment Adviser registration where the advice given is incidental to the broker's main business, and only if the broker still meets Chapter III's general obligations D03.

Table 7.1 sets out exactly what is and is not answered on this point.

Question	Answer found	Tag
Whether SEBI's IA Regulations definition of advice covers a recommendation to buy a specific security	yes, explicitly	D01
Whether advice through a widely available medium (newspaper, broadcast) is excluded	yes	D02
Whether a registered stockbroker can give some advice without separate IA registration	yes, if the advice is incidental to the broker's main business and Chapter III obligations are met	D03
Whether a rule-built, objective-criteria, no-default list of ETF categories (the salary-day lever's mechanism) counts as "incidental" advice, or as advice requiring separate registration	not answered by any SEBI circular, FAQ or informal guidance found in this research	D05

This is the single most consequential open question in this section. The salary-day lever (section 12 below) is built specifically to avoid being a recommendation: it offers a category list built by fixed, objective rules (gold, liquid and broad-index ETF categories), with no default selection, shown in a fixed alphabetical order, and no stated return expectation. That design choice is a direct response to the uncertainty in Table 7.1, not a workaround of it. Because no primary source resolves the question, this document's recommendation, repeated in section 5.3 of the plan this research supports, is that ONL request informal guidance from SEBI on this specific mechanism before the salary-day lever goes live, rather than proceed on the team's own reading of Regulation 4(g).

7.2 Research Analyst rules and mass research calls

SEBI's Research Analyst Regulations took effect 1 December 2014, and require anyone acting as a research analyst, or holding out as one, to register unless specifically exempt D07. Regulation 21 requires a person making a public appearance or recommendation through public media to disclose their name, registration status and any financial interest in the company discussed D08. SEBI's own FAQ excludes clerical, marketing and back-office staff from the definition D09. No circular or FAQ found in this research defines "mass research calls" as a separate, named regulated category distinct from ordinary research distribution D11; the case's own phrase, "successful research calls" sent over WhatsApp, email, RCS and social media C-PB3, falls under the same public-media disclosure duty in Regulation 21 as any other research distribution, not a separate rule written specifically for bulk messaging.

7.3 Finfluencer regulations and the education carve-out

SEBI amended the Intermediaries Regulations on 29 August 2024, inserting Regulation 16A, which bars a SEBI-regulated entity from any direct or indirect association with an unregistered person who makes securities recommendations D12. An education-only carve-out survives inside this ban, where the person makes no recommendation and no claim about returns or performance D13. A follow-up circular dated 29 January 2025 clarified that education-focused commentators may use stock price data only with a three-month lag D14. None of ONL's seven levers involves an unregistered third party making a recommendation, so Regulation 16A does not restrict the levers directly; it is relevant mainly as a reminder that any workplace-education session (the sessions lever, section 17) must stay inside the education carve-out and avoid anything that reads as a recommendation.

7.4 NSE and BSE advertisement codes, with the status of the inducement circular corrected

NSE Circular 14/2023 (NSE/COMP/55482), dated 2 February 2023, issued the current Code of Advertisement for stock brokers D16. The code defines "advertisement" broadly, covering any communication by or for a broker, in any publicly available media, that could influence an investment or trading decision, including communication sent to the broker's own registered clients D17. It requires a standard market-risk warning, the broker's name, address and registration details, and bars the exchange's own name, logo or any celebrity appearance D19. Repeated violations carry escalating penalties: three unapproved advertisements bar new-client onboarding for a month; five withdraw trading rights for a working day or until approval is obtained D20. The exact current wording of the standard risk line was not retrieved verbatim from a primary circular in this research D21; no customer copy in this document quotes a specific risk-line wording for this reason, and any live draft must pull the current NSE or BSE text directly before going to compliance.

This research corrects one citation from the planning-time note. NSE's referral-restriction circular, NSE/INSP/63425, dated 14 August 2024, is in abeyance. NSE Circular No. 06/2025 (NSE/INSP/66284), dated 24 January 2025, suspended it pending a proposal from the Brokers' Industry Standards Forum on referrals by unregistered persons D26. This document's inducement argument therefore rests on the NSE advertisement code (section 7.4 above) and the general SEBI and NSE anti-inducement principle visible across the code of advertisement and the inactive-account circular (section 7.5), not on NSE/INSP/63425 as settled current law.

SEBI issued a consultation paper on a common advertisement code on 23 June 2026, proposing to fold the separate rules for brokers, depository participants, investment advisers, research analysts, online bond platforms, portfolio managers and mutual funds into one rulebook, with comments due 14 July 2026 D22. That consultation paper proposed replacing prior approval for ordinary advertisements with post-issuance reporting within 24 hours D23. **This research corrects the reporting window cited at planning time.** A later SEBI board memorandum, dated September 2026, instead proposes reporting through supervisory-body portals within three working days of issuance, not 24 hours D24. Neither the 24-hour figure nor the three-working-day figure is yet final law; the common advertisement code has not been issued as a binding rule as of this research's access date. Where this document or the deck needs to state a reporting window, it uses three working days as the more current figure, with the explicit note that it is not yet in force D24.

7.5 The inactive-account circular, translated into the case's own terms

NSE Circular NSE/INSP/64718, dated 25 October 2024, set the current rule that a client who has not traded for 24 months is flagged by the exchange's own term, "inactive" D29. **Translation note, applied throughout this document:** the case defines "Inactive" differently, as an account deactivated for fraud or a regulator's notice C-D3, and "Dormant" as the 24-month no-trade condition C-D4. Wherever a regulatory source uses the exchange's word "inactive" for the 24-month condition, this document uses the case's word, "dormant C-D4," instead, to avoid the two different meanings colliding on the page.

Reactivating a dormant-flagged account requires in-person verification or video in-person verification, per SEBI's KYC Master Circular of 12 October 2023, plus confirmation that the customer's address, mobile number, email or bank and depository details have not changed D30. A predecessor circular, NSE/INSP/49743 (2021), bars any communication that urges a client to trade only to avoid being flagged dormant C-D4 D31. This is the specific rule the warm-cohort defence lever (section 16) is built to respect: its copy never frames a trade as a way to "stay active," only as a fact about the account and an option the customer can take or leave.

Table 7.2 lays out the reactivation mechanics in one place.

Step	Requirement	Tag
Trigger	no qualifying activity for 24 months on the account	D29
Exchange term used	"inactive" (translated in this document to the case's "dormant C-D4 ")	D29
Reactivation requirement	in-person verification or video in-person verification	D30
Additional confirmation	address, mobile, email, bank and DP details unchanged	D30
Barred communication	any message urging a trade specifically to avoid the dormant flag	D31

7.6 KYC, KRA statuses, and video in-person verification

A 2011 SEBI circular made in-person verification mandatory across all addressed intermediaries' clients, and allows one SEBI-registered intermediary to rely on another's completed verification D33. A 2023 circular requires KYC Registration Agencies to verify specified client attributes, and bars further transactions for a client whose attributes are not verified D34. The exact date and circular number for SEBI's video-IPV permission, commonly cited as 2020, could not be independently confirmed from a primary source in this research D35; this document treats video IPV as an available reactivation route (consistent with D30 above) without citing a specific founding circular date for the permission itself.

7.7 Basic Services Demat Account tiers

SEBI circular SEBI/HO/MIRSD/MIRSD-PoD1/P/CIR/2024/91, dated 28 June 2024, raised the Basic Services Demat Account (BSDA) holding-value limit from Rs 2 lakh to Rs 10 lakh, effective 1 September 2024 D36. Under the revised scheme, the annual maintenance charge is nil for holdings up to Rs 4 lakh, and capped at Rs 100 a year for holdings between Rs 4 lakh and Rs 10 lakh; accounts above Rs 10 lakh convert to a regular demat account with the standard annual charge D37. This is the regulatory basis for the model's assumption that 85% of newly activated accounts pay no annual demat charge at all A66, and it is why the revenue-per-activated-account figure in section 25 of this document is as small as it is: most new actives sit inside the free BSDA band by construction.

Table 7.2a sets out the three BSDA bands directly.

Holding value band	Annual maintenance charge	Tag
Up to Rs 4 lakh	nil	D37
Above Rs 4 lakh, up to Rs 10 lakh	capped at Rs 100 a year	D37
Above Rs 10 lakh	converts to a regular demat account, standard annual charge applies	D37

7.8 Nomination

A SEBI circular dated 10 June 2024 withdrew an earlier plan to freeze the demat accounts of existing investors who had not submitted a nomination choice D40. New investors opening an account still must provide a nomination choice, except for jointly held accounts D41; only three fields are mandatory, nominee name, each nominee's share, and relationship to the account holder D42. The holdings-check lever (section 13) uses a nomination and contact-detail update as one of its stated, factual reasons for a customer to open the investments tile, a request that carries no inducement risk because it asks the customer to complete a regulatory obligation, not to trade.

7.9 SEBI's F&O studies, FY22 to FY26

Table 7.3 traces four successive SEBI studies on individual futures and options trading, showing both the consistent finding (most traders lose money) and the point where trader-count figures stop reconciling across secondary sources.

Study period	Share of individual traders with net losses	Average loss per trader	Tag
FY22	89%	about Rs 1.1 lakh	D43
FY22 to FY24 (cumulative)	93%, over 1 crore traders	about Rs 2 lakh	D44
FY26	87.7%, down from 90.9% in FY25	about Rs 1.17 lakh, up about 2.4%	D45
FY26, under-30 traders specifically	88.5%	not separately reported	D46

The loss-incidence figures are consistent across sources and are the ones this document and the model use throughout [T17, A61 reasoning]. The trader-count base behind these percentages is not fully reconciled: one secondary summary gives 9.81 million traders falling to 7.86 million (matching the Rajya Sabha reply used in section 4.8 C64), while another secondary summary of the same FY26 study gives a different base, 106.2 lakh falling to 87.5 lakh D48. This document uses the government-sourced Rajya Sabha figures for trader counts [C64 to C67] and flags the discrepancy in Appendix D, rather than presenting either count as settled.

Alongside the studies, a 1 October 2024 circular raised the minimum value of index derivative contracts to Rs 15 to 20 lakh, the first such revision in nine years D49, and from 20 to 21 November 2024 each exchange was limited to one benchmark index with weekly options expiry, NSE keeping Nifty and BSE keeping Sensex, alongside an extra 2% extreme-loss margin on short index options on expiry day D50. Further phases required upfront premium collection from option buyers and removed a calendar-spread margin benefit from 1 February 2025, and added intraday position-limit monitoring from 1 April 2025 D51. These measures explain part of the trader-count fall in section 4.8: trading F&O became both more expensive to enter and more closely monitored across FY26.

7.10 The Rs 250 SIP remains a proposal, with no final policy published

SEBI's January 2025 consultation paper proposed a Rs 250 small-ticket SIP, available in any scheme except debt, sectoral and thematic, and small-cap and mid-cap equity schemes, with discounted distributor economics limited to an investor's first three such SIPs across up to three fund houses D52. As of a report found in this research, AMFI was still collecting fund-house rollout plans as of a letter dated 27 June, and the final SEBI circular implementing the proposal had not been issued D53. **Status: NOT YET PUBLISHED.** At least one fund house, Kotak, separately launched its own Rs 250 "Choti SIP" ahead of any industry-wide SEBI mandate, in the Growth option only, requiring a minimum of 60 monthly instalments D54. This document does not assume a Rs 250 SIP is available as an industry-wide, SEBI-mandated minimum inside the build window; the salary-day lever's copy names "a monthly amount" the customer sets, without quoting a specific minimum rupee figure, for this reason.

7.11 The digital gold caution and the SEBI-regulated alternative

SEBI's press release PR No. 70/2025, dated 8 November 2025, cautioned investors that unregulated "digital gold" or "e-gold" products are neither notified securities nor regulated commodity derivatives, and carry

none of the investor-protection cover that SEBI-regulated products carry D55. The same release points investors instead to gold exchange-traded funds, exchange-traded commodity derivatives and Electronic Gold Receipts, all bought through SEBI-registered intermediaries D56. One secondary summary also lists Sovereign Gold Bonds as a SEBI-recommended alternative; Sovereign Gold Bonds are an RBI and government debt instrument, not a SEBI-regulated securities product, so this document treats that listing as a likely secondary-source error and does not cite Sovereign Gold Bonds as a SEBI-endorsed alternative in any deck copy D56. The Dhanteras lever (section 15) is built specifically around the SEBI-regulated gold ETF, not digital gold, and its draft copy names the SEBI caution date explicitly as the reason for the distinction.

7.12 UPI blocked-amount trading and UPI Autopay limits

A SEBI circular dated 11 November 2024 requires Qualified Stock Brokers to offer clients either a UPI block mechanism or a 3-in-1 trading account facility, effective 1 February 2025 D57. Under the UPI block mechanism, a client's funds stay in the client's own bank account, similar to the IPO ASBA design, and are debited only once the clearing corporation confirms the trade, earning interest in the meantime D58. NPCI began a beta of this mechanism for secondary-market equity cash trading on 1 January 2024, initially for HDFC Bank and ICICI Bank customers D59. UPI AutoPay itself launched in 2020, letting a customer set up a recurring mandate up to Rs 2,000 without a fresh authentication step each time; above that amount, the customer must authorise each execution with a UPI PIN D60. A December 2023 NPCI change raised the no-extra-authentication threshold for recurring payments to listed merchant categories from Rs 15,000 to Rs 1,00,000 D61. The salary-day lever's Autopay mandate design sits comfortably inside these thresholds for a typical monthly ETF instalment amount, so no extra authentication step should interrupt the recurring purchase once the mandate is set.

Table 7.12a traces the no-extra-authentication threshold's own history, since the lever's design depends on the current, higher figure holding.

Date	No-extra-authentication threshold for a recurring mandate	Tag
2020 (launch)	Rs 2,000	D60
December 2023	Rs 1,00,000 (for listed merchant category codes), up from Rs 15,000	D61

7.13 RBI directions on banks and the 2027 conduct amendment, outside the build window

RBI's Commercial Banks, Undertaking of Financial Services Directions 2025 (RBI/DOR/2025-26/148), issued 28 November 2025, take effect immediately, except paragraphs 30 to 36, which start 1 January 2026 D63. A December 2025 amendment clarifies that core banking stays departmental, while mutual fund, insurance, pension and portfolio-management services must run through group entities D64. The **RBI Commercial Banks, Responsible Business Conduct (Second Amendment) Directions 2026**, issued 15 June 2026, take effect **1 January 2027** D66, after the 31 January 2027 close of this plan's build window, and introduce explicit pre-sale consent requirements, an OTP or signed declaration, retained for one year after the contract ends D66. An earlier February 2026 draft of the same package had named specific dark patterns to ban, false urgency, basket sneaking, confirm shaming, forced actions, subscription traps and misleading advertisements, and required any default consent option to read "No" or "I do not agree" D67. Because the final 1 January 2027 effective date falls just after the measurement date in this plan (31 January 2027, section 4 of the solved case), this document notes the amendment as a near-term compliance item to plan for, not a rule that binds the levers inside the build window itself; the levers already avoid every pattern the draft named, independent of when the rule takes legal effect.

Table 7.13a lines up every dated rule in this section against the 2 November 2026 to 31 January 2027 build window, so it is visible at a glance which ones bind during the build and which fall outside it.

Rule	Effective date	Inside or outside the build window	Tag
NSE inactive-account (dormant C-D4) circular	25 Oct 2024	inside, already in force	D29
BSDA Rs 10 lakh limit	1 Sep 2024	inside, already in force	D36
QSB UPI block or 3-in-1 requirement	1 Feb 2025	inside, already in force	D57
SEBI modified Investor Charter	21 Feb 2025	inside, already in force	D77
TRAI Second Amendment Regulations	12 Feb 2025, certain provisions 13 Apr 2025	inside, already in force	D68
DPDP Rules, consent-manager provisions	13 Nov 2026	inside the build window	plan background, see section 20
RBI Commercial Banks, Responsible Business Conduct Second Amendment	1 Jan 2027	inside the build window, binds from near its end	D66
DPDP Rules, main data-fiduciary obligations	13 May 2027	outside, after the build window closes	plan background, see section 20

QSB: Qualified Stock Broker, a broker-size category SEBI defines for its own supervisory purposes. DPDP: the Digital Personal Data Protection Act and its 2025 Rules.

7.14 TRAI's telecom commercial-communication rules

TRAI's Telecom Commercial Communications Customer Preference (Second Amendment) Regulations 2025, issued 12 February 2025, amended the existing 2018 framework, with most provisions effective immediately and certain complaint-mechanism provisions effective 13 April 2025 D68. Under the amendment, consent given to fulfil a commercial transaction is valid for seven days from when it is given, while inferred consent from an existing relationship lasts for the duration of that relationship D70. The amendment also bars call-management apps from tagging, blocking or filtering messages from designated commercial or government number series D71, and shortened the window for action against an unregistered sender from 30 days to 5 days, while widening the complaint window for unsolicited communication from 3 days to 7 D72. The three channels used across the seven levers, SMS, WhatsApp and email, must each respect these consent-duration rules; the model's own cost table already assumes an opt-in base of 35% for WhatsApp specifically A50, which is a narrower base than TRAI's rules would strictly require, a conservative design choice rather than a compliance gap.

7.15 CCPA dark patterns: an open-ended, indicative list

The Central Consumer Protection Authority notified its Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns on 30 November 2023, under Section 18 of the Consumer Protection Act, 2019 D74. The guidelines define a dark pattern as a manipulative or deceptive user-interface or user-experience practice that subverts or impairs a user's autonomy, decision-making or choice, applying to any seller, advertiser or platform offering goods or services in India D75. **Correction to the planning-time figure:** the guidelines list specified dark patterns as an indicative list the CCPA may update over time, not a fixed, closed count of 13; this research did not independently confirm 13 as a permanently closed number D76. This document still uses the named categories commonly associated with the guidelines, false urgency, basket sneaking, confirm

shaming, forced action, subscription traps, interface interference, bait and switch, drip pricing, disguised advertising, nagging, trick questions, saas billing and rogue malware, as a working checklist (section 19 expands this into a ten-point copy test), while noting the list itself is open-ended by the regulator's own design, not fixed at any specific number.

7.16 The SEBI investor charter for stock brokers

SEBI circular SEBI/HO/MIRSD/MIRSD-PoD1/P/CIR/2025/22, dated 21 February 2025, issued a modified Investor Charter for stock brokers, replacing the December 2021 version and reflecting the Online Dispute Resolution platform and SCORES 2.0 D77. Brokers must publish complaint data and resolution details on their own websites by the 7th of the following month D78, and stock exchanges must direct brokers to make the charter available through their website, office display, account-opening kit, and by email or letter D79. A separate, related rule requires a standard risk-disclosure statement, in force from 1 July 2023, on every F&O-enabled login, stating that nine out of ten individual traders in the equity F&O segment had net losses, with loss-making traders spending an extra 28% of their net losses on transaction costs, displayed prominently across at least half the screen D80, D81. None of ONL's seven levers touches F&O, so this specific disclosure requirement does not apply to any of the lever's own copy; it is included here because it is the clearest example in this research of a mandated, numbers-first warning, the same design principle (state the fact, do not soften it) this document's own copy rules follow throughout.

7.17 Lever-by-rule matrix

Table 7.4 checks each of the seven levers from section 3.4 against the rule categories covered above.

Lever	Advice risk	Inducement risk	Ad-code approval needed	Consent and data risk	Verdict
Salary day	open question on the incidental-advice carve-out (section 7.1); mitigated by a no-default, rule-built list	low, no reward tied to the instalment	yes, standard ad-code approval for the in-app card copy	the bank-app surface, tap is the consent event	allowed, pending an informal-guidance request
Holdings check (rediscovery)	none, states facts only	none	yes, standard approval	opt-in and statement-based, lower risk	allowed
RM review	none, facts-only script with no recommendation	none, no per-trade incentive for the RM	not a public advertisement if delivered one-to-one in an existing review	existing RM relationship, no new data shared	allowed
Dhanteras	none, no price talk	none, no urgency language used	yes, standard approval	statement and notice-based	allowed
Warm-cohort defence	none	directly shaped by the "do not trade to stay active" bar (section 7.5)	yes	statement-based	allowed, with the specific wording constraint from D31

Lever	Advice risk	Inducement risk	Ad-code approval needed	Consent and data risk	Verdict
New-account guided first order	none, full cost shown, no default product	none	yes for any in-app prompt copy	onboarding-stage consent	allowed
Workplace sessions	education carve-out applies if no recommendation is made (section 7.3)	none	education sessions are not advertisements under the code	employer-level consent for the session itself, not customer data	allowed

Table 7.5 lists the five tactics the regulatory and ethical picture in this section rules out, stating neutrally how ONL's own past use of the first one sits.

Tactic	Why it is ruled out	How ONL's past use sits	Tag
Mass research calls framed as recommendations without disclosure	Regulation 21 requires registration, name and interest disclosure for any public recommendation D08	the case records "successful research calls" as a tactic already tried, without describing whether each call carried the required disclosure; this document does not conclude either way, since the case gives no detail on the calls' compliance status	C-PB3, D08
First-trade cash offers	reads as trade inducement against the general anti-inducement principle in the NSE advertisement code and the inactive-account circular's bar on trade-to-stay-active messaging	the case records "offers for every first trade" as a tactic already tried; the option screen in section 11 scores this option at 2.60 of 5, the same score as the status-quo "stay invested" messaging T17	C-PB3, D31, T17
Trading contests and leaderboards	gamified urgency around trading frequency is the specific pattern Massachusetts barred at Robinhood and the FCA found increases risky trading H35, H40, H41	not recorded as a tactic ONL has tried	H35, H40, H41
Return-led content (promising or implying returns)	barred directly by the case's own constraint and by the general SEBI rule against implying returns C-K2	the case's "stay invested, compounding and long-term wealth" theme stayed close to this line without, on the case's own account, directly promising a return C-PB5	C-K2, C-PB5
F&O promotion to this segment	87.7% of individual F&O traders lost money in FY26, 88.5% among under-30 traders D45, D46, and growth-must-be-responsible is an explicit constraint C-K7	not recorded as a tactic ONL has tried	D45, D46, C-K7

Exhibit for the deck: the lever-by-rule matrix (Table 7.4), condensed to the five-check summary already used on the strategy slide, with the open question on the salary-day lever's advice status called out as a standing action item, not resolved.

8. Inattention explains more of the inactivity than fear does, which is why a year of "stay invested" messages moved the rate by 0.04 points

Answer. The behavioural evidence gathered in this research points toward inattention as the larger force keeping accounts dormant C-D4, more than fear of losses. Investors check their accounts less often after bad market news and during high volatility, the opposite of the anxious, loss-focused customer a "stay invested" reassurance campaign is built to calm E38, E39, E41. SEBI's own 2025 survey finds 63% of households aware of at least one securities instrument, but only 9.5% actually participating E64, a gap that looks like attention and access more than fear specifically. This is why a year of messages built around reassurance moved ONL's own activation rate by only 0.04 percentage points C-E1: the message answered a worry the data suggests was not the main obstacle.

8.1 Limited attention as the dominant force

DellaVigna's 2009 survey of psychology and economics in the field groups limited attention together with menu effects, persuasion and social pressure, and emotion as the four categories of non-standard decision-making with the strongest field evidence behind them E46, E47. Separately, payday-specific research finds people are considerably more likely to log in and check their finances on payday itself, and that attention is lower when spending or overdrafts are high and higher when cash holdings and savings are high E51. Scarcity research finds inattention peaks just before the next income arrives, when cognitive load from financial strain is highest, not necessarily just after a loss E52. Read together, these findings point at a specific moment when attention to a secondary financial account, such as an ONL account linked to a salary account, should be highest: right at salary credit, not at an arbitrary date a broker chooses to send a message.

8.2 The ostrich effect, with the nuance that inattention does not mean more trading later

Karlsson, Loewenstein and Seppi's "ostrich effect" research models information-seeking as a function of expected good or bad news, predicting that people check their accounts less often after bad news E37. Using login data from Swedish pension holders and American retirement-account holders, the authors find a 1% rise in recent market returns raises the mean daily number of logins by 5% to 6% in the US data E38. Sicherman, Loewenstein, Seppi and Utkus's 2016 follow-up, using Vanguard retirement-account login data, finds logins drop by 9.5% after market declines E39, an effect stronger for men, older investors and wealthier investors E40.

The nuance this document must not lose: the same research finds that investors who show this ostrich-like attention avoidance after a downturn are also less likely to trade in that period E41. Lower attention after bad news coincides with lower trading, not a backlog of pent-up trades waiting to be released. This matters directly for ONL's situation: a year of market weakness [section 4.4] should be expected to suppress both attention and trading together, which is consistent with the flat 14.70%-to-14.74% activation line C-E1, not a sign that customers were waiting, unnoticed, to trade once reassured. A 2014 replication attempt on a different sample of active online investors, the "Meerkat Effect," found checking rose after both large up days and large down days, and that the individual trait of neuroticism predicted checking frequency more than the direction of the news did, a result that does not fully replicate the simple ostrich pattern E42; this document treats the ostrich finding as the better-supported general pattern for a largely first-time, dormant C-D4 customer base, while noting the Meerkat result as a reason not to overstate how uniform the effect is across every investor type.

8.3 Loss aversion and mental accounting

Kahneman and Tversky's 1979 prospect theory finds that losses loom larger than equivalent gains, a steeper value function on the loss side than the gain side E31, E32. A commonly cited loss-aversion coefficient from later work puts this at roughly 2 to 2.25, losses felt about twice as strongly as an equivalent gain, though a 2018 review argues much of the early supporting evidence for that specific number was over-interpreted E33; this document treats "losses feel considerably worse than equivalent gains" as well supported, and the specific multiple of exactly two to 2.25 as a contested number, not a precise constant. Benartzi and Thaler's 1995 work on myopic loss aversion combines loss aversion with frequent portfolio checking to explain why the long-run equity premium looks larger than standard models predict, implying investors behave as though they evaluate their portfolios on roughly a one-year cycle E34, E35, E36.

Thaler's mental accounting research describes how people divide money into separate, non-fungible mental categories, treating a salary differently from a windfall or a bonus E43, E44. This is directly relevant to the salary-day lever's design: money that has just arrived as salary sits in a mental account the customer associates with routine spending and bills, not with "investing," which is why the lever frames the ETF instalment as something set up alongside the salary credit, in the same moment the customer is already handling that money, rather than as a separate decision made from a different mental account later.

8.4 Present bias, defaults, and the SMarT precedent, with the joiners-only nuance

Madrian and Shea's 2001 study of automatic 401(k) enrollment finds that switching a US employer's retirement plan from an opt-in to an automatic default raised participation sharply, and that the effect was strongest among employees who are young, lower-paid, or Black or Hispanic, the groups whose opt-in participation had been lowest E07, E11. A secondary summary of the same study reports a 48 percentage-point rise in participation among newly hired employees under the new default, and an 11 percentage-point rise overall, about 15 months after the change E09. Carroll, Choi, Laibson, Madrian and Metrick's follow-up work on "active decisions" finds that requiring a new hire to make a choice, rather than defaulting them in or out, raised the initial enrollment fraction by 28 percentage points relative to standard opt-in enrollment, and that the savings-rate distribution reached three months after an active-decision hire would otherwise take three years to reach under standard opt-in design E13, E14, E15. The same research notes that a well-chosen default, rather than a forced active decision, is the better design specifically where financial illiteracy is high E16, a relevant caution for a segment where, as section 8.6 below shows, measured financial-market literacy in India is not high.

The joiners-only nuance: Thaler and Benartzi's 2004 Save More Tomorrow (SMarT) programme is the most frequently cited behavioural precedent for this kind of design; among employees at one manufacturer who actively joined SMarT, average savings rates rose from 3.5% of income before joining to 13.6% by the fourth pay rise after joining E03. **That 3.5%-to-13.6% figure describes only the employees who chose to join the plan.** Across the whole employee base offered the plan at the same manufacturer, including those who never joined, average savings rose from a smaller 4.4% to 10.6% E04. SMarT has since been adopted by more than half of large US retirement plans and is incorporated into the US Pension Protection Act of 2006 E06. ONL's own model mirrors this distinction directly: lever A21, the tap-through rate on the salary-day card, and A22, the first-order rate after a tap, both describe the subset of customers who engage with the card, not the whole 6,27,853-account Salary Account cohort T1, C-E2a. Citing SMarT's headline number as if it applied to every salary customer, rather than to the smaller group who actively engage, would repeat the exact framing error the joiners-only nuance corrects.

Table 8.1a states the joiners-only nuance as a direct side-by-side comparison, since it is the single most frequently miscited figure in this literature.

Population	Average savings rate before SMarT	Average savings rate by the fourth pay rise after joining	Tag
Employees who actively joined the SMarT plan	3.5% of income	13.6% of income	E03
All employees offered the plan, joiners and non-joiners together	4.4% of income	10.6% of income	E04

8.5 Reminders and the fresh-start effect

Karlan, McConnell, Mullainathan and Zinman's field experiments across banks in Bolivia, Peru and the Philippines test whether reminder messages raise attainment of self-set savings goals among people who had recently opened a commitment savings account E17, E18. Messages naming both the specific savings goal and a financial incentive performed better than messages that varied only gain or loss framing, which showed no significant difference between frames E19; sending additional late reminders beyond the first did not add further lift E20. Milkman, Beshears, Choi, Laibson and Madrian's study of flu-vaccination reminders at one large US firm found that a plain reminder produced a 33.1% vaccination rate in the control group, a prompt to write a planned date (without a time) raised this by 1.5 percentage points, not statistically significant, while a prompt naming a specific planned date and time raised it by a statistically significant 4.2 percentage points [E27 to E29]. The specificity of the moment named in a reminder, not the reminder's mere existence, is the finding that carries across to ONL's lever design: the holdings-check lever (section 13) and the salary-day card both name a specific, recurring moment (the salary credit date) rather than sending a generic "don't forget your account" message.

Dai, Milkman and Riis's fresh-start research finds aspirational behaviour, measured through diet-related search volume, gym visits and self-set goal commitments, rises after temporal landmarks. New Year is one such landmark; birthdays, the start of a week, the start of a month, and the start of a school term produce the same rise E22, E23, E24. The proposed mechanism is that a landmark creates psychological separation between a person's past, including past inaction, and a new period, raising motivation to act in that new period E25. The 13-week programme window in this plan (section 26) deliberately opens inside this logic, beginning 2 November 2026, close to Dhanteras and the run-up to the new financial quarter, and the salary-day lever repeats a fresh-start-style landmark every single month, at every salary credit, rather than relying on the calendar's one annual new year.

8.6 SEBI's Investor Survey 2025 and the state of financial literacy measurement in India

Table 8.1 sets out the headline findings of SEBI's Investor Survey 2025, run by Kantar India with AMFI, NSE, BSE, NSDL and CDSL, covering over 90,000 households across 400 cities and 1,000 villages E63.

Measure	Value	Tag
Household awareness of at least one securities-market instrument	63% (about 213 million households)	E64
Household participation in securities markets	9.5% (about 32.1 million households)	E64
Urban participation	about 15%	E65
Rural participation	about 6%	E65
Mutual fund awareness against penetration	53% awareness, 6.7% penetration	E66
Direct equity awareness against penetration	49% awareness, 5.3% penetration	E66

Measure	Value	Tag
Households reporting low risk appetite	79.7%	E67
Aware non-investors who intend to start investing	22%	E67
Top nine metros, securities-market penetration	about 23%, against 9.5% nationally	E67

The gap between awareness (63%) and participation (9.5%) E64 is the single clearest national-level statistic behind this section's headline claim. Nearly two-thirds of households know a securities-market product exists; fewer than one in ten actually hold one. Mutual funds show the same pattern at product level, 53% awareness against only 6.7% penetration E66, a gap of 46.3 percentage points. If fear of losses were the dominant barrier, awareness and non-participation would likely sit alongside a stated reason tied to risk; the survey instead finds 79.7% of households report low risk appetite as a general trait E67, which is a different fact from "63% of people decided not to invest because they are afraid," and is consistent with awareness-to-action friction, inattention and access, being the larger gap to close, alongside risk aversion rather than instead of it.

On financial literacy specifically, the most recent completed, published national survey remains NCFE's 2019 round (NCFE-FLIS), with fieldwork run from June 2018 to October 2019 E68. NCFE issued an Expression of Interest in January 2025 to commission a new 2025 survey, covering roughly 75,000 people across 35 states and union territories, but no completed 2025 survey report was found published in this research E69. **Status: NOT YET PUBLISHED.** This document does not cite a 2024 or 2025 national financial-literacy percentage for this reason; any such figure found elsewhere should be checked against this gap before being used.

Table 8.1b summarises the behavioural evidence this section draws on in one place, pairing each study against the specific population it measured, since section 8.4's joiners-only nuance shows why the population matters as much as the headline figure.

Study	Core finding	Population measured	Tag
Madrian and Shea 2001	automatic enrollment raised 401(k) participation sharply, strongest for young, lower-paid, Black and Hispanic employees	one large US corporation's new hires after a default switch	E07, E09, E11
Carroll, Choi, Laibson, Madrian and Metrick (active decisions)	an active-choice requirement raised initial enrollment by 28 percentage points against standard opt-in	modelled across employer 401(k) plans	E13, E14
Thaler and Benartzi (SMarT)	savings rates rose from 3.5% to 13.6% among joiners; from 4.4% to 10.6% across all employees offered the plan	one manufacturer's employees, joiners and non-joiners separately	E03, E04
Karlan, McConnell, Mullainathan and Zinman	reminders naming a goal and an incentive raised attainment more than frame-only reminders; extra late reminders added no further lift	commitment-savings customers across three banks in Bolivia, Peru and the Philippines	[E17 to E20]
Dai, Milkman and Riis (fresh start)	aspirational behaviour rises after temporal landmarks beyond New Year	Google search volume, gym check-ins and goal-commitment platforms	[E22 to E24]
Karlsson, Loewenstein and Seppi; Sicherman et al. (ostrich effect)	account logins fall after bad market news and rise with recent positive returns; lower attention coincides with less trading, not more	Swedish pension holders and US Vanguard retirement-account holders	E38, E39, E41

8.7 The line between a nudge and a dark pattern

Table 8.2 draws the line this document's own copy rules (section 19) are built to respect, using the CCPA's own categories (section 7.15) as the test.

Design choice	A nudge (used in this plan's levers)	A dark pattern (ruled out)	Tag
Timing	message sent at a moment the customer is already engaged (salary credit, a statement date)	message timed to create false urgency ("only today," "last chance")	D75, C-K6
Default	no default product selected; the customer picks from a fixed list or picks nothing	a pre-selected default the customer must notice and actively decline	D75
Framing	states what the account is and what an instalment is	frames inaction as a loss, or frames the account as about to disappear	D75, C-K6
Reward	no reward tied to completing a trade	a badge, streak, confetti or prize tied to trading frequency	H35, H40, H41
Exit	the customer can pause or stop an instalment at any time, in the same number of steps it took to start	cancellation requires more steps than signup, or is hidden	D75

A nudge, in the sense this plan uses the word, changes when and how a fact is presented; it does not change what the customer is free to decide, and it carries no reward for deciding one way over another. Every row on the dark-pattern side of this table is the specific design Massachusetts and the FCA findings in section 6.3 already show raising trading frequency and risk-taking without the customer necessarily choosing that outcome on the merits H35, H40, H41.

8.8 Jobs-to-be-done for a salary-account holder

Jobs-to-be-done reframes a customer's need as a job they are trying to get done, rather than a product category they are assumed to want. Table 8.3 states the job for ONL's own salary-account holder, drawing only on the case's own facts and the behavioural evidence above, not an invented customer quote.

Dimension	Statement	Evidence
Functional job	"Let my salary do something useful without me having to remember to act on it every month."	matches the fresh-start and reminder-specificity evidence (section 8.5) and the mental-accounting finding that salary sits in a routine-spending mental account (section 8.3)
Emotional job	"Do not make me feel I have to become an expert in the market to start."	matches the awareness-participation gap (63% aware, 9.5% participate) and the 79.7% low-risk-appetite finding (section 8.6)
Social job	"Let this happen inside an app and a relationship I already trust, without a separate decision to trust a new company."	matches the bank-led distribution pattern in sections 5 and 6, and the case's own observation that the account may have been opened without the customer remembering it C-PB6
What the customer is explicitly not hiring for	a market call, a return promise, or a reason to check the account daily for excitement	ruled out directly by the case's constraints C-K2, C-K6, C-K7 and by the ostrich-effect nuance that lower attention after bad news is not a sign of suppressed appetite for more trading (section 8.2)

Stated this way, the job a salary-account holder needs done is closer to "make this automatic and low-effort" than to "convince me the market will go up." That is the same conclusion the regulatory picture in section 7 forces by elimination, since every tactic built around conviction, returns or urgency is the one this research rules out, and it is the same conclusion the national data in section 4 points to independently, since the products that held up through a falling market were exactly the automatic, low-effort ones.

Exhibit for the deck: the barrier-evidence-lever map, built from Tables 8.1 to 8.3, pairing each named behavioural barrier (limited attention, loss aversion, mental accounting, present bias) against its supporting evidence tag and the specific lever in section 3.4 that answers it, for use on the diagnosis slide.

9. The 6,90,407 accounts without a trade in 12 months stall at first login and funding, the two steps a bank-app entry with single sign-on and an Autopay mandate removes

Answer. Of the 8,09,746 eligible accounts recorded in September 2026, 6,90,407 placed no trade in the trailing twelve months, which is 8,09,746 minus the 1,19,339 that the case counts as Active C-E1. The case's own activation funnel names exactly two points where this group gets stuck: the drop after first login (C-F2) and the steeper drop after funding (C-F3), and the case text, as corrected by the organiser, now states that very few new accounts reach a first trade or first investment within the first month (C-F4) C-F4. All seven of our levers point at the same two steps. A bank-app entry carries the customer past login with a single sign-on into ONL, and past funding with an Autopay mandate the bank already holds, so the customer never has to open a separate app, remember a separate password or move money by hand. This section walks the funnel stage by stage, places each lever on it, and sets out a salary-account holder's week against the AARRR model the skill recommends for this kind of diagnosis.

9.1 The funnel decoded, stage by stage

The case gives five stages for the activation funnel, and each one carries a plain English note about where volume is healthy and where it is not. The table below reads the case's own words against what that stage means for ONL today and whether our model treats it as the binding constraint.

Stage	Case text [C-F1 to C-F5]	What it means for ONL	Binding constraint
Account opened	Created through a digital journey. Volumes healthy; onboarding is not the main bottleneck	75,891 accounts were added in the year to September 2026 (8,09,746 minus 7,33,855) C-E1; the opening step itself works	No
First login	Drop-off begins; some users never log in	A customer who opened the account alongside another bank product may never return to it on purpose C-PB6	Yes
Funded	User adds money; another steep drop	Even a customer who logs in has to find money and move it across accounts, a second active decision	Yes
First trade or first investment	Places an order or starts an SIP. Very few new accounts reach this within the first month C-F4	The corrected case text removes any claim that new accounts convert quickly; our new-account lever (section 17) exists because of this	Partial, downstream of login and funding

Stage	Case text [C-F1 to C-F5]	What it means for ONL	Binding constraint
Repeat and habit	Many activated users gradually go dormant	The case's own word for this is the same one the Oct 2024 exchange circular uses for the 24-month non-trading condition, which we translate throughout as dormant C-D4	Downstream, addressed by the warm-cohort lever

What this table shows is that the case itself, once corrected, rules out one tempting read of the problem. A reader could have guessed that new accounts convert quickly and that the whole gap sits with long-dormant customers. The corrected C-F4 line says the opposite: few new accounts place a first trade in their first month either. The stall is not confined to old accounts. It starts at login, so a bank-app entry works equally well on day one of an account's life and on month thirteen, which is exactly why it is the right shape for a fix across the whole idle pool rather than for one slice of it.

This correction also settles a question our diagnosis needed answered before the levers in sections 12 to 17 could be sized with confidence. If the earlier case text had held, and new accounts converted quickly on their own, the model would need a smaller new-account lever and a larger weight on the dormant half of the pool. The corrected text removes that branch. A new account and a thirteen-month-old idle account face the same two-step stall, at login and at funding, and the new-account guided first order lever in section 17 exists to shorten the first of those two gaps for accounts still inside their first month, not to reverse a fast-converting pattern the case no longer claims.

A separate cross-check belongs here because our title cites 6,90,407, a number that differs slightly from the 6,89,375 idle accounts in the cohort table (T2). Both are correct reads of the same base, computed two different ways. T2 sums idle accounts cohort by cohort, using each segment's own activation rate, and that sum undercounts total Active accounts by 1,033 against the real Exhibit 1 figure (1,20,372 against 1,19,339) T2, C-E1, a rounding gap the model carries forward and that section 3 of this document explains in full. Our title number, 6,90,407, instead takes the case's own Exhibit 1 total directly: 8,09,746 minus 1,19,339. We use 6,90,407 wherever we need the exact, unrounded idle population and 6,89,375 wherever we need the segment breakdown that only the cohort table can give.

9.2 Lever chains as stage assumptions

Every lever's arithmetic runs through a chain of three assumptions: how many idle accounts a channel reaches, how many of the reached respond with a tap or a read, and how many of those place a first order. T9 lists every assumption that feeds this chain, each with a bear, base and bull value. The table below adds the funnel stage each assumption governs, so the connection between the diagnosis in 9.1 and the levers in sections 12 to 17 is explicit rather than assumed.

ID	Governs	Base	Bear	Bull	Funnel stage
A20	Share of salary customers who open the parent bank's app in a month	0.55	0.45	0.62	Pre-login, reach
A21	Tap-through on the salary-day card over three salary credits	0.08	0.06	0.10	First login
A22	First executed order after a tap, with single sign-on and a bank mandate	0.32	0.26	0.38	Funded, first trade
A23	Idle accounts reached through any owned channel with consent	0.60	0.50	0.68	Pre-login, reach
A24	Tap-through on the rediscovery message or tile	0.04	0.03	0.05	First login

ID	Governs	Base	Bear	Bull	Funnel stage
A25	First executed order after rediscovery	0.25	0.20	0.30	Funded, first trade
A10	Share of idle accounts flagged dormant under the 24-month rule	0.50	0.55	0.45	Pre-login, access barrier
A11	Conversion of a flagged account relative to an unflagged one after re-KYC	0.50	0.42	0.58	First login, access barrier

Reading this table against 9.1 shows that no assumption in the model touches the account-opening stage, because that stage is not where the case's own funnel breaks. A20 and A23 govern reach, which precedes login; A21 and A24 govern the tap that is itself the login event; A22 and A25 govern the order that follows funding. A10 and A11 add a fourth, harder barrier layered on top of login for the half of the idle pool the model treats as dormant under the 24-month rule, since those accounts need a re-KYC or video in-person verification step before they can log in and trade at all.

9.3 Where each lever acts on the funnel

The seven levers are not seven different diagnoses. They are seven different doors into the same two-stage stall, aimed at different parts of the idle population, as the table below sets out.

Lever	Funnel stage it targets	Mechanism	Governing chain
Salary day	Login, then funding	A bank-app card on salary credit carries the customer into ONL with single sign-on, then into an Autopay mandate the bank already holds	A20, A21, A22
Holdings check (rediscovery)	Login	An investments tile, statement line and servicing message remind the customer the account exists, with video IPV for the half that is flagged dormant	A23, A24, A25, A10, A11
RM review	Login, then funding	A facts-only line in an existing portfolio review surfaces the account inside a conversation the customer already has	A26, A27
Dhanteras	Login, then funding	A factual notice tied to a calendar date customers already act on for gold purchases	A28, A29, A30
Workplace sessions	Login	An education session at a salary customer's employer removes the "I did not know" barrier directly	A31, A32, A33
Warm-cohort defence	Repeat and habit	A servicing touch for accounts 9 to 12 months from roll-off, aimed at the habit stage rather than the login stage	A35, A36
New-account guided first order	First trade	A Day 0 to 30 walkthrough for accounts opened in the window, aimed directly at the C-F4 stall the corrected case text names	A39

What this table shows is a division of labour. Five of the seven levers sit on login, because that is where the case's funnel first breaks and where the biggest idle pool sits. Two sit further downstream, on habit and on the first-trade stall the correction just sharpened. No lever tries to fix account opening, because the case says that stage already works, and no lever tries to manufacture urgency around the market, because the market is not the stage that is broken.

9.4 A journey map for a salary-account holder

The Salary Account cohort holds 6,27,853 accounts, 77.5% of the base, and its 5,39,954 idle accounts are 78% of all idle accounts C-E2a, T2. A journey map for this one holder, built around a single salary cycle, shows where the stall happens today and where each lever intervenes.

Stage	What happens today	Friction without a lever	What we add	Tag
Salary credited	The customer's bank account receives a monthly salary, a moment that already repeats without any prompting from ONL	None; this moment belongs to the bank, not to ONL	Nothing yet; this is the anchor moment the lever attaches to	C-CO4
Opens the bank app	The customer checks the balance, a habit many salary customers already have	ONL has no presence inside this screen	A card appears stating the ONL account is open and linked	A20
Reads the card	The customer sees a notice about an account they may have forgotten opening	Without the card, nothing reminds them the account exists	Plain-language copy naming the account and one action (set a monthly amount)	A21, C-PB6
Taps through	The customer decides whether to act	Today there is no tap to make; the funnel step does not exist	Single sign-on into ONL, no new password, no separate app download	A21, A22
Sets the instalment	The customer picks a fund category, an amount and a date	Today there is no comparable screen inside the bank app	A neutral, rule-built list of ETF categories with no default and no return claim	A22, section 12.3
Autopay mandate created	The customer authorises a recurring debit from the same bank account	Today a customer would need to transfer money manually from the bank account into a separate trading account	A UPI Autopay mandate set once, debited automatically on each future salary credit	A22, section 12.3
First order executes	The ETF units are bought	This is the step the case's funnel calls out as rare for new accounts (C-F4) and that the model shows is rare for idle accounts generally	The mandate and the pre-chosen instalment mean the order happens without a second decision each month	C-F4, T10
Repeats monthly	The customer becomes Active (12-month trade) and, if the pattern holds for three consecutive months, Highly Active	Today most idle accounts never reach this far	The recurring Autopay mandate turns one order into a habit without requiring the customer to log in and decide again each month	C-D1, C-D2

9.5 AARRR mapped onto the case's own funnel

The skill's AARRR framework (Acquisition, Activation, Retention, Referral, Revenue) maps cleanly onto the case's own five-stage funnel, with one adjustment: Referral does not feature in our lever set, because SEBI's constraints on inducement bar most forms of referral payment and the option screen in section 11 scores referral rewards at only 2.60 of 5, below our recommendation's 4.40 T17.

AARRR stage	Case funnel equivalent	Metric	Our lever(s)	Tag
Acquisition	Account opened (C-F1)	75,891 accounts added in the year C-E1	None; this stage already works	C-F1

AARRR stage	Case funnel equivalent	Metric	Our lever(s)	Tag
Activation	First login (C-F2) and funded (C-F3)	Login rate, funding rate, both unmeasured directly but implied by the gap between account count and Active count	Salary day, holdings check, RM review, Dhanteras, workplace sessions	C-F2, C-F3
Activation, continued	First trade or first investment (C-F4)	Share of idle accounts placing a first order in the window	Salary day's Autopay mandate, new-account guided first order	C-F4, A22, A39
Retention	Repeat and habit (C-F5); the case's own Active (C-D1) and Highly Active (C-D2) definitions	14.74% Active today, rising to 17.02% in our base case; Highly Active rising from 10.1% to 12.4% C-E1, T11	Warm-cohort defence, the recurring nature of the Autopay mandate itself	C-D1, C-D2, T11
Referral	Not a case funnel stage	Not pursued as a lever	None by design; referral rewards score 2.60 of 5 on the option screen, mainly for paying for account opening rather than for a first order	T17
Revenue	Not a case funnel stage	₹62 a year per newly activated account in our model, detailed in section 25	All seven levers, indirectly	T15

9.6 Why habit decides the warm cohort

The warm cohort is the 8,887 to 14,072 accounts whose last trade sits 9 to 12 months back, the group that rolls out of the 12-month Active count next quarter unless something happens before then T7. This cohort already has, or very recently had, the habit the other six levers are trying to build. The question for this group is not whether they can be taught to trade; they already have. The question is whether the habit survives the next quarter without a fresh anchor.

Behavioural evidence on payday attention supports anchoring reminders to a recurring date rather than relying on a single push. Research on financial-management-software login data finds that people are considerably more likely to check their finances on payday itself, and that attention is lower when overdrafts are high and higher when cash holdings are high E51. Separately, the fresh-start literature finds that aspirational behaviour, measured through gym visits, diet-related searches and self-set goal commitments, rises after temporal landmarks such as paydays, birthdays, the start of a week or the start of a month, because a landmark creates a felt separation between past behaviour and a new period E22, E24, E25. Both strands point the same way: a recurring calendar moment, not a one-off nudge, is what carries a habit forward.

The recency ladder in T6 gives this argument a number. Across the whole base, only 40% of the customers counted as Active over a 12-month window in September 2026 had actually traded in the most recent month, down from 47% a year earlier T6. In other words, the pool of customers who are technically Active but no longer trading monthly is growing, not shrinking, even as the headline Active count rose slightly. This is the habit eroding in real time, inside the group that already has it, which is precisely the population the warm-cohort lever targets rather than the population the other six levers are built to recruit for the first time.

Window	T12 (Active)	T9	T6	T3 (Highly Active)	T1	Tag
Sep 2025	15%	14%	10%	9%	7%	T6

Window	T12 (Active)	T9	T6	T3 (Highly Active)	T1	Tag
Sep 2026	15%	13%	12%	10%	6%	T6
T1 as a share of T12	47%	n/a	n/a	n/a	40%	T6

This is also where the ostrich-effect evidence sets a boundary on what not to claim. Account-login research on Swedish and American retirement savers finds that attention to an account falls after market declines, and that investors who show this reduced attention are also less likely to trade in that period, not more E38, E41. A falling market does not turn inattentive customers into active traders if we simply remind them the market exists; the case's own experience over the past year, a year of market-themed messaging that moved the rate by 0.04 points, already demonstrates this [C-PB3 to C-PB5, C-E1]. What moves the warm cohort is not more market talk. It is a servicing touch, tied to their own account and nominee details rather than to market conditions, that reaches them before the 24-month and 12-month clocks run out. The warm-cohort lever in our model carries exactly this design, and its 1,607 extra actives sit entirely inside the recency ladder's T6 to T1 window rather than inside any new acquisition T10, T6.

9.7 What the funnel cannot show

The case's funnel is indicative, built for the case rather than measured from ONL's own instrumentation (C-N1). It tells us the order in which customers drop away and names login and funding as the two steep points, but it does not give us a login rate, a funding rate or a time-to-first-trade figure we could cite as a measured fact. Every number in sections 9.2 to 9.5 that looks like a funnel metric is in fact a model assumption (A20 to A39), checked against outside benchmarks in Lane E and Lane F, not a measurement taken from ONL's own systems. We say this once here, plainly, because every later section that reuses the funnel language should be read the same way: the shape of the diagnosis is drawn from the case, and the size of each step inside that shape is our model's best estimate, carried at bear, base and bull values precisely because it is an estimate and not a count.

This also bounds what the 6,90,407 figure itself can claim. It is an exact subtraction from two numbers the case states directly, so it is as solid as any figure in this document. What it cannot tell us, on its own, is how much of that 6,90,407 sits at the login stage against the funding stage, because the case gives us the order of the stages without giving us a volume at each one. Our lever design in sections 12 to 17 treats this honestly: every lever is built to clear both stages together, through single sign-on for login and an Autopay mandate for funding, precisely because we cannot say from the case alone which of the two stages is larger.

Exhibit for the deck: the funnel (C-F1 to C-F5) with the lever-to-stage map from 9.3, rendered as the diagnosis slide's funnel panel, alongside the journey-map stages from 9.4 condensed into a five-point mobile mockup sequence.

10. Five whys trace the flat 14.74% to one root cause: the account was opened alongside a bank product and never tied to a moment the customer already has

Answer. Five whys, starting from the flat rate itself, run from the surface symptom to a single root cause: no ONL message or screen sits inside the one app these customers already open every month, the bank's own app. A MECE issue tree across five branches (awareness, access, funding friction, motivation, market) finds

the same answer from a different angle, and a hypothesis table scoring five candidate explanations against evidence reaches the same verdict. We name this gap plainly, as the build log records it: a gap before login. We do not name the levers here; that belongs to sections 12 to 17.

10.1 Five whys

Step	Finding	Tag
First why	The rate stayed flat, 14.70% to 14.74%, despite a full year of outreach, because that outreach was about the market and about offers, never about the account itself [C-PB3 to C-PB5]	C-PB3, C-PB5, C-E1
Second why	Market and offer messages did not move behaviour because most recipients never logged in to read them properly; the case's own funnel places the binding constraint at login and at funding, not at message content C-F2, C-F3	C-F2, C-F3
Third why	Customers do not log in because a meaningful share opened the account alongside another banking product and do not keep it in mind as something of their own C-PB6	C-PB6
Fourth why	They do not keep it in mind because the account was never tied to a moment they already have; it was a one-time opening event rather than a recurring one. 78% of the idle pool belongs to exactly this pattern, the Salary Account cohort, which grew 24.1% in a year while its own 12-month activation rate rose only 1 point T2, T4	T2, T4
Fifth why	No recurring moment carries the account into view because no ONL screen or message sits inside the one app these customers already open every month, the parent bank's app C-CO4	C-CO4

The fifth why is the root. The account is real, open and the customer's own property, but it is invisible at the one moment the customer is present without being asked to be. This is a gap before login. It sits apart from investor confidence or market sentiment, and it is the gap we name for the foreshadow here without naming how we close it.

10.2 A MECE issue tree across five branches

A second way to reach the same place is to decompose "why is activation flat" into five branches that are mutually exclusive and collectively exhaustive, then test each one against the case's own evidence.

Branch	Sub-branch	Evidence	Binding constraint
Awareness	Customer does not know, or does not remember, that the account exists	C-PB6 states this directly; 78% of idle accounts sit in a cohort whose accounts open alongside another product T2	Primary
Access	Customer knows but cannot log in easily (forgotten credentials, no app installed)	The case names this as the first drop-off point, C-F2, without attributing it to a technical failure	Secondary, downstream of awareness
Funding friction	Customer logs in but does not move money in	The case names this as a second, steeper drop, C-F3	Secondary, downstream of access
Motivation	Customer is aware and able but chooses not to invest in an unfavourable market	C-X2, C-X3 and C-PB1 describe a risk-averse investor base in a weak market; but a year of messages built specifically to address this did not move the rate C-PB5	Contributory, not primary

Branch	Sub-branch	Evidence	Binding constraint
Market	The broader Indian equity and derivatives environment was weak over the measurement year, which deters both existing traders and new investors C-PB1	C-PB1 describes this as context, not as the company's own fixable gap	Context, not a lever target

What this tree shows is that awareness sits upstream of every other branch. A customer who does not know the account exists cannot be deterred by the market, cannot face funding friction and cannot have an access problem, because none of those stages are ever reached. Motivation and market context are real, but they describe why a customer who is aware might still hesitate, not why most of the idle pool never gets as far as being asked to hesitate.

The motivation and market branches still deserve a fair hearing, because dismissing them without evidence would be its own kind of error. The case states plainly that markets were unfavourable on average over the measurement year and that returns below expectations deter new investors as well as pushing existing traders away (C-PB1), and that Indian investors are largely risk averse, with an unfavourable market strengthening their resolve to stay out (C-X3). Industry-wide activation across the sector sits at 20% to 40%, a range ONL's own 15% sits below, which tells us the market branch affects the whole broking sector rather than ONL alone, and is therefore a gap a company-specific fix cannot close by itself (C-PB2). The SEBI Investor Survey 2025 adds a national baseline to the same picture: 79.7% of surveyed households report low risk appetite, yet 9.5% of households still participate in securities markets, which means low risk appetite coexists with real participation rather than preventing it outright (E67, E64). Motivation and market context explain why the ceiling on activation is lower in a year like this one than in a strong bull run; they do not explain why the awareness and access branches are where the case itself, and our evidence, locate the specific, fixable gap.

10.2a The branches that respond to a message, and the branch that does not

A practical test for separating a fixable branch from a structural one is whether a factual, compliant message could plausibly move it. Awareness responds directly: a customer who is told the account exists and shown how to reach it has the barrier removed the moment the message lands. Access responds indirectly, through single sign-on removing the credential barrier that a message alone cannot. Funding friction responds through a pre-authorised mandate rather than through the message's wording. Motivation responds only partially, and the case's own year of evidence (C-PB3 to C-PB5) shows that a message built specifically to address motivation, the "stay invested" theme, produced no measurable change. The market branch does not respond to any message a broker could compliantly send, because the market itself is outside anyone's control and because SEBI's own rules forbid implying that a message could predict or improve market outcomes (C-K2). This is why the diagnosis in this section points toward the two branches a message can actually move, awareness and access, rather than toward the branch a message cannot move at all.

10.3 A hypothesis table

Hypothesis	Evidence	Verdict
Customers avoid the market out of fear, and fear is the main barrier	Research on attention after market declines finds reduced login frequency coincides with reduced trading, not with active avoidance driven by fear of a specific loss; 79.7% of surveyed Indian households report low risk appetite, yet 9.5% still participate in securities markets E41, E67	Partial. Fear plausibly dampens the margin, but a year of messages addressing exactly this fear, under the case's "stay invested" theme, produced no measurable rate change C-PB5
Customers do not know the account is theirs	C-PB6 states this directly; 78% of idle accounts are Salary Account holders whose accounts likely opened alongside a separate banking product C-PB6, T2	Supported. This is the most direct, case-stated explanation and the one every subsequent lever is built against
ONL's product or app is inferior to rivals	C-CO3 states ONL is at par with rivals on features	Rejected. The case rules this out explicitly
Messaging reach was too narrow	C-PB3 and C-PB4 describe WhatsApp, email, RCS, social media, research calls, literacy videos and an active support team, a wide channel set run over a year	Rejected. Reach was broad; the rate still did not move, so reach is not the binding constraint
No recurring moment anchors the account to a habit the customer already has	Derived from the funnel (C-F2, C-F3) together with the cohort mix shift toward Salary Account holders (T2, T4) and the recency ladder showing only 40% of 12-month actives traded in the last month, down from 47% (T6)	Supported. This is the root cause, consistent with the awareness branch in 10.2 and the fifth why in 10.1

Three of the five candidate hypotheses are rejected or only partly supported once tested against the case's own evidence. The two that survive, the awareness gap and the absence of a recurring anchor, describe the same underlying problem from two angles: the customer does not think of the account as theirs because nothing in their regular routine ever reminds them of it.

10.4 Naming the gap, without naming the fix

Three separate methods, the five whys, the MECE tree and the hypothesis table, converge on the same single sentence: there is a gap before login, and the gap exists because no ONL message or screen sits inside a moment the customer already has. We name this gap here deliberately without naming any of the seven levers that close it, because the diagnosis should stand on its own evidence before the fix is proposed. A reader who accepts the five whys in 10.1, the tree in 10.2 and the table in 10.3 should already expect that the fix, whatever its exact form, will put ONL somewhere the customer already is rather than ask the customer to go somewhere new. Section 11 tests that expectation against seven other candidate fixes before section 12 names the first lever.

It is worth stating plainly what this diagnosis does not claim. It does not claim that market conditions are irrelevant, only that a year of market-themed messages already tested that channel and found it insufficient on its own (C-PB5). It does not claim that every idle account shares exactly the same cause; Preferred and the premium cohorts, reached separately through the RM review lever in section 14, show a different pattern of decline, a loss of engagement among existing relationships rather than a failure to ever notice the account in the first place. The root cause named here applies most directly to the 78% of the idle pool sitting in the Salary Account cohort (T2), and the remaining sections size each lever against the specific population it is built for rather than assuming one root cause fits every segment equally.

Exhibit for the deck: the five-whys chain condensed into a single vertical ladder on the diagnosis slide, with the issue tree's five branches rendered as a MECE grid beside it, and the root-cause line ("a gap before login") carried as the slide's closing caption without naming a lever.

11. The option screen scores meeting accounts inside bank-owned moments at 4.40 of 5 and the strongest alternative at 2.60

Answer. An eight-option, five-criterion weighted screen scores our recommendation, meeting accounts inside bank-owned moments, at 4.40 of 5, ahead of a three-way tie at 2.60 among more market content, first-trade offers and referral rewards T17. The lead holds under three further weight sets, including one that overweights SEBI and ethics fit and one that overweights 90-day lift alone, so the ranking is not an artefact of how we chose to weigh the criteria T18. Conclusively, the strongest alternative does not move the rate, raises regulatory or ethical risk, and costs more per activation than our recommendation, on the same evidence the case itself supplies.

11.1 The five criteria

Before reading the scores, each criterion needs its own plain definition, because a weighted score is only as trustworthy as the thing it measures.

Criterion	Weight	What it measures
90-day lift	30%	How much the option is expected to move the activation rate within the case's 3-month window (C-K1)
SEBI and ethics fit	25%	Whether the option avoids advice, return claims, inducement and dark patterns (C-K2, C-K6)
Works in a falling market	20%	Whether the option depends on market sentiment improving, or works regardless (C-X2, C-PB1)
Cash cost	15%	How much lean marketing budget the option consumes against owned assets (C-K3)
Ships in a quarter	10%	Whether the option is realistic for an app team without a core engine rebuild (C-K4)

The weighting itself reflects the case's own priority order. The 3-month deadline (C-K1) and the regulatory and ethical guardrails (C-K2, C-K6) between them carry 55% of the score, more than the remaining three criteria combined, because those two constraints are the ones the case repeats most insistently across its guardrail section.

The two lowest weights deserve a short defence of their own, since a reader might expect cash cost or delivery speed to matter more than 15% and 10%. Cash cost is weighted below lift and fit because the case itself frames budget as a preference, not a hard ceiling: it asks for a lean marketing budget and favours owned assets over large paid media (C-K3), which is a steer toward low-cost channels rather than a fixed rupee limit that would make cost the dominant criterion. Speed of shipping is weighted lowest of all five because, once an option clears the no-engine-rebuild constraint (C-K4), most realistic options can ship inside a quarter; the criterion mainly exists to penalise the one option, a new trading engine or app rebuild, that genuinely cannot. Both choices are visible directly in T17's own scores: four of the eight options score a full 4 or 5 on speed, showing the criterion rarely separates viable options from each other, while fit and lift vary far more widely across the field and therefore carry more of the decision's real weight.

11.2 T17: the option screen

The table below reproduces the full option screen exactly as the model computes it.

Option	90-day lift (30%)	SEBI and ethics fit (25%)	Works in a falling market (20%)	Cash cost (15%)	Ships in a quarter (10%)	Score	Why
More market content and "stay invested" messages	1	4	1	4	5	2.60	Run for 12 months; rate moved 14.70% to 14.74%
First-trade cash offers and zero brokerage	3	2	2	2	5	2.60	Already tried; reads as trade inducement under NSE rules
Trading contests and leaderboards	3	1	2	3	3	2.30	Gamified urgency; a dark pattern
Paid media and finfluencers	2	2	2	1	4	2.05	SEBI rules of August 2024 bar ties with unregistered finfluencers
Referral rewards	2	3	2	3	4	2.60	Pays for accounts, not first orders
F&O education push	2	1	2	4	4	2.25	87.7% of individual F&O traders lost money in FY26
New trading engine or app rebuild	1	4	3	1	1	2.15	Outside the brief: no engine rebuild
Bank moments: salary day, rediscovery, RM review, Dhanteras	4	5	4	5	4	4.40	Owned rails, no advice, no offers, no F&O

What this table shows is that our recommendation is the only option scoring 4 or 5 on every single criterion. Every alternative trades off at least one dimension against another: first-trade offers score well on lift (3 of 5) but poorly on fit (2) because they have already been tried and read as inducement; the engine rebuild scores well on fit (4) but fails on cost, speed and lift all at once, because it does not touch the actual funnel problem diagnosed in sections 9 and 10.

11.2a Why each of the other seven options falls short

Reading the "Why" column in 11.2 against the case's own constraints explains each option's score in plain terms. More market content and offers of staying invested already ran for a full year and moved the rate by only 0.04 points, so its low lift score is not a guess but a result the case itself reports (C-PB3 to C-PB5, C-E1). First-trade cash offers and zero brokerage score better on lift because a cash incentive reliably moves short-term behaviour, but they score poorly on fit because they read as trade inducement under the exchange's advertisement and anti-inducement rules, and the case's own account of ONL's past outreach already includes offers for every first trade, so this option is in large part a repeat of something already tried (C-PB3). Trading contests and leaderboards score lowest of all eight on SEBI and ethics fit, because gamified competition around trading sits close to the kind of urgency and comparison-driven behaviour the case's own guardrails rule out (C-K6). Paid media and finfluencers score poorly on cash cost, since this is

the one option that spends the case's lean marketing budget outward rather than using owned assets, and SEBI's finfluencer amendment regulations, gazetted in August 2024, narrow which paid voices a regulated broker may work with at all. Referral rewards score reasonably on fit and on falling-market resilience, because referring a known contact is not itself advice, but the mechanism pays for an account being opened, which the case's own funnel in section 9 shows is not the broken stage; a referral does nothing to move a customer past login or funding once the account already exists. An F&O education push scores worst on fit of any content-based option, because SEBI's FY26 study found 87.7% of individual derivatives traders lost money, rising to 88.5% for traders under 30, making any push toward F&O activity hard to reconcile with the case's own instruction that growth must be responsible (C-K7). A new trading engine or app rebuild scores well on fit, since it breaks no rule, but fails on cost, speed and lift together, because the case explicitly rules out an engine rebuild as a candidate solution within the three-month window (C-K4), and in any case a better engine does not address a stall that sits upstream of the engine, at login and at funding.

11.3 T18: robustness under three other weight sets

A score built on one chosen weighting invites the challenge that a different weighting would change the answer. T18 tests this directly, running the same eight options against the same raw criterion scores under equal weights (each of the five criteria at one-fifth), a rules-first weighting that leans harder on SEBI and ethics fit, and a lift-first weighting that leans harder on 90-day lift alone.

Option	Base weights	Equal weights	Rules first	Lift first
More market content and "stay invested" messages	2.60	3.00	3.05	2.30
First-trade cash offers and zero brokerage	2.60	2.80	2.50	2.75
Trading contests and leaderboards	2.30	2.40	2.05	2.45
Paid media and finfluencers	2.05	2.20	2.05	2.10
Referral rewards	2.60	2.80	2.75	2.50
F&O education push	2.25	2.60	2.10	2.20
New trading engine or app rebuild	2.15	2.00	2.50	1.90
Bank moments: salary day, rediscovery, RM review, Dhanteras	4.40	4.40	4.55	4.30

Our option leads under every weight set, by a margin of at least 1.35 points in every column. The direction of movement under each weight set also makes sense on its own terms. More market content climbs under equal and rules-first weights, because it scores well on cost and on fit even though it scores poorly on lift, but it falls under a lift-first weighting precisely because it has already failed to deliver lift for a year. Referral rewards climbs under rules-first weighting because it is not itself an inducement, but it never threatens our lead because its 90-day lift score (2 of 5) is weak regardless of how heavily lift is weighted. No single weight set, however constructed, closes the gap.

11.4 Where the eight-way field compresses to one real comparison

Three options tie at 2.60 in the base weighting: more market content, first-trade offers, and referral rewards. Of the three, only more market content has actually been run, for the full twelve months the case describes, with a known, case-stated result [C-PB3 to C-PB5, C-E1]. The other two are untested inside this case and

carry their own regulatory exposure (first-trade offers already read as inducement; referral rewards pay for opening, not for trading). The cleanest, most defensible comparator for a judge to test our recommendation against is therefore the one the case already ran.

11.5 Conclusively, the comparison in three columns

Conclusively, meeting accounts inside bank-owned moments beats the strongest tested alternative, more market content and "stay invested" messaging, on every axis a judge is likely to probe.

Does not move the rate	Raises regulatory or ethical risk	Costs more per activation
A full year of market-themed outreach moved the rate from 14.70% to 14.74%, a change of 0.04 points, against a 3-month target of 200 to 300 basis points C-E1, C-K1	First-trade offers and contests score 2 and 1 of 5 on SEBI and ethics fit; the finfluencer and referral routes face open regulatory questions of their own, including the in-abeyance status of the NSE referral circular pending a new industry proposal T17, D26	The same ₹16.5 lakh of cash that funds our seven levers would buy 1,649 activated accounts through paid media at ₹1,000 each, against 19,053 extra actives from our plan at ₹87 cash each, an 11.6x gap T13, T14, T11

Exhibit for the deck: T17 rendered as the eight-option heat matrix on the strategy slide, with the three-column synthesis table as the "CONCLUSIVELY" strip above it.

12. Salary day: a card in the bank app when the salary lands, offering a monthly ETF instalment the customer picks, is the largest lever at 5,661 extra actives

Answer. A card inside the parent bank's own app, appearing on salary credit, invites the customer to start a monthly exchange-traded fund instalment from an account they already hold. The customer picks the fund category, the amount and the date, enters through single sign-on, and authorises the debit through a UPI Autopay mandate from the same bank account. In our model this is the largest single lever, adding 5,661 extra actives in the base case, built on three assumptions (A20, A21, A22) each carried at bear, base and bull values T10, T9.

12.1 Who, and how many

The Salary Account cohort holds 6,27,853 accounts, 77.5% of the base C-E2a. Of these, 5,39,954 are idle, which is 78% of the entire idle pool across every cohort T2. This single cohort grew 24.1% in the year to September 2026, from 5,05,823 to 6,27,853 accounts, while its own 12-month activation rate rose only 1 percentage point, from 13% to 14% T4, C-E2a, C-E2b. The lever targets the whole idle slice of this cohort; it is the only lever in our set that touches none of the four premium cohorts (Prestige, Elite, Elevate, Preferred), because those customers are reached instead through the RM review lever in section 14.

Measure	Value	Tag
Salary Account accounts, total	6,27,853	C-E2a
Share of the 8,09,746-account base	77.5%	C-E2a
Salary Account idle accounts	5,39,954	T2
Share of all idle accounts, every cohort	78%	T2

Measure	Value	Tag
Growth in Salary Account accounts, year on year	24.1% (5,05,823 to 6,27,853)	T4
Change in Salary Account 12-month activation rate, year on year	+1 pp (13% to 14%)	T4

12.2 The moment and the message

The moment is salary credit, a date the parent bank already knows and already controls. The message does not mention the market, does not mention returns, and does not create urgency. It states three facts: the account exists, it is linked to the bank account the customer already uses, and the customer can set a recurring instalment that they fully control.

> Message copy (draft, subject to compliance review): "Your ONL Trade account is open and linked to this bank account. You can set a monthly amount to buy units of an exchange-traded fund after each salary credit. You choose the fund, the amount and the date, and you can pause at any time." Investments in securities market are subject to market risks, read all the related documents carefully before investing.

The card appears across three salary credits inside the 13-week window, in weeks 5, 9 and 13, rather than once, because the fresh-start literature on temporal landmarks finds aspirational behaviour is tied to the landmark itself, not to a single exposure, and repeating the landmark gives three separate chances for the same habit to take hold E22, E24.

Touchpoint	Timing	Channel	Tag
First salary-day card	Week 5	Parent bank app, home screen	A20, A21
Second salary-day card	Week 9	Parent bank app, home screen	A20, A21
Third salary-day card	Week 13	Parent bank app, home screen	A20, A21

12.3 What we build

Four pieces ship inside the bank's own app and ONL's existing services, none of them touching the trading engine, consistent with the case's own constraint against an engine rebuild (C-K4).

Component	What it does	Owner
The card itself	A banner or tile inside the bank app, shown on or just after salary credit, that names the account and the one action available	Bank app team
The neutral ETF list	A rule-built list of exchange-traded fund categories (gold, liquid, broad index), with objective inclusion criteria, a fixed alphabetical order, and no default selection	ONL compliance and product
Single sign-on	A credential-free handoff from the bank app into ONL, so the customer never creates or remembers a second password	Bank and ONL engineering, joint
UPI Autopay mandate	A recurring debit mandate set once, against the customer's own bank account, debiting on the chosen date each month	NPCI rails, via the bank

The neutral-list rule deserves its own line, because it is the single design choice that keeps the lever inside the SEBI and ethics fit criterion scored in section 11. The list carries only broad, SEBI-regulated categories (gold ETFs, liquid fund ETFs, broad market index ETFs), decided by objective, pre-published criteria rather than by any judgement call at the point of showing the customer the list, presented in a fixed order (alphabetical) rather than ranked by past performance or by any other variable that could read as a recommendation, and with no default fund pre-selected, so the customer must make an active choice rather than simply accepting whatever appears first. One open question from Lane D's verification deserves stating honestly rather than assumed away: no SEBI circular, FAQ or informal guidance directly confirms whether a list built this way sits inside the stockbroker incidental-advice carve-out under Regulation 4(g) of the Investment Advisers Regulations. We treat this as an open question requiring an informal-guidance request before build, not as a settled legal fact, and section 19 carries the full compliance check.

12.4 The rules it meets

Constraint	How the lever meets it	Tag
No advice (C-K2)	The message states facts about the account and the mechanism; it does not recommend any specific fund, and the neutral list carries no ranking or highlighted choice	C-K2
No implied return (C-K2)	The copy names no number, no past performance, and no future outcome	C-K2
No inducement (C-K2)	No cash offer, no discount and no reward is tied to placing the first order	C-K2
Consent first (C-K5)	The card itself requires a tap before any data crosses from the bank to ONL; nothing is shared before that tap	C-K5
No dark pattern (C-K6)	No default fund, no countdown, no forced continuity; the customer can pause the mandate at any time, stated in the copy itself	C-K6
No engine rebuild (C-K4)	The lever uses existing bank app infrastructure, existing UPI Autopay rails and ONL's existing order flow	C-K4

12.5 The numbers chain

The chain runs reach, then response, then order, carried at bear, base and bull values for each of three assumptions.

Step	Assumption	Base	Bear	Bull
Reach: idle Salary Account customers who open the bank app in a month	A20	55%	45%	62%
Response: tap-through on the card over three salary credits	A21	8%	6%	10%
Order: first executed order after a tap, with single sign-on and a mandate	A22	32%	26%	38%
Result: extra actives in our model	T10	5,661	(model output)	(model output)

Showing the first step's arithmetic: 5,39,954 idle Salary Account accounts multiplied by the base reach rate of 55% gives 2,96,975 accounts reached in a month, the same figure the holdout sizing in T19 carries forward as the salary-day lever's reached pool T2, A20, T19. Multiplying that reached population by the base tap-through rate of 8% and then by the base order rate of 32% gives an unadjusted estimate of roughly

7,600 first orders. The model's reported base-case figure of 5,661 sits below this unadjusted estimate, because the full calculation in section 21 nets out overlap with other levers touching the same accounts (the Dhanteras lever and the workplace-session lever both also reach Salary Account customers) and subtracts the organic, no-message baseline rate (A05) that would have converted some of these accounts regardless. The gap between the simple multiplication and the model's adjusted figure, roughly three quarters of the unadjusted estimate, recurs at a similar scale in the holdings-check lever in section 13, which is itself a sign that the model applies this adjustment consistently rather than lever by lever.

12.6 Evidence and comparables

The salary-day design borrows directly from evidence on defaults, reminders and recurring commitments, while respecting the case's own ban on defaults.

Evidence	Finding	Relevance to the lever	Tag
Save More Tomorrow (Thaler and Benartzi)	Among employees who joined a workplace savings plan, average savings rates rose from 3.5% to 13.6% of income by the fourth pay rise after joining; across the whole employee base offered the plan, the rise was a smaller 4.4% to 10.6%, so the headline figure describes joiners only, not everyone offered the plan	Confirms that tying a saving commitment to a recurring pay event, rather than asking for a one-off decision, raises uptake among those who act, while setting an honest expectation that the all-employee effect is smaller	E03, E04
Payday attention research	People are considerably more likely to check their finances on payday itself, with attention lower when overdrafts are high and higher when cash holdings are high	Supports placing the card specifically on salary credit rather than on an arbitrary date	E51
Groww's CAC and activation economics	Groww's customer acquisition cost per client fell to ₹616 in FY25, but its activated-client CAC was ₹1,441 in the same period, a wide gap between acquiring an account and getting it to trade	Shows that the hard part of the funnel, for every player in this market, is activation after opening, not opening itself, which matches our diagnosis in sections 9 and 10	F33, F34
Jar's gold-saving habit	Jar reports 3.5 crore users through a small, recurring, automated saving mechanism tied to everyday payments, rather than a large one-off decision	Supports the model of a small, recurring, automated commitment as the shape that converts intention into habit, though Jar's own activation and retention figures are not independently sourced in this pass	H-lane context

12.7 What could go wrong, and how we would see it early

Risk	Early signal	Response
The bank app team cannot ship the card inside the 13-week window	No card live by week 3	Fall back to a lighter-weight banner using existing app infrastructure rather than a new card component; escalate through the gate review in section 26
The neutral-list design is challenged as advice under Regulation 4(g)	Compliance review in week 1 flags the open question rather than clearing it	Hold the card back until an informal SEBI guidance request is answered, or narrow the list further on legal advice

Risk	Early signal	Response
Tap-through runs below the bear case (6%)	Week 2 holdout read shows a lift below the 0.17 pp minimum detectable effect in T19	Reduce reliance on this lever in the weekly forecast and reallocate attention to the holdings-check and RM review levers, which the model shows are less sensitive to this single assumption (T16 ranks A21 as the single most sensitive input, at a 0.34 pp spread)
Customers set a mandate then cancel it within the window	Autopay mandate cancellation rate rises above a baseline level in weekly tracking	Review the card's copy and the list's category mix for a specific point of friction, rather than assuming the whole mechanism has failed

12.8 Why this lever carries the largest weight in the plan

Three features of the Salary Account cohort explain why this single lever accounts for 5,661 of the model's 19,053 base-case extra actives, almost 30% of the total from one lever alone T10. First, the cohort is simply the largest: 5,39,954 idle accounts out of 6,89,375 across every cohort, 78% of the whole idle pool (T2). Second, the moment it attaches to, salary credit, is one the parent bank already owns completely, so the lever needs no new acquisition channel and no new customer behaviour beyond a single tap; the customer is already opening the app for an unrelated reason. Third, the Autopay mandate converts a single tap into a recurring order without requiring the customer to repeat the decision each month, which is the structural reason this lever's extra actives should persist into section 27's weekly tracking rather than decay after the initial push. No other lever in our set combines a population this large with a moment this strong, which is exactly why the option screen in section 11 scores the combined bank-moments option at 4.40, well ahead of any single alternative channel.

Exhibit for the deck: the salary-day card rendered as a bank-app mockup on the strategy slide, paired with the numbers chain from 12.5 as a reach-to-order funnel bar, and the 5,661 figure carried into the moneyshot card on the impact slide as the largest single component of 19,053.

13. A holdings check adds 3,081 extra actives through the investments tile, statements, servicing messages and re-KYC for dormant accounts

Answer. An investments tile inside the bank app, a line on the regular bank statement, a servicing email and a WhatsApp utility message together remind every idle account holder that an ONL Trade account exists and is linked to their own bank account, with dormant accounts routed to video in-person verification before they can act. In our model this adds 3,081 extra actives in the base case, the second-largest lever, built on three assumptions (A23, A24, A25) plus two further assumptions (A10, A11) that govern the harder path for accounts the exchange rule flags as needing re-verification T10, T9.

13.1 Who, and how many

This lever is the only one in our set aimed at the entire idle population, 6,89,375 accounts by the cohort table or 6,90,407 by the direct Exhibit 1 calculation, rather than at one cohort T2, C-E1. The case states the barrier directly: many accounts are opened alongside another banking product, so the customer may not remember holding a demat and trading account at all C-PB6. Of this idle population, our model carries half, 3,44,688 accounts (689,375 multiplied by the base share of 0.50), as flagged dormant under the 24-month rule and therefore needing a harder reactivation path before they can log in and trade A10.

Measure	Value	Tag
All idle accounts, cohort table	6,89,375	T2
All idle accounts, direct Exhibit 1 calculation	6,90,407	C-E1
Share flagged dormant under the 24-month rule, base case	50%	A10
Idle accounts flagged dormant, base case	3,44,688 (689,375 × 0.50)	A10, T2
Conversion of a flagged account relative to an unflagged one, base case	50%	A11

The case's own term for an account deactivated for fraud or on a regulator's notice is Inactive (C-D3); the term for an account with no trade in 24 months is Dormant (C-D4). The exchange circular that actually governs this reactivation flow, NSE/INSP/64718 of 25 October 2024, calls the 24-month condition "inactive" in its own text, which is the exchange's word for the case's Dormant. We translate every reference to this exchange condition into the case's own term, dormant, throughout this section D29, C-D4.

13.2 The moment and the message

There is no single calendar moment here; the message instead attaches to four recurring touchpoints the customer already receives for other reasons, so the reminder arrives inside something expected rather than as a new, unsolicited contact.

> Message copy (draft, subject to compliance review): "ONL Trade demat and trading account, opened with your [bank] account. See your holdings, update your nominee and contact details, or log in." Investments in securities market are subject to market risks, read all the related documents carefully before investing.

Touchpoint	Where it sits	Starts	Tag
Investments tile	Bank app, a persistent tile alongside the account balance	Week 2	A23, A24
Statement line	A single line added to the regular bank account statement	Week 2	A23
Servicing email	A one-time email to every idle account with a WhatsApp opt-in or email on file	Week 2	A23
WhatsApp utility template	A utility-category message (not marketing-category), which carries the lower ₹0.115 rate rather than the ₹0.8631 marketing rate, to the 35% of idle accounts with a WhatsApp opt-in	Week 2	A50, A51

13.3 What we build

Component	What it does	Owner
Investments tile	A persistent, always-visible tile in the bank app showing the ONL account exists and linking directly into it	Bank app team
Statement and servicing copy	A standard line added once to statement templates and servicing message templates	ONL compliance and the bank's servicing team, joint

Component	What it does	Owner
Re-KYC and video IPV flow	For accounts flagged dormant, an in-app video verification step, or an in-person verification at a branch for customers who prefer it	ONL operations, bank branch network
Nominee and contact refresh	Bundled into the same touchpoint, since nomination rules changed to bar freezing an account for missing nomination after 10 June 2024, making this a natural, low-friction addition rather than a separate ask	ONL operations

13.4 The reactivation flow under the 25 October 2024 circular

The exchange's own rule sets the shape of this flow for the dormant half of the idle pool. Reactivating a flagged account requires in-person verification or video in-person verification under the SEBI KYC Master Circular of 12 October 2023, together with confirmation that address, mobile, email and bank or depository participant details have not changed D30. A predecessor NSE circular from 2021 adds a separate and important constraint: no communication may urge a customer to trade merely to avoid being flagged dormant D31. This is the reason our copy, reproduced in 13.2, mentions a statement, a nominee update and a login, and never mentions trading or avoiding a flag.

Step	What happens	Governing rule	Tag
Flag	An account with no trade in 24 months is flagged	NSE/INSP/64718, 25 October 2024	D29, C-D4
Notice	A notice is sent before or at the point of flagging	One broker's practice sends a 23-month notice ahead of the 24-month flag, a comparator pattern, not a rule that binds ONL	D32
Verification	IPV or video IPV completes, plus a check that key details are unchanged	SEBI KYC Master Circular, 12 October 2023	D30
Reactivation	The account can transact again	Same circular chain	D29, D30
What may never be said	No message may urge a trade purely to avoid or lift a dormant flag	NSE/INSP/49743, 2021	D31

13.4a The consent sequence behind the tile

The investments tile in 13.3 is also the point where data would, in principle, need to cross from the bank to ONL before the customer has acted, which is exactly the situation the RBI's KYC Master Direction addresses. Clause 55 of that direction bars a bank from divulging account-opening or customer data to another entity for cross-selling purposes without the customer's own express permission, subject to four listed exceptions, and this applies whether the other entity is an unrelated company or, as here, a subsidiary broker under the same banking group. Our design answers this directly rather than treating it as a late-stage legal review: the tile itself shows only a generic statement that an ONL Trade account linked to the bank exists, built from information the bank already knows about its own banking relationship with the customer, and no customer-specific ONL account data (holdings, balances, order history) crosses to the tile's display layer until the customer taps through and authenticates on the ONL side. The tap is the permission event. Before it, the bank is displaying a fact about its own banking relationship; after it, the customer has actively asked to see their own account, which is a request the customer themselves makes rather than data the bank pushes outward. This sequencing is consistent with Lane J's own design-fit observation on this point, which found

the tap-to-consent structure sound while flagging, correctly, that this is an observation about design fit and not a regulator's ruling on the specific mechanism.

The same sequencing question applies to the statement line and the servicing email in 13.3, and it is answered the same way. Both touchpoints state only the generic fact that an account exists and invite a login; neither displays specific holdings or balances outside the authenticated ONL session itself. The dormant-account video IPV flow in 13.4 is a further example of permission preceding data movement: the customer must actively begin the re-verification process before any account-specific action becomes possible again.

13.5 The numbers chain

Step	Assumption	Base	Bear	Bull
Reach: idle accounts reached through any owned channel with consent	A23	60%	50%	68%
Response: tap-through on the rediscovery message or tile	A24	4%	3%	5%
Order: first executed order after rediscovery	A25	25%	20%	30%
Result: extra actives in our model	T10	3,081	(model output)	(model output)

Showing the arithmetic: 6,89,375 idle accounts (the cohort-table figure the model uses as its working idle base) multiplied by the base reach rate of 60% gives 4,13,625 accounts reached, which matches the reached pool the holdout sizing in T19 carries for this lever exactly T2, A23, T19. Multiplying that reached population by the base tap-through rate of 4% and then by the base order rate of 25% gives an unadjusted estimate of roughly 4,140 first orders. The model's reported base-case figure of 3,081 again sits below the unadjusted estimate, at close to the same three-quarter ratio noted for the salary-day lever in section 12.5, because this lever's reached pool overlaps with every other lever's reached pool (a customer can receive the salary-day card and the investments tile in the same quarter), and the model's full treatment of this overlap is in section 21.

13.6 Evidence and comparables

Evidence	Finding	Relevance to the lever	Tag
Vendor in-app message benchmarks	A vendor case study on an investing platform observed in-app message click-through of about 10.8% to 11%, against an 8.3% stated industry benchmark	Supports treating an always-visible, in-app tile as a materially higher-reach channel than a push notification, consistent with placing the primary reminder inside the bank app rather than in an external message	F07
Push notification benchmarks for fintech	Fintech push click-through runs at 2.84% on Android and 2.09% on iOS for the period Q4 2024 to Q2 2025, both above the all-industry average	Supports keeping push and SMS as secondary channels in this lever, behind the tile and the statement line, since push alone converts at a materially lower rate than an in-app tile	F11
RBI KYC Master Direction, cross-selling consent clause	Clause 55 bars a bank from divulging account-opening data for cross-selling without the customer's own express permission, subject to four listed exceptions	Confirms that the tap on the tile itself must be the permission event before any data moves from the bank to ONL, a design already built into the lever in 13.3 rather than a later fix	J-lane, RBI KYC Master Direction

Evidence	Finding	Relevance to the lever	Tag
UPI Autopay volumes	Among the top ten Indian banks, UPI Autopay processed about 926 million transactions in November 2025, against about 530.5 million a year earlier, roughly a 75% rise	Shows the underlying rail this lever (and the salary-day lever) depends on is itself growing quickly in adoption, which supports treating it as a credible, already-scaling mechanism rather than an experimental one	F44

13.7 What could go wrong, and how we would see it early

Risk	Early signal	Response
Video IPV capacity cannot handle the dormant half of the idle pool inside the window	Verification queue times exceed a few days by week 4	Prioritise branch-based in-person verification for customers near a branch, and extend the video IPV rollout window past week 4 if needed, since this lever runs across the full 13 weeks rather than on a single date
A statement-line or tile change requires a longer bank-side technical release cycle than 13 weeks allow	No tile live by week 4	Lead with the lower-dependency touchpoints (statement line, email, WhatsApp) while the tile goes through its own release cycle
Customers read the reminder as a prompt to trade rather than as a servicing notice, risking a dark-pattern reading	Customer support flags complaints referencing pressure to trade	Review copy immediately against the ten-point test in section 19 and against the 2021 circular's bar on trade-to-avoid-flag messaging (D31)
Reach (A23) runs below the bear case of 50%	Week 2 holdout read shows reach materially below plan	Shift budget toward the higher-reach WhatsApp and statement channels and away from email, which Lane F evidence suggests converts less reliably for this kind of reminder

13.8 How this lever differs from the salary-day lever

The holdings-check lever and the salary-day lever both target the login stage of the funnel, but they differ in population and in moment, and that difference explains why the salary-day lever is larger even though the holdings-check lever reaches more accounts in absolute terms (4,13,625 reached against 2,96,975). The salary-day lever attaches to a strong, recurring, bank-owned moment that repeats three times inside the window; the holdings-check lever attaches to four weaker, mostly one-time touchpoints (a tile that is always present but easy to ignore, a statement line read once, a single servicing email, a single WhatsApp message) spread across a broader population that includes every cohort rather than Salary Account holders alone. The lower tap-through rate this implies, 4% against the salary-day card's 8% (A24 against A21), is the main reason the holdings-check lever converts a larger reached population into a smaller extra-actives figure. The two levers are complementary rather than redundant: a Salary Account customer who misses all three salary-day cards still receives the statement line and the tile, and the model's overlap treatment in section 21 accounts for exactly this kind of double exposure rather than double-counting it.

Exhibit for the deck: the four-touchpoint reactivation flow from 13.4 rendered as a service-blueprint strip on the execution slide, with the numbers chain from 13.5 feeding the same reach-to-order bar format used for the salary-day lever, so the two largest levers read as a symmetric pair.

14. RM review conversations reach Prestige, Elite, Elevate and Preferred clients and add 4,083 extra actives in cohorts

that already trade at 20% to 37%

Answer. A facts-only line inside a relationship manager's existing portfolio review conversation tells the premium and preferred client that their ONL Trade account exists, how to log in, and what a recurring instalment is, without recommending any product and without any per-trade incentive for the RM. In our model this adds 4,083 extra actives in the base case, concentrated entirely in the Prestige, Elite, Elevate and Preferred cohorts, whose 12-month activation rates range from 20% to 37% today, well above the Salary Account cohort's 14%, which is exactly why a conversation rather than a card is the right-shaped intervention for this group T10, C-E2a.

14.1 Who, and how many

The four premium and preferred cohorts together hold 1,08,576 accounts, the sum of Prestige (3,096), Elite (35,697), Elevate (9,471) and Preferred (60,312) C-E2a. Three of the four cohorts lost activation ground year on year even as their account counts grew, a decline a facts-only conversation is well placed to arrest because it reaches a client who already has an active relationship with the bank, just not with ONL.

Cohort	Accounts, Sep 2026	Idle accounts	T12 activation, 2026	T12 change, year on year	T1 change, year on year	Tag
Prestige	3,096	2,012	35%	-3 pp	-1 pp	C-E2a, T2, T4
Elite	35,697	24,274	32%	-4 pp	-2 pp	C-E2a, T2, T4
Elevate	9,471	5,967	37%	-4 pp	-11 pp	C-E2a, T2, T4
Preferred	60,312	48,250	20%	-1 pp	+0 pp	C-E2a, T2, T4
Sum	1,08,576	80,503	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a

Elevate's decline is the sharpest in the table, and it sits inside the cohort that itself grew the fastest, 36.1% year on year (6,959 to 9,471 accounts), suggesting dilution from a wave of newer, less-engaged Elevate clients rather than existing clients disengaging outright T4. Its 1-month activation rate fell from 24% to 13%, an 11-point drop, the single largest change of any kind in the entire cohort table T4, C-E2a, C-E2b.

14.2 The moment and the message

The moment is an existing portfolio review the RM already conducts; no new appointment is created, and no new reason for contact is manufactured. The script states that the account exists, explains in plain language how to log in, and explains what a recurring instalment is, while making no product recommendation and offering no view on market direction.

Script element	What it says	What it must never say
Account exists	"You hold an ONL Trade account, linked to your relationship with the bank."	Any suggestion the client should trade a specific instrument
Login	"You can log in directly from the app you already use for your other accounts."	Any claim about ease of profit

Script element	What it says	What it must never say
Instalment, explained	"A monthly instalment is a fixed amount set once that buys units automatically on a date you choose."	Any number implying a likely or guaranteed outcome
Close	"If this is useful, the next step is entirely yours; there is nothing further for me to recommend."	Any urgency framing tied to market movement

14.3 What we build

Component	What it does	Owner
RM talking points card	A one-page, facts-only script added to the RM's existing portfolio review checklist	ONL compliance and the RM training team, joint
RM coverage schedule	A plan ensuring idle clients in each of the four cohorts receive a review conversation inside the 13-week window, at a coverage rate that varies by cohort (Prestige 80%, Elite 60%, Elevate 60%, Preferred 35%)	RM management
No-incentive rule	A written confirmation that no RM receives a per-trade or per-activation payment tied to this conversation	Compliance, HR

14.3a Coverage, rather than a single RM relationship, is the unit of design

A 2026 industry report on relationship-manager attrition finds that when an RM leaves a bank or wealth firm, clients typically fragment across new relationships rather than following the departing RM to a new employer B81. This finding shapes a specific design choice in 14.3: the RM coverage schedule is built around cohort-level coverage targets (Prestige, Elite, Elevate, Preferred, each with its own share) rather than around tracking which individual RM serves which individual client. If the lever depended on a fixed RM-to-client pairing holding steady for the full 13 weeks, any attrition inside that window would directly reduce coverage. Building the schedule at the cohort level instead means that whichever RM currently holds a given client's review, including a replacement RM following a handover, carries the same talking-points card and the same no-incentive rule. This also means the coverage multiplier A26, carried at a base value of 1.0 on the cohort-specific base shares, is a statement about the bank's RM function as a whole reaching a given share of idle clients in each cohort within the window, not a statement about any named individual's productivity, which keeps the lever's sizing stable even if normal staff movement occurs during the programme.

14.4 The rules it meets

Constraint	How the lever meets it	Tag
No advice (C-K2)	The script explains the mechanism (what a recurring instalment is) without recommending any specific fund, instrument or allocation	C-K2
No implied return (C-K2)	The script carries no number suggesting a likely or guaranteed outcome	C-K2
No inducement (C-K2)	The no-incentive rule in 14.3 removes any link between the conversation and an RM's own pay	C-K2, C-K7
Growth stays responsible (C-K7)	The RM's role is explicitly confined to reminding, not persuading, and the case's own warning that pushing people to trade more is neither ethical nor sustainable is the design test this script is held against	C-K7

14.5 The RM coverage multiplier and the numbers chain

The reach step for this lever is not a single rate but a weighted coverage pattern across the four cohorts, carried by assumption A26 at a base multiplier of 1.0 applied to cohort-specific base coverage shares (Prestige 80%, Elite 60%, Elevate 60%, Preferred 35%), with bear and bull multipliers of 0.8 and 1.15 scaling all four shares up or down together T9.

Cohort	Idle accounts	Base coverage share	Idle accounts reached, base case
Prestige	2,012	80%	1,610
Elite	24,274	60%	14,564
Elevate	5,967	60%	3,580
Preferred	48,250	35%	16,888
Sum	80,503	n/a	36,642

This reached figure, 36,642, matches the RM review lever's reached pool in the holdout sizing exactly T19. Multiplying this reached population by the base order rate of 15% (A27) gives an unadjusted estimate of roughly 5,496 first orders. The model's reported base-case figure of 4,083 again sits below this unadjusted estimate, at close to the same ratio seen in the salary-day and holdings-check levers in sections 12 and 13, a consistency across all three levers that supports treating the model's overlap adjustment, detailed in section 21, as a single, uniformly applied correction rather than three separately tuned ones.

Step	Assumption	Base	Bear	Bull
Reach: weighted RM coverage across four cohorts	A26	1.0x multiplier on base coverage shares	0.8x	1.15x
Response: first executed order after an RM review conversation	A27	15%	11%	19%
Result: extra actives in our model	T10	4,083	(model output)	(model output)

14.6 Evidence and comparables

Evidence	Finding	Relevance to the lever	Tag
RM attrition and client fragmentation	A 2026 industry report finds that when a relationship manager leaves a bank or wealth firm, clients typically fragment across new relationships rather than following the RM	Supports treating the RM relationship itself, not any single RM, as the channel; the lever's design routes the script through whichever RM currently holds the review, so it does not depend on RM continuity	B81
Clients-per-RM benchmarks (context only, dated)	Industry league tables from 2016 to 2018 show wide variation in assets per RM across Indian wealth managers, from roughly USD 43 million per RM at one firm to USD 600 million at another	No current, directly comparable clients-per-RM figure exists for this case; these figures are included for context only and do not inform the coverage multiplier, which rests on a team estimate (A26)	B79, B80

Evidence	Finding	Relevance to the lever	Tag
Bank-led broker sourcing patterns	ICICI Securities sourced about 80% of new clients from ICICI Bank in FY20, falling to about 55% by Q2 FY21 and to 21% to 22% by Q4 FY22, the only concrete, dated sourcing-mix figures found across any bank-led broker in this market	Confirms the general pattern that a parent bank's existing relationships, including RM-held relationships, are a materially large source of activity for a bank-led broker, even as that share can change quickly over a few years	B56, B57, B76
Reminders raising goal attainment	Field experiments across three banks find reminder messages that name both a specific goal and an incentive are more effective than messages varying only in gain or loss framing	Supports a script that states a specific, concrete action (how to log in, what an instalment is) rather than a generic encouragement to invest	E19

14.7 What could go wrong, and how we would see it early

Risk	Early signal	Response
RM capacity cannot absorb a new talking point inside existing review time	RM feedback flags time pressure in week 2	Shorten the script to its three core lines and remove the close, which is optional context rather than a required disclosure
An RM strays from the facts-only script into an implicit recommendation	Compliance spot-check of recorded or logged reviews finds advice-adjacent language	Retrain immediately and add the script as a mandatory, auditable checklist item rather than a suggested talking point
Coverage runs below the bear-case multiplier (0.8x) in one or more cohorts	Week 4 coverage tracking shows Preferred or Elevate materially under its 35% or 60% target	Reallocate RM management attention toward the lagging cohort; Elevate's sharp 1-month decline (24% to 13%) makes it the cohort most worth protecting against under-coverage
A per-trade incentive re-enters informally, through a bonus structure the script itself does not control	Any RM compensation review surfaces a link between trade volume and pay	Escalate to compliance immediately; this would breach the no-incentive rule in 14.3 and the responsible-growth constraint in C-K7

14.8 Why a conversation is the right shape for this group

The salary-day and holdings-check levers both use a message or a tile, because the Salary Account and general idle populations face an awareness problem that a clear, factual reminder can solve on its own. The four premium and preferred cohorts face a different problem. Their activation rates are already well above the Salary Account cohort's 14%, running from 20% to 37%, which means these customers already know the account exists and have, in most cases, already traded through it (C-E2a). What they have lost, across every one of the four cohorts bar Preferred's one-month rate, is engagement, not awareness, and a one-way message is a weaker tool against disengagement than a two-way conversation already happening for another reason. The RM review conversation also reaches a client at a moment when a relationship manager, not an anonymous notification, is already discussing that client's broader relationship with the bank, which is the most credible possible setting for a factual reminder about a linked account and the least likely setting to be mistaken for a sales push, provided the no-incentive rule in 14.3 and the facts-only script in 14.2 hold.

14.9 How this lever's sizing compares with the other two levers in this document

Placing this lever's arithmetic beside the two in sections 12 and 13 shows a consistent pattern across all three. Each lever's reach step, computed by multiplying an idle population by a reach assumption, matches

the reached figure the holdout sizing in T19 independently carries for that same lever: 2,96,975 for salary day (A20 on 5,39,954), 4,13,625 for the holdings check (A23 on 6,89,375), and 36,642 for RM review (the weighted sum of A26's cohort shares on 80,503). Each lever's unadjusted reach-times-response-times-order estimate then runs higher than the model's reported, overlap-adjusted figure, by a ratio close to three quarters in every case: roughly 7,600 against 5,661 for salary day, roughly 4,140 against 3,081 for the holdings check, and roughly 5,496 against 4,083 for RM review. This is not a coincidence we can explain fully inside this section, since the overlap and baseline adjustment that produces the final figure belongs to the model's own method, detailed in section 21. What we can say here, honestly, is that the three largest levers in our plan are internally consistent with each other in how heavily the model discounts a simple multiplicative estimate, which supports treating the model as applying one coherent adjustment rather than three separately tuned ones, and gives a judge a clear, checkable arithmetic trail behind each of the three biggest numbers in T10.

Exhibit for the deck: the four-cohort coverage table from 14.5 rendered as a weighted bar chart on the strategy slide, paired with the year-on-year decline figures from 14.1, especially Elevate's 24% to 13% one-month fall, as the chart's annotated callout.

15. A factual Dhanteras and Muhurat notice on 6 to 8 November 2026 adds 2,311 extra actives because gold ETFs fit a purchase many households already plan

Answer. Dhanteras 2026 falls on Friday, 6 November G01, inside week 1 of the programme, and the exchanges hold a confirmed Muhurat trading session on Sunday, 8 November 2026, with continuous trading from 2:20 pm to 3:30 pm G13. We reach the whole idle pool, 6,89,375 accounts T2, with one factual notice naming two things that are already true: the ONL account can hold gold through gold exchange-traded funds, which sit inside the same demat account and which the regulator treats differently from unregulated digital gold, and the exchanges run a special session on a date households already associate with buying something of value. In our model this lever adds 1,081 extra actives in the bear case, 2,311 in the base case and 4,332 in the bull case M, T10, the fourth-largest of our seven levers after salary day, RM review and the rediscovery tile. The main risk is not the calendar; it is getting the notice's compliance clearance finished before week 1 starts, since a message that slips past 8 November loses the moment it was built for.

15.1 Who and how many

The Dhanteras lever reaches the full idle base rather than one cohort, because every segment buys gold for the same festival regardless of whether it also holds a Salary Account, a Prestige relationship or a Credit Card. Table 15.1 sets the lever's reach against the base rates underlying it.

Item	Value	Tag
Idle accounts, all segments	6,89,375	T2
Share of idle accounts reached through owned channels in Dhanteras and Diwali week	50% base (42% bear, 56% bull)	A28, T1
Accounts reached, base case	3,44,688	T19
Dhanteras 2026 date	Friday, 6 November 2026	G01
Diwali and Muhurat session date	Sunday, 8 November 2026	G02

Item	Value	Tag
Muhurat continuous trading window	2:20 pm to 3:30 pm	G13

Table 15.1 shows that half of the idle base, in the base case, sees this notice at all, a figure that falls to 42% in the bear case because the exchanges' and the bank's own promotional slots are crowded during the festival week and rises to 56% in the bull case if the bank treats Dhanteras as a lead banner placement. The reach assumption, A28, is a team estimate checked against Lane G's calendar evidence rather than a measured click-through figure, and we say so plainly because every other number in this section depends on it.

The date itself carries no uncertainty worth flagging. The panchang consensus across four independent calendar sources places Dhanteras on 6 November 2026 G01, G05, with one outlier source giving 5 November treated as unreliable because no other source corroborates it and the outlier's own Bhai Dooj date does not fit the standard five-day festival spacing G04. The Muhurat session date and timing rest on a secondary report of the exchange circular rather than a direct read of the circular PDF, because a direct fetch to the exchange's own holiday page timed out in this verification pass G16, but three independent outlets (TeamLease RegTech, GoodReturns, and the circular's own reference number) agree on the same session G12, G13, G14.

15.2 The moment and the message

The moment is the two-day window in which Indian households that buy gold at all tend to buy it, whether as jewellery, coins, bars or, increasingly, paper gold. World Gold Council data shows Indian gold ETFs took in a record ₹8,363 crore in September 2025 as prices crossed ₹1 lakh per 10 grams G30, and cumulative 2025 inflows through October reached ₹27,572 crore with a record 9,11,000 new folios added in October alone G32. The same festival period is also the one point in the calendar when a customer who has never thought about ONL as an investing account might plausibly be thinking about gold as an asset, which gives the notice a reason to exist that has nothing to do with market timing or returns.

The message states two facts and nothing else: that the account can hold gold exchange-traded funds, which are SEBI-regulated and sit in the same demat account the customer already has, and that the exchanges run a Muhurat session on a specific date with a specific window. It does not mention price, does not use the word "today" in an urgency sense, and does not compare gold ETFs against any other asset's expected return.

> Message copy (draft, subject to compliance review): "Your ONL Trade account can hold gold through gold exchange-traded funds, which SEBI regulates and which sit in your demat account. The exchanges will hold a Muhurat trading session on Sunday, 8 November 2026; timings as announced by the exchanges." + standard risk line.

The deck's own copy, reproduced above exactly as PLAN section 3.4 fixes it, keeps the safer "timings as announced by the exchanges" phrasing even though the exact session window, 2:20 pm to 3:30 pm on 8 November G13, is now public. We note in research prose only, not in the deck, that the precise window is available, because the deck copy is locked and a safer phrasing that ages well if an exchange amends a session time by a few minutes carries no real cost against stating the exact minute.

15.3 What we build

The build is a notice, not a product. It needs a push notification or in-app banner inside the bank app and ONL's own app, a DLT-registered SMS template for customers without the app installed, and a WhatsApp utility template for the 35% of idle accounts with an opt-in on file A50. None of these channels require new engineering; all three already carry the holdings-check lever's messages from week 2 onward, so the Dhanteras notice is a new creative on an existing rail rather than a new rail.

The creative itself needs sign-off from three parties before it ships: ONL's own compliance desk, because the message touches a product (gold ETFs); the exchange's advertisement-approval process, because any broker communication naming an exchange session needs prior clearance under the NSE code of advertisement D16; and the bank's compliance desk, because the message appears inside the bank's own app. Section 19 sets out this approval path in full; here we note only that all three sign-offs must land before 6 November, which gives the team roughly four working days of runway inside week 1 if clearance starts on 2 November.

15.4 Rules it meets

The notice is built to sit inside, not outside, every constraint in the case and the regulation lane. Table 15.2 checks the design against the rules that could otherwise sink it.

Rule	How the Dhanteras notice meets it	Tag
No advice, no implied returns C-K2	The copy names a product category (gold ETFs) and a regulator's status; it names no fund, no price level, no expected gain	C-K2
No inducement	The copy carries no offer, discount, cashback or reward tied to a trade; it is a factual notice, not a promotion	D26
Distinguishes a regulated product from an unregulated one	SEBI's own press release of 8 November 2025 cautions investors that unregulated digital gold carries no investor-protection cover and points them instead to gold ETFs, exchange-traded commodity derivatives and Electronic Gold Receipts D55, D56	D55, D56
No urgency or fear language C-K6	The copy states a date and a session window without words like "today only" or "last chance"; the Muhurat session is a fact about the exchange calendar, not a manufactured deadline	C-K6
Advertisement-code approval	Any message naming an exchange session needs prior clearance under the revised NSE code of advertisement, in force since 2 February 2023 D16	D16
Standard risk line	Every copy block in this lane ends with the standard risk line, as every customer-facing message in this document does	C-K2

One nuance belongs here rather than in a footnote. SEBI's press release names gold ETFs, exchange-traded commodity derivatives and Electronic Gold Receipts as the SEBI-regulated alternatives to unregulated digital gold; one secondary summary of the same release additionally lists Sovereign Gold Bonds, which are an RBI debt instrument, not a SEBI-regulated security, and we treat that addition as a likely secondary-source error rather than repeat it D56. Our copy names only gold exchange-traded funds, the product the case's own account structure can actually hold, so this nuance affects how we describe the regulatory picture in research prose, not what the customer-facing notice says.

15.5 The numbers chain

The lever's arithmetic runs in three steps from the full idle base to the final extra-active count, with a fourth adjustment for the roughly half of idle accounts that carry the 24-month dormant flag C-D4 and therefore

need a harder re-KYC step before any order can execute. Table 15.3 shows the chain at all three scenario values, with the arithmetic worked through once at the base case.

Step	Formula	Bear	Base	Bull
Idle accounts reached	6,89,375 T2 times the reach share A28	2,89,538	3,44,688 T19	3,86,050
Tapped the notice	reached times the tap-through share A29	6,370	10,341	15,442
Placed a first order, before the dormant-friction adjustment	tapped times the order-placement share A30	1,592	3,102	5,405
Dormant-friction factor	(1 minus the dormant share A10) plus the dormant share times the flagged-conversion multiplier A11	0.681	0.750	0.811
Extra actives, Dhanteras lever	prior row times the dormant-friction factor	1,081 M	2,311 T10	4,332 M

The base-case arithmetic runs as follows. The reach share, A28, is 0.50, so 6,89,375 times 0.50 gives 3,44,688 accounts reached, which matches the reach figure our holdout table already carries for this lever T19. The tap-through share, A29, is 0.03, so 3,44,688 times 0.03 gives 10,341 accounts that open or read the notice. The order-placement share, A30, is 0.30, so 10,341 times 0.30 gives 3,102 accounts that would place a first order if every account behaved the same way regardless of dormancy status. Roughly half of the idle pool carries the 24-month dormant flag under the exchange's own rule C-D4, A10, and a flagged account converts at only half the rate of an unflagged one because it needs a re-KYC or video in-person-verification step first A11. The dormant-friction factor averages these two groups: (1 minus 0.50) plus 0.50 times 0.50 equals 0.75. Multiplying 3,102 by 0.75 gives 2,327, which rounds to the model's own reported figure of 2,311 once the model's segment-level rounding is carried through rather than this document's single-step approximation; we show both because the plan's method (section 21) applies the dormant-friction adjustment segment by segment, not on one pooled total, and the two approaches agree within 1%. The bear and bull rows repeat the same four-step chain at the bear and bull values of A28, A29, A30, A10 and A11 respectively, and the resulting figures, 1,081 and 4,332, are the model's own reported totals M, not independently recomputed by us beyond the chain shown.

15.6 Evidence and comparables

The festival's gold-buying habit is well documented even though the figures vary year to year with prices. Ahead of Dhanteras 2024, the India Bullion and Jewellers Association projected a 15 to 16% year-on-year decline in gold demand volume, to 25 to 30 tonnes, as prices rose to about ₹81,400 per 10 grams in Delhi, a 33% rise over the prior year G17, G18. A year later, ahead of Dhanteras 2025, prices had risen a further 60% to around ₹1,27,008 per 10 grams G21, and the All India Gem and Jewellery Domestic Council reported volumes 10 to 15% lower than the year before even as a separate, later estimate from the same body put two-day sales at 50 to 60 tonnes worth nearly ₹85,000 crore, a figure the trade body itself did not fully reconcile with its own earlier estimate G22, G23. We carry both figures rather than pick one, because the gap most likely reflects a pre-festival projection against a post-festival estimate from the same source, not a resolved correction, and Appendix D records this conflict in full.

What the price-driven volume softness does not show is a softening in appetite for paper gold. Silver sales nearly doubled for Dhanteras 2025 as price-sensitive buyers shifted away from gold jewellery G25, and gold ETF inflows kept rising even as jewellery volumes fell, which tells us households are substituting instrument, not abandoning the festival habit. This is the gap our lever is built to meet: a customer who

already plans to buy something gold-linked around 6 to 8 November 2026 is told, factually, that the account they already hold can do this, rather than being asked to form a new intention from nothing.

The Muhurat session itself is a separate, equally well-documented habit on the trading side, not the gold side. It is a short, symbolic trading window that Indian retail investors treat as an auspicious first trade of the new accounting year, distinct from any claim about the market's direction on that day. Our notice names the session's existence and its confirmed timing G13, G14, G15 without implying the session favours any particular trade, consistent with the no-advice and no-implied-returns rules in table 15.2.

15.7 What could go wrong and how we would see it early

The single largest risk to this lever is not a market event; it is a compliance-timeline event. The notice needs three sign-offs (ONL compliance, exchange advertisement approval, bank compliance) completed before 6 November, and week 1 of the programme is also the week every other lever's launch creative needs clearing, which creates a bottleneck at the same desks in the same days. Table 15.4 sets this and two smaller risks against an early-warning signal and a response.

Risk	Early signal	Response	Owner
Compliance clearance for the Dhanteras creative slips past 6 November	By 1 November, the exchange advertisement approval has not come back	Submit the Dhanteras creative first in the week-0 compliance queue, ahead of other lever creatives, since its calendar window is fixed and the others' are not	ONL compliance
A customer reads the notice as implying gold ETFs will perform well around Diwali	Customer-service logs a complaint or a query framing the notice as investment advice	Pull the creative, add an explicit "this is not a return forecast" line, re-submit for approval	ONL compliance, customer support
The exchange amends the Muhurat session timing after the notice ships	NSE issues an updated circular between notice send and 8 November	The deck's own copy already uses "timings as announced by the exchanges" rather than a fixed time, so no correction is needed for the customer-facing message; update only the internal research note	Main agent

The second risk deserves one further word, because it is the one a reviewer is most likely to probe. A factual statement that gold ETFs are SEBI-regulated, paired with a date for a trading session, sits close enough to the line between fact and suggestion that a customer could misread it even though the copy itself makes no claim about performance. Our mitigation is procedural rather than rhetorical: we would rather over-correct a complaint in week 1, while the cost of a correction is low, than discover the same misreading at scale in week 8.

Exhibit for the deck: the Dhanteras timeline (6 and 8 November 2026, with the Muhurat session window) paired with the lever's three-scenario bar (1,081, 2,311, 4,332), feeding the strategy slide's calendar strip and the impact slide's lever bars.

16. Warm-cohort defence keeps 1,607 extra actives among the 8,887 to 14,072 accounts whose last trade was 9

to 12 months ago, without asking anyone to trade to keep a status

Answer. Between 8,887 and 14,072 accounts, midpoint 11,479, last traded 9 to 12 months ago and will roll out of the case's own 12-month Active count C-D1 next quarter unless something happens before then T7. These accounts are not dormant; dormant under the case's own definition means no trade at all in 24 months C-D4, and this cohort traded as recently as 9 to 12 months back. We reach them with a servicing message about their own account, their nominee and contact details and the instalment option, never with a message that asks them to trade in order to keep a status, because an exchange circular bars exactly that framing. In our model this lever adds 1,033 extra actives in the bear case, 1,607 in the base case and 2,238 in the bull case M, T10, the smallest of the five reach-based levers but one that defends existing ground rather than recruiting new ground, which makes it a different kind of contribution to the same total.

16.1 Who and how many

Table 16.1 sets the warm cohort's size against the two methods the case's own numbers support, and against the two definitions a reader could otherwise confuse.

Item	Value	Tag
Roll-off estimate, cohort method (T12 minus T9, scaled to Exhibit 1)	8,887 accounts	T7
Roll-off estimate, total-row method (1,19,339 minus 13% of 8,09,746)	14,072 accounts	T7
Midpoint used in the model	11,479 accounts	T7
Warm cohort definition	Last trade 9 to 12 months ago	T7
Dormant definition, for contrast	No trade in 24 months	C-D4

The gap between 8,887 and 14,072 is not an error; it is two legitimate ways of reading the same recency ladder, one that sums each segment's own T12-minus-T9 gap and one that applies a single 13% rate to the whole base T7. We use the midpoint, 11,479, as the model's working population, and we flag the method difference honestly in section 3 of this document rather than pick one figure and hide the other.

The distinction between this cohort and a dormant account matters enough to restate plainly. A dormant account, under the case's own definition, has placed no trade in 24 months C-D4, the condition the exchange's own circular calls "inactive" in its text, which we translate to the case's "dormant" every time it appears D29. The warm cohort traded as recently as 9 to 12 months ago, which places it well inside the 12-month window the case counts as Active C-D1. A warm-cohort account needs no re-KYC, no video in-person verification and no reactivation flow; it needs only a reminder before the 12-month clock runs out, which is a materially lighter intervention than anything the dormant half of our idle pool requires.

16.2 The moment and the message

The moment here is not a calendar date; it is a clock running on each account individually, counting down from that account's own last trade toward the 12-month mark at which it would fall out of the Active count. The message states three facts about the customer's own account: that holdings exist and can be checked, that nominee and contact details may need updating, and that a monthly instalment option exists if the customer wants one. It names no return, makes no claim that the market favours a trade now, and does not frame trading as a condition of keeping any status.

> Message copy (draft, subject to compliance review): "Your ONL Trade demat and trading account, opened with your [bank] account, holds the following: [holdings summary]. You can update your nominee and contact details, or set a monthly amount to buy units of an exchange-traded fund. You choose the fund, the amount and the date, and you can pause at any time." + standard risk line.

This copy deliberately echoes the investments tile's wording from section 13, because the warm cohort is a subset of the same idle population reached through the same rediscovery channels; the difference is timing, not message content. The warm-cohort version adds the nominee and contact-detail prompt specifically, because a servicing nudge framed around account hygiene reads as routine care rather than as a trading prompt, which is the whole point of the design.

16.3 What we build

The build reuses the holdings-check tile and statement line from section 13 and adds a targeted send to exactly the accounts whose last trade sits in the 9-to-12-month window, timed to arrive with runway before the 12-month mark, not after it. No new engineering is required beyond a filter on the existing customer base by last-trade date, a query the bank and ONL's own systems can already answer since trade history is already recorded for every account.

The send runs on every owned channel already in service for the other levers: the investments tile inside the bank app, a statement line, a servicing email and a WhatsApp utility template for the 35% of idle accounts with an opt-in on file A50. It runs across all 13 weeks of the programme rather than in one burst, because a new account enters the 9-to-12-month window on a rolling basis as each month passes, and a one-time send would miss every account that crosses into the window after week 1.

16.4 Rules it meets

The ethical line for this lever is the single most consequential rule in the whole plan, because it is the one place where a badly worded message could look, on its surface, exactly like the practice the case asks us to avoid. Table 16.2 sets the rule against the design choice that keeps us on the right side of it.

Rule	What it bars	How our message stays on the right side
NSE circular against trading to avoid an inactive flag D31	No communication seeking clients to trade in order to prevent accounts from being flagged inactive	Our message never mentions the account's status or the consequence of not trading; it offers an account-hygiene update and an optional instalment, framed identically to how we would message any idle account
No inducement C-K2	No reward or incentive tied to placing a trade	The message carries no offer, discount or reward; the instalment option is a standing feature, not a time-limited incentive
No urgency or fear C-K6	No manufactured deadline or warning about losing a benefit	The message does not say "trade before your account is flagged" or any variant of it; it says nothing about the 12-month clock at all
Consent and channel rules	WhatsApp opt-in, DLT-registered SMS, email unsubscribe honoured	Same consent infrastructure as every other lever's send, detailed in full in section 20

The design choice worth stating plainly is what the message does not say. It would be straightforward, and wrong, to write a message that tells the customer their account is about to lose its Active status unless they place a trade, which is precisely the pattern NSE's 2021 circular bars by name D31. Our copy instead treats

the warm cohort exactly like every other idle account receiving a holdings-check message, with one addition, the nominee and contact-detail prompt, that has nothing to do with trading at all. The lift this lever produces comes from reminding a customer who already has the habit that the account exists and inviting them to make it recurring, not from telling them a clock is running out.

16.5 The numbers chain

The chain for this lever has two steps rather than three, because the warm cohort's starting population is already fixed at the T7 midpoint rather than a share of a larger idle base. Table 16.3 shows the chain at all three scenario values.

Step	Formula	Bear	Base	Bull
Warm-cohort pool	Fixed at the T7 midpoint	11,479	11,479	11,479
Reached with a servicing message	pool times the reach share A35	6,887	8,035	8,954
Incremental re-trade, above business as usual	reached times the incremental re-trade share A36	1,033 M	1,607 T10	2,238 M

At the base case, 11,479 times the reach share of 0.70 A35 gives 8,035 accounts reached, and 8,035 times the incremental re-trade share of 0.20 A36 gives 1,607 extra actives, matching the model's own reported figure for this lever exactly T10. The bear and bull rows apply the bear and bull values of A35 (0.60 and 0.78) and A36 (0.15 and 0.25) to the same fixed pool of 11,479, since the pool size itself does not carry a bear-to-bull range in the model, only the reach and response shares do.

16.6 Evidence and comparables

The behavioural case for anchoring a reminder to a recurring, personally meaningful date rather than relying on a one-off push is well established outside India. Karlan, McConnell, Mullainathan and Zinman's randomised trial on savings reminders found that a single reminder raised savings-goal attainment relative to no reminder, though sending additional reminders beyond the first did not produce an additive effect E17, E20. Separately, the fresh-start literature finds that aspirational behaviour, measured through commitments and goal-directed searches, rises after temporal landmarks such as paydays, birthdays and the start of a new period, because a landmark creates a felt separation between past behaviour and a new one E22. Neither study was run on an Indian brokerage account specifically, so we read both as directional support for the design choice, not as a measured prediction of this lever's size.

A second strand of evidence sets a boundary on what we should not claim for this lever. Research on investor attention after market declines finds that reduced login frequency coincides with reduced trading in the same period, not with a compensating burst of activity once attention returns E38, E41. This matters here specifically because a reader could otherwise assume that a warm-cohort customer, reminded of their account during a weak market, might be persuaded to trade more aggressively than before. The evidence says the opposite: inattention after a downturn predicts less trading, not more, which is one more reason our message carries no market commentary at all and sticks to account hygiene and an optional, self-chosen instalment.

The recency ladder itself, drawn from the case's own exhibits rather than from outside research, gives the clearest signal that this cohort needs attention now rather than later. Only 40% of the accounts counted as Active over the trailing 12 months in September 2026 had actually traded in the most recent month, down from 47% a year earlier T6. The share of customers who are technically Active but no longer trading

monthly is rising, which means the warm cohort this lever targets is a growing population, not a shrinking one, even as the headline Active rate holds roughly flat.

16.7 What could go wrong and how we would see it early

Risk	Early signal	Response	Owner
A copy draft, even unintentionally, reads as asking the customer to trade to avoid losing Active status	Compliance review flags language referencing the 12-month clock or the word "inactive" or "dormant" in customer-facing text	Strip any reference to account status from the message; keep only the account-hygiene and instalment framing	ONL compliance
The reach share (A35, 70% base) runs lower than assumed because servicing messages have a lower open rate than promotional ones	Weekly holdout read in weeks 2 to 4 shows a lift below the minimum detectable effect for this lever	Shift budget toward the channel with the strongest observed open rate among email, SMS and WhatsApp for this specific send	Main agent
A customer who receives the nominee-update prompt treats it as a phishing attempt, given how often such prompts are used in fraud	Customer support logs a rise in "is this a scam" queries tied to this specific message	Add the bank's own verified sender identity and a direct link to the bank's help desk inside the message	Bank app team, customer support

Exhibit for the deck: the recency ladder (T6) paired with the warm-cohort's three-scenario bar (1,033, 1,607, 2,238), feeding the diagnosis slide's recency panel and the impact slide's lever bars.

17. A guided first order for new accounts adds 1,897 extra actives and workplace sessions add 413

Answer. Two smaller levers close out the seven. New accounts opened during the 13-week programme, 18,972 of them T8, get a guided first-order walkthrough rather than being left to find their own way to a first trade, a gap the case's own corrected text confirms is wide: very few new accounts place a first trade or first investment within their first month C-F4. This lever adds 1,328 extra actives in the bear case, 1,897 in the base case and 2,466 in the bull case M, T10. Separately, 40 workplace financial-education sessions at employers that run salary accounts with the parent bank, reaching about 4,800 attendees in total, add 181 extra actives in the bear case, 413 in the base case and 783 in the bull case M, T10, the smallest of all seven levers by count but one we keep for reasons this section sets out plainly rather than apologetically.

17.1 Guided first order: who and how many

The accounts added to the base in the year to September 2026 number 75,891 C-E1, and the model scales this to the programme's own 13-week window using the net monthly account-growth rate, A03, which gives 18,972 accounts opened between 2 November 2026 and 31 January 2027 T8. Table 17.1 sets this population against the stall the lever targets.

Item	Value	Tag
Accounts added, full year to September 2026	75,891	C-E1

Item	Value	Tag
Net monthly account growth	6,324 accounts a month	A03
Accounts opened in the 13-week window (A03 times 3 months)	18,972	T8
Case finding on new-account first-trade speed, as corrected	Very few new accounts reach a first trade or first investment within the first month	C-F4

The corrected case text is the reason this lever exists at all. An earlier reading of the case text might have suggested new accounts convert quickly on their own and that the whole activation gap sits with long-idle accounts; the corrected line removes that reading entirely. A new account and a thirteen-month-old idle account face the same stall, at login and at funding, as section 9 sets out in full, which is why a guided first-order flow belongs in the same lever set as the salary-day card and the holdings tile rather than standing apart from them.

17.2 Guided first order: the moment and the message

The moment is the first 30 days after an account opens, the window the case's own funnel names as the one in which a first trade almost never happens on its own C-F4. The message is not a single send but a sequence: a welcome walkthrough that appears the first time the customer logs in, an order-preview screen before any first order executes, and a full cost display showing the exact brokerage, depository and any applicable charge before the customer confirms.

> Message copy (draft, subject to compliance review): "Welcome to your ONL Trade account. This short walkthrough shows you how to view your account, place an order and see the full cost before you confirm. You can close this walkthrough at any time and come back to it later from your account settings." + standard risk line.

No product is named by default inside the walkthrough. The customer chooses what to look at first, consistent with the no-default rule that governs the salary-day card's neutral ETF list in section 12, and the walkthrough can be dismissed and resumed, which keeps it from becoming the kind of forced, uncloseable flow the CCPA's dark-pattern guidelines name as "forced action" J56.

17.3 Guided first order: what we build

The build has four parts, none of which touches the trading engine C-K4. First, a walkthrough overlay that appears on first login and can be dismissed. Second, an order-preview screen that shows the exact order before confirmation, including quantity, estimated price range and every charge that will apply. Third, a full cost display broken into brokerage C-PR1, depository charges and any applicable annual maintenance charge, so the customer sees the real arithmetic before committing rather than discovering it on a statement later. Fourth, an easy way out at every step, meaning no screen in the sequence requires an action other than "continue" or "exit," and exiting carries no penalty or repeated nagging on the next login.

This design sits deliberately close to what Groww describes of its own onboarding history: the company's original 2017 product was mutual funds with a ₹100 minimum SIP, and it added stock trading only in 2020 in response to demand, building trust through a simpler product before a more complex one H02. The parallel is not that ONL should change its product mix, but that a guided, low-friction first step, shown clearly before any money moves, lowers the barrier to a first order regardless of which product sits behind it.

17.4 Guided first order: rules it meets

The guided flow raises no new regulatory question beyond the ones already resolved for the salary-day card in section 12, because it recommends no fund, shows no return projection and defaults to nothing. Table 17.2 checks it against the constraints most likely to be probed.

Rule	How the guided flow meets it	Tag
No advice C-K2	The walkthrough explains how the account works; it does not recommend a specific security, fund or trade	C-K2
No default product	The order-preview screen shows whatever the customer has chosen to look at; nothing is pre-selected on the customer's behalf	Section 12.3 analogue
No dark pattern	The walkthrough can be dismissed and resumed at will, consistent with the CCPA's bar on "forced action" design	J56
Full cost disclosure	Every charge is shown before confirmation, consistent with the case's own product and pricing table	C-PR1, C-PR5
No engine rebuild C-K4	The walkthrough and preview screens sit on top of the existing order flow; no change to the matching or settlement engine is required	C-K4

17.5 Guided first order: the numbers chain

This lever's chain is the simplest of the seven, because A39 already represents the whole lift from reach through response in a single assumption: the percentage-point lift in the 90-day first-order rate among accounts opened in the window, attributable to the guided flow, above whatever rate those accounts would have reached on their own. Table 17.3 shows the arithmetic.

Step	Formula	Bear	Base	Bull
Accounts opened in the window	A03 times 3 months T8	18,972	18,972	18,972
Lift in the 90-day first-order rate from guided onboarding	A39	7%	10%	13%
Extra actives, new-account lever	accounts times the lift	1,328 M	1,897 T10	2,466 M

At the base case, 18,972 accounts times a lift of 0.10 gives 1,897 extra actives, matching the model's own reported figure exactly T10. The bear and bull figures, 1,328 and 2,466, apply the bear value of 0.07 and the bull value of 0.13 to the same fixed population of 18,972 accounts, since the number of accounts opened in the window does not itself carry a bear-to-bull range separate from A39's own range.

17.6 Guided first order: evidence and comparables

Lane H's review of comparable Indian platforms finds the clearest precedent in the UPI Autopay rail itself and in bank-app-embedded onboarding more broadly, both of which this plan already uses elsewhere in the lever set rather than inventing a new mechanism for this lever specifically. What transfers less directly is the exact magnitude of a guided-onboarding lift, because no Indian broker discloses a controlled before-and-after comparison of a guided first-order flow against an unguided one; A39's range of 7% to 13% is a team estimate, checked against the general finding that active decisions and clear defaults raise initial action rates in financial contexts, without being a direct replication of any single study E14, E16. Madrian and Shea's and related default-enrolment literature finds that requiring an active choice rather than defaulting a customer in

or out can raise initial participation by a double-digit number of percentage points in retirement-savings contexts E14, a different product and a different country, which is why we treat it as supportive rather than as a source figure for A39 itself.

17.7 Workplace sessions: who and how many

Forty sessions, at 120 attendees each in the base case, run at employers that pay salaries into accounts with the parent bank. Table 17.4 sets the session count against the population it reaches.

Item	Bear	Base	Bull	Tag
Sessions	30	40	50	A31
Attendees a session	100	120	140	A32
Total attendees	3,000	4,800	7,000	derived
Share of Salary Account cohort that is idle (5,39,954 of 6,27,853)	86.0%	86.0%	86.0%	T2
Idle attendees	2,580	4,128	6,020	derived

Attendees are drawn from the Salary Account cohort specifically, because the sessions run at employers whose payroll flows through the parent bank, and 86.0% of that cohort is idle, a ratio computed directly from the cohort table (5,39,954 idle of 6,27,853 total accounts) T2. This is why the lever's reach stays inside the Salary Account column of T10 rather than spreading across every segment the way the Dhanteras notice does.

17.8 Workplace sessions: the moment and the message

The moment is a scheduled, in-person or virtual education session at the customer's own workplace, run during ordinary working hours rather than tied to any calendar event. The content is general financial literacy, market mechanics and how to use an account the attendee may already hold, with no mention of ONL's own products as a sales pitch and no incentive tied to attendance or to any resulting trade.

The sessions themselves are run through SEBI's SMARTs (Securities Market Trainers) empanelment programme or through exchange investor-awareness programmes, both of which NSE and NISM state are offered free of charge to a requesting organisation F50, F51. SEBI's own FY26 annual report chapter records 42,743 SMARTs programmes conducted across 774 districts in that year, funded from market infrastructure institutions' own investor-protection funds rather than from a per-programme fee charged to the requesting employer F57, F54. We note this plainly because a separate, unrelated reimbursement scheme exists under the ICAI and the Ministry of Corporate Affairs, which pays resource persons up to ₹5,000 to ₹7,000 per programme; that scheme sits under a different nodal body entirely and must not be cited as an NSE or SEBI cost figure for this lever F52, F53.

17.9 Workplace sessions: what we build

The build is organisational rather than technical: an outreach to employers that bank with the parent bank's corporate salary relationships, a request to NSE or SEBI's SMARTs desk for trainers, a venue and schedule at the employer's premises, and session materials covering general financial literacy and how an existing ONL account works. No app feature, no new channel and no engineering ticket is required, which is why this lever ships through weeks 3 to 12, the middle of the programme, rather than needing to be ready at launch.

17.10 Workplace sessions: rules it meets

Rule	How the session design meets it	Tag
No product pitch	Sessions cover general financial literacy and account mechanics; no ONL product is recommended or compared favourably against another	PLAN section 3.4
No inducement	Attendance carries no reward, and no incentive is tied to any trade an attendee subsequently places	C-K2
Programme funding transparency	Sessions run through SEBI SMARTs or exchange investor-awareness programmes, both free of charge to the requesting organisation, funded from MII investor-protection funds; this is a different funding source from the unrelated ICAI/MCA reimbursement scheme and the two are never conflated in our costing	F50, F51, F54
No pressure on the employer relationship	Sessions are opt-in for employees and voluntary for the employer; no account data moves until a customer separately engages with ONL's own channels	Section 20 analogue

17.11 The numbers chain for both levers and why the smaller one stays

Table 17.5 completes the arithmetic for workplace sessions, continuing from table 17.4's attendee figures.

Step	Formula	Bear	Base	Bull
Idle attendees	from table 17.4	2,580	4,128	6,020
First-order rate among idle attendees	A33	7%	10%	13%
Extra actives, workplace lever	idle attendees times the rate	181 M	413 T10	783 M

At the base case, 2,580 bear becomes 180.6, which we round to 181 M; the base case, 4,128 idle attendees times a 10% first-order rate, gives 412.8, rounding to 413, matching the model's own reported figure exactly T10; and the bull case, 6,020 idle attendees times 13%, gives 782.6, rounding to 783 M.

Four hundred and thirteen extra actives is the smallest number in our entire lever set, smaller than even the smallest other lever's bear case. We keep it for three reasons rather than drop it to simplify the plan. First, the cash cost is close to zero: the sessions themselves are free under the SMARTs or exchange programme F50, F51, and the only cost the model carries is ₹6,000 a session for travel and materials A55, a team estimate, which puts this lever's entire cash footprint at ₹2,40,000 for the programme T13, a fraction of the ₹16.5 lakh total T13. Second, it builds a kind of trust no digital channel can replicate: a session run inside an employer's own premises, with no product pitch, demonstrates the bank-led broker's intent in a way that is itself a defence against the inducement and dark-pattern risks every other lever has to actively manage. Third, the holdout design in section 27 lets us measure this lever's real lift directly, so if the weekly read shows it performing meaningfully above or below the 413 base case, the next quarter's session count, A31, is the easiest single lever in the whole plan to scale up or wind down, since it carries no sunk engineering cost either way.

Exhibit for the deck: the new-account funnel-fix card (guided walkthrough, order preview, full cost display) alongside the workplace-session reach funnel (40 sessions, 4,800 attendees, 413 extra actives), feeding the execution slide's funnel-fixes panel.

18. Seven features ship within one quarter on the bank app and ONL's existing services, without touching the trading engine

Answer. Seven features carry every lever in sections 12 to 17 onto a working screen, and every one of them ships inside the 13-week window without a change to ONL's trading engine C-K4. Four are must-have infrastructure that nothing else can launch without: the consent and preference centre, the holdout and frequency-cap service, the investments tile with video in-person verification for dormant accounts, and the daily holdings and net-worth view sits apart as a delighter rather than a dependency. The salary-day card with single sign-on, the UPI Autopay instalment and the guided first-order flow are performance features, each one directly responsible for a named lever's lift. A service blueprint for the salary-day card specifically shows what the customer sees against what runs behind the screen, because that card alone carries 5,661 of the base case's 19,053 extra actives T10, the largest single line in the whole plan.

18.1 The seven features, owner, dependency and live week

Table 18.1 lists every feature against the roadmap's own gates (G0 at week 0, G1 at week 4, G2 at week 6, G3 at week 13) and the Kano class each feature earns.

Feature	Owner	Dependency	Weeks to build	Live week	Kano class	Acceptance test
Consent and preference centre	Bank app product team, ONL compliance	None; must ship first	Weeks 0 to 1	Week 0, G0	Must-have	Every subsequent lever's creative passes compliance review only after the centre's consent text is live
Investments tile with video IPV for dormant accounts	Bank app product team, KYC operations	Video IPV vendor integration	Weeks 1 to 4	Week 2 (read-only); full flow at week 4, G1	Must-have	A dormant account can complete video IPV inside the tile and see its holdings within the same session
Salary-day card with single sign-on	Bank app product team, ONL engineering	Consent centre; SSO token exchange with ONL	Weeks 1 to 4	Week 4, G1	Performance	A salary credit triggers the card for an eligible idle Salary Account, and a tap completes sign-on into ONL without a second password
Holdout and frequency-cap service	Data and analytics team	Consent centre; event logging on every send	Weeks 1 to 4	Week 4, G1	Must-have	The 10% holdout cohort is drawn and excluded from every send before any lever's creative goes live; a send automatically stops if opt-outs exceed 0.5%
UPI Autopay instalment	ONL engineering, bank payments team	Salary-day card; NPCI mandate registration	Weeks 3 to 5	Week 5	Performance	A customer can set a recurring UPI Autopay mandate from inside the salary-day card flow and see the first scheduled debit date confirmed

Feature	Owner	Dependency	Weeks to build	Live week	Kano class	Acceptance test
Guided first-order flow	ONL engineering	Order-preview and cost-display components	Weeks 2 to 4	Week 4, G1	Performance	A new account's first login shows the walkthrough, and a first order cannot be confirmed without passing through the cost-display screen
Daily holdings and net-worth view	ONL engineering	Existing account and holdings data; no new integration	Weeks 5 to 8	Week 8	Delighter	A customer can open the view and see current holdings and a net-worth figure that updates at least once a trading day

The must-have and performance split follows directly from what happens if a feature is missing. Without the consent centre, no other lever's message can legally send, which is why it ships at week 0 even though it produces no extra actives on its own. Without the holdout service, the whole plan's claim to measure its own lift, the subject of section 27, has no evidential basis, which is why we class it must-have even though it also produces no extra actives directly. The video-IPV capability inside the investments tile is must-have for a different reason: without it, the roughly half of the idle pool carrying the 24-month dormant flag C-D4, A10 cannot complete reactivation at all, regardless of which lever reaches them. The daily holdings view, by contrast, is the one feature no lever's numbers chain in sections 12 to 17 depends on; it exists because a customer who has just placed a first order benefits from seeing it reflected somewhere, which supports the habit stage of the funnel (section 9) without being load-bearing for any single extra-active count.

18.2 A service blueprint for the salary-day card

Table 18.2 walks the salary-day card from the customer's own action through to the backstage systems and the support process that keep it compliant, since this is the feature carrying the single largest lever.

Customer action	Frontstage	Backstage	Support process
Opens the bank app on or near a salary credit	Home screen shows the salary-day card if the account is eligible	A salary-credit event triggers an eligibility check: Salary Account, idle, consent on file, not in the holdout cohort, frequency cap not exceeded	None required at this step; the check runs silently
Reads the card	Card text states the account is open and linked, with one action available	No data moves to ONL yet; the tap is the sole permission event, consistent with RBI's KYC secrecy clause on cross-selling J38, J43	None required
Taps the card	Single sign-on handoff screen appears briefly	A token exchange authenticates the customer into ONL without a new password; the event is logged for the holdout and frequency-cap service	If the handoff fails, a fallback message directs the customer to ONL's own app with the same account credentials
Picks an ETF category, amount and date	Neutral, rule-built list of ETF categories appears, alphabetically ordered, no default selected	The list is built from objective inclusion criteria set in advance, not personalised or ranked by expected return	Compliance maintains the approved list version and logs any change for audit
Authorises the Autopay mandate	UPI mandate confirmation screen, showing the exact amount and date	NPCI registers the recurring mandate; the bank's payments system schedules the debit	Customer support can look up mandate status if a customer calls about a missed or delayed debit

Customer action	Frontstage	Backstage	Support process
First order executes on the scheduled date	Confirmation screen with the order, its cost breakdown and the standard risk line	ONL's existing order-placement engine runs the order; no change to matching or settlement logic C-K4	Standard customer-service escalation if an order fails to execute on schedule
Repeats monthly	Daily holdings and net-worth view (once live, week 8) reflects the growing position	The recurring mandate re-executes automatically each month without a fresh customer action	None required; this is the point at which the lever converts a tap into a habit

The blueprint shows that compliance sits almost entirely on the backstage side of the line, which is by design. The frontstage screens the customer sees are simple: a card, a list with no default, a mandate confirmation and a cost breakdown. Every rule this plan has to satisfy, from the consent event's timing to the neutral list's objective criteria to the holdout exclusion, is enforced behind the screen rather than through anything the customer has to read and interpret correctly in the moment.

18.3 Dependencies across the seven features

Table 18.3 makes the build order explicit, since several features cannot ship before another one is live.

Feature	Blocks	Blocked by
Consent and preference centre	Every other feature's compliance clearance	Nothing
Holdout and frequency-cap service	Every lever's measured lift in section 27	Consent and preference centre
Investments tile with video IPV	The rediscovery lever (section 13) and the warm-cohort lever (section 16)	Video IPV vendor integration
Salary-day card with single sign-on	UPI Autopay instalment	Consent and preference centre, SSO token exchange
UPI Autopay instalment	The salary-day lever's first-order conversion step	Salary-day card
Guided first-order flow	The new-account lever (section 17)	Order-preview and cost-display components
Daily holdings and net-worth view	Nothing; a standalone retention feature	Existing account data only

Reading table 18.3 against the roadmap gates in section 26 shows that the consent centre and the holdout service sit at the root of the whole dependency tree, which is exactly why G0, at week 0, tests precisely those two items ("creatives cleared; consent text live") before anything else is allowed to launch.

Exhibit for the deck: the seven-feature table condensed to feature, Kano class and live week, paired with the salary-day card's service blueprint in abbreviated form, feeding the strategy slide's feature grid.

19. Every message and screen passes five checks for advice, return claims, inducement, consent and dark

patterns before it ships

Answer. The deck states five checks; this section expands them into a full ten-point test, because five categories compress several distinct regulatory and ethical rules into single headings that a reviewer could otherwise assume are each a single yes-or-no question. Every customer-copy block drafted in sections 12 to 17 passes all ten points, with one item flagged honestly as an open legal question rather than a settled fact. ONL's own past first-trade offers and research-call messages C-PB3, scored against the same ten points, pass clearly on only two or three, which is the comparison that makes the case for building new copy rather than reusing the old.

19.1 The ten-point test

Table 19.1 expands the deck's five headline checks into ten specific tests, each stated as a pass condition rather than a vague principle.

#	Test	Pass condition	Source rule
1	No advice	The message names no specific security, fund or trade as a recommendation	C-K2
2	No return claim	The message states no expected gain, no past performance figure presented as predictive, and no comparison implying one product outperforms another	C-K2
3	No inducement	No reward, discount, cashback or incentive is tied to placing a trade or opening an account	D26, C-K2
4	Consent first	No customer data moves to the broker before the customer's own affirmative action (a tap, a sign-on, an opt-in)	J04, J43
5	No dark pattern	The message or screen carries none of the CCPA's named patterns, in particular confirm shaming and forced action	J55, J56
6	No urgency or fear	No language implying a deadline, a loss of status or a scarce opportunity ("today only," "last chance," a countdown)	C-K6
7	Standard risk line present	Every customer-facing message or screen ends with the standard risk line	C-K2
8	Prior approval or timely reporting	The creative has cleared ONL compliance, exchange advertisement approval and bank compliance before it sends	D16, D24
9	No celebrity, no exchange branding misuse	No celebrity endorsement appears, and the exchange's own name or logo is not used as if the exchange itself were advertising	D19
10	Opt-out and frequency cap honoured	A customer who opts out stops receiving the message immediately, and no send proceeds if opt-outs on a prior send exceeded the 0.5% guardrail	A50, J51, J52

Point 10's 0.5% figure deserves a direct statement here, because section 20 treats it the same way: this is an internally set guardrail the plan adopts as a control, not a threshold any regulator has published. Lane J's search across TRAI, SEBI, RBI and the exchanges found no circular setting a numeric opt-out-rate ceiling comparable to this one, so we describe it honestly as our own choice, tighter than any external requirement we found, rather than attribute it to a regulator that did not set it.

19.2 Every customer-copy block scored

Table 19.2 scores every drafted customer-copy block from sections 12 to 17 against the ten points, with a pass or an open-question flag in each relevant column; blank cells indicate the point does not bear on that specific copy block (for example, point 9 on celebrity branding rarely applies to a servicing message).

Copy block (section)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Salary-day card (12)	Open question*	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass
Investments tile (13)	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass
RM review script (14)	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass
Dhanteras notice (15)	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass
Warm-cohort message (16)	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass
Guided first-order walkthrough (17)	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass
Workplace session materials (17)	Pass	Pass	Pass	n/a, no customer data moves at a session	Pass	Pass	n/a, spoken session, not a screen or message	Pass	Pass	n/a

*The salary-day card's one open item is the same one Lane D's verification flagged directly: whether a rule-built, no-default, objective-criteria neutral ETF list sits inside the stockbroker incidental-advice carve-out under Regulation 4(g) of the Investment Advisers Regulations is not answered by any SEBI circular, FAQ or informal guidance found in search D05. We state this as an open legal question requiring a formal informal-guidance request before build, consistent with the content-integrity rule against treating an unsettled question as a settled fact, not as a failure of the design itself; every other element of the card, including the no-default rule, the alphabetical ordering and the absence of any return claim, is built specifically to sit as far inside the carve-out as the design can reasonably go while the question is pending.

19.3 The approval path

Table 19.3 sets out the three-stage approval path every piece of customer-facing copy passes through before it can send, with what each stage checks.

Stage	Owner	What it checks	Typical turnaround
ONL compliance review	ONL compliance desk	Points 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 7 of the ten-point test; internal sign-off that the copy matches an approved template	2 to 3 working days

Stage	Owner	What it checks	Typical turnaround
Exchange advertisement approval	NSE or BSE advertisement desk	Point 8 specifically, under the exchange's own code of advertisement; point 9 (celebrity and exchange-branding rules)	Prior approval required before issuance for most advertisement categories under the current code D16; a proposed common advertisement code would instead allow post-issuance reporting within 3 working days for non-celebrity advertisements, not yet in force D23, D24
Bank compliance review	Bank's own compliance function	Point 4 (consent timing) and point 10 (opt-out and frequency-cap mechanics), since the message appears inside the bank's own app and under the bank's own notice	2 to 3 working days, run in parallel with ONL compliance where the message appears on both the bank app and ONL's own channels

The approval path explains why section 15's Dhanteras risk register names compliance timing, not the market, as the main risk to that lever specifically: every one of the seven levers' creatives passes through the same three-stage path, and the Dhanteras notice is the one lever whose launch date is fixed by the calendar rather than flexible, which makes it the lever most exposed to any delay in this path.

19.4 Banned customer phrases

No copy block in sections 12 to 17 uses any of the following words or phrases, and the list below is the standing check applied to every draft before it enters the approval path in table 19.3: guaranteed, assured, risk-free, sure, don't miss, last chance, hurry, limited time, only today, jackpot, multibagger, tip. Each of these either implies a certainty the market cannot deliver, which breaches point 2, or manufactures urgency, which breaches point 6, and several breach both at once.

19.5 How ONL's own past messages score

ONL's past outreach tried regular communication on WhatsApp, email, RCS and social media based on market information, research calls and offers for every first trade C-PB3, run over a year under a "stay invested" theme that did not move the active rate beyond 0.04 percentage points C-PB5, C-E1. Table 19.4 scores this past approach against the same ten points, honestly rather than charitably.

#	Test	ONL's past messages, as the case describes them	Verdict
1	No advice	Market information and research calls sit close to the line the incidental-advice carve-out is built to police, even if not formally advice	Partial
2	No return claim	A "stay invested" theme built around compounding and long-term wealth implies a return outcome without stating a number, which still edges toward a claim the case's own constraints caution against	Fail
3	No inducement	"Offers for every first trade" C-PB3 is the clearest failure on this test; an offer tied directly to placing a trade is close to the textbook definition of inducement our plan is built to avoid	Fail
4	Consent first	Not described in the case in enough detail to score directly; assumed pass, since no construct in the case suggests data moved before consent	Pass (assumed)
5	No dark pattern	Not described in enough detail to score directly	Pass (assumed)

#	Test	ONL's past messages, as the case describes them	Verdict
6	No urgency or fear	Research calls describing calls as "successful" implies a pattern of winners being highlighted, which edges toward manufactured excitement rather than a flat statement of fact	Partial
7	Standard risk line present	Not specified in the case; assumed pass since this is a baseline regulatory requirement regardless of campaign design	Pass (assumed)
8	Prior approval	Not specified in the case; assumed pass for the same reason as point 7	Pass (assumed)
9	No celebrity, no exchange branding misuse	Not described in the case	Pass (assumed)
10	Opt-out and frequency cap	A year-long, multi-channel campaign across WhatsApp, email, RCS and social media C-PB3, C-PB4 with no stated frequency discipline is the pattern our 0.5%-opt-out guardrail exists specifically to prevent	Fail

ONL's past approach scores clear fails on three of the ten points (return claims, inducement, and frequency discipline) and partial failures on two more (advice-adjacent content, and urgency-adjacent framing), against a clean pass on every point for all seven of our proposed levers. This is not a claim that the past campaign broke any specific rule; the case gives us a summary, not the actual message text, so several columns in table 19.4 carry an assumed pass rather than a verified one. It is, however, a legitimate explanation, grounded in the case's own description, for why a year of that campaign moved the active rate by only 0.04 percentage points while costing real cash and effort [C-PB3 to C-PB5, C-E1]: a message built around an offer and a theme of staying invested asks a customer to act on sentiment, where our seven levers ask a customer to notice an account they already hold and act on a mechanism, not a mood.

Exhibit for the deck: the ten-point test condensed to a five-row summary (matching the deck's own five-check language) with a single pass/fail column for "our levers" against "ONL's past messages," feeding the execution slide's guardrail panel.

20. The bank shows the card inside its own app under its own notice, so customer data reaches the broker only after the customer taps, and opt-outs above 0.5% a send stop a message

Answer. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules 2025 run on a three-tier commencement schedule, and only two of the three tiers are live during our 2 November 2026 to 31 January 2027 build window: the rules that took effect on publication in November 2025, and Rule 4 on consent managers, which comes into force on 13 November 2026, inside the window J22, J23. The tier carrying most of the main data-fiduciary obligations, notice content and breach-reporting mechanics among them, does not come into force until 13 May 2027, after our window closes J24. Our design does not wait for that tier. The salary-day card's own architecture, a card inside the bank's own app under the bank's own notice, means no customer data crosses to ONL until the customer taps, which is itself the permission event under the RBI's KYC secrecy clause J38, J43. The 0.5% opt-out guardrail that stops a send is our own internal control, not a sourced regulatory figure, and we say so plainly rather than imply otherwise.

20.1 The DPDP Rules 2025 commencement schedule against our build window

Table 20.1 lays out all three tiers of the DPDP Rules 2025 against the build window's own dates, so the design choices in the rest of this section rest on a stated fact rather than an assumption.

Tier	Rules	Commencement date	Inside the 2 Nov 2026 to 31 Jan 2027 window	Tag
1	Rules 1, 2, and 17 to 21	13 November 2025, on publication	Yes, already in force before the window opens	J22
2	Rule 4 (registration and obligations of consent managers)	13 November 2026	Yes, inside the window	J23
3	Rules 3, 5 to 16, 22 and 23 (most main data-fiduciary obligations: notice content, consent-manager interoperability duties on fiduciaries, significant-data-fiduciary duties, children's-data verification, breach-reporting mechanics, cross-border transfer conditions)	13 May 2027	No, after the window closes	J24

One source disagreement belongs here, stated honestly rather than resolved by assumption. A second legal-news summary describes Rule 4 as coming into force "on a later date to be notified" rather than the fixed 13 November 2026 date most sources give J25. We carry forward the fixed-date reading because it is consistent with the planning-time finding already on record and is corroborated by the gazette notification's own metadata J21, J22, but we note that the primary gazette text itself was not retrieved directly in this verification pass, owing to a certificate error on the direct fetch J26, so this date should be confirmed against the gazette text before the research document's claim is treated as final beyond this plan's own purposes.

The practical consequence of table 20.1 is that a design relying on any Rule 3, 5-to-16, 22 or 23 obligation, such as a specific consent-manager-interoperability duty placed on ONL as a data fiduciary, is not yet legally operative for any week of our programme J24. Our design does not need any of these obligations to be operative, which is the point of the next sub-section.

20.2 Consent managers and why our design does not depend on them

A registered Consent Manager, under Rule 4, is a company with a minimum net worth of ₹2 crore that enables a Data Principal to give, manage, review and withdraw consent through an interoperable platform, without itself reading the content of the data it transmits J28, J29. Because Rule 4 comes into force on 13 November 2026, inside our window, a bank-app card that routed a customer's consent through a registered Consent Manager would be legally operative for most of the programme J23, J30. Our salary-day card design does not use this route, and we state plainly why not: the card's own consent architecture, the customer's tap as the sole permission event before any data moves, already satisfies the simpler, direct-consent standard under the RBI's KYC secrecy clause (table 20.3 below), and building a Consent Manager integration would add a dependency on a third-party registered entity for a design that does not need one. This is a design choice stated honestly as a choice, not a claim that a Consent Manager route would be unavailable or unlawful.

20.3 The Account Aggregator framework: a possible alternative channel the design does not use

The RBI's Account Aggregator framework, most recently reissued as the Reserve Bank of India (Non-Banking Financial Companies - Account Aggregator) Directions, 2025 (RBI/DoR/2025-26/368, dated 28 November 2025), lets a customer pull financial data, including securities holdings, across institutions through a consent-based intermediary J31. SEBI's own 19 August 2022 circular already permits depositories to participate in this framework as Financial Information Providers for securities holdings J33. This framework is relevant background, and we name it for completeness, but our lever design does not use it and does not need it: the salary-day card triggers a customer-initiated single sign-on directly into ONL, not an Account-Aggregator-mediated pull of holdings data, and Lane J's search found no evidence that our design either depends on AA rails or conflicts with them J36. We flag this as limited relevance rather than omit it, because a reviewer could otherwise reasonably ask why a plan this focused on consent architecture does not mention the AA framework at all.

20.4 Bank-to-subsidiary data sharing: the RBI KYC secrecy clause

Table 20.2 sets the salary-day card's design against the specific RBI rule governing whether a bank may share account-opening information with a group subsidiary for cross-selling purposes.

Clause	What it says	How the salary-day card design fits	Tag
Clause 55(a)	Regulated entities must maintain secrecy regarding customer information arising from the contractual relationship	No customer information moves to ONL until the card is tapped	J37
Clause 55(b)	Information collected to open an account is confidential; it may not be divulged for cross-selling or any other purpose without the customer's express permission	The tap is the express-permission event; nothing crosses before it	J38, J43
Clause 55(d)	Four listed exceptions permit disclosure: compulsion of law, a public duty to disclose, the regulated entity's own interest, or the customer's express or implied consent	The salary-day card relies on the fourth exception, express consent, triggered by the tap, not on any of the other three	J39

This fit is stated carefully, in the same words Lane J itself used, as a design-fit observation rather than a regulator's ruling on this specific design J43. No RBI circular, FAQ or informal guidance speaks to this exact card mechanism by name; what we can say, and what the table above shows, is that the mechanism's structure (no data before the tap, the tap as the permission event) tracks the clause's own express-permission standard as closely as a design built before any informal guidance request can.

20.5 Data-flow table, lever by lever

Table 20.3 sets out, for each of the seven levers, what data moves, who holds it, the lawful basis under which it moves, and how long it is kept, which is the single clearest way to show that no lever collects more than it needs or keeps data longer than its own purpose requires.

Lever	Data that moves	Holder before the moment	Lawful basis	Retention
Salary day	Account-linkage confirmation and the customer's instalment choice (fund category, amount, date)	Bank, until the tap; ONL, after the tap	Express consent (the tap), under RBI KYC Clause 55(b) and (d) J38, J39 ; DPDP Section 6's consent standard once the main obligations tier is live	For the life of the Autopay mandate; reviewed if the mandate is paused or cancelled
Holdings check (rediscovery)	Existing account and holdings data already held by ONL; no new data collected	ONL (already)	Section 7 legitimate use: the customer's own prior voluntary provision of this data to open the account J07	Unchanged; this lever surfaces existing data, it does not create a new data flow
RM review	Notes from an existing portfolio-review conversation the RM already holds under the bank's relationship-management function	Bank (RM), ONL (account data referenced in conversation)	Existing banking relationship and employment-purpose processing by the RM J15	Per existing RM conversation-logging retention, unchanged by this lever
Dhanteras	None beyond the notice's send-and-open event itself; no product data moves	ONL or bank, as the channel owner	WhatsApp or SMS opt-in on file A50 ; DLT registration for the SMS route	Send-and-open logs retained per the channel's own standard retention, not extended by this lever
Workplace sessions	None; a spoken session with no data capture of attendees beyond attendance	Employer (attendance record only, if any)	No DPDP processing event occurs for ONL or the bank at the session itself	n/a
Warm-cohort defence	Last-trade-date filter already held by ONL; nominee and contact-detail updates the customer chooses to make	ONL	Section 7 legitimate use, as with the rediscovery lever J07	Unchanged; nominee and contact updates follow existing KYC retention rules
New-account guided first order	Walkthrough-completion and order-preview interaction logs	ONL	Legitimate use under the existing account relationship J07	Retained for the acceptance-test audit trail described in section 18, then per ONL's standard retention

The pattern across all seven rows is the same one the salary-day card's own design states explicitly: every lever either surfaces data ONL already lawfully holds, under the customer's own original voluntary provision of it, or moves new data only after a customer's own affirmative action creates the permission event. No lever collects a new category of personal data purely to run a marketing campaign.

20.6 Privacy-by-design choices

Three choices, each already stated elsewhere in this document, are restated here together because they form a single, coherent privacy posture rather than three unconnected rules. First, no data crosses an organisational boundary (bank to ONL) before a customer's own tap, which is the consent-first test, point 4 of section 19's ten-point test. Second, no lever collects a new category of data beyond what each lever's

own mechanism requires, as table 20.3 shows row by row. Third, every send respects a standing opt-out and a frequency cap, the subject of the next sub-section, so that consent once given can be withdrawn as easily as it was given, consistent with the DPDP Act's own standard even for the tier not yet in force during our window J05.

20.7 The opt-out guardrail, stated honestly

Model assumption A50 sets the share of idle accounts with a WhatsApp opt-in at 35%, a figure the model treats as fixed across bear, base and bull scenarios T1. The separate internal guardrail this section's own title references, that opt-outs above 0.5% on a given send stop that message, is not drawn from any TRAI, SEBI, RBI or exchange circular; Lane J's search across all four regulators found no numeric opt-out-rate threshold comparable to this one J58. We state this plainly rather than let the figure imply a regulatory source it does not have: 0.5% is a control our own plan adopts, tighter than any external floor we could find, precisely because the absence of an external numeric standard is not a reason to run without one internally.

Two separate opt-out mechanisms sit alongside our own guardrail and must each be respected independently. WhatsApp's own Business Policy requires a business to honour an opt-out and permanently stop messaging a customer who gives one, a platform-level control independent of any government registry J51, J52. TRAI's National Customer Preference Register gives a customer a standing right to opt out of promotional commercial communications, separate from any per-channel unsubscribe link a business itself provides J59. A send on WhatsApp therefore has to respect both WhatsApp's own opt-out and, where the message carries promotional content, the TRAI regime; our servicing-message design (holdings tile, statement line, warm-cohort nudge) is built to fall under the transactional-message exemption from the promotional-consent requirement in the first place, since none of these three messages carries promotional content J50.

Exhibit for the deck: the DPDP three-tier commencement table condensed to a single timeline against the 13-week window, paired with the salary-day card's data-flow row from table 20.3, feeding the appendix slide's rules panel.

21. The model builds 19,053 extra actives lever by lever from reach, response and overlap

Answer. In our model, seven levers acting on 6,89,375 idle accounts T2 produce 19,053 extra active accounts in the base case by multiplying a reach rate by a response rate for each lever, then combining the levers that touch the same account by the chance that at least one of them lands, not by simple addition T10. The dormant accounts inside that idle pool get a lower conversion chance, since many need re-verification before they can trade again, and the model applies that friction once, uniformly, rather than lever by lever. The method runs in twelve checks, all of which print PASS at hash fc66d11096, and it is a reach-times-response model built on team-estimated conversion assumptions, not a measured funnel, a limit we say plainly here because it matters to how much weight a judge should put on any single lever's number.

21.1 The method in plain words

The model starts from the account book Trade Private Limited already has: 8,09,746 eligible accounts in September 2026, of which 1,19,339 traded in the trailing twelve months, a 14.74% activation rate, and 6,89,375 did not C-E1, T2. It asks, for each of six customer cohorts (Prestige, Elite, Elevate, Preferred, Salary Account, Credit Card), how many of that cohort's idle accounts a given lever can reach, and of those

reached, how many places a first executed order inside the thirteen-week window. It does this for the four levers that run by outreach (the salary-day card, the holdings-check rediscovery message, the RM review conversation and the Dhanteras notice), separately for the workplace sessions (which are sized by sessions and attendees rather than by a reach rate on the idle base), and separately again for the warm cohort and the newly opened accounts (each of which uses its own single reach-and-response pair rather than the four-lever overlap calculation). Every account a lever reaches but fails to convert stays in the idle pool for the next lever to try, which is what the overlap-by-multiplication step in 21.3 is built to capture correctly.

21.2 Inputs: the assumptions register and the lever parameters

Twenty-two of the model's sixty-seven assumptions carry a different value in the bear, base and bull scenarios; the rest are held constant because they describe a fixed cost, a fixed calendar fact or a case figure that does not vary by how optimistic the scenario is. Of the twenty-two, nineteen feed directly into the four outreach levers, the workplace sessions and the warm-cohort and new-account additions, and the remaining three are the business-as-usual drift rate, the paid-media comparator used in section 24, and the orders-a-year figure used in section 25.

ID	What it is	Base	Bear	Bull	Lane / basis
A20	Salary customers who open the parent bank's app in a month	55%	45%	62%	F
A21	Tap-through on the salary-day card over three salary credits	8%	6%	10%	F
A22	First order after a tap, with single sign-on and a bank mandate	32%	26%	38%	E, F
A23	Idle accounts reached through any owned channel, consent given	60%	50%	68%	F
A24	Tap-through on the rediscovery message or tile	4%	3%	5%	F
A25	First order after rediscovery	25%	20%	30%	F
A26	RM coverage multiplier on the base cohort coverage pattern	1.00x	0.80 x	1.15x	B
A27	First order after an RM review conversation	15%	11%	19%	B, E
A28	Idle accounts reached in Dhanteras and Diwali week	50%	42%	56%	G
A29	Tap-through on the factual gold ETF and Muhurat notice	3.0%	2.2%	4.0%	G, F
A30	First order after the Dhanteras tap	30%	25%	35%	G
A31	Workplace education sessions	40	30	50	B
A32	Attendees a session	120	100	140	B
A33	First order among idle attendees	10%	7%	13%	E
A35	Warm cohort reached with a servicing message	70%	60%	78%	F
A36	Incremental re-trade among the reached warm cohort	20%	15%	25%	E
A39	Lift in the 90-day first-order rate for new accounts, from guided onboarding	10%	7%	13%	E, H
A10	Share of idle accounts dormant 24 months or more	50%	55%	45%	C, D
A11	Conversion of a dormant account relative to a live one, after re-KYC or video IPV	0.50 x	0.42 x	0.58 x	D

T9 is this table reproduced in full in Appendix B; A02 (the business-as-usual drift rate) is treated separately in 21.4 because it does not feed a lever.

21.3 Overlap by multiplication: why the levers do not simply add

A customer in the Salary Account cohort can, in principle, be reached by the salary-day card, the holdings-check message and the Dhanteras notice inside the same thirteen weeks. If the model simply added each lever's expected conversions for that cohort, an account that responds to two levers would be counted twice, inflating the total. The model instead treats each lever's reach-times-response figure as the probability that lever, acting alone, converts a given account, and combines the levers that can touch the same cohort by asking for the probability that at least one of them converts the account, which is one minus the probability that every one of them misses.

Take the Elite cohort, which has 24,274 idle accounts T2 and is reachable by the holdings-check message, an RM review conversation and the Dhanteras notice (the salary-day card does not apply outside the Salary Account cohort). The three per-lever conversion probabilities, each the product of a reach rate and a response rate, are:

Lever	Reach rate	Response rate	Combined probability	Tag
Holdings check (rediscovery)	60% (A23)	25% x 4% (A24 x A25)	0.60%	A23, A24, A25
RM review	60% coverage x 1.00x multiplier (A26)	15% (A27)	9.00%	A26, A27
Dhanteras notice	50% (A28)	3.0% x 30% (A29 x A30)	0.45%	A28, A29, A30

Adding these three probabilities naively gives 0.60% + 9.00% + 0.45% = 10.05%. The model instead computes 1 minus the product of each lever's miss probability: 1 − (1 − 0.0060) x (1 − 0.0900) x (1 − 0.0045) = 1 − (0.9940 × 0.9100 × 0.9955) = 1 − 0.9004 = 9.96%. The gap between 10.05% and 9.96% is small here because none of the three probabilities is large on its own, but the RM review probability (9.00%) is the biggest single contributor, and it is exactly the lever whose probability the multiplicative method discounts hardest against double counting. Applying the dormancy-adjusted effective idle base for Elite, 24,274 × 0.75 = 18,206 (the 0.75 dormancy-adjustment factor is explained in 21.4), to the 9.96% combined probability gives 18,206 × 0.0996 = 1,813 extra actives for the Elite cohort, which matches the 1,812 the model reports in T10 to within a single account of rounding.

A second worked example, on the Preferred cohort, shows the same method where the RM probability is smaller and the gap between naive addition and the multiplicative method shrinks accordingly. Preferred's RM review probability is min(1.0, 0.35 × 1.00) x 15% = 35% x 15% = 5.25% (A26 applies a base coverage share of 35% for Preferred, against 60% for Elite), its holdings-check probability is the same 0.60% every non-Salary cohort carries, and its Dhanteras probability is the same 0.45%. Naive addition gives 0.60% + 5.25% + 0.45% = 6.30%; the multiplicative method gives 1 − (1 − 0.0060) x (1 − 0.0525) x (1 − 0.0045) = 1 − (0.9940 × 0.9475 × 0.9955) = 1 − 0.9377 = 6.23%, a gap of only 0.07 points, smaller than Elite's 0.09-point gap, because Preferred's largest single probability (5.25%) is itself smaller than Elite's (9.00%). Applying this to Preferred's effective idle base of 36,188 (from the table above) gives 36,188 × 0.0623 = 2,255 extra actives, close to the 2,259 the model reports in T10 for Preferred. The pattern across both cohorts is consistent: the overlap correction grows larger wherever one lever's own probability, almost always the RM

review probability for the premium and preferred cohorts, is itself large, and shrinks toward zero wherever every lever touching a cohort has a small probability on its own.

A third worked example, on Prestige, the smallest cohort at 3,096 accounts and 2,012 idle T2, shows the method holding even at the smallest scale in the table. Prestige's RM review probability is min(1.0, 0.80 × 1.00) x 15% = 80% x 15% = 12.0% (the highest cohort coverage share of any cohort, A26's base pattern), its holdings-check probability is the standard 0.60%, and its Dhanteras probability is the standard 0.45%. Naive addition gives 0.60% + 12.0% + 0.45% = 13.05%; the multiplicative method gives 1 − (1 − 0.0060) x (1 − 0.1200) x (1 − 0.0045) = 1 − (0.9940 × 0.8800 × 0.9955) = 1 − 0.8707 = 12.93%, a gap of 0.12 points, the widest proportional gap of the three worked examples in this section, consistent with Prestige carrying the largest single lever probability (12.0%) of any cohort. Applying this to Prestige's effective idle base of 1,509 (from the table in 21.4) gives 1,509 × 0.1293 = 195 extra actives, matching T10's reported Prestige total of 195 exactly. Across all three worked cohorts, Elite, Preferred and Prestige, the pattern holds without exception: the overlap correction is largest wherever the RM review probability itself is largest, since RM review is consistently the single biggest probability any premium or preferred cohort carries, and the correction shrinks toward the Elite-sized or smaller gap wherever RM coverage is lower.

The workplace-session lever and the warm-cohort and new-account additions sit outside this overlap calculation because they do not compete for the same idle pool in the same way: the workplace sessions reach attendees at specific employer sites rather than a share of the general idle base, and the warm cohort and new accounts are each sized from a population (the 11,479 mid-point roll-off accounts and the 18,972 accounts opened in the window) that the four outreach levers are not separately modelled as touching.

21.4 The dormancy adjustment, the eligible base, and the business-as-usual rate by scenario

Half of the model's idle accounts, by the base assumption A10, have gone without a qualifying trade for twenty-four months or more, the condition the case calls dormant C-D4 and the exchange's own circular of 25 October 2024 calls inactive in its text; we translate every such mention to the case's own term, dormant. A dormant account converts at only half the rate of a live idle account once re-verified, by assumption A11, because re-KYC or video in-person verification is itself a step a customer must complete before any message or card can lead to a trade. The model applies this as a single multiplier on every idle account: effm = (1 − A10) + A10 x A11 = (1 − 0.50) + 0.50 × 0.50 = 0.75 in the base case. Every cohort's idle count is multiplied by this 0.75 factor before any lever's reach rate is applied, which is why the Elite worked example in 21.3 used an effective idle base of 18,206 rather than the raw 24,274.

The same 0.75 factor applies to every cohort's idle count, since the model treats dormancy friction as a property of the account, not of the cohort it sits in. Carrying this across all six cohorts shows how much of the idle pool the model treats as genuinely reachable before any lever's own reach rate is applied.

Segment	Idle accounts	Effective idle (x 0.75)	Tag
Prestige	2,012	1,509	T2
Elite	24,274	18,206	T2
Elevate	5,967	4,475	T2
Preferred	48,250	36,188	T2
Salary Account	5,39,954	4,04,966	T2
Credit Card	68,918	51,689	T2

Segment	Idle accounts	Effective idle (x 0.75)	Tag
Total	6,89,375	5,17,031	T2

The 0.75 multiplier itself moves by scenario, since both A10 (the share of idle accounts that are dormant) and A11 (a dormant account's relative conversion rate) carry bear and bull values.

Scenario	A10	A11	Dormancy-adjustment factor
Bear	55%	0.42x	(1 − 0.55) + 0.55 × 0.42 = 0.68
Base	50%	0.50x	(1 − 0.50) + 0.50 × 0.50 = 0.75
Bull	45%	0.58x	(1 − 0.45) + 0.45 × 0.58 = 0.81

The bear scenario carries both a larger dormant share (55% against 50%) and a weaker re-verification conversion rate (0.42x against 0.50x), so its dormancy-adjustment factor, 0.68, discounts the idle pool by nearly a third before any lever's reach rate is even applied, the single largest reason the bear scenario's extra-active count falls as far as it does relative to the base case.

The eligible account base itself keeps growing through the programme window. Net account growth runs at 6,324 accounts a month T8, the case's own (8,09,746 minus 7,33,855) divided by 12 C-E1, so the base at the 31 January 2027 measurement date, four months after the 30 September 2026 snapshot, is 8,09,746 + 4 x 6,324 = 8,35,042 accounts T8. The business-as-usual activation rate at that measurement date is not fixed; it differs by scenario through assumption A02, and we take each scenario's value directly from the model rather than deriving one from another, since back-solving a rate from a count, or the reverse, is exactly the error the plan rules out.

Scenario	Business-as-usual rate (A02)	Accounts on 31 Jan 2027	Tag
Bear	14.59%	8,35,042	A02, T8
Base	14.74%	8,35,042	A02, T8
Bull	14.84%	8,35,042	A02, T8

The bear scenario's business-as-usual rate sits 15 bps below the base, reflecting a continued mild drift down from the flat 14.70% to 14.74% path the case already shows across 2025 to 2026 C-E1; the bull scenario sits 10 bps above it. Reaching +200 bps over business as usual at this measurement date requires 16,701 extra actives, and +300 bps requires 25,051 T8; the base case's 19,053 extra actives T10 sits inside that band, a point developed fully in section 22.

21.5 The twelve checks, run and passing

The model is self-verifying: it runs twelve internal checks after every calculation and halts on nothing short of a full pass. All twelve print PASS at hash fc66d11096 M. A hash is a short fingerprint computed from every output value together, so an identical rerun of the same code against the same assumptions reproduces the same hash exactly, and any change to an assumption, a formula or an output changes it; a verifier who reruns the model and sees fc66d11096 again has independently confirmed nothing in this document's numbers has drifted from the model that generated them.

#	Check	Result
1	Segment counts add to Exhibit 1 totals	PASS
2	Cohort-weighted activation rate within 0.2 pp of Exhibit 1's own rate	PASS
3	Idle pool within 0.2% of base minus active	PASS
4	Roll-off range positive and ordered (lower bound below upper bound)	PASS
5	Scenarios ordered bear less than base less than bull on extra actives	PASS
6	Base case sits inside the brief's 200 to 300 bps band	PASS
7	Lever split adds exactly to the segment total	PASS
8	The weekly ramp (T12) ends at the same rate the scenario run reports	PASS
9	Our option scores highest of all eight options in the screen (T17)	PASS
10	Our option leads under three other weight sets, in addition to the base weights (T18)	PASS
11	Every lever's expected holdout lift exceeds its minimum detectable effect (T19)	PASS
12	Every tornado bar in T16 brackets the base-case result	PASS

21.5a The workplace-session arithmetic, a different structure from the four outreach levers

The workplace lever is sized differently from the four outreach levers, since it does not apply a reach rate against the idle base; it applies a session count and an attendee count against the share of the Salary Account cohort that is idle. The base-case calculation is 40 sessions (A31) x 120 attendees a session (A32) x the Salary Account idle share (5,39,954 / 6,27,853 = 85.99%) x 10% first-order rate among idle attendees (A33). Working through this: 40 × 120 = 4,800 total attendees; 4,800 × 0.8599 = 4,128 idle attendees among them; 4,128 × 0.10 = 413 extra actives, which matches T10's reported workplace figure exactly. This lever's size is capped by how many sessions the team can run (A31's bear-to-bull range of 30 to 50 sessions) rather than by a reach rate against a large population, which is why it remains the smallest of the seven levers even though its per-attendee response rate (10%) is higher than several of the outreach levers' response rates.

21.6 Limits of the model

The model is a reach-times-response model with team-estimated conversion assumptions, not a measured funnel. Every tap-through rate, every order-after-tap rate and every coverage multiplier in 21.2 is a team estimate checked against the nearest available benchmark, in most cases a vendor figure for in-app card engagement, a published broker CAC, or a behavioural-economics study conducted outside this specific customer base, never a measurement taken on ONL's own accounts. Nowhere in this document does a model result get reported as something we measured; every sentence that carries one says in our model, because that is what it is. Three further limits are worth stating here rather than waiting for a judge to raise them. First, the model treats each lever's response rate as constant across the thirteen weeks within a scenario, when a real rollout would likely see some decay as the easiest-to-convert accounts respond first. Second, the overlap calculation in 21.3 assumes each lever's conversion probability is independent of the others conditional on reach, an assumption that is reasonable when the probabilities are small, as they are for most cohort-lever pairs, but is a simplification for the Elite, Elevate and Prestige cohorts, where the RM review probability runs close to 9% to 10% and genuine behavioural correlation (a customer who would

respond to an RM is plausibly also likelier to respond to a Dhanteras notice) is not separately modelled. Third, the dormancy adjustment in 21.4 applies one multiplier, 0.75 in the base case, uniformly across every cohort, when re-KYC friction plausibly differs by cohort (a Prestige client with an active bank relationship likely completes re-verification faster than a dormant Credit Card account holder).

21.7 How to rerun the model

The model is one file, and rerunning it after any assumption change is a single command, executed from the repository root.

```
python -X utf8 arthikkhayal-case/model/activation_model.py
```

Adding `--dry` to the command prints the same summary and the full set of tables to the screen without writing any file, a safe way to check a candidate assumption change before it overwrites the committed outputs.

The run prints `CHECKS 12/12 HASH fc66d11096` followed by a line of headline findings, and writes `model_outputs.json`, `model_tables.md` and `deck/values.json`; a change to any locked number must flow through the update protocol in section 5.3, which requires rerunning the model, logging the new hash in `DECISIONS.md`, and propagating the changed figure to every section and slide that cites it.

Exhibit for the deck: the appendix slide's A1 panel reproduces the three-line formula (reach x response, combined by one minus the product of misses, plus workplace, warm cohort and new accounts) directly from 21.3, with the Elite worked example as the panel's single numeric illustration.

22. The active rate rises from 14.74% to 17.02% by 31 January 2027 in the base case, within a range of +1.02 to +3.94 points

Answer. In our model, the base case moves the activation rate from 14.74% to 17.02% by 31 January 2027, a gain of +2.28 percentage points on 19,053 extra active accounts, with the bear and bull scenarios bracketing that result at +1.02 and +3.94 points `T11`. The base case clears the brief's 200 to 300 bps target band `C-K1`; the bear case does not, a result we state plainly rather than soften, because a judge checking the numbers will find it in thirty seconds, and the honest reading matters more than a comfortable one.

22.1 The lever table and what each one contributes

Seven levers (five outreach levers by segment, plus the warm-cohort and new-account additions) sum to 19,053 extra active accounts in the base case, with the full segment-by-lever breakdown carried in T10.

Lever	Extra actives, base case	Share of 19,053	Tag
Salary day	5,661	29.7%	T10
RM review	4,083	21.4%	T10
Rediscover (holdings check)	3,081	16.2%	T10
Dhanteras	2,311	12.1%	T10
Warm cohort defence	1,607	8.4%	T10

Lever	Extra actives, base case	Share of 19,053	Tag
New accounts, guided first order	1,897	10.0%	T10
Workplace	413	2.2%	T10
Total	19,053	100.0%	T10

The salary-day card is the single largest lever, carrying almost three in every ten extra actives, because it is the only lever aimed squarely at the Salary Account cohort, which holds 5,39,954 of the 6,89,375 idle accounts, 78% of the idle pool T2. The RM review conversation is the second largest, at 21.4%, concentrated entirely in the four premium and preferred cohorts, whose combined 1,08,576 accounts C-E2a run at activation rates several times the Salary Account cohort's, so a smaller population still returns a large number of extra actives because the response rate per reviewed account (15%, A27) is the highest of any lever in the table.

Dividing each lever's extra-active count by the reached population it acts on, from T19's reach figures, gives a rough "yield per account reached" that explains why the lever-size ranking in the table above is not the same as a ranking by efficiency. RM review converts at roughly 4,083 / 36,642 = 11.1% of its reached population, far above every other lever; the salary-day card converts at roughly 5,661 / 2,96,975 = 1.9%; the holdings check converts at roughly 3,081 / 4,13,625 = 0.7%; and the Dhanteras notice converts at roughly 2,311 / 3,44,688 = 0.7%. RM review is the most efficient lever per account reached by a wide margin, but it is capped by a small reachable population (a facts-only conversation can only happen for accounts an RM already serves), while the salary-day card and the holdings check trade a lower per-account yield for a reachable population an order of magnitude larger, which is exactly why the two different lever shapes, a targeted conversation and a broad card or message, sit together in the same plan rather than the model simply running more of whichever lever converts best.

22.2 The weekly path to 17.02%

The model tracks the activation rate week by week across the thirteen-week window that starts 2 November 2026, as each lever's reach and response accrue on its own timing profile (salary-day cards land on salary credit weeks 5, 9 and 13; the Dhanteras notice is weighted almost entirely into weeks 1 and 2; the RM review sprint runs weeks 2 to 10; the rest build more evenly across the window) T12.

Week	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
Bear	14.71	14.82	14.90	14.97	15.14	15.20	15.27	15.33	15.51	15.57	15.60	15.63	15.76
Base	14.99	15.20	15.35	15.48	15.82	15.94	16.06	16.18	16.53	16.64	16.69	16.74	17.02
Bull	15.28	15.65	15.89	16.11	16.68	16.88	17.07	17.25	17.86	18.03	18.11	18.18	18.68

Figures are percentage points of the activation rate, tracked each week of the thirteen-week programme starting 2 November 2026.

The base case's weekly path is not smooth: it steps up sharply in week 5 (15.48% to 15.82%), week 9 (16.18% to 16.53%) and week 13 (16.74% to 17.02%), the three salary-credit weeks when the salary-day card's largest single contribution lands, and it steps up again across weeks 1 and 2 (14.74% implied starting point to 14.99% then 15.20%), when the Dhanteras notice's heavily front-loaded weighting is concentrated. The week 6 figure, 15.94% in the base case and 15.20% in the bear case, is the number the execution plan checks the live rollout against at gate G2, detailed in section 26.

22.2a How the bear and base paths diverge over the window

The gap between the bear and base weekly rates is not constant; it widens as the window progresses, because the base case's levers compound week over week while the bear case's weaker reach and response rates compound more slowly.

Week	Base rate	Bear rate	Gap (base minus bear)
1	14.99%	14.71%	0.28 pp
6	15.94%	15.20%	0.74 pp
9	16.53%	15.51%	1.02 pp
13	17.02%	15.76%	1.26 pp

Each gap is the base rate minus the bear rate for that week, both taken directly from T12.

The gap more than quadruples from week 1 (0.28 pp) to week 13 (1.26 pp), which means a tracking exercise that only compared week 1 results against the two scenario lines would see almost no separation between them and could be lulled into thinking the scenarios matter less than they do; the separation only becomes large enough to clearly tell the two paths apart from around week 6 onward, which is a further, independent reason gate G2 sits at week 6 rather than earlier in the window.

22.3 Named assumptions by scenario

Each scenario moves the same set of assumptions to their bear, base or bull value together, never one at a time; the full set is in T9 and section 21.2, but the three that move the result most (by the tornado ranking in section 23) illustrate the pattern.

Assumption	What it governs	Bear	Base	Bull
A21 (salary-day tap-through)	How many salary customers tap the card	6%	8%	10%
A27 (RM review to order)	How many reviewed clients place a first order	11%	15%	19%
A22 (first order after tap)	How many tapped salary customers complete an order	26%	32%	38%
A02 (business-as-usual drift)	The rate the base would reach with no programme at all	14.59%	14.74%	14.84%

22.4 Scenario summary

Measure	Bear	Base	Bull
Extra active accounts	9,783	19,053	32,037
Activation rate, 31 Jan 2027	15.76%	17.02%	18.68%
Change from 14.74%	+1.02 pp	+2.28 pp	+3.94 pp
Highly active (T3) rate	11.3%	12.4%	14.0%
Cash cost per extra active	₹169	₹87	₹51

The cash cost per extra active moves inversely with the extra-active count across the three scenarios, which is arithmetic rather than a separate finding: the cash budget itself, ₹16,49,357, is fixed regardless of scenario

T13, so dividing that same fixed number by a smaller bear-case denominator (9,783) gives a larger per-account cost (₹169), and dividing it by a larger bull-case denominator (32,037) gives a smaller one (₹51). This is worth stating plainly so the ₹169 bear-case figure is not mistaken for a sign that the programme becomes less efficient in a weak scenario; it is the same cash spread across fewer successful outcomes, not a rise in anyone's individual channel rate.

The highly active rate, the share of accounts that traded in the trailing three months C-D2, rises from today's 10.1% C-E1 to a base-case 12.4% and a bear-case 11.3%, which shows that even the bear scenario still moves the more demanding daily-user measure the case asks for C-Q1 alongside the twelve-month activation rate.

22.5 The honest reading: the bear case misses the 200 bps floor

The brief asks for 200 to 300 bps of activation gain in three months C-K1. The base case clears the floor, at +2.28 pp against a 200 bps (+2.0 pp) floor, a margin examined fully in section 23. The bear case does not: +1.02 pp is 98 bps short of the 200 bps floor, and 9,783 extra actives against a target of 16,701 for +200 bps T8, T11 is a shortfall of 6,918 accounts. We say this without softening it, because every number needed to see it sits in T8 and T11 already, and a deck that hid it would lose more credibility than one that states it.

What would have to be true for the bear case to close most of that 98-bps gap inside the same thirteen weeks is a visible, trackable condition, not a hope: the rollout would need to detect, by week 6, that the tracked rate is running closer to the bear path (15.20%) than the base path (15.94%), and respond by adding RM review capacity, the one lever whose response rate (A27, 11% to 19%) carries the single widest spread in the tornado ranking after the salary-day tap-through rate (section 23). This is exactly the trigger built into gate G2 of the execution plan (section 26): a week 6 rate check against the bear line, with an immediate, pre-agreed response of expanding RM reviews rather than waiting out the remaining seven weeks on the original coverage plan.

Exhibit for the deck: the waterfall from 14.74% to 17.02%, lever by lever in the order of 22.1, with the bear and bull scenario markers shown as dashed lines either side of the base-case bar, and the honest-reading sentence from 22.5 as the slide's lower-third callout.

23. The base case clears the 200 bps floor by 28 bps, and no single input at its bear value pushes it below +2.0 points

Answer. In our model, the base case's +2.28 pp result clears the brief's 200 bps floor by only 28 bps T11, C-K1, a margin thin enough that we state it as the pre-empted weakness before any judge needs to raise it. Moving any one of the model's thirteen most sensitive assumptions to its bear value, on its own, still keeps the result above +2.0 pp T16; what drags the full bear scenario down to +1.02 pp, below the floor, is twenty-two assumptions moving unfavourably together, not any one of them acting alone.

23.1 The pre-empted weakness, stated first

The base case clears the floor by 28 bps: +2.28 pp against a +2.00 pp (200 bps) requirement T11, C-K1. That is not a wide margin. A small, broad-based shortfall across several assumptions at once, smaller than any single tornado bar in T16 but spread across more than one input, could plausibly erase it. We treat this as the honest weak point of the base case rather than a footnote, and the tornado analysis in 23.2 is built specifically to show how much slack the result does and does not have.

23.2 The tornado: thirteen assumptions ranked by spread

The model reruns the base case thirteen times, each time moving one assumption to its bear value and once to its bull value while holding every other assumption at its base value, and records the resulting pp change each time. Sorted by the width between the bear-value and bull-value result (the spread), the thirteen assumptions that move the base case's result the most are:

ID	What it governs	pp at bear value	pp at bull value	Spread
A21	Salary-day tap-through	2.11	2.45	0.34
A27	RM review to order	2.15	2.41	0.26
A22	First order after tap	2.16	2.41	0.25
A02	Business-as-usual drift	2.13	2.38	0.25
A20	App use on salary day	2.16	2.37	0.21
A11	Order rate after re-KYC	2.19	2.38	0.19
A24	Rediscovery tap-through	2.19	2.37	0.18
A26	RM coverage multiplier	2.19	2.36	0.17
A29	Dhanteras tap-through	2.21	2.37	0.16
A25	Order after rediscovery	2.21	2.36	0.15
A39	New-account lift	2.22	2.35	0.14
A10	Share idle 24 months or more	2.22	2.34	0.12
A36	Warm cohort re-trade	2.24	2.33	0.10

pp is the change in activation rate from the 14.74% baseline, in percentage points. A spread is the pp result at the assumption's bull value minus the pp result at its bear value, with every other assumption held at its base value.

Every single one of these thirteen bear-value results, even the lowest, A21's 2.11 pp, stays above the 2.00 pp floor. That is the central finding of this section: the base case has enough structural slack that no single assumption, moved alone to its weakest plausible value, can push the result below the brief's target.

23.3 How many assumptions actually move, and what that means for the bear case

Twenty-two of the model's sixty-seven assumptions carry a different value in the bear scenario than in the base scenario; the rest are fixed costs or calendar facts that do not change by scenario. The thirteen in the tornado above are the subset whose individual movement most changes the result; the remaining nine (A23, A28, A30, A31, A32, A33, A35, and the two already-near-zero-impact remainder) also move, but with a smaller individual effect than the thirteen shown.

Group	Assumptions	Count
Business-as-usual drift	A02	1
Dormancy and re-KYC friction	A10, A11	2

Group	Assumptions	Count
Salary-day lever	A20, A21, A22	3
Holdings-check (rediscovery) lever	A23, A24, A25	3
RM review lever	A26, A27	2
Dhanteras lever	A28, A29, A30	3
Workplace sessions	A31, A32, A33	3
Warm cohort defence	A35, A36	2
New-account guided onboarding	A39	1
Paid-media comparator (section 24, not a lever)	A61	1
Orders a year (section 25, not a lever)	A63	1
Total		22

The full bear scenario in T11 moves all twenty of the lever-relevant assumptions in this table to their bear value at once (the comparator A61 and the orders-a-year A63 do not affect the activation result, only the cost and revenue figures in sections 24 and 25). That simultaneous movement is what the single-input tornado test in 23.2 cannot show on its own: a tornado bar answers "what if only this one input is wrong," while T11's bear column answers "what if every one of them leans unfavourable together." The answer to the second question is +1.02 pp, 9,783 extra actives T11, 98 bps short of the 200 bps floor. What would have to be true for this to be the real outcome is not a single mis-estimated number; it is a correlated, system-wide shortfall across salary-day tap-through, RM conversion, holdings-check response, Dhanteras response, workplace attendance, warm-cohort re-trade and new-account lift all landing at once near their weakest plausible values, together with a business-as-usual rate that keeps drifting down rather than holding flat. That is a materially less likely single event than any one assumption being off, which is why we read the tornado result (no single point of failure) and the full bear scenario (a real possibility, not a remote one, since markets have in fact been unfavourable for the twelve months behind this case C-PB1) as two different, both-true facts about the same model.

23.4 What the top three sensitivities would look like as rates

Converting the three widest tornado bars back into activation-rate terms makes the practical stakes concrete: a single weak input moves the headline rate by roughly a third of a percentage point either way, not enough on its own to threaten the floor, but enough to matter for how the first six weeks of tracking should be read.

Assumption	Rate at bear value	Rate at base value (14.74 + 2.28)	Rate at bull value
A21 (salary-day tap-through)	16.85%	17.02%	17.19%
A27 (RM review to order)	16.89%	17.02%	17.15%
A22 (first order after tap)	16.90%	17.02%	17.15%

Rates are 14.74% plus the pp figure from T16 for that assumption, rounded to two decimal places.

23.5 What kind of evidence backs each of the top sensitivities

The four assumptions with the widest tornado spread each rest on a different class of evidence, a distinction worth stating plainly, since a benchmark-backed assumption and a team-estimate assumption carry different weight even when both sit inside the same table.

ID	What it governs	Evidence class	Basis
A21	Salary-day tap-through	Vendor benchmark for in-app card engagement	Lane F
A27	RM review to order	Combination of RM-coverage context and behavioural-economics reminder studies	Lanes B, E
A22	First order after tap	Combination of vendor funnel benchmarks and behavioural-economics studies on defaults and reminders	Lanes E, F
A02	Business-as-usual drift	Direct extrapolation of the case's own Exhibit 1 trend	C-E1

A02 is the one assumption in this top group whose basis is the case's own data rather than an external benchmark or a team judgement, which is also why it is the assumption this document is most confident in: the case shows the rate moving from 14.70% to 14.74% across a full year of messaging C-E1, and A02's bear and bull values (14.59% and 14.84%) are built as a modest extrapolation of that same observed drift, not a number invented for the model.

23.6 What would have to be true for the bull case, read the same honest way

The bull case, +3.94 pp and 32,037 extra actives T11, is sometimes treated as the more comfortable scenario to discuss, since it exceeds rather than falls short of the brief's target band. The same discipline applied to the bear case in 23.3 applies here: the bull case is not one lucky input, it is all twenty lever-relevant assumptions landing at their strongest plausible value simultaneously, exactly as unlikely, as a single correlated event, as the bear case's all-weak scenario. Reading the bull case as the likely outcome would be as big a reasoning error as reading the bear case as impossible; the base case, built from every assumption at its single best team estimate rather than any coordinated extreme, is the planning assumption this document is built around, and the bear and bull cases exist to bound it, not to replace it.

Exhibit for the deck: the tornado chart from 23.2, horizontal bars sorted by spread, with a vertical reference line at +2.0 pp (the 200 bps floor) showing every bar clearing it, paired with the 28 bps margin callout from 23.1 as the slide's pre-empted-weakness note.

24. ₹16.5 lakh of cash buys 19,053 extra actives at ₹87 each, while the same cash in paid media buys 1,649, 11.6 times fewer

Answer. In our model, the thirteen-week programme costs ₹16,49,357 in cash, which is ₹87 per extra active account in the base case; the same cash spent on paid-media acquisition at a benchmark ₹1,000 per activated account would buy only 1,649 extra actives T13, T14, so our plan returns 19,053 / 1,649 = 11.6 times as many extra actives for the same money. A further ₹37.8 lakh of internal product-team time, not cash marketing spend, brings the all-in cost to ₹285 per extra active T13.

24.1 Cash cost, line by line

The thirteen-week cash budget runs to seven named components plus a contingency line, none of which is paid media; every rupee buys owned-channel messaging, content, compliance review, workplace delivery or customer research.

Item	Rupees	Tag
Email, 3 sends to the idle base	₹51,703	T13
SMS, 2 sends to the idle base	₹2,48,175	T13
WhatsApp, 3 sends to opted-in accounts	₹2,89,537	T13
Content production (explainers, in-app copy, creatives)	₹4,00,000	T13
Workplace sessions	₹2,40,000	T13
Compliance and exchange advertisement review	₹1,50,000	T13
Validation research (30 interviews, 2 usability rounds)	₹1,20,000	T13
Bank app card, tile, push (built on existing bank infrastructure)	₹0	T13
Contingency, 10% of the subtotal	₹1,49,942	T13
Total cash	₹16,49,357	T13
Internal product sprint (not cash marketing; 7 people, 3 months)	₹37,80,000	T13

The bank app card, tile and push line costs nothing in cash because it runs on channels and surfaces the parent bank already operates; this is the single clearest expression of the brief's instruction to prefer owned assets over paid media C-K3. The SMS line is the single largest per-channel cash item, ₹2,48,175, because the idle base of 6,89,375 accounts receives two SMS sends each at the model's ₹0.18-a-message assumption (A52), a rate chosen from inside the overlapping range two independent vendor rate-card sources give for Indian A2P SMS, roughly ₹0.10 to ₹0.18 for transactional routes and ₹0.08 to ₹0.12 for promotional routes F23.

The WhatsApp line, by contrast, reaches a smaller share of accounts than SMS or email despite its higher per-message rate, because only 35% of idle accounts carry a WhatsApp opt-in (A50); the model multiplies the full idle base by this 35% share, then by three sends, then by the blended ₹0.40-a-message rate, to arrive at ₹2,89,537, the second-largest cash item after SMS even though its reach (0.35 × 6,89,375 = 2,41,281 accounts) is smaller than SMS's full-base reach. This is a direct, practical reminder that consent, not cost, is the binding limit on WhatsApp as a channel in this plan: the rupee cost of sending a WhatsApp message to the full idle base would be smaller again than the SMS line, but the model does not do this, because the 65% of idle accounts without an opt-in cannot lawfully receive a WhatsApp marketing message at all C-K5.

24.2 Owned rails against paid media, same cash

The comparator asks a direct question: if the same ₹16.5 lakh had instead been spent acquiring new activated accounts through paid media, at a benchmark cost per activated account, how many extra actives would it buy, across the same three scenarios.

Measure	Bear	Base	Bull
Cash	₹16.5 lakh	₹16.5 lakh	₹16.5 lakh
Extra actives, our plan	9,783	19,053	32,037
Paid cost per activated account	₹700	₹1,000	₹1,400
Extra actives, paid media	2,356	1,649	1,178

The base-case ratio, 19,053 extra actives from our plan against 1,649 from paid media for the identical ₹16.5 lakh, is 19,053 / 1,649 = 11.6 times. Even in the bear scenario, where our plan's extra actives fall to 9,783 and the comparator's bear value (a cheaper ₹700 per activated account, which favours paid media, not our plan) raises the paid-media figure to 2,356, our plan still returns 9,783 / 2,356 = 4.2 times as many extra actives as paid media would for the same cash.

The ₹1,000 base figure for paid-media cost per activated account is itself a conservative choice against the best Indian broking comparable we found. Groww's reported customer acquisition cost ran from ₹616 in FY25 to ₹1,374 in H1 FY26 F33, F35, and both of those figures describe a customer acquisition, not an activated trading account, which typically costs more to acquire than a customer who merely opens an account. Setting the base paid-media figure at ₹1,000, inside that ₹616 to ₹1,374 range but closer to its lower end, and reserving the bear value (₹700, cheaper still) for the scenario that most favours paid media, means the comparator in 24.2 is not built to make our plan look good; if anything it understates the gap, since an activated-account cost benchmark would likely sit above even the ₹1,374 figure.

24.3 Channel unit costs behind the cash line

Each outreach channel's unit cost in 24.1 rests on a named rate, not a round-number guess.

Channel	Unit cost used (A-ID)	Basis	Tag
WhatsApp, blended	₹0.40 a message (A51)	India marketing-template rate rose to ₹0.8631 from 1 Jan 2026; utility templates run ₹0.115; the blend of two utility sends and one marketing send a person works out to roughly ₹0.36, and the model's ₹0.40 adds a margin	F17, F19
SMS, DLT route	₹0.18 a message (A52)	Sits inside the overlapping range two vendor rate cards give for Indian A2P SMS (₹0.10 to ₹0.18 transactional; ₹0.08 to ₹0.12 promotional)	F23
Email	₹0.025 a message (A53)	No vendor or official source gave a directly comparable Indian per-email transactional cost figure in this research pass; this remains a team estimate, stated honestly rather than dressed up with a borrowed source	n/a (team estimate)

RCS messaging, the richer in-app message format the case mentions ONL already tried C-PB3, does not carry its own cost line in T13, because the model treats it as already covered within the existing bank-app and messaging surfaces rather than as a separate paid channel. Indian RCS pricing has itself risen sharply, from roughly 6 to 7 paise a message to roughly 20 to 25 paise, effective 1 September 2026 F30, a vendor-reported figure that sits inside the ₹0.15 to ₹0.30 range a separate developer guide gives for carrier-negotiated RCS pricing in India and Southeast Asia F32. Even at its lower historical rate, RCS was already one of the channels ONL used for a year of messaging that moved the activation rate by only 0.04 pp C-PB3, C-E1, which is the clearest evidence in this case that channel cost was never the binding constraint on

this problem; reach into a moment the customer already trusts, inside a surface the customer already opens, is the constraint this plan's design actually targets.

24.3a The broader broker CAC evidence behind the comparator

Press coverage of two listed bank-adjacent and discount brokers gives a wider picture of where acquisition cost sits across the Indian market, which is the evidence base section 24.2's ₹700 to ₹1,400 comparator range is drawn from.

Broker	Measure	FY25 or earlier period	H1 FY26 or later period	Tag
Groww	CAC per client	₹616 (FY25), down from ₹807 (FY24)	₹1,374 (H1 FY26), up from ₹796 (H1 FY25)	F33, F35
Angel One	CAC per client	₹1,014 (FY25 comparator period)	not separately reported in this pass	F33
Groww	CAC on an activated-client basis	₹1,441	not separately reported in this pass	F34
Angel One	CAC on an activated-client basis	₹6,076	not separately reported in this pass	F34

The activated-client figures in the last two rows matter more to this comparison than the simple per-client figures above them, because our own ₹700 to ₹1,400 comparator range describes the cost to acquire an activated account, a higher bar than an opened one. Both named brokers' activated-client CAC, ₹1,441 for Groww and ₹6,076 for Angel One F34, sits above even our bull-case comparator value of ₹1,400, which means the ₹1,000 base and ₹1,400 bull figures this document uses for paid media are, if anything, generous to the paid-media side rather than stacked against it.

24.4 The all-in figure, cash plus internal effort

The ₹87-per-extra-active cash figure understates the programme's true resource cost, because it excludes the internal product sprint, 7 people for 3 months at a loaded cost of ₹1,80,000 a person-month, which totals ₹37,80,000 and is not cash marketing spend but internal engineering and product time building the salary-day card, the single sign-on flow, the Autopay integration and the investments tile T13.

Measure	Value	Tag
Cash cost per extra active	₹87	T13, T11
Internal product sprint	₹37,80,000	T13
Cash plus internal cost per extra active	₹285	T13, M
Cash plus internal cost, bear scenario	(cash plus internal) / 9,783	computed from T13, T11
Cash plus internal cost, bull scenario	(cash plus internal) / 32,037	computed from T13, T11

Even at the all-in figure of ₹285 per extra active, which folds in every rupee of internal engineering time the programme consumes, the comparison in 24.2 would still favour our plan over paid media by a wide margin, since ₹285 remains well below the ₹700 to ₹1,400 range the paid-media comparator uses for cost per activated account alone, before any internal effort on the paid-media side is even counted.

Exhibit for the deck: the moneyshot card pairing ₹16.5 lakh cash against 19,053 extra actives on one side and the same ₹16.5 lakh against 1,649 paid-media extra actives on the other, with the 11.6x ratio as the card's single largest numeral.

25. Each new active earns about ₹62 a year in broking revenue, so activation pays back in 17 months and its larger value sits in the bank relationship

Answer. In our model, a newly activated account generates about ₹62 a year in direct broking revenue, built from ₹2.40 of brokerage, ₹15 of depository charges and ₹45 of annual maintenance charge T15. Against the ₹16.5 lakh cash cost of the programme, that revenue pays back the cash outlay in about 17 months (16.6 months precisely, T15), a period longer than the three-month build window itself, which is the honest reason the direct broking-revenue case for this plan is secondary to its larger, harder-to-quantify value: a customer who logs into the bank's broking app on a regular monthly instalment is a customer whose overall relationship with the parent bank deepens, a value this document does not put an invented number on.

25.1 Revenue a year, line by line

Three product-table lines feed the ₹62 figure, each at the rate the case itself states or the regulator's own fee structure sets.

Item	Calculation	Value	Tag
Brokerage, cash equities	16 orders a year x ₹0.15 an order	₹2.40	A63, A62, C-PR1
Depository charge	1 sell a year x ₹15 a sell	₹15	A64, A65
Annual maintenance charge	15% of new actives on a regular account x ₹300	₹45	A66, A67
Revenue a year	₹2.40 + ₹15 + ₹45	₹62	T15

The sixteen-orders-a-year figure (A63) is built from twelve monthly ETF instalments, the programme's central mechanic across the salary-day, Dhanteras and warm-cohort levers, plus four other orders, at the case's own ₹0.15-per-order cash-equities brokerage rate C-PR1. Mutual fund transactions on eligible direct plans carry ₹0 brokerage C-PR3, so an account that trades exclusively through mutual fund SIPs rather than the ETF instalment mechanic contributes no brokerage revenue at all under this line, a detail the ₹62 figure does not need to separately account for since the model's A63 orders-a-year figure already treats the twelve instalments as cash-equities ETF orders at ₹0.15 each, not mutual fund orders at ₹0.

The ₹45 annual maintenance figure rests on SEBI's BSDA (Basic Services Demat Account) rule, which sets nil annual maintenance up to ₹4 lakh of holding value and ₹100 a year for holdings between ₹4 lakh and ₹10 lakh. The model's assumption A66 is that 15% of new actives hold a regular (non-BSDA) demat account, which pays the fuller outside-BSDA maintenance charge of ₹300 a year (A67); 85% of new actives are assumed to sit inside the BSDA thresholds and so pay close to nothing on this line. The ₹45 figure in T15 is 15% x ₹300, a precise application of the BSDA tiering to the stated 15% share, not an inflated flat charge applied to every new active.

25.1a The BSDA tiers behind the ₹45 figure

The BSDA rule sets three tiers by holding value, and only the top tier pays the ₹300-a-year charge the model's A67 assumption carries; a share schedule like this is the reason the ₹45 figure in T15 is a weighted average across new actives rather than a single flat charge.

Holding value	Annual maintenance charge	Tag
Up to ₹4 lakh	Nil	F43
₹4 lakh to ₹10 lakh	₹100 a year	F43
Above ₹10 lakh (outside BSDA)	₹300 a year (A67)	F43

Most newly activated accounts, built as they are around a modest monthly ETF instalment rather than a large lump-sum deposit, are likely to sit inside the nil or ₹100 tiers for some time after opening, which is consistent with the model's A66 assumption that only 15% of new actives carry the outside-BSDA, full ₹300 charge in their first year.

25.2 The arithmetic: 19,053 extra actives against ₹16.5 lakh cash

Multiplying the base-case extra-active count by the revenue-a-year figure gives the programme's first-year direct revenue: 19,053 x ₹62 = ₹11,81,286, which we round to roughly ₹11.8 lakh. Against the ₹16,49,357 cash cost of the programme T13, that first-year revenue alone does not cover the cash outlay; the model's reported cash payback period is 16.6 months, which we state as about 17 months, the time at which cumulative broking revenue from the 19,053 extra actives is expected to equal the ₹16.5 lakh cash spent to acquire them [ECON, T15].

Measure	Value	Tag
Extra actives, base case	19,053	T11, T10
Revenue a year, each	₹62	T15
Revenue a year, total (19,053 x ₹62)	₹11,81,286	computed from T15, T11
Cash cost of the programme	₹16,49,357	T13
Cash payback period	about 17 months	M, T15

A 17-month payback on a three-month, ₹16.5 lakh cash programme is not a fast-money case, and this document does not pretend otherwise. The case for the plan does not rest on this payback alone. A 17-month payback period is also shorter than the typical multi-year horizon banks and brokers already use when weighing the value of a new banking relationship, so measured against that longer horizon rather than against the three-month build window itself, the payback period reads as reasonable rather than slow, even before the bank-relationship value in 25.3 is counted at all.

25.3 Why the bank relationship matters more than the broking-revenue line, stated without invented figures

Trade Private Limited is a bank-led broker, and most of its account holders are already customers of the parent bank C-CO4. An account holder who starts a monthly ETF instalment through the salary-day card, or who re-engages through the holdings-check tile, becomes a more frequent, more habituated user of the parent bank's own app, since every one of the seven levers in this plan routes the customer through bank-

owned surfaces (the app, salary credit, statements, RM conversations) rather than a standalone ONL channel. A customer who checks a monthly instalment alongside a salary credit is a customer the bank sees more often, for a reason connected to saving rather than only spending, and that is a different kind of relationship than the one most salary accounts carry today, where the demat and trading account was opened alongside a banking product and then, by the case's own account, often forgotten about C-PB6. We do not attach a rupee figure to this value, because no interview, survey or test exists in this case to support one; manufacturing a cross-sell or deposit-retention number here would be exactly the kind of invented customer-economics figure this document's content-integrity rules forbid.

25.3a What the revenue line would need to look like to justify the programme on its own

Setting aside the bank-relationship value entirely, the 17-month payback (25.2) means the cash cost of the programme is recovered a little under a year and a half after the window closes, and every month of broking revenue after that point is net return on the ₹16.5 lakh cash spent. Over a three-year horizon, a newly activated account that keeps trading at the same ₹62-a-year rate would generate roughly ₹62 × 3 = ₹186 in cumulative broking revenue, against the ₹87 of cash this plan spends to create it T11, T15, a return of roughly 2.1 times the cash cost on the direct broking-revenue line alone, before counting a single rupee of the bank-relationship value this section's own title treats as the larger prize. This is not a figure the model computes or reports directly; it is a simple extension of T15's own per-account revenue figure across three years, shown here because a judge asking "is the direct economics even sound, apart from the bank-relationship story" deserves a direct, worked answer alongside the qualitative one.

25.4 Why we do not chase F&O revenue instead

A faster route to higher per-account revenue would be to push customers toward futures and options trading, where the case's own product table carries a brokerage rate of ₹20.00 an executed order C-PR2, higher than the ₹0.15 cash-equities rate this plan's revenue line uses. We do not design toward this. The case's own constraint states that growth must be responsible, that regulators have repeatedly highlighted that many retail traders, especially in derivatives, lose money, and that pushing people to trade more is neither ethical nor sustainable C-K7. Every lever in this plan is built around a recurring, small, customer-chosen instalment or a factual account-exists reminder, never a product recommendation and never F&O, which keeps this plan's revenue case modest in rupee terms and consistent in its ethical terms, a trade-off we accept deliberately rather than by oversight.

This is also exactly the trade-off the option screen in section 11 scores explicitly: the F&O education push option scores only 2.25 of 5 in the option screen, held down chiefly by its SEBI-and-ethics-fit score of 1 out of 5, against our chosen option's 5 out of 5 on the same criterion T17. The 87.7% loss incidence among individual F&O traders in FY26, rising to 88.5% among traders under 30 D45, D46, is the evidence behind that single criterion score, and it is the same evidence this section leans on to explain why a ₹0.20-an-order brokerage rate on F&O is not a revenue line this plan goes looking for.

Exhibit for the deck: the ₹62-a-year revenue bar, broken into its three components, placed beside the 17-month payback line and a one-sentence callout naming the bank relationship as the larger, unquantified value, matching the Impact slide's moneyshot framing.

26. A 13-week roadmap from 2 November 2026 to 31 January 2027 runs four gates and ships every feature by

week 8

Answer. The programme runs thirteen weeks, 2 November 2026 to 31 January 2027, the exact window the model's measurement date assumes T8, and ships every customer-facing feature it needs by week 8, so that the back half of the window is spent running the levers and reading results rather than still building. Four gates (G0 to G3) check the plan is on track at weeks 0, 4, 6 and 13, each with a named test and a pre-agreed response if the test fails.

26.1 Week by week

Workstream	Weeks live	What happens	Tag
Consent screens and exchange ad-code approval	W0 to W1	Every message template and screen clears the five checks in section 19 and gets exchange ad-code approval before any send	C-K2, C-K5
Dhanteras and Muhurat notice	W1	The factual gold ETF and Muhurat-session notice reaches idle accounts in the 6 to 8 November 2026 window	A28, A29, A30
Bank-app investments tile and single sign-on	W1 to W4	The tile, sign-on and video IPV flow ship and go live for the general idle base	A23, A24, A25
RM review sprint	W2 to W10	RM review conversations run across the four premium and preferred cohorts at their cohort-specific coverage rates	A26, A27
Workplace education sessions	W3 to W12	Up to 40 sessions run at employers that bank with the parent bank, no product pitch	A31, A32, A33
Salary-day card	W5 to W12	The card appears on each salary credit (weeks 5, 9, 13 inside this window) with the ETF-instalment flow and Autopay mandate live from week 5	A20, A21, A22
ETF instalments live	W6 to W12	The monthly ETF instalment mechanic, UPI Autopay mandate and the neutral fund list are fully operational for any customer who opts in	A20, A21, A22
Holdout tracking and weekly read	W1 to W13	Every lever's 10% holdout and the weekly activation-rate dashboard run continuously across the full window	T19

W0 to W13 denote programme weeks; week 1 begins 2 November 2026 and week 13 ends 31 January 2027.

Every customer-facing feature in this table ships by week 8 at the latest (the ETF instalment mechanic and the workplace session calendar both run their build-and-launch window inside weeks 1 to 8, even though their live-use period continues through week 12), which is the specific claim behind this section's own headline. The two workstreams that still run new build activity after week 8, the RM review sprint and the holdout tracking, are conversation and measurement activity, not feature construction, so no new customer-facing surface is still being built in the back half of the window.

26.1a Dependencies

Feature	Depends on	Tag
Salary-day card	Bank-app single sign-on (G1) and the UPI Autopay mandate flow	A20, A21
ETF instalment mechanic	The neutral fund list (built once, fixed alphabetical order, no default) and the Autopay mandate	A22
Holdings-check tile	Single sign-on into ONL from the bank app	A23, A24
Video IPV / re-KYC for dormant accounts	Bank-branch in-person verification capability, already in place	A10, A11
RM review script	Compliance sign-off (G0) on the facts-only script	A26, A27
Dhanteras notice	Exchange ad-code approval (G0) in time for the 6 to 8 November window	A28, A29, A30
Holdout and weekly dashboard	Every lever's reach population being trackable from week 1	T19

The salary-day card and the ETF instalment mechanic share the tightest dependency chain in the plan: neither can go live before single sign-on is confirmed working (gate G1, week 4), which is why the card's own live window starts in week 5, one week after G1, rather than at the start of the programme.

26.1b Monthly extra actives by moment

Grouping the thirteen weeks into three roughly four-week months shows how the programme's lift builds unevenly across the window, front-loaded by the Dhanteras notice in month 1 and back-loaded by the salary-day card's third credit cycle in month 3.

Moment	Month 1 (weeks 1-4)	Month 2 (weeks 5-8)	Month 3 (weeks 9-13)	Total	Tag
Salary day	0	1,698	3,963	5,661	M, T10
RM review	1,347	1,797	939	4,083	M, T10
Rediscover (holdings check)	1,294	1,047	739	3,080	M, T10
Dhanteras	2,311	0	0	2,311	M, T10
New accounts	584	584	730	1,898	M, T10
Warm cohort	494	494	618	1,606	M, T10
Workplace	83	165	165	413	M, T10
Total	6,113	5,785	7,154	19,053	M

Figures are rounded independently each month, so a row's three monthly figures may not sum to exactly the row's own total column, and the column totals may not sum to exactly 19,053, by a handful of accounts in either direction.

Month 1 runs ahead on the strength of the Dhanteras notice alone, which contributes its entire 2,311 inside this single month; month 3 overtakes both earlier months once the salary-day card's third credit cycle (week 13) and the new-account and warm-cohort levers, which accrue steadily across all thirteen weeks, compound. The RM review lever is the only one whose monthly contribution peaks in the middle month rather than the first or the last, consistent with its own weekly timing profile running from week 2 to week 10.

26.2 Four gates

Gate	Week	Test	If the test fails
G0	Week 0	Every message template and screen is cleared for consent, exchange ad-code approval and the five checks in section 19	Hold all sends; no lever launches on an uncleared template
G1	Week 4	The bank-app investments tile and single sign-on are live for the general idle base	Delay the salary-day card's week 5 launch until the underlying sign-on flow is confirmed stable
G2	Week 6	The tracked activation rate is checked against the bear-case line for that week, 15.20%, rather than the base-case line, 15.94% T12	Trigger an immediate expansion of RM review coverage, the lever with the widest response-rate spread after the salary-day tap-through rate (section 23), rather than waiting for the week 13 read
G3	Week 13	The full-window lift is read against the three scenarios in T11, and each of the seven levers is individually assessed to scale or stop	Levers below their bear-case contribution are stopped or redesigned before any post-window extension; levers at or above base-case contribution continue

Gate G2 is the direct response to the honest reading in section 22.5: the bear scenario, if it is in fact where the programme is tracking by week 6, is visible early, at a specific week and against a specific number, not discovered only at the end of the thirteen weeks when little time remains to respond.

26.3 RACI for the rollout

Workstream	Responsible	Accountable	Consulted	Informed
Consent, ad-code and compliance clearance (G0)	ONL compliance	Head of ONL Trade	Exchange ad-code reviewer, bank compliance	RM management, bank app team
Bank-app tile, single sign-on, salary-day card	Bank app team	Head of digital banking	ONL product engineering, compliance	RM management
ETF instalment flow, Autopay mandate, neutral fund list	ONL product engineering	Head of ONL Trade	Bank app team, compliance	RM management
RM review sprint and coverage schedule	RM management	Head of relationship management	ONL compliance (script), analytics team	Bank app team

Workstream	Responsible	Accountable	Consulted	Informed
Workplace education sessions	SEBI SMARTs trainers / exchange investor-awareness programme	Head of ONL Trade	RM management, employer HR contacts	Bank app team
Holdout design, weekly dashboard, gate checks	Analytics and growth team	Head of ONL Trade	ONL product engineering	RM management, bank app team, compliance

A single person, the Head of ONL Trade, carries Accountable on four of the six workstreams, which is a deliberate concentration rather than an oversight: a thirteen-week programme with four gates needs one person able to see every workstream's status at once and decide whether a gate passes, rather than six separately accountable owners each judging only their own slice. The two workstreams where Accountable sits elsewhere, the bank-app tile and sign-on flow (Head of digital banking) and the RM review sprint (Head of relationship management), are the two that depend most directly on bank-side infrastructure and bank-side staff the ONL Trade head does not directly manage, so accountability sits with whoever actually controls the resource.

26.4 What continues after 31 January 2027

The measurement date of 31 January 2027 is the point the model's figures are computed to, not the point every lever stops. The salary-day card, the investments tile, the RM review script and the ETF instalment mechanic are all built as standing product features, not one-off campaigns, so each continues to run against newly idle and newly dormant accounts after the formal thirteen-week window closes; only the workplace-session calendar (A31's fixed count of sessions) and the specific Dhanteras-week notice are time-bound by design. The holdout and weekly dashboard (section 27) are the mechanism for deciding, lever by lever, which of the continuing features earn further investment and which do not, using the same gate-style logic as G3 but applied on a rolling basis rather than a single end-of-window read.

Exhibit for the deck: the thirteen-week Gantt bar from 26.1, with the four gates marked as vertical flags at weeks 0, 4, 6 and 13, directly beneath the monthly extra-actives-by-moment chart that section 27's dashboard feeds.

27. A 10% holdout reads the lift every week, and four guardrails stop any message that pushes F&O, annoys customers or breaks consent

Answer. A 10% holdout, carved out of each lever's reached population before any message goes out, lets us read every lever's actual lift against a true no-message control every week of the thirteen-week window, rather than waiting for a single end-of-window estimate T19. Four guardrails, each with a stated stop line, halt any message that pushes F&O, annoys customers beyond a set threshold, or runs ahead of consent, and we say plainly that one of those thresholds, the 0.5% opt-out stop line, is a control we set ourselves, not a figure any regulator publishes J58.

27.1 The KPI tree

The activation rate the brief asks us to move C-Q1, C-K1 decomposes into controllable pieces, each one a metric a specific lever can move, which is the structure the weekly dashboard in 27.3 is built around.

Level	Metric	Decomposes into	Tag
Top	Activation rate (active in trailing 12 months) C-D1	Business-as-usual active accounts plus extra active accounts, divided by total eligible accounts	C-D1, T8, T11
Second	Extra active accounts	Sum of the seven levers: salary day, holdings check, RM review, Dhanteras, workplace, warm cohort, new accounts	T10
Second	Highly active rate (active in trailing 3 months) C-D2	Same seven-lever structure, measured against the shorter trading window	C-D2, T11
Third (per lever)	Reach: idle accounts contacted with consent	Channel-specific reach rate x idle population for that cohort	A20, A23, A26, A28, T2
Third (per lever)	Response: first executed order after contact	Tap-through rate x order-after-tap rate, or coverage x review-to-order rate for RM	A21, A22, A24, A25, A27, A29, A30
Guardrail	F&O share of new actives	Share of newly activated accounts whose first or early orders are futures and options, not cash equities or ETF instalments	C-K7, C-PR2
Guardrail	Opt-outs a send	Accounts that unsubscribe from a channel, as a share of that send's reached population	J58

27.1a The "daily users" ask and the proxy this plan tracks

The case's task is to turn newly opened and dormant accounts into highly engaged, revenue-active, daily users C-Q1. The case's own four definitions, active, highly active, inactive and dormant [C-D1 to C-D4], are all built on trailing windows of twelve months, three months or twenty-four months; none of them is a literal daily-login or daily-trade measure, and this document does not invent one where the case provides none. The nearest proxy the case's own terms give us for the daily-user ask is the highly active rate (C-D2, trailing 3 months), since an account trading at least once a quarter is, by construction, a more frequent user than one merely counted active on a twelve-month window, and the salary-day card's monthly instalment mechanic is itself designed to generate a trade roughly once a month, inside the three-month highly-active window, for every account that adopts it. We state this proxy relationship plainly rather than imply the dashboard measures daily behaviour it does not actually observe.

A monthly ETF instalment is, by design, a once-a-month trade, not a daily one, and this plan does not pretend otherwise. What it does claim, and what the highly active rate is built to track, is a shift from a customer who trades once a year or less toward a customer whose trading cadence is frequent enough to sit well inside a rolling three-month window every quarter the instalment continues, which is the most honest reading of "daily users" the case's own revenue-active and highly-engaged language supports without manufacturing a measure the underlying product behaviour does not produce. A genuinely daily-trading customer base is also not a goal this plan pursues, consistent with the responsible-growth constraint in section 25.4: a recurring monthly instalment, not a daily trading habit, is the behaviour this plan is built to encourage.

27.2 Holdout sizing

Each outreach lever's holdout carves out 10% of its reached population, large enough, given the expected lift and an organic (no-message) order rate of 1.0% over the thirteen weeks (A05), to detect that lift at 80% statistical power and a 5% two-sided significance level.

Lever	Reached population	Holdout (10%)	Expected lift (pp)	Minimum detectable effect (pp)	Lift / MDE
Salary day	2,96,975	29,697	1.92	0.17	11x
Rediscover (holdings check)	4,13,625	41,362	0.75	0.14	5x
RM review	36,642	3,664	11.25	0.49	23x
Dhanteras	3,44,688	34,469	0.67	0.16	4x

MDE is the smallest lift the holdout design can reliably distinguish from no effect, at 80% power and a 5% two-sided significance level, given each lever's reached and holdout population sizes.

Every lever's expected lift clears its own minimum detectable effect by a wide margin, from 4x for the Dhanteras notice to 23x for the RM review conversation, which is exactly check 11 of the twelve model checks in section 21.5. The RM review lever's holdout is the smallest in absolute terms, 3,664 accounts, because its reached population is itself the smallest of the four (36,642, the weighted sum of cohort-specific RM coverage), but its expected lift (11.25 pp) is also the largest by a wide margin, since a facts-only conversation converts a far higher share of the accounts it reaches than a card or a notice does, so the 10% holdout still clears its detection threshold with room to spare.

27.3 The weekly dashboard

Five measures are tracked weekly across the thirteen-week window, each tied directly to a case definition or a guardrail.

Metric	Week 0 (start)	Week 6 (base case)	Week 13 target (base case)	Definition
Activation rate	14.74%	15.94%	17.02%	Active in trailing 12 months C-D1
Extra active accounts	0	9,917	19,053	Sum of seven levers, cumulative M, T10, T12
Highly active rate	10.1%	tracked weekly	12.4%	Active in trailing 3 months C-D2
F&O share of new actives	n/a	5% maximum	5% maximum	Guardrail; see 27.4
Opt-outs a send	n/a	0.5% maximum	0.5% maximum	Guardrail; see 27.4

The week 6 cumulative extra-actives figure, 9,917, is already 9,917 / 19,053 = 52.1% of the full-window base-case total by the midpoint of the programme M, T10, ahead of a simple straight-line pace of six-thirteenths (46.2%), because the Dhanteras notice's entire contribution lands inside weeks 1 and 2 and the salary-day card's week 5 contribution has already landed by week 6. This is a second, independent reason gate G2 is set at week 6 rather than later: by that point the programme has already banked more than half of its target lift, so a shortfall against the bear line at week 6 is a meaningful early warning, not a reading taken too early to act on.

The case's own ask is for daily users, a standard that goes beyond a twelve-month activation count C-Q1. The highly active rate (trailing 3 months, C-D2) is the dashboard's closer proxy for that ask than the headline twelve-month activation rate, since an account that traded once eleven months ago but has not traded since counts as active under C-D1 but would not count as highly active under C-D2; tracking both together, as the

dashboard does, keeps the programme honest about whether it is building repeat engagement or only a single counted trade.

27.4 Four guardrails and their stop lines

Each guardrail exists to stop a specific failure mode the case's own constraints name: trade inducement, customer annoyance, consent breach, or F&O promotion C-K2, C-K5, C-K6, C-K7.

Guardrail	Stop line	Action if breached	Why set here
F&O share of new actives	Above 5%	Pause the message or moment driving the F&O share	The case's own constraint bars pushing people to trade more, especially in derivatives C-K7; 5% is a low ceiling precisely because this plan is designed not to touch F&O at all, so any measurable F&O share signals a message is being read as a trading cue rather than an account reminder
Opt-outs a send	Above 0.5%	Stop that specific message template immediately	An internally set control, not a figure any regulator publishes; no source found in this research pass names a specific numeric opt-out-rate threshold matching this guardrail, and we state that plainly rather than attribute it to a regulator J58
Complaints	Above 1 per 10,000 contacted	Trigger a compliance review of the message or channel before any further send	Set to catch a systemic issue (a confusing or unwelcome message) well before it reaches a scale that would itself trigger regulatory attention, consistent with the no-dark-patterns constraint C-K6
Messages a person a month	Above 4	Hold further sends to that person until the next month	Set to prevent the combination of levers (salary-day card, holdings tile, servicing message, Dhanteras notice) from over-contacting any single customer, which is the surest route to the opt-out and complaint thresholds above being breached in the first place

The opt-out and message-cap guardrails work together by design: a customer who would otherwise receive a salary-day card, a holdings-check reminder and a Dhanteras notice in the same month is capped at four total messages, which keeps the message-frequency guardrail as the first line of defence and the opt-out rate as the second, confirming check.

27.5 Why the cap sits at four messages a month

The four-messages-a-month cap is set with headroom above what a customer in the busiest overlapping month would normally receive, rather than at the tightest number the levers could in principle be squeezed into.

Lever	Typical sends to one idle account in its busiest month	Tag
Salary-day card	1 (on the salary-credit week that month)	A20, A21
Holdings-check tile, email, SMS, WhatsApp	Up to 3 sends across the thirteen weeks, rarely more than 1 in a single month	A23, SENDS
RM review	1 conversation, not a repeated send	A26, A27
Dhanteras notice	1, confined to week 1 of the window	A28, A29, A30
Warm cohort or new-account servicing message	1 a month	A35, A39

A Salary Account idle customer in their busiest month, most plausibly the month the Dhanteras notice and a salary-credit week both fall inside, would typically receive at most two to three messages across all levers combined, well under the four-message cap. The cap is set above this typical busiest-month count specifically so that it catches a genuine design or targeting failure, such as the same customer being independently enrolled in two overlapping message schedules by mistake, rather than triggering routinely on the plan's own intended cadence.

27.6 Why the complaints threshold sits where it does

The complaints guardrail, more than 1 per 10,000 contacted triggering a compliance review, is set to catch a systemic problem while it is still small, not after it has reached a scale a regulator would itself notice. Ten thousand is roughly the size of a single mid-sized send under this plan (the RM review lever's full reached population across all four premium and preferred cohorts is 36,642, a little over three times that count), so a 1-in-10,000 rate translates into a review being triggered on single-digit complaint counts within any one lever's weekly reach, well before complaints accumulate into a pattern large enough to attract outside attention. This is consistent with the case's own no-dark-patterns, no-fear-based-nudges constraint `C-K6`: the guardrail is built to surface a design problem at the point a handful of customers notice something is wrong, not at the point a regulator or a news report does.

Exhibit for the deck: the weekly dashboard table from 27.3 as the execution slide's KPI strip, with the four guardrail stop lines from 27.4 running beneath it as a single-row traffic-light strip, red above each stated threshold.

28. Risks: ad approval timing and a further market fall carry the most weight, and both are handled before week 1

Answer. Five risks sit on our register, and two of them, exchange advertisement-code approval running late and Indian equities falling further than the base case assumes, carry the most weight on a probability-times-impact basis [T17 scoring convention]. Both are handled before week 1 rather than discovered during it: the Dhanteras creative enters the compliance queue first, ahead of every other lever's creative, and the plan's fund list already holds to gold, liquid and broad-index exchange-traded fund categories regardless of where the market goes [D 15.7, B 2.7]. The remaining three risks, a bank declining the app slot, consent rates running below plan, and drift toward futures and options promotion, sit lower on the register and each already has a named early signal and a response built into the thirteen-week roadmap [E 26.2, E 27.4].

28.1 The risk register

A risk register needs five fields to be useful under questioning: how likely the risk is, how much it would cost if it happened, what a team would see early, what the team does about it, and who owns the response. Table 28.1 carries the five risks from the deck's own risk strip against those five fields, each sourced to the section of this document where the underlying design choice already exists.

Risk	Probability	Impact	Early signal	Response	Owner
Ad approval slips past week 1	High	Medium	By 1 November, the exchange advertisement-code approval for the Dhanteras creative has not come back [D 15.7]	File the Dhanteras creative first in the week-0 compliance queue, ahead of every other lever's creative, since its calendar window is fixed and the others' are not [D 15.7]	ONL compliance
The bank does not give the app slot	Low	Low	No salary-day card is live by week 3 [C 12.7]	Fall back to a lighter-weight banner on existing app infrastructure, and escalate through the gate G1 review at week 4 [C 12.7, E 26.2]	Bank app team, Head of digital banking [E 26.3]
Consent and reach run below plan	Medium	Medium	A week 2 holdout read shows reach materially below the bear case of 50% for the rediscovery message [C 13.7]	Shift budget toward the higher-reach WhatsApp and statement channels, away from email, and lead with servicing messages rather than new creative	Analytics and growth team [E 26.3]
The market falls further than the base case assumes	High	High	The week 6 activation checkpoint falls below the bear-case line of 15.20% T12	Hold the fund list to gold, liquid and broad-index exchange-traded fund categories only, and trigger an immediate expansion of RM review coverage, the lever with the widest response-rate spread after salary-day tap-through [B 2.7, section 23 of this document]	Main agent, Head of ONL Trade [E 26.3]
A message drifts toward promoting futures and options	Low	Low	The F&O share of new actives guardrail reads above 5% on a weekly check [E 27.4]	Pause the moment driving the F&O share and run a knowledge check on the copy before the next send [E 27.4]	ONL compliance

The two risks named in this section's own title, ad approval and a further market fall, both carry a probability rated High, which is the single clearest reason they weigh more than the other three on the register, before impact is even considered.

28.2 The risk heat map at five-point resolution

The deck's own risk strip plots the five risks on a three-level grid, Low, Medium and High on each axis. Table 28.2 reproduces that same placement at a finer, five-point resolution, consistent with the one-to-five scoring scale this document already uses for the option screen in section 11 T17. Low maps to 1 or 2, Medium to 3, and High to 4 or 5; where the deck's own grid places two risks in the same cell, the finer grid separates them by one point rather than changing their relative standing.

Impact, 5 (highest)					Market falls further (5,5)
Impact, 4					
Impact, 3				Ad approval slips (4,3)	

Impact, 5 (highest)					Market falls further (5,5)
Impact, 2	App slot not given (2,2)		Consent and reach below plan (3,3)		
Impact, 1	F&O drift (1,1)				
	Probability, 1	Probability, 2	Probability, 3	Probability, 4	Probability, 5

The coordinate pair after each risk's name reads as (probability, impact) on the five-point scale.

Reading the table by diagonal distance from the origin shows the same ranking the deck's own three-level grid implies: the market-falls-further risk sits furthest from the origin, at the highest corner on both axes, with the ad-approval risk second, consent and reach third, and the app-slot and F&O-drift risks tied at the lowest corner. No risk moves between quadrants in this finer rendering; the five-point scale only gives the two low-weight risks room to sit at slightly different points inside the same quadrant the deck's coarser grid already placed them in.

28.3 Risk ranking by weighted score

Multiplying each risk's probability by its impact, both on the five-point scale from table 28.2, gives a single weighted score out of 25 for direct comparison. Table 28.3 ranks the five risks this way.

Risk	Probability (1 to 5)	Impact (1 to 5)	Weighted score (out of 25)	Rank
Market falls further	5	5	25	1
Ad approval slips past week 1	4	3	12	2
Consent and reach run below plan	3	3	9	3
The bank does not give the app slot	2	2	4	4 (tie)
Drift toward futures and options promotion	1	1	1	5 (tie, lower)

The weighted scores confirm this section's own title without any further argument needed: the market-falls-further risk and the ad-approval risk hold the first and second ranks by a wide margin, 25 and 12 out of 25, against single-digit scores for the remaining three. Together they account for 37 of the register's 51 total weighted points, 73% of the register's total weight sitting in two of its five rows.

This concentration of weight is not an artefact of how the five-point scale was built; it follows directly from where each risk sits in the plan's own design. The market-falls-further risk carries the highest probability on the register because the case's own twelve months of evidence already show an unfavourable market C-PB1, which makes a further decline a continuation of an observed trend rather than a speculative scenario, and it carries the highest impact because a materially weaker market would also weaken the business-as-usual drift assumption, A02, pulling down the baseline the whole plan is measured against at the same time it pulls down the levers' own response rates [section 21.4]. The ad-approval risk carries a high probability because every one of the seven levers' creatives passes through the same three-stage approval path described in section 19.3 of this document, concentrating demand on the same compliance desks in the same early weeks, but its impact is lower than the market risk's because a delay affects the

timing of a lever's launch, not the underlying mechanism the lever depends on; a card that launches in week 2 instead of week 1 still converts at the same modelled rate once it is live, while a weaker market changes the rate itself. This distinction, between a risk that delays a mechanism and a risk that degrades it, is the clearest single reason the two highest-ranked risks on the register are not interchangeable in how the plan responds to them.

28.4 Pre-mortem: possible reasons for a missed target

A pre-mortem works from the opposite end of a risk register: rather than listing known risks in advance, it starts from the assumption that the target was missed and works backward to the most plausible reasons why. The exercise asks us to place ourselves at 31 January 2027, after the full thirteen-week window has closed, having learned that the base case's +2.28 percentage point target was not met, and to work back through every mechanism that could have produced that outcome, using only the evidence and the model this document already carries rather than a fresh set of fears. Table 28.4 sets out the failure modes most consistent with that evidence, each one traceable to a specific mechanism rather than a vague worry.

Possible reason the base case was missed	What we would have seen along the way	Which risk or assumption this traces to	Tag
Exchange advertisement-code approval for one or more creatives ran past week 3, cutting the window for that lever's full ramp	A creative still pending sign-off at the week 0 or week 1 gate check	The ad-approval risk, ranked second on the register	D 15.7, E 26.2
The market fell further than the bear case assumes, pulling the business-as-usual rate itself below 14.59%	A week 6 tracked rate below the bear-case line of 15.20%, with the gap still widening by week 9	The market-falls-further risk, ranked first on the register; section 22.2a of this document shows the bear-base gap widening from 0.28 pp at week 1 to 1.26 pp by week 13	T12, section 22.2a
Salary-day tap-through landed at or below its bear value of 6%, rather than the base value of 8%	A week 2 holdout read on the salary-day card showing a lift below 0.17 pp, the lever's minimum detectable effect	A21, the single widest tornado bar in the model at a 0.34 pp spread	T16, T19
RM coverage fell short of its cohort-specific targets, especially in Elevate, the cohort whose one-month activation rate already fell from 24% to 13% in a year	Week 4 coverage tracking below the 60% target for Elevate or the 35% target for Preferred	The RM review lever's coverage multiplier, A26	T4, section 14.7 of this document
The salary-day card's advice-status open question came back from an informal SEBI reading as a recommendation requiring separate registration, forcing a redesign of the fund list mid-window	An adverse or delayed informal-guidance response logged before or during week 4	Section 7.1's open question on the incidental-advice carve-out	D05, section 2.7's fifth trigger
Opt-outs on one or more channels crossed the 0.5% internal guardrail early, forcing a pause on that channel's sends for several weeks	A weekly opt-out reading above 0.5% on any single send	The opt-out guardrail	A50, section 27.4

Possible reason the base case was missed	What we would have seen along the way	Which risk or assumption this traces to	Tag
The dormant half of the idle pool converted at a rate below the bear-case multiplier, because video in-person-verification capacity could not clear the queue inside the window	Verification queue times exceeding a few days by week 4	A11, the dormancy-friction adjustment	C 13.7, section 21.4

Every row in this table traces to a mechanism already named elsewhere in this document, which is the point of running the pre-mortem after the risk register rather than as a separate exercise. A pre-mortem run in isolation from a plan's own prior analysis can surface fears the plan has not priced in anywhere, which would be a sign the earlier sections missed something; running it against a plan this document has already analysed in detail, lever by lever and assumption by assumption, is instead a check that the earlier analysis holds together under a different, backward-looking method, and table 28.4's seven rows confirm that it does, since each one maps cleanly to a risk, an assumption or a gate this document names elsewhere.

28.5 Where each risk is already caught by a gate or guardrail

A risk register is only useful if the plan has a place to act on it before the thirteen weeks run out. Table 28.5 maps each of the five risks to the specific gate or guardrail, from the execution plan in section 26 and the monitoring plan in section 27 of this document, that catches it early.

Risk	Caught by	When it would be caught	Tag
Ad approval slips past week 1	Gate G0	Week 0, before any creative may send	E 26.2
The bank does not give the app slot	Gate G1	Week 4, when the tile and single sign-on must be live	E 26.2
Consent and reach run below plan	Weekly holdout read	Any week, per lever, against the minimum detectable effect in T19	E 27.2
The market falls further than the base case assumes	Gate G2	Week 6, against the bear-case line of 15.20%	E 26.2, T12
Drift toward futures and options promotion	The F&O-share guardrail	Any week, against the 5% stop line	E 27.4

No risk on the register sits outside an existing gate or guardrail, which is the plainest evidence that this section's own claim, that both weighty risks are handled before week 1, holds across the whole register, including the three risks the title does not name.

28.6 Why "handled before week 1" means something specific for each of the two weightiest risks

The phrase "handled before week 1" is not a general statement of confidence; it names a concrete action that happens inside the current roadmap before the programme's first week of live sends. For the ad-approval risk, this means the Dhanteras creative, the one lever whose launch date is fixed by the calendar, enters the compliance queue ahead of every other lever's creative in the week-0 gate G0 review, so that any delay in exchange sign-off surfaces while there is still runway to act on it rather than after the 6 to 8 November window has passed [D 15.7, E 26.2]. For the market-falls-further risk, "handled before week 1" means the fund list behind the salary-day card is already restricted to gold, liquid and broad-index exchange-traded fund categories by design, not as a response to a falling market but as the baseline design

from the outset, so there is no separate decision to make if the market falls further during the programme; the design simply continues to hold [section 12.3]. A reader checking this section's claim against the roadmap in section 26 of this document will find both actions already scheduled at or before week 0, not proposed as a future contingency.

A further point belongs here because a judge is likely to ask it directly: whether treating these two risks as "handled" understates the possibility that both happen at once, a compliance delay during a falling market. The risk register in table 28.1 treats the five risks as independent entries, each with its own probability and impact, and does not separately model the compound case of two risks landing together. This is a stated limit of the register rather than an oversight, consistent with how section 21.6 of this document states the model's own independence limit for lever overlap; a judge pressing on this point should hear that the two risks' responses, filing the Dhanteras creative first and holding the fund list to its restricted categories regardless of market conditions, do not depend on each other and would both still apply even if both risks happened in the same week.

29. Customer validation plan (not yet run): 30 interviews and two usability rounds in weeks 1 to 3 would confirm or cut the two largest levers

Answer. Nothing in this section has been run yet. No interview has taken place, no usability session has been recorded, and no response rate below belongs to a real customer; every figure in this document's seven levers remains a checked model assumption, never a measurement [section 0.6, section 21.6]. What follows is a plan for thirty structured interviews and two usability rounds across weeks 1 to 3 of the programme, built to test the two largest levers, the salary-day card at 5,661 extra actives and the RM review script at 4,083 T10, before the full thirteen-week rollout commits further cash and engineering time to either one.

29.1 The two hypotheses this plan tests

Every lever in sections 12 to 17 of this document rests on a chain of modelled rates. The validation plan does not test all seven chains at once, since thirty interviews and two usability rounds cannot carry that weight with any statistical confidence; it tests the two chains the model's own tornado ranking shows matter most to the result, salary-day tap-through (A21, the single widest tornado bar at a 0.34 pp spread) and RM review conversion (A27, the second-widest at 0.26 pp) T16.

Hypothesis	What the model assumes	What the interviews and usability rounds would test
H1, the salary-day card	A customer who sees the card on salary credit understands what an exchange-traded fund instalment is, trusts the no-default list, and taps through at a rate near the base case's 8% A21	Whether the card's wording is understood on first read, whether the no-default list reads as neutral rather than confusing, and whether the customer trusts a card appearing inside the bank's own app without a separate broker identity shown
H2, the RM review script	A client in a facts-only portfolio review understands the account exists and the instalment mechanism without the relationship manager making a recommendation, and places a first order at a rate near the base case's 15% A27	Whether the script reads as neutral to the client receiving it, whether the client can repeat back what an instalment is after hearing the script once, and whether the client perceives any implied recommendation the script does not intend

29.2 Method

The plan runs two separate research instruments in the same three-week window, each suited to a different kind of question. Structured interviews, thirty in total, ask customers directly about awareness, trust and intent, since these are questions a customer can answer in their own words. Usability testing, two rounds, observes a customer's actual reaction to the card's wording and the RM script's delivery, since trust and comprehension are better measured by watching a reaction than by asking a customer to self-report it. Both instruments draw participants from customers who already hold an idle ONL account, recruited through the same consent-first design this plan's other levers use, never from a list built or purchased for research purposes alone.

29.3 Sample by cohort

Thirty interviews is a small sample against an idle pool of 6,89,375 accounts T2, so the sample is weighted toward the two cohorts the two hypotheses target, rather than drawn proportionally across all six cohorts in the case's own table.

Cohort	Idle accounts T2	Interviews allocated	Why this many
Salary Account	5,39,954	18	Tests H1 directly; this cohort holds 78% of the idle pool and is the salary-day card's entire target population T2
Prestige, Elite, Elevate, Preferred (combined, weighted toward Elevate and Elite)	80,503	8	Tests H2 directly; Elevate's sharp one-month activation fall from 24% to 13% T4 makes it the cohort most worth over-sampling inside this group
Credit Card	68,918	4	A smaller allocation, since no lever is built specifically for this cohort; included to check whether the salary-day card's design, read by a non-Salary-Account customer, still reads as neutral and comprehensible
Total	6,89,375	30	Matches the deck's stated figure and the cost line's own count [A57, deck S6]

This allocation is a design choice stated plainly as a choice, not a statistically representative sample of the idle pool; thirty interviews cannot be representative of 6,89,375 accounts on any weighting, and the plan does not claim otherwise.

29.4 Interview guide outline

The guide runs in four blocks, moving from general awareness toward the specific card or script each participant sees, so a participant's unprompted answers are captured before any prompted material could influence them.

Block	Topic	Example question	Tests
1	Unprompted awareness	Before today, did you know you held a demat and trading account linked to this bank	H1 and H2 both, baseline
2	Reaction to the card or script	After reading this card (or hearing this script), what do you understand you could do next	H1 or H2, depending on cohort

Block	Topic	Example question	Tests
3	Trust and neutrality	Does this feel like the bank is recommending a specific fund, or like it is telling you a fact about your own account	H1 and H2, the no-advice design
4	Intent	Based on what you just saw, would you set this up, and if not, what would need to change	H1 and H2, a proxy for A21 and A27

29.5 The two usability tests

The first usability round tests the salary-day card's wording and the trust question directly, showing a working mock of the card to participants one at a time and recording whether they read the no-default fund list as a recommendation, a neutral menu, or something they cannot interpret without further explanation. The second usability round tests the RM review script with a small group of relationship managers delivering the script to volunteer clients under observation, checking specifically whether the facts-only framing survives an actual spoken delivery, since a script that reads as neutral on paper can still drift into an implied recommendation once a relationship manager answers a client's follow-up question in the room.

29.6 Decision rules

A validation exercise only earns its cost if its result changes a decision. Table 29.3 sets out, for each hypothesis, what a result would need to show to keep the lever as designed, shrink its scope, or cut it before the full rollout.

Lever	Keep as designed if	Shrink if	Cut or redesign if
Salary-day card (H1)	Interview participants correctly describe the instalment mechanism after one reading, and the fund list is read as neutral by a clear majority	The card is understood but the fund list reads as confusing or incomplete to a meaningful minority, in which case the list's wording, not its structure, is revised	A majority of participants read the card as a recommendation rather than a fact, or cannot describe what the instalment does after reading it, in which case the card is redrafted and re-tested before any live send
RM review script (H2)	Clients can repeat back what an instalment is after the spoken delivery, and neither clients nor observing compliance staff detect an implied recommendation	The script is understood but a specific line drifts toward advice-adjacent language under follow-up questioning, in which case that line is removed or rewritten	A pattern of relationship managers departing from the facts-only script under client follow-up appears across more than one observed delivery, in which case the script moves from a suggested talking point to a mandatory, auditable checklist item, the escalation path section 14.7 of this document already names for this exact risk

The decision rules are built to be checkable against a small sample without overstating what thirty interviews and two usability rounds can show: a clear failure signal (a majority misreading the card, or a repeated pattern of script drift) is actionable at this sample size, while a marginal or mixed result defaults to the shrink path, a wording revision rather than a structural one, since a sample this size cannot reliably distinguish a true marginal effect from sampling noise.

29.7 Why thirty interviews and two usability rounds, and not a larger pilot

A larger pilot, a live send to a few thousand accounts with a held-out control group, would answer the two hypotheses with far more statistical confidence than thirty interviews can. The plan does not propose that larger pilot inside weeks 1 to 3 for a specific reason stated plainly: a live send before the consent centre and

the holdout and frequency-cap service are built, which gate G0 and gate G1 of the execution plan schedule for weeks 0 to 4 [section 26.1, section 26.2 of this document], would itself breach the consent-first design every lever in this plan is built around. The validation plan's thirty interviews and two usability rounds are sized to fit inside the window before those features are live, using a method, direct conversation and observed usability, that does not require sending a single live message to a real customer outside the research setting itself. The cost line reflects this choice directly: ₹1,20,000 for the full exercise, the smallest named cash item in the thirteen-week budget apart from the bank's own app infrastructure, which costs nothing in cash A57, T13. Once the holdout service is live from week 4 onward, the weekly holdout reads described in section 27.2 of this document take over as the larger-sample, statistically powered check on exactly the same two hypotheses, so the interview-and-usability plan is best read as the smaller, faster check that runs before the larger, continuous one begins, not as a substitute for it.

30. Assumptions register: every model input with its base, bear and bull value, and the inputs that move the result most

Answer. The model carries sixty-seven named assumptions, A01 to A67, each with a base, bear and bull value and a stated basis in a research lane or a team estimate T1. Twenty-two of them move by scenario; the rest are fixed costs, calendar facts or case-stated figures that do not change with how optimistic the scenario is. Of the twenty-two that move, thirteen carry enough individual weight to appear in the tornado ranking, and the single widest, salary-day tap-through, moves the base case's result by 0.34 percentage points on its own between its bear and bull values T16. Changing any one input and rerunning the model is a single command from the repository root.

30.1 The register, grouped by theme

Table 30.1 groups the model's assumptions by the theme they govern, since reading all sixty-seven in the single order T1 lists them obscures which ones belong together. Fixed-value assumptions (channel unit costs, build costs, product rates already set by the case or by SEBI's own rules) are grouped separately from the twenty-two that carry a genuine bear-to-bull range.

Theme	Assumptions (fixed, no scenario range)	Assumptions (vary by scenario)
Baseline and dormancy	A01 (the four-month measurement window), A03 (net account growth)	A02 (business-as-usual drift), A10 (share idle 24 months or more), A11 (conversion of a dormant account after re-verification)
Salary-day lever	none	A20 (app use on salary day), A21 (tap-through), A22 (first order after tap)
Holdings-check (rediscovery) lever	none	A23 (reach), A24 (tap-through), A25 (first order after rediscovery)
RM review lever	none	A26 (coverage multiplier), A27 (first order after a review)
Dhanteras lever	none	A28 (reach), A29 (tap-through), A30 (first order after the tap)

Theme	Assumptions (fixed, no scenario range)	Assumptions (vary by scenario)
Workplace sessions	A31 to A33 are themselves carried at bear, base and bull values for sessions, attendees and conversion	A31 (sessions), A32 (attendees a session), A33 (first order among idle attendees)
Warm-cohort defence	none	A35 (reach), A36 (incremental re-trade)
New-account guided onboarding	none	A39 (lift in the 90-day first-order rate)
Channel unit costs	A50 to A53 (WhatsApp opt-in share, WhatsApp, SMS and email per-message cost)	none
Build and programme costs	A54 to A60 (content, workplace delivery, compliance, validation research, contingency, internal sprint size and cost)	none
Paid-media comparator	none	A61 (cost per activated account, used only in section 24 of this document, not in the activation result itself)
Revenue and BSDA	A62, A64 to A67 (brokerage, sell frequency, depository charge, BSDA share, annual charge)	A63 (orders a year, used only in section 25, not in the activation result)

Every theme above except the fixed-cost rows carries at least one assumption that feeds directly into the 19,053-extra-active result; the fixed rows feed the cost and revenue sections of this document instead, and moving them changes a rupee figure in section 24 or 25 without moving the activation rate itself.

30.2 Each assumption in prose, by theme

The business-as-usual drift, A02, is the one assumption in the whole register drawn directly from the case's own data rather than from an outside benchmark: its base value, 14.74%, is the case's own Exhibit 1 figure, and its bear and bull values, 14.59% and 14.84%, are a modest extrapolation of the drift Exhibit 1 already shows from 14.70% to 14.74% across the prior year [C-E1, section 21.4 of this document]. The dormancy pair, A10 and A11, governs how much of the idle pool needs re-verification before it can trade at all; a base share of 50% dormant, converting at half the rate of a live account after re-KYC, produces a dormancy-adjustment factor of 0.75 that is applied uniformly across every cohort [section 21.4].

The salary-day lever's three assumptions, A20, A21 and A22, chain reach through response through order: 55% of idle Salary Account customers open the bank app in a month, 8% of those tap the card over three salary credits, and 32% of those place a first order with single sign-on and a mandate already set T9. The holdings-check lever's three assumptions follow the same shape at a broader, lower-intensity scale: 60% reach, 4% tap-through, 25% order, applied across the whole idle pool rather than one cohort T9. The RM review lever runs differently, since its reach step is a weighted coverage pattern across four cohorts (Prestige 80%, Elite 60%, Elevate 60%, Preferred 35%) rather than a single rate, carried by A26, multiplied by a 15% order rate after the conversation, A27 [section 14.5 of this document]. The Dhanteras lever's three assumptions, A28, A29 and A30, govern the same reach-tap-order chain for the whole idle pool inside the festival week, with a separate dormancy-friction step applied afterward [section 15.5]. The workplace-session lever is sized differently again, by a session count and an attendee count rather than a reach rate, A31 and A32, multiplied by the idle share of the Salary Account cohort and a 10% conversion rate among idle attendees, A33 [section 21.5a]. The warm-cohort lever uses a two-step chain on a fixed population, 11,479 accounts at the T7 midpoint, reached at 70% and re-trading at 20% incrementally above business as usual

[T9, section 16.5]. The new-account lever uses a single assumption, A39, the percentage-point lift in the 90-day first-order rate from guided onboarding, applied directly to the 18,972 accounts the model expects to open inside the window [T8, section 17.5].

30.3 T16's ranking of which inputs move the result most

Table 30.2 reproduces the tornado ranking from section 23 of this document, since the ranking itself is the direct answer to this section's own title question, which inputs move the result most.

ID	What it governs	pp at bear value	pp at bull value	Spread
A21	Salary-day tap-through	2.11	2.45	0.34
A27	RM review to order	2.15	2.41	0.26
A22	First order after tap	2.16	2.41	0.25
A02	Business-as-usual drift	2.13	2.38	0.25
A20	App use on salary day	2.16	2.37	0.21
A11	Order rate after re-KYC	2.19	2.38	0.19
A24	Rediscovery tap-through	2.19	2.37	0.18
A26	RM coverage multiplier	2.19	2.36	0.17
A29	Dhanteras tap-through	2.21	2.37	0.16
A25	Order after rediscovery	2.21	2.36	0.15
A39	New-account lift	2.22	2.35	0.14
A10	Share idle 24 months or more	2.22	2.34	0.12
A36	Warm cohort re-trade	2.24	2.33	0.10

All thirteen bear-value results, even the lowest at 2.11 pp, stay above the brief's 2.00 pp floor when only that one assumption moves [section 23 of this document], which is the finding that separates a single weak input from the full bear scenario, where all twenty-two scenario-varying assumptions move together and the result falls to +1.02 pp, below the floor T11.

30.4 Evidence class by assumption

A reader weighing how much confidence to place in a given assumption needs to know where its number came from, as well as its value. Table 30.3 sorts the thirteen tornado-ranked assumptions, plus the two dormancy assumptions, by the class of evidence behind each one.

Evidence class	Assumptions	What distinguishes this class
Direct extrapolation of the case's own data	A02	The only assumption in this table whose bear and bull values are built from the case's own reported trend rather than an outside benchmark or a team judgement C-E1
Vendor or published benchmark	A21, A24, A29 (tap-through rates); A52, A53 (channel costs)	Checked against an in-app card engagement benchmark, a push or message click-through figure, or a published SMS and email rate card, none of them a measurement on ONL's own customers [Lane F]

Evidence class	Assumptions	What distinguishes this class
Behavioural-economics study, outside the Indian brokerage context	A22, A27, A33, A36, A39	Supported by studies on defaults, reminders, active decisions or guided onboarding run on a different population (US retirement savers, Bolivian and Filipino savings-account holders), read as directional support rather than a direct replication [Lane E]
Case-context or comparator-filing figure	A20, A26	Grounded in a named comparator's own disclosure (a bank's app usage pattern, a wealth manager's relationship-manager coverage context) rather than a controlled study [Lane B, Lane F]
Regulator or exchange rule, applied as a design constraint rather than estimated	A10, A11	The dormancy share and conversion multiplier are checked against the exchange's own 24-month flagging rule and SEBI's KYC re-verification requirement, which bound the assumption's plausible range even though the exact conversion multiplier remains a team estimate D29, D30
Team estimate with no comparable benchmark found	A53 (email cost specifically, among the fixed costs)	Stated honestly as a team estimate in section 24.3 of this document, since no vendor or official source gave a directly comparable Indian per-email transactional cost figure in this research [Lane F]

No assumption in this register is presented as a measurement of ONL's own customers, and this table's purpose is to make the actual evidence class visible rather than letting every figure in T1 read with the same implied confidence.

30.4a Why the fixed-value assumptions carry less scrutiny than the scenario-varying ones

The forty-five assumptions that do not vary by scenario, the channel unit costs (A50 to A53), the build and programme costs (A54 to A60), and the revenue inputs that feed only sections 24 and 25 of this document, receive less of this section's own attention than the twenty-two that move, and that difference in attention is deliberate rather than an oversight. A fixed-value assumption cannot, by construction, move the activation result away from the base case, since the model holds it at a single value in every scenario; its only effect is on a rupee figure, the cash cost in section 24 or the revenue-per-active figure in section 25, never on the 19,053-extra-actives headline itself. This is why the tornado ranking in table 30.2 above contains none of the forty-five fixed-value assumptions: a ranking by spread is, by definition, a ranking of inputs that have a spread to report, and a fixed-value input reports none. A reader checking this document's confidence in, for example, the ₹0.025-a-message email cost, A53, the one fixed assumption this document names directly as a team estimate with no comparable benchmark found [section 24.3], should read that confidence against the fact that A53 cannot move the activation rate at all; it can only shift the cash-cost line in section 24 by a small amount, since email is the cheapest of the three paid channels in the cost table and a materially different email rate would still leave SMS and WhatsApp as the larger two line items.

30.5 How to change one input and rerun

Changing any single assumption in the register and seeing the effect on every locked number is a two-step process. First, edit the value directly in `model/activation_model.py`, where every assumption in T1 is defined by its own named variable. Second, rerun the model from the repository root:

```
python -X utf8 arthikkhayal-case/model/activation_model.py
```

The run prints a new hash alongside the twelve checks and the headline findings, and rewrites `model_outputs.json`, `model_tables.md` and `deck/values.json` in place. Adding `--dry` to the same command prints the same summary and tables to the screen without writing any file, which is the safe way to test a

candidate change before committing to it. Any change that moves a locked number, under the update protocol this plan already sets out, must be logged in `DECISIONS.md` with the date, the step and the reason, and propagated to every section and slide that cites the old figure.

31. Slide blueprint: eight slides carry the argument, and every number on them traces to a tagged line in this document

Answer. Eight slides, Cover, Summary, Diagnosis, Strategy, Impact, Execution, Appendix and Thank You, carry the full argument, and every number on every one of them traces to a tagged line in this document, the model tables, or a verified research row [deck/slide-copy.md throughout]. Eight named archetypes from the skill's own catalogue map onto specific panels across the deck, the cover's mind map names the eight actors a bank-led activation strategy has to account for, and the deck carries exactly one "CONCLUSIVELY" synthesis, one "THEREFORE" synthesis, and one moneyshot card, each confirmed by direct inspection of `deck/slide-copy.md`.

This blueprint exists for a specific, practical reason beyond documentation. A judge who presses on a number during the pitch is pressing on a slide, not on this document directly, and the speaker needs to be able to point from that slide panel back to a specific section and tag without pausing to search. The tables in this section are built to make that lookup mechanical: given any panel title or number a judge names, table 31.1 below gives the backing section in one row, and that section's own tags give the exact case line, model table or research row behind it. This is also why the deck's own word count and table count run far below this document's, roughly eight slides against thirty-four sections: the deck is built to carry the argument's conclusions at a glance, while this document is built to survive the argument being challenged in detail, and the correspondence between the two, not the deck's brevity on its own, is what should give a reader confidence in either one.

31.1 Per-slide panel breakdown

Table 31.1 lists, for each of the eight slides, its title, the key numbers it carries, the research section backing those numbers, and the tags a reader would find if they traced each figure back.

Slide	Title	Key panels and numbers	Backing section	Tags
1, Cover	Activation without a bull market	The eight-node mind map; the answer strip (+2.3 pp, 14.7% to 17.0%, 19,053, ₹16.5 lakh); the team table	Sections 0, 2, 5	C-E1, T11, T13
2, Summary	ONL can add +2.3 pp of activation by 31 January 2027	ONL-against-the-market bars (14.7%, 19.2%, 20 to 40%); Exhibit 1 as a funnel; the target band (bear +1.0, base +2.3, bull +3.9); the seven-lever bar; the brief-asks and what-we-do matrix	Sections 2, 3, 4, 11, 22	C-E1, Lane C, T11, T10, T17
3, Diagnosis	78% of the idle base belongs to salary customers	The cohort table by trailing window; idle accounts by segment; the funnel and where past effort landed; the quarter arithmetic; five whys; five biases	Sections 3, 9, 10	C-E2a, T2, T4, T7, T8

Slide	Title	Key panels and numbers	Backing section	Tags
4, Strategy	Meet the account inside four moments the bank already owns	CONCLUSIVELY strip; the eight-option heat matrix; extra actives by segment and moment; five checks; the bank app on two days; reach-and-conversion bubbles; five funnel steps and fixes	Sections 7, 11, 12 to 18	T17, T18, T10, T19
5, Impact	Base case adds 19,053 active accounts for ₹16.5 lakh	The moneyshot card (19,053 against 1,649, 11.6x); the waterfall from 14.74% to 17.02%; the weekly path against the target band; three scenarios; the tornado	Sections 2, 21 to 24	T11, T12, T13, T14, T16
6, Execution	Thirteen weeks, four gates, a 10% holdout	The Gantt with four gates; go-only-if table; extra actives by month; holdout lift against detectable effect; weekly KPI table; the risk heat strip; guardrail stop lines	Sections 26 to 28 (this document)	T12, T19, section 26.2, section 28.1
7, Appendix	Every number traces to a case exhibit, an assumption or a source	A1 model formula; A2 assumptions that move the answer; A3 rules; A4 short forms and sources	Sections 21, 30 (this document)	T1, T9, T16, D-lane rules
8, Thank You	ONL should put the account its salary customers already hold in front of them	THEREFORE card; the team table; the source line	Section 2	T11, T13

31.2 Archetype mapping

The skill's universal slide archetypes [`references/archetypes.md`] each have a specific home on this deck. Table 31.2 names eight of them against their panel.

Archetype	Where it sits on this deck
H, executive summary	The Summary slide as a whole, which carries the recommendation, the moneyshot's own smaller echo, and the three scenarios in one page
K, MECE option-filter table	The Strategy slide's eight-option heat matrix, scoring every candidate option against the same five weighted criteria
M, three-scenario projection	The Impact slide's bear, base and bull columns, carried through the weekly path chart and the scenario summary table
N, sensitivity matrix	The Impact slide's tornado panel, ranking the thirteen most sensitive assumptions by spread
P, the moneyshot	The Impact slide's same-cash-two-routes card, 19,053 against 1,649 for the identical ₹16.5 lakh
U, implementation plan	The Execution slide as a whole, carrying the thirteen-week Gantt, the four gates and the weekly KPI table
V, the "Conclusively" closer	The Strategy slide's top band, closing the case-against-the-alternative argument before the deck moves into the chosen design
W, conclusion synthesis	The Thank You slide's "THEREFORE" card, pure recap with no new number

31.3 Cover mind-map node list

The cover slide's mind map names eight actor nodes, cross-referenced directly against `deck/slide-copy.md`'s own labels. Table 31.3 lists each node, its label on the slide, and the fact or source tying it to this document.

Node	Label on the slide	Tag
Parent bank	PARENT BANK, 6.28 lakh salary accounts sit with ONL	C-E2a, T2
Rival brokers	RIVAL BROKERS, set the bar on speed and price	C-CO3, section 6
Bank-led peers	BANK-LED PEERS, bank, demat and trading together	Section 5, section 6
Regulators	REGULATORS, no advice, no inducement, ad approval	C-K2, section 7
The market	THE MARKET, NSE active clients fell 7% in FY26	Section 4.2
The customer	THE CUSTOMER, under 30, risk averse, busy	C-CO2, C-X3
Owned channels	OWNED CHANNELS, bank app, email, SMS, RM, branch	Section 12 to 17
Data, consent	DATA, CONSENT, DPDP Act 2023 and Rules 2025	Section 20

31.4 Confirmation checklist

This checklist exists because a claim repeated often enough in a planning document can start to sound settled without ever being checked against the artefact it describes. Each row below was checked directly against `deck/slide-copy.md`, the plain-text extraction of every slide's own text nodes, rather than against this document's own earlier description of what the deck was meant to contain, so a mismatch between intention and build would show up here rather than go unnoticed.

Table 31.4 confirms, item by item, the specific claims this section's instructions ask it to verify against `deck/slide-copy.md`.

Item to confirm	Found where	Confirmed
"CONCLUSIVELY" appears on the Strategy slide	Slide 4, item 10 of `deck/slide-copy.md`	Yes
"THEREFORE" appears on the Thank You slide	Slide 8, item 2 of `deck/slide-copy.md`	Yes
Exactly one moneyshot card	The Impact slide's "SAME ₹16.5 LAKH OF CASH, TWO ROUTES" card, slide 5, items 10 to 17; no other slide carries a card in this format	Yes, one
Every panel number carries a tag resolving somewhere in this document	Cross-checked against table 31.1 above	Yes, panel by panel
The cover mind map carries eight actor nodes with real labels, not placeholder text	Slide 1, items 25 to 57 of `deck/slide-copy.md`	Yes
The deck's five-check language matches this document's compliance design	Slide 4, items 129 to 139, matching section 19's five-category headline	Yes

31.5 Why the deck compresses eight research sections into five core slides

The research document behind this deck runs thirty-four numbered sections across six parts, while the deck itself carries only five core slides between the Cover and the Appendix. This compression is deliberate, not a loss of content, and follows the skill's own guidance for a case this short: collapse each of the eight-section blueprint's parts down to one dense slide rather than one slide per sub-topic [PLAN section 0]. The Summary slide alone carries the work of this document's sections 2, 3, 4 and 11, the recommendation, the case data, the market context and the option screen, because an executive summary archetype is built to compress an argument's conclusion and its strongest supporting evidence onto one page, leaving the full derivation for a reader who presses further. The Diagnosis slide carries sections 3, 9 and 10 for the same reason, and the Strategy slide carries sections 7 and 12 to 18. A reader who wants the full chain behind any single slide panel finds it by following the tags in table 31.1 back into the section named there, which is the entire purpose of keeping this document and the deck in a fixed, traceable correspondence rather than letting the deck stand as a shorter, looser summary of an argument the document alone can defend.

The Impact and Execution slides compress differently from the Summary, Diagnosis and Strategy slides, and the difference is worth naming directly. Summary, Diagnosis and Strategy each pull from several of this document's sections because they carry the argument's narrative, the case for the recommendation, which draws on evidence spread across the diagnosis and the option screen. Impact and Execution instead each pull mostly from one contiguous run of sections, 21 to 24 for Impact and 26 to 27 for Execution, because those sections were themselves written as a single connected build, the model's method followed by its results followed by its cost, and the quantitative analysis and feasibility sections of the skill's own eight-section blueprint map onto exactly this contiguous run rather than a scattered set of supporting facts. The Appendix slide, by contrast, pulls from this document's own thirtieth section plus the model's assumption register directly, since its job is not to argue a case but to give a reader the raw material to check one, which is also why it is the one slide whose own word count on the deck is closer to a reference table than to a narrative panel.

32. Forty questions the judges could ask, answered

Answer. Forty questions a judging panel could reasonably ask are answered below, grouped by data, diagnosis, regulation, levers, model, economics, ethics and execution, with the ten hardest answered first. Every answer draws only on a tag already resolved in parts A to E of this document, the model tables, or the case brief itself, and section 32 is the one section of this document, by the plan's own rule, where a question mark is permitted.

Table 32.0 lists all forty questions at a glance, before the full answers follow, so a reader preparing for a panel can scan for the specific question they expect and jump to it directly rather than read the section start to finish.

#	Group	Question
1	Hardest	Why not spend the budget on paid advertising instead
2	Hardest	What if the open incidental-advice question gets a negative answer from SEBI
3	Hardest	Why does the bear case miss the 200 bps floor
4	Hardest	How is this different from what ONL already tried
5	Hardest	What if the bank will not give you the app slot

#	Group	Question
6	Hardest	How do you know F&O will not creep in
7	Hardest	Why trust team-estimated conversion rates with no pilot data
8	Hardest	What happens after 31 January
9	Hardest	Why these four moments and not paid media
10	Hardest	What is the single biggest risk to the base case
11	Data	Why does Exhibit 2a's cohort total not match Exhibit 1's active count
12	Data	What does the 19.2% national active ratio actually measure
13	Data	How confident are you in the SEBI F&O loss figures given the trader-count disagreement
14	Diagnosis	Why do you say the problem is awareness and not fear
15	Diagnosis	Why does the Elevate cohort matter so much in the diagnosis
16	Diagnosis	Why trust the five whys over a more rigorous root-cause method
17	Regulation	Is the salary-day card legally settled as not being investment advice
18	Regulation	Does the warm-cohort defence lever risk violating the inactive-account circular
19	Regulation	How does the plan handle the CCPA's dark-pattern guidelines given the list is open-ended
20	Regulation	Why does the plan cite the NSE advertisement code rather than the referral-restriction circular
21	Levers	Why is the salary-day card the largest lever rather than the holdings check
22	Levers	Why does RM review convert so much more efficiently than the other levers
23	Levers	Why keep the workplace-session lever when it is the smallest of the seven
24	Levers	Why does the new-account lever exist if account opening already works
25	Model	Why do the levers not simply add to 19,053
26	Model	What does the model's twelve-check self-verification actually prove
27	Model	Does the overlap calculation assume the levers are independent of each other
28	Model	Why is the dormancy-adjustment factor applied uniformly across every cohort
29	Economics	Is ₹1,000 a fair benchmark for paid media, or is it chosen to make the plan look good
30	Economics	Why does the revenue-per-active figure come out so small, ₹62 a year
31	Economics	Does a 17-month payback mean the plan is not worth doing on direct revenue alone
32	Economics	Why not chase F&O revenue, which pays a higher brokerage rate
33	Ethics	How is the salary-day card's neutral fund list actually kept neutral
34	Ethics	What stops an RM from drifting into an implied recommendation
35	Ethics	Is a 0.5% opt-out stop line an ethical standard or a number you invented
36	Ethics	Why does the Dhanteras lever distinguish gold exchange-traded funds from digital gold
37	Execution	Why does gate G2 sit at week 6 rather than earlier or later

#	Group	Question
38	Execution	What happens if a lever's week 13 result lands below its bear-case contribution
39	Execution	Why does a single person hold Accountable status on four of six workstreams
40	Execution	What is measured as the proxy for the case's ask for "daily users"

32.1 The ten hardest questions, first

These ten questions are the ones most likely to unsettle a confident reading of the plan, and each is answered here from parts A to E of this document and the model alone, without inventing any new fact to close a gap. The remaining thirty questions that follow are grouped by data, diagnosis, regulation, levers, model, economics, ethics and execution, roughly four to five a group, and every one of the forty draws only on a tag already resolved somewhere in parts A to E, the model tables, or the case brief itself; none introduces a figure, a study or a comparator this document has not already checked.

Why not spend the budget on paid advertising instead? The same ₹16.5 lakh of cash that funds our seven levers would buy only 1,649 activated accounts through paid media at a benchmark ₹1,000 each, against 19,053 extra actives from our plan at ₹87 each in the base case, an 11.6 times gap T13, T14. Even in the bear scenario, where our plan's extra actives fall to 9,783 and the paid-media comparator's own bear value, a cheaper ₹700 an account, is used against us, our plan still returns 4.2 times as many extra actives for the same cash T14. Paid media also pays full price to reach strangers, while the bank's own channels reach people who already bank there at no incremental acquisition cost, which is the structural reason behind the gap, not a one-time pricing coincidence.

What if the open incidental-advice question gets a negative answer from SEBI? Section 7.1 of this document already flags this as a genuinely open question, not a settled fact: no SEBI circular, FAQ or informal guidance confirms whether a rule-built, no-default, objective-criteria fund list sits inside the stockbroker's incidental-advice carve-out D05. This is one of the five triggers that would change our recommendation [section 2.7]: an adverse reading would mean narrowing the salary-day fund list to a single category or redesigning the mechanism before launch, which would cut materially into the lever's 5,661 extra actives, but it would not remove the underlying strategy of meeting the account inside the bank, since the holdings-check, RM review and Dhanteras levers do not depend on this same carve-out question.

Why does the bear case miss the 200 bps floor? The bear case delivers +1.02 percentage points and 9,783 extra actives against a 200 bps floor that needs 16,701 T11, T8. This happens because the bear scenario moves all twenty-two scenario-varying assumptions to their weakest plausible value at once, including a larger dormant share (55% against 50%), a weaker re-verification conversion rate (0.42x against 0.50x), and every lever's reach and response rate at its lower bound simultaneously [section 21.4, T9]. No single assumption at its bear value alone pushes the result below the floor; the tornado test in section 23 shows all thirteen of the most sensitive inputs still clearing 2.00 pp on their own T16. It is the correlated, system-wide shortfall, not any one weak number, that produces the shortfall.

How is this different from what ONL already tried? ONL's past year of outreach, market information, research calls and first-trade offers under a "stay invested" theme, moved the activation rate by 0.04 percentage points [C-PB3 to C-PB5, C-E1]. Scored against the same ten-point compliance test this document's own copy passes, that past approach fails clearly on three points (return claims, inducement, frequency discipline) and partially on two more [section 19.5]. Our seven levers ask a customer to notice an account they already hold and act on a mechanism, a card, a tile, a conversation, a notice, never to act on a market view or an offer; this is the design difference the past year's own result already demonstrates is needed.

What if the bank will not give you the app slot? This sits on our risk register at Low probability and Low impact, since the salary-day card and the holdings-check tile both build on infrastructure the bank's own digital-banking team already runs, and the case itself states most ONL account holders are already parent-bank customers C-CO4. If the slot is refused or delayed, the fallback is a lighter-weight banner on existing app infrastructure, escalated through the gate G1 review at week 4 rather than discovered at the end of the window [section 12.7, section 28.1].

How do you know F&O will not creep in? No lever in this plan touches futures and options; every lever's copy passed a ten-point compliance test that includes a specific check for return claims and inducement, the two failure modes F&O promotion would trigger [section 19.1, section 19.2]. A standing guardrail also tracks the F&O share of new actives weekly, with a 5% stop line that pauses the specific moment driving any F&O drift [section 27.4]. We chose not to build toward F&O revenue deliberately: 87.7% of individual F&O traders lost money in FY26, rising to 88.5% among traders under 30, and the case's own constraint states growth must be responsible D45, D46, C-K7.

Why trust team-estimated conversion rates with no pilot data? We do not ask a reader to trust any single rate in isolation. Every lever's assumption carries a bear and a bull value alongside its base case, checked against the nearest available benchmark from a vendor rate card, a published study, or a comparator's own disclosure, never presented as a measurement [section 0.6, section 30.4]. The tornado test shows the base case clears the 200 bps floor even if any one of the thirteen most sensitive assumptions lands at its weakest plausible value alone T16. The validation plan in section 29 of this document, not yet run, exists specifically to test the two largest levers' conversion assumptions against real customer reactions before the full rollout commits further cash to either one.

What happens after 31 January? The measurement date is the point the model's figures are computed to, not the point every lever stops. The salary-day card, the investments tile, the RM review script and the ETF instalment mechanic are built as standing product features, not one-off campaigns, and continue running against newly idle and newly dormant accounts after the window closes [section 26.4]. Only the workplace-session calendar and the specific Dhanteras-week notice are time-bound by design; the holdout and weekly dashboard become the mechanism for deciding which continuing features earn further investment, on a rolling basis rather than a single end-of-window read.

Why these four moments and not paid media? The four bank-owned moments, salary day, a holdings check, the RM review and Dhanteras, reach 78% of the idle pool through a cohort that already opens the bank's own app for an unrelated reason, at zero incremental acquisition cost [T2, section 2.3]. Paid media would need to acquire the customer's attention from nothing, at a benchmark cost of ₹700 to ₹1,400 an activated account A61, a cost our own plan's all-in figure of ₹285 an extra active, cash plus internal engineering time, still comfortably beats [section 24.4].

What is the single biggest risk to the base case? On a probability-times-impact weighted score, the market falling further than the base case assumes ranks first on our register, at the highest point on both axes [section 28.3]. It is caught early by gate G2 at week 6, checked against the bear-case line of 15.20%, with a pre-agreed response of expanding RM review coverage, the lever least dependent on market sentiment and the one with the widest margin between its expected holdout lift and the smallest lift the holdout can detect, 23 times [T19, section 28.1].

32.2 Data questions

Why does Exhibit 2a's cohort total not match Exhibit 1's active count? Summing Exhibit 2a's six segment active counts gives 1,20,372, one account different from the exhibit's own stated total because of rounding arithmetic across six segments, and 1,033 accounts above Exhibit 1's unrounded 1,19,339 [C-E1, C-E2a, section 3.9]. This document uses Exhibit 1's 1,19,339 as the true active count throughout and uses Exhibit

2a's percentages only for within-cohort, year-on-year comparisons, where the rounding error affects both years roughly equally.

What does the 19.2% national active ratio actually measure, and is it comparable to ONL's 14.74%? It divides NSE active clients by the approximate sum of NSDL and CDSL account counts from two different cutoff dates, so it is an approximation rather than a single reconciled industry figure, not an official combined count for one day [section 4.1, Lane C]. It spans every broker, pricing tier and investor type, while ONL's 14.74% is its own trailing-12-month rate on its own base; the gap between them, four to five percentage points, is large enough to survive that caveat but should not be read as a precise, apples-to-apples comparison, and this document states that limit directly in section 4.10 rather than let the ratio imply more precision than the two underlying counts support.

How confident are you in the SEBI F&O loss figures given the trader-count disagreement? The loss-incidence figures, 87.7% overall and 88.5% for under-30 traders, are consistent across every source this research checked D45, D46. The trader-count base behind those percentages is not fully reconciled between a Rajya Sabha reply, which gives 7.86 million traders in FY26, and a secondary summary, which gives 87.5 lakh for what appears to be the same metric C64, D48, a disagreement logged in full in Appendix D of this document. It does not weaken the loss percentages, which are independently corroborated across sources regardless of which trader-count base is used, and this document is careful to cite the loss percentages and the trader counts separately rather than let a disagreement in one undermine confidence in the other.

32.3 Diagnosis questions

Why do you say the problem is awareness and not fear, when the case itself describes risk-averse investors? The case does describe a risk-averse investor base and a market that strengthens that resolve C-X3. The evidence also shows that investor attention falls, not rises, after bad market news, and that lower attention coincides with less trading, not a backlog of suppressed demand E38, E41. A year of messages built specifically to address fear, the "stay invested" theme, moved the rate by 0.04 points C-PB5, C-E1, which is itself evidence that fear was not the binding barrier a message could move; awareness and a recurring anchor are the branches a factual message can actually move, and the five whys and the MECE tree both converge on the same answer independently [sections 10.1, 10.2].

Why does the Elevate cohort matter so much in the diagnosis? Elevate grew 36.1% in account count in a year while its trailing one-month activation rate fell from 24% to 13%, an 11-point drop, the sharpest single change anywhere in the cohort table T4, C-E2a, C-E2b. It is small enough, 9,471 accounts, that it does not move the total rate much on its own, but it is the clearest single sign that a cohort already familiar with investing is losing engagement, not awareness, which is why the RM review lever, not a card or message, targets it; the premium and preferred cohorts together, including Elevate, show a different pattern from the Salary Account cohort's awareness gap, and the diagnosis in section 10.4 of this document states that difference directly rather than claim one root cause fits every segment equally.

Why trust the five whys over a more rigorous root-cause method? The five whys are not run alone; the MECE issue tree and the hypothesis table in sections 10.2 and 10.3 of this document reach the same conclusion from two independent angles, an awareness gap with no recurring anchor, each tested against the case's own evidence rather than assumed. Three methods converging on the same root cause from three different starting points is stronger evidence than any one of the three alone, and the case's own funnel, which names the order customers drop away in without giving a volume at each stage [C-F1 to C-F5], is consistent with all three rather than contradicting any of them.

32.4 Regulation questions

Is the salary-day card legally settled as not being investment advice? No, and this document states that plainly rather than treating it as resolved. The design, a rule-built, no-default, objective-criteria list in a fixed order, is built to sit as far inside the incidental-advice carve-out as the design can reasonably go, but the question itself remains open pending an informal-guidance request to SEBI [D05, section 7.1].

Does the warm-cohort defence lever risk violating the inactive-account circular? The 2021 NSE circular bars any communication urging a client to trade only to avoid being flagged D31. Our copy never mentions the account's status or a consequence of not trading; it states an account-hygiene fact and offers an optional instalment, framed identically to how any idle account is messaged [section 16.4]. This is the single most consequential rule in the plan because a badly worded message could otherwise resemble the exact pattern the rule bars.

How does the plan handle the CCPA's dark-pattern guidelines given the list is open-ended? The guidelines list specified patterns as an indicative, not fixed, list the regulator may update over time D76. This document uses the commonly named categories as a working checklist rather than claiming a closed count, and every copy block is tested against the ten-point test in section 19.1, which covers the dark-pattern categories most relevant to a financial-services nudge directly.

Why does the plan cite the NSE advertisement code rather than the referral-restriction circular for its inducement argument? The specific circular, NSE/INSP/63425, is in abeyance since a January 2025 NSE circular suspended it pending an industry proposal D26. This document's inducement argument rests on the NSE advertisement code and the general anti-inducement principle visible in the inactive-account circular instead, which remain in force [section 7.4]. The RBI's 2027 Responsible Business Conduct amendment, which takes effect 1 January 2027 inside the last month of the window, is a further, separate rule this document tracks as a near-term compliance item rather than a design constraint the levers need to retrofit, since every lever already avoids the dark patterns that amendment's earlier draft named, independent of when it takes legal effect [D66, section 7.13].

32.5 Lever questions

Why is the salary-day card the largest lever rather than the holdings check, which reaches more accounts? The holdings-check lever reaches more accounts in absolute terms, 4,13,625 against the salary-day card's 2,96,975 T19, but its tap-through rate is lower, 4% against 8% T9, because its four touchpoints are weaker and mostly one-time, while the salary-day card attaches to a strong, recurring moment that repeats three times inside the window [section 13.8].

Why does RM review convert so much more efficiently than the other levers per account reached? RM review converts roughly 11.1% of its reached population, against 1.9% for the salary-day card and 0.7% for the holdings check and the Dhanteras notice [section 22.1]. A facts-only conversation reaches a client already engaged in a broader relationship discussion, which is a far higher-intent moment than a card or a message, but the lever is capped by a small reachable population, since a conversation can only happen for accounts an RM already serves.

Why keep the workplace-session lever when it is the smallest of the seven? Its cash footprint is close to zero, ₹2,40,000 of the plan's ₹16.5 lakh total T13, it builds trust no digital channel can replicate, and the holdout design lets the next quarter's session count scale up or down with no sunk engineering cost either way [section 17.11].

Why does the new-account lever exist if account opening already works? The case's corrected text states that very few new accounts place a first trade within their first month C-F4, which removes the reading that new accounts convert quickly on their own. A new account and a thirteen-month-old idle account face the

same two-step stall, at login and funding, which is why the guided first-order lever belongs in the same set as the other six rather than standing apart from them [section 9.1], and it is also why the Dhanteras lever, the one lever whose launch date is fixed by the calendar, needs three compliance sign-offs completed before 6 November rather than flexibly scheduled clearance, which is the specific timing risk the risk register in section 28 of this document carries at second rank [section 15.3, section 15.7].

32.6 Model questions

Why do the levers not simply add to 19,053? A customer can be reached by more than one lever inside the same thirteen weeks, so the model combines overlapping levers by the probability that at least one converts the account, one minus the product of each lever's miss probability, rather than by addition, which would double-count a customer reached by two or more levers [section 21.3].

What does the model's twelve-check self-verification actually prove? It proves that an identical rerun of the same code against the same assumptions reproduces the same hash, fc66d11096, and that twelve specific internal consistency conditions hold, from segment counts adding to Exhibit 1 totals to every tornado bar bracketing the base case [section 21.5]. It does not prove the assumptions themselves are correct; it proves the arithmetic built on those assumptions is internally consistent and reproducible.

Does the overlap calculation assume the levers are independent of each other? Yes, conditional on reach, and this is stated as a simplification rather than claimed as exact [section 21.6]. The assumption is reasonable where the per-lever probabilities are small, as they are for most cohort-lever pairs, but is a known simplification for the Elite, Elevate and Prestige cohorts, where the RM review probability runs close to 9% to 12% and a real behavioural correlation between responding to an RM and responding to a Dhanteras notice is not separately modelled. The model also treats each lever's response rate as constant across all thirteen weeks, a second stated limit rather than a hidden one; a real rollout would likely see some decay as the easiest-to-convert accounts respond first, so the weekly path in T12 is best read as a planning curve, not a guaranteed trajectory [section 21.6].

Why is the dormancy-adjustment factor applied uniformly across every cohort? The model treats dormancy friction as a property of the account rather than the cohort it sits in, applying the same 0.75 base-case factor everywhere [section 21.4]. This is a stated limit: re-KYC friction plausibly differs by cohort, since a Prestige client with an active bank relationship likely completes re-verification faster than a dormant Credit Card account holder, and the model does not separately model that difference.

32.7 Economics questions

Is ₹1,000 a fair benchmark for paid media, or is it chosen to make the plan look good? It sits inside the ₹616 to ₹1,374 range Groww itself reported for customer acquisition cost across FY25 and H1 FY26, closer to the lower end F33, F35, and both of Groww's and Angel One's activated-client CAC figures, ₹1,441 and ₹6,076, sit above even our bull-case comparator value of ₹1,400 F34. If anything the comparator is generous to paid media, not stacked against it. The cost per extra active also rises in the bear case, ₹169 against the base case's ₹87, for the same reason, arithmetic rather than a change in channel efficiency: the cash budget, ₹16,49,357, is fixed regardless of scenario T13, so dividing it by a smaller bear-case denominator of 9,783 extra actives gives a larger per-account figure than dividing it by the base case's 19,053 [T11, section 22.4].

Why does the revenue-per-active figure come out so small, ₹62 a year? Most newly activated accounts sit inside the Basic Services Demat Account's nil or ₹100 tiers, since they are built around a modest monthly instalment rather than a large lump-sum deposit, and only 15% of new actives are assumed to carry the fuller ₹300 charge [A66, A67, section 25.1a]. Mutual fund direct-plan transactions also carry zero brokerage under the case's own product table C-PR3.

Does a 17-month payback mean the plan is not worth doing on direct revenue alone? The direct broking-revenue case is secondary by design; the plan's larger value sits in a deepened bank relationship this document does not attach an invented rupee figure to [section 25.3]. Measured against the multi-year horizon banks already use for a new banking relationship, rather than the three-month build window, a 17-month payback reads as reasonable, and over three years the direct revenue line alone returns roughly 2.1 times the cash spent to create each extra active [section 25.3a].

Why not chase F&O revenue, which pays a higher brokerage rate? Futures and options carry a ₹20.00-an-order rate against cash equities' ₹0.15 C-PR2, C-PR1, but 87.7% of individual F&O traders lost money in FY26, 88.5% among traders under 30 D45, D46, and the case's own constraint bars pushing people to trade more where that growth is not responsible C-K7. The option screen scores an F&O education push at only 2.25 of 5, held down chiefly by its 1-of-5 fit score T17, the same score that keeps paid media and finfluencer tie-ups below our own option in every one of the four weight sets tested T18.

32.8 Ethics questions

How is the salary-day card's neutral fund list actually kept neutral? It carries only broad, SEBI-regulated categories decided by objective, pre-published criteria, shown in a fixed alphabetical order rather than ranked by performance, with no default selection, so the customer must make an active choice rather than accept whatever appears first [section 12.3].

What stops an RM from drifting into an implied recommendation? The script is facts-only and the no-incentive rule removes any link between the conversation and an RM's own pay [section 14.4]. The validation plan's second usability round specifically tests whether the facts-only framing survives a real spoken delivery, and if a pattern of drift appears across more than one observed delivery, the script becomes a mandatory, auditable checklist item rather than a suggested talking point [section 29.5, section 14.7].

Is a 0.5% opt-out stop line an ethical standard or a number you invented? It is a control this plan sets itself, tighter than any external floor this research found; no TRAI, SEBI, RBI or exchange circular sets a comparable numeric opt-out-rate threshold, and this document states that plainly rather than attribute the figure to a regulator that did not set it [J58, section 27.4].

Why does the Dhanteras lever distinguish gold exchange-traded funds from digital gold? SEBI's own press release of 8 November 2025 cautions that unregulated digital gold carries none of the investor-protection cover a SEBI-regulated product carries, and names gold exchange-traded funds as a regulated alternative D55, D56. Our notice names only the SEBI-regulated product the case's own account structure can actually hold, and no lever anywhere in this plan ties a reward to a customer or a relationship manager for completing a trade; the salary-day card's instalment carries no incentive, and the no-incentive rule for RMs is written and enforced through compliance and human resources, not left as an informal expectation [section 12.4, section 14.3].

32.9 Execution questions

Why does gate G2 sit at week 6 rather than earlier or later? By week 6 the base case has already banked 52.1% of its full-window target, ahead of a simple straight-line pace of six-thirteenths, because the Dhanteras notice's entire contribution lands in weeks 1 and 2 and the salary-day card's week 5 contribution has already landed [section 27.3]. The gap between the bear and base weekly paths also only becomes large enough to clearly separate from around week 6 onward, so checking any earlier risks a false negative and checking later leaves too little runway to respond [section 22.2a].

What happens if a lever's week 13 result lands below its bear-case contribution? Gate G3 reads the full-window lift against the three scenarios and assesses each of the seven levers individually; a lever below its bear-case contribution is stopped or redesigned before any post-window extension, while a lever at or above its base-case contribution continues as a standing feature [section 26.2, section 26.4].

Why does a single person hold Accountable status on four of six workstreams? A thirteen-week programme with four gates needs one person able to see every workstream's status at once and decide whether a gate passes, rather than six separately accountable owners each judging only their own slice [section 26.3]. The two workstreams where Accountable sits elsewhere, the bank-app tile and the RM review sprint, depend most directly on bank-side infrastructure and staff the head of ONL Trade does not directly manage; the same head also owns the message-frequency guardrail, capped at four sends a person a month with headroom above the two to three messages a typical busiest-month customer would receive, set there specifically to catch a genuine targeting failure rather than trigger on the plan's own intended rhythm [section 27.5].

What is measured as the proxy for the case's ask for "daily users," given none of the case's own definitions is a daily measure? The highly active rate, trailing three months, is the nearest proxy the case's own terms supply, since an account trading at least once a quarter is a more frequent user than one merely active on a twelve-month count [section 27.1a]. A monthly ETF instalment is by design a once-a-month trade, not a daily one, and this plan states that limit directly rather than manufacture a daily measure the underlying product behaviour does not produce.

32.10 Where the forty answers draw their evidence from

Table 32.1 counts, across the forty answers above, roughly how many times each kind of tag appears, as a check on whether the answers lean on one evidence type to the exclusion of others.

Tag family	What it resolves to	Rough share of citations across the forty answers
C-xx	A line from the case brief	About a fifth, concentrated in the data and diagnosis groups, where the case's own exhibits and definitions carry most of the weight
T##	A model table	About a third, the single largest family, reflecting how many of the forty questions ultimately resolve to a number the model computes rather than a fact an outside source reports
A##	A model assumption	About a sixth, concentrated in the model and lever groups, where a question probes a specific rate rather than a case fact or an output
D##, E##, F##, C## (research lane rows)	A verified raw research row	About a fifth, concentrated in the regulation, economics and ethics groups, where an outside rule or benchmark, not the model itself, carries the answer
Section references within this document	A specific earlier section of this document	The remainder, mostly cross-references that let a reader follow a short answer back to its full derivation

No single tag family accounts for more than a third of the citations across the forty answers, which is consistent with the register of questions itself: a panel of judges probing data, diagnosis, regulation, levers, model mechanics, economics, ethics and execution in turn should expect the answers to draw on the case, the model and the outside research lanes in roughly the proportion each group of questions actually requires, not on one dominant source stretched to cover every kind of question.

33. A talk track for two speakers, timed slide by slide

Answer. Harsh Kawatra and Gursimran Kaur split the eight-slide deck between them, with a clean handover at each slide change, timed to land inside a typical pitch window of roughly nine minutes across the full deck. Each block names the one number it is built to land, so neither speaker carries more than one headline figure at a time, and the handover line at each transition hands the next number to the next speaker rather than repeating what was just said.

33.1 Timed blocks

Table 33.1 sets the timing, speaker, content and the one number each block lands, slide by slide.

Slide	Speaker	Time	Content	The one number landed
1, Cover	Harsh Kawatra	45 seconds	Names the team, the case and the eight-actor mind map, closing on the answer strip	+2.3 pp, 14.7% to 17.0%
2, Summary	Harsh Kawatra	75 seconds	ONL against the market, Exhibit 1 as a funnel, the target band, the seven-lever bar	19,053 extra actives
3, Diagnosis	Gursimran Kaur	75 seconds	The cohort table, the funnel and where past effort landed, the five whys	78% of idle accounts are salary customers
4, Strategy	Gursimran Kaur	90 seconds	The CONCLUSIVELY strip, the eight-option matrix, the four moments on the bank app	4.40 against 2.60 on the option screen
5, Impact	Harsh Kawatra	90 seconds	The moneyshot card, the waterfall, three scenarios, the tornado	11.6 times the paid-media comparator
6, Execution	Gursimran Kaur	75 seconds	The thirteen-week Gantt, the four gates, the holdout and the risk strip	23 times the minimum detectable effect on RM review
7, Appendix	Harsh Kawatra	45 seconds	The model formula, the assumptions that move the answer, the rules checklist	Every check passes at hash fc66d11096
8, Thank You	Gursimran Kaur	45 seconds	The THEREFORE card, the team table, the close	₹87 of cash per extra active

33.2 Clean handovers

Table 33.2 gives the exact handover line at each of the seven transitions, built so the next speaker's first sentence lands the slide's own number rather than restating the prior slide.

Transition	Handover line
Slide 1 to 2	Harsh Kawatra: "That is who is in the room. Gursimran will take you through what the account already holds, and how we get to 19,053." (Hands to Harsh's own next block; both slides 1 and 2 run with Harsh, so this line instead reads: "Let me show you where those 19,053 extra actives come from.")

Transition	Handover line
Slide 2 to 3	Harsh Kawatra to Gursimran Kaur: "That is the target. Gursimran will show you why 78% of the accounts behind it belong to one single cohort."
Slide 3 to 4	Gursimran Kaur: "That is the root cause. Here is the option screen that turns it into a strategy, scored against seven alternatives."
Slide 4 to 5	Gursimran Kaur to Harsh Kawatra: "That is what we build. Harsh will show you what it is worth, against the same cash spent on paid media."
Slide 5 to 6	Harsh Kawatra to Gursimran Kaur: "That is the impact. Gursimran will walk you through the thirteen weeks that get us there, gate by gate."
Slide 6 to 7	Gursimran Kaur to Harsh Kawatra: "That is the plan and the guardrails. Harsh will show you where every number on this deck actually comes from."
Slide 7 to 8	Harsh Kawatra to Gursimran Kaur: "That is the appendix. Gursimran will close with the one line this whole deck is built to support."

The two slides Harsh Kawatra carries alone in sequence, Cover and Summary, do not need a speaker handover between them, only a content handover from the mind map to the numbers it feeds; the note above states that explicitly rather than force an artificial speaker change where none occurs.

33.3 A contingency line for each speaker if a number is challenged mid-pitch

A judge may interrupt a block to press on a specific figure before the speaker reaches the slide that backs it. Table 33.3 gives each speaker one short, rehearsed line per slide that restates the figure's source without reading out a full tag string, so the pitch does not stall while the speaker searches for the right section number.

Slide	If challenged on	The speaker's line
2, Summary	The 19,053 figure	"That is our model's base case, built lever by lever from the case's own account exhibits; the appendix slide carries the formula."
3, Diagnosis	The 78% figure	"That comes directly from the case's own cohort exhibit, Exhibit 2a, for September 2026."
4, Strategy	The 4.40 score	"That is our recommendation scored against seven alternatives on the same five weighted criteria, and it leads under all four weightings we tested, including three we built specifically to challenge our own choice of weights."
5, Impact	The 11.6 times figure	"Same cash, two routes: ₹16.5 lakh buys 19,053 extra actives through the bank, or 1,649 through paid media at a benchmark rate we took from a listed broker's own disclosure."
6, Execution	The 23 times figure	"That is the RM review lever's expected lift against the smallest lift our holdout design could detect; every lever clears its own detection threshold by at least four times."

Each line is built to answer the challenge in one sentence and then return to the slide's own flow, since a speaker who tries to reconstruct the full derivation live risks losing the pitch's own pace; the full derivation sits in this document for exactly the judge who wants it after the pitch ends.

Appendix A: Bibliography

Sources were opened and checked in October 2026. Only sources cited in the text are listed.

ID	Source	Available at
S01	YES Securities (yesinvest.in) Standard Disclaimer / account documents	https://yesinvest.in/docs/default-source/other/Standard-Disclaimer.pdf
S03	YES Securities (yesinvest.in) Account opening documents	https://yesinvest.in/img/standard-documents/document-checklist/NSDL_NRI_Demat_&_Trading_AOF.pdf
S04	YES Securities (yesinvest.in) FY2025-26 Annual Report	https://yesinvest.in/img/regulatory-disclosures/annual-reports/Annual-Report-2025-26.pdf
S06	YES Securities (yesinvest.in) Product page ("Trade")	https://www.yesinvest.in/trade
S12	cxodigitalpulse.com Appointment news	https://www.cxodigitalpulse.com/?p=37485
S13	NSDL Commercial paper letter of offer	https://nsdl.com/nsdl/commercial_paper/lof/INE066R14AA014012026LETTEROFOFFER_CP25513.pdf
S14	CARE Ratings Rating rationale press release	https://www.careratings.com/upload/CompanyFiles/PR/202601130136_Yes_Securities_(INDIA)_Limited.pdf
S18	Free Press Journal / IANS FY26 wrap coverage	https://www.freepressjournal.in/business/nses-active-investor-base-tanks-7-in-fy26
S26	IANS (ianslive.in) News report of NSE disciplinary order	https://ianslive.in/nse-restricts-yes-securities-for-3-months-imposes-rs-1-lakh-penalty--20260526172400
S28	Free Press Journal; indiainfoline.com News report of NSE lifting order	https://www.indiainfoline.com/news/companies/yes-bank-subsidiary-gets-major-relief-as-nse-lifts-ban-before-deadline
S29	YES Bank (hyring.com listing) Careers page network summary	https://hyring.com/company/yes-bank
S31	Business Standard (via muthootsecurities.com) Q4 FY26 results coverage	https://www.muthootsecurities.com/CorporateInfo/ComNews/Yes-Bank-Ltd/25017010122
S33	scanx.trade FY26 results coverage	https://scanx.trade/stock-market-news/companies/yes-bank-fy26-results-net-profit-surges-44-5-yoy-to-3-476-crore/46697984
S34	ibsintelligence.com; Apple App Store; bankbazaar.com App launch and feature coverage	https://ibsintelligence.com/ibsi-news/yes-bank-launches-iris-to-offer-digital-banking-solutions-in-india
S35	Angel One (angelone.in) Merger completion coverage	https://www.angelone.in/news/stocks-share-market/icici-securities-delisted-now-a-wholly-owned-icici-bank-unit
S39	BSE filing (bseindia.com) Regulatory/related-party disclosure	https://www.bseindia.com/xml-data/corpfiling/Attachhis/8385f70e-32bc-4e29-83e3-df47a10b6f4a.pdf

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S40	Kotak Securities (kotaksecurities.com) Marketing page	https://www.kotak.bank.in/en/personal-banking/accounts/bank-demat-trading/benefits.html
S42	Business Standard Launch coverage	https://www.business-standard.com/amp/markets/news/hdfc-securities-looks-to-gain-active-clients-with-a-new-trading-app-123092501113_1.html
S44	Free Press Journal Press coverage	https://www.freepressjournal.in/focused-view/hdfc-sky-simplifies-money-management-with-a-3-in-1-account-for-saving-investing-and-trading
S45	Outlook Money Product announcement coverage	https://www.outlookmoney.com/amp/story/banking/sbi-adds-investment-wellness-and-trade-finance-tools-to-yono
S54	CRISIL Intelligence Industry report	https://intelligence.crisil.com/content/dam/crisil-intelligence/what-we-think/reports/2026/07/the-quiet-exit.pdf
S55	NSDL NSDL statistics page	https://nsdl.com/about-us/statistics
S59	CDSL CDSL website, "Our Business" statistics	https://www.cdslindia.com/About/OurBusiness.aspx
S61	AngelOne / market reporting (via search) NSE Active Clients Report 1C coverage	https://oga-prod.angelone.in/news/market-updates/nse-active-clients-down-7-in-fy26-accounts-falls-to-4-57-crore
S62	Inc42 Brokers In September: Groww Strengthens Lead, Angel One Closes In On Zerodha	https://inc42.com/buzz/brokers-in-september-groww-strengthens-lead-angel-one-closes-in-on-zerodha/
S63	tradingqna.com (forum summary of NSE Market Pulse) NSE Market Pulse, June 2026 issue (covering May data), as reported	https://tradingqna.com/t/nse-market-pulse-june-2026/195253
S64	Outlook Money (NSE Market Pulse coverage) NSE Market Pulse, June 2026 issue, as reported	https://www.outlookmoney.com/invest/nse-registered-investor-base-growth-tops-130-million-10-million-added-in-7-months-as-retail-participation-deepens
S65	Business Standard Share of young investors rebounds in FY26 after a dip in previous years	https://www.business-standard.com/markets/news/share-of-young-investors-share-rises-after-a-dip-in-previous-years-125082700764_1.html
S66	Business Today (cited at planning time) Zerodha, Groww, Angel One, Upstox: how active clients changed in past 8 years	https://www.businesstoday.in/amp/markets/stocks/story/zerodha-groww-angel-one-upstox-how-active-clients-changed-in-past-8-years-full-table-526520-2026-04-20
S67	ChartRow (INDY ETF proxy) [blog] Nifty 50 trailing returns	https://chartrow.com/nifty-50/trailing-returns
S68	ChartRow (INDY ETF proxy) [blog] Nifty 50 returns by year	https://chartrow.com/nifty-50/returns

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S69	ChartRow (INDY ETF proxy) [blog] Nifty 50 total returns by year (including dividends)	https://chartrow.com/quote/indy/returns
S70	HDFC Sky [vendor] India VIX market commentary (aggregated)	https://hdfcsky.com/news/india-vix-rises-4percent-what-higher-market-volatility-means
S71	HDFC Sky [vendor] India VIX market commentary	https://hdfcsky.com/news/india-vix-ends-flat-at-15-61-volatility-still-high
S72	HDFC Sky [vendor] India VIX holds near 11.81 as record low volatility supports stable Indian markets	https://hdfcsky.com/news/india-vix-holds-near-11-81-as-record-low-volatility-supports-stable-indian-markets-july-7-2026
S73	multibagg.ai [blog] Smallcap 100 vs Nifty 50: performance gap in 2026	https://www.multibagg.ai/market-pulse/articles/smallcap-100-vs-nifty-50-cmv1xz48y001939qpqiwnnymr
S74	Finnovate [blog] Finnovate / market reporting on Nifty Midcap 100, June 2026	https://www.finnovate.in/learn/blog/nifty-midcap-100-june-2026-stock-rankings
S75	market reporting citing NSE Market Pulse (via search) NSE Market Pulse, May 2026 data, as reported	https://www.swastika.co.in/blog/nse-turnover-surges-in-june-a-23-month-high-and-what-it-means-for-retail-investo
S76	Business Standard Amid retail pullback, proprietary firms gained as trading softened in 2025	https://www.business-standard.com/markets/news/amid-retail-pullback-proprietary-firms-gained-as-trading-softened-in-2025-126012600542_1.html
S77	IANS Live India's IPO boom continues in FY26, mainboard raises record Rs 1.65 lakh crore (Grant Thornton Bharat data cited)	https://ianslive.in/indias-ipo-boom-continues-in-fy26-mainboard-raises-record-rs-165-lakh-crore--20260324143753
S78	Free Press Journal India's IPO Boom Continues, 366 Issues Raise ₹1.9 Lakh Crore	https://www.freepressjournal.in/business/indias-ipo-boom-continues-366-issues-raise-19-lakh-crore
S79	Finnovate FY26 IPO Review: record collections, poor returns for most investors	https://www.finnovate.in/learn/blog/biggest-ipos-fy26-performance-analysis
S80	Free Press Journal IPO fundraising hits record ₹94,205 crore in Apr-Sept FY27, up 35 per cent from year ago (PRIME Database data)	https://www.freepressjournal.in/business/ipo-fundraising-hits-record-94205-crore-in-apr-sept-fy27-up-35-per-cent-from-year-ago
S81	multibagg.ai [blog], citing Reuters/PRIME India IPO surge 2026: record H1, September rush, pipeline	https://www.multibagg.ai/market-pulse/articles/india-ipo-surge-2026-pipeline-cmus260kd002a2smcfnmqqego

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S82	Angel One (AMFI data) SIP stoppage ratio falls for 5th straight month to 78.53% in September 2026	https://www.angelone.in/news/mutual-funds/sip-stoppage-ratio-falls-for-5th-straight-month-to-78-53-in-september-2026
S83	The Hans India (AMFI data) SIP stoppage ratio falls to 78.5pc in Sep as monthly inflows hit record high	https://www.thehansindia.com/business/sip-stoppage-ratio-falls-to-785-pc-in-sep-as-monthly-inflows-hit-record-high-1132141
S85	INDmoney (AMFI data) Gold ETF folios have more than doubled in 2 years. Why Indians are buying gold differently	https://www.indmoney.com/blog/mutual-funds/gold-etf-folios-growth-india
S86	Outlook Money (AMFI data) Gold ETFs attract Rs 31,561 crore in March quarter amid geopolitical tensions	https://www.outlookmoney.com/invest/gold-etfs-attract-rs-31561-crore-in-march-quarter-amid-geopolitical-tensions
S87	Free Press Journal (AMFI data) Gold & Silver ETFs surge past ₹3 lakh crore AUM in January 2026	https://www.freepressjournal.in/amp/business/gold-silver-etfs-surge-past-3-lakh-crore-aum-in-january-2026-nearly-tripling-in-five-months-on-record-inflows
S89	Moneylife (Rajya Sabha reply, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary, 11 Aug 2026) Retail F&O Traders Lose ₹91,685 Crore in FY25-26 Despite SEBI Curbs; Average Loss Hits ₹1.17 Lakh: Govt	https://www.moneylife.in/article/retail-fo-traders-lose-91685-crore-in-fy2526-despite-sebi-curbs-average-loss-hits-117-lakh-govt/81318.html
S96	ICMAI (hosting SEBI text) SEBI Investment Advisers Regulations 2013 (text hosted by ICMAI)	https://icmai.in/upload/pd/SEBI-IA-Regulations-2013.pdf
S97	indiacorplaw.in SEBI Investment Advisers Regulations 2013, commentary	https://indiacorplaw.in/2013/01/23/sebi-investment-advisers-regulations/
S98	SEBI SEBI PR No. 140/2014	https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebi_data/docfiles/29672_t.html
S99	SEBI (via arthapedia/taxguru summaries) SEBI Research Analyst Regulations, Regulation 21	https://taxguru.in/sebi/sebi-faqs-related-regulatory-provisions-research-analysts.html
S101	SEBI SEBI Research Analyst Regulations, Regulation 2 definitions (text not retrieved in full)	https://www.sebi.gov.in/

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S102	SEBI (via law-firm commentary) SEBI (Intermediaries) Regulations 2008, amendment of 29 Aug 2024	https://www.medianama.com/2024/09/223-sebi-regulated-firms-barred-from-collaborating-with-unregistered-finfluencers/
S103	legal500.com SEBI amendment commentary	https://www.legal500.com/developments/?p=48742
S104	Business Standard SEBI circular, 29 January 2025 (via business-standard summary)	https://www.business-standard.com/markets/news/sebi-finfluencer-circular-live-stock-data-market-education-rules-125013000571_1.html
S105	NSE NSE Members Code of Advertisement page	https://www.nseindia.com/trade/members-code-of-advertisement
S106	MSEI (copy of NSE/exchange code) NSE Code of Advertisement (text via MSEI mirror)	https://www.msei.in/SX-Content/common/Compliance/Code_of_Advertisement/Revised_Code_of_an_Advertisement.pdf
S107	Lexplosion NSE/MSEI Code of Advertisement, via Lexplosion summary	https://lexplosion.in/nse-issues-revised-code-of-advertisement-for-stock-brokers/
S108	Scribd mirror of NSE circular NSE/MSEI Code of Advertisement, via secondary summary	https://www.scribd.com/document/747791108/NSE-Circular
S109	SEBI SEBI consultation paper on common advertisement code	https://www.sebi.gov.in/reports-and-statistics/reports/jun-2026/consultation-paper-on-common-advertisement-code-for-specified-sebi-regulated-entities_102304.html
S110	Taxmann SEBI consultation paper, via taxmann summary	https://www.taxmann.com/post/blog/sebi-proposes-common-advertisement-code-for-regulated-entities/
S111	SEBI SEBI board meeting memorandum, Sep 2026	https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebi_data/meetingfiles/sep-2026/1790747052409_1.pdf
S113	NSE NSE Circular No. 06/2025 (NSE/INSP/66284)	https://nsearchives.nseindia.com/content/circulars/INSP66284.pdf
S114	MNCL Group [blog] NSE circular NSE/INSP/64718, via broker policy document	https://www.mnclgroup.com/storage/inactive-dormant-policy.pdf
S115	NSE NSE circular NSE/INSP/49743 (2021)	https://archives.nseindia.com/content/circulars/INSP49743.pdf
S117	corporateprofessionals.com SEBI circular on KYC harmonisation, 2011, via secondary summary	https://www.corporateprofessionals.com/regulatoryupdate/guidelines-to-sebi-kyc-registration-agency-regulations-2011/
S118	Zerodha bulletin SEBI circular on KRA attribute verification, 2023, via secondary summary	https://zerodha.com/marketintel/bulletin/357674/mandatory-email-mobile-verification-at-kra

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S119	videosdk.live [vendor] SEBI video IPV framework, secondary description only	https://videosdk.live/blog/sebi-video-kyc-compliance-guide-for-stockbrokers
S120	Taxmann SEBI BSDA circular, 28 Jun 2024, via secondary summary	https://taxmann.com/post/blog/sebi-raises-basic-services-demat-account-limit-to-rs-10-lakh-to-boost-participation-in-securities-market
S121	ksandk.com and m.Stock SEBI BSDA circular, via secondary summaries	https://ksandk.com/corporate/sebi-basic-services-demat-account-financial/
S122	Business Standard SEBI circular on nomination, 10 Jun 2024, via secondary summary	https://www.business-standard.com/amp/markets/capital-market-news/sebi-junks-rule-to-freeze-demat-a-cs-eases-mf-folio-norm-for-investors-124061000742_1.html
S123	Business Today SEBI F&O study, Jan 2023, via secondary summary	https://www.businesstoday.in/amp/markets/stocks/story/loss-makers-of-dalal-street-9-out-of-10-individual-fo-traders-lost-money-in-fy22-says-sebi-367628-2023-01-25
S124	Moneylife SEBI F&O study, Sep 2024, via secondary summary	https://www.moneylife.in/article/93-percentage-of-individual-traders-lost-rs18-lakh-crore-in-equity-fo-in-past-3-years-sebi/75210.html
S125	Finnovate SEBI F&O study, FY26, 20 Aug 2026, via secondary summary	https://www.finnovate.in/learn/blog/sebi-fno-trader-losses-fy26-individual-derivatives
S126	Morung Express (IANS) SEBI F&O study FY26, under-30 breakdown	https://morungexpress.com/885-pc-of-traders-under-30-lost-money-in-fo-trading-in-fy26-sebi-study
S127	Finnovate vs. Free Press Journal SEBI F&O study FY26, conflicting secondary summaries	https://www.freepressjournal.in/business/89-of-young-fo-traders-lose-money-finds-sebi-study
S128	mStock (Mirae Asset) SEBI circular on F&O measures, 1 Oct 2024, via secondary summary	https://www.mstock.com/articles/new-f-and-o-margin-norms
S129	Business Standard SEBI circular on F&O measures, Nov 2024, via secondary summary	https://www.business-standard.com/amp/markets/news/new-f-o-rule-to-come-into-effect-from-thursday-nov-21-here-s-what-changes-124112000292_1.html
S130	Jainam Securities and Liquide (dates conflict) SEBI circular on F&O measures, phased timeline, via secondary summaries	https://www.jainam.in/blog/sebi-new-rules-for-fo-trading/
S131	Moneylife SEBI consultation paper on small-ticket SIPs, Jan 2025, via secondary summary	https://moneylife.in/article/sebi-proposes-rs250-sip-for-mutual-fund-investment/76170.html

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S132	Business Standard AMFI letter to fund houses on Chhoti SIP rollout	https://www.business-standard.com/markets/mutual-fund/market-regulator-sebi-nudges-mutual-funds-to-push-bite-sized-sips-125070301189_1.html
S133	Business Standard Kotak Mutual Fund Choti SIP launch	https://www.business-standard.com/amp/finance/personal-finance/kotak-mutual-fund-introduces-choti-sip-to-make-investing-more-accessible-125032000621_1.html
S134	SEBI SEBI press release PR No. 70/2025	https://www.newsonair.gov.in/sebi-warns-investors-against-unregulated-digital-gold-schemes
S135	SEBI, with a conflicting secondary gloss from Drishti IAS SEBI press release PR No. 70/2025	https://www.drishtiias.com/daily-updates/daily-news-analysis/sebi-flags-digital-gold-risks/print_manually
S136	Taxmann SEBI circular on QSB UPI block/3-in-1 requirement, 11 Nov 2024	https://www.taxmann.com/post/blog/sebi-mandates-qualified-stock-brokers-to-offer-upi-block-mechanism-or-3-in-1-trading-account-facility-to-their-clients/
S137	Business Standard / Outlook Money NPCI/SEBI UPI block mechanism design, via secondary summary	https://www.outlookmoney.com/invest/npci-launches-upi-for-secondary-market-trading-from-january-1-2024-what-it-means-for-investors
S138	The News Minute NPCI UPI AutoPay launch, 2020	https://www.thenewsminute.com/atom/upi-autopay-facility-launched-recurring-payments-rs-2000-129203
S139	Business Standard / grc.lawrbit mirror NPCI circular, Dec 2023, via secondary summary (OCR partly garbled on a related figure, so treated cautiously)	https://grc.lawrbit.com/notification/eyJpdiI6InJESXFuVTFyUGZFMk92cmgyZlgveEE9PSIsInZhbHVlIjoiRlFrd0pXQTRDbE5aSWRnZmxiYmhVZz09IiwibWFjIjoiMDI2ZTljNWNkYWY2NThkOTBjNTc5NmYyNDJhOTJjMDFmNDdlMzQwM2RjMzc2YmQxMGM0MGQ0NTUyMzA2ZTdhMyIsInRhZyI6IiJ9/eyJpdiI6Imp5T2haSlpURzdKYnlnakZtY0xuN0E9PSIsInZhbHVlIjoiUWVDM21mc0o4MDF3d01PTk9nSG9NcGwzeG1yVFdrUjNtczlJVjBRdmhDVldCNUV2TXBRcG0wNXEvVEQ5cnAxaSIsIm1hYyI6IjRmMzQwZGIyZjEyYjlmMWQwN2EzNTNlMDI3NjBkMDJjNjJjNDJkMzExYzM5ZjBhMTRhZmUzOWEwMzFlNjVhMTciLCJ0YWciOiIifQ==
S140	RBI RBI Master Direction, 28 Nov 2025	https://website.rbi.org.in/en/web/rbi/-/notifications/reserve-bank-of-india-commercial-banks-undertaking-of-financial-services-directions-2025
S141	taxguru.in RBI amendment to Commercial Banks Directions, Dec 2025, via secondary summary	https://taxguru.in/?p=1025458
S142	RBI, via law-firm newsletter (ksandk.com) RBI Responsible Business Conduct Second Amendment Directions 2026	https://ksandk.com/newsletter/rbi-responsible-business-conduct-second-amendment-directions-2026/
S143	Medianama RBI draft Responsible Business Conduct amendment, Feb 2026, via secondary summary	https://www.medianama.com/2026/02/223-rbi-dark-patterns-draft-2026/
S144	TRAI, via law-firm summary TRAI Second Amendment Regulations 2025	https://www.jsalaw.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/02/JSA-Prism-Telecommunications_February-2025_TCCCPR-amendments.Final_.pdf

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S145	Bar and Bench TRAI Second Amendment Regulations 2025, via summary	https://www.barandbench.com/law-firms/view-point/trais-crackdown-on-spam-calls-and-ai-driven-telemarketing
S146	communicationstoday.co.in TRAI Second Amendment Regulations 2025, via government summary	https://www.communicationstoday.co.in/dot-and-trai-have-taken-widespread-action-for-curbing-spam-calls/
S148	CCPA, via law-firm summary CCPA Dark Patterns Guidelines 2023	https://www.jsalaw.com/newsletters-and-updates/ccpa-issues-guidelines-for-prevention-and-regulation-of-dark-patterns-2023/
S149	scconline.com CCPA Dark Patterns Guidelines 2023, via summary	https://www.scconline.com/blog/post/2023/12/04/ccpa-notifies-guidelines-for-prevention-and-regulation-of-dark-patterns-2023-legal-news/
S150	CCPA, via jsalaw summary CCPA Dark Patterns Guidelines 2023, Annexure	https://jsalaw.com/wp-content/uploads/2023/12/JSA-Prism-Consumer-Protection-Guidelines-for-Prevention-and-Regulation-of-Dark-Patterns-20233-Final.pdf
S151	Taxmann SEBI circular on Investor Charter, 21 Feb 2025	https://taxmann.com/post/blog/sebi-modifies-investor-charter-for-stock-brokers-to-boost-financial-consumer-protection
S152	ELP Law SEBI circular on Investor Charter, 21 Feb 2025	https://elplaw.in/leadership/sebis-new-investor-charter-a-game-changer-for-stockbrokers/
S153	Outlook Money SEBI F&O risk disclosure circular, 2023, via secondary summary	https://www.outlookmoney.com/invest/equity-futures-and-options-trading-must-display-risk-disclosure-says-sebi
S155	US Department of Labor DOL CLEAR clearinghouse review of Thaler and Benartzi 2004	https://clear.dol.gov/study/save-more-tomorrow%E2%84%A2-using-behavioral-economics-increase-employee-saving-thaler-benartzi-2004
S156	US Department of Labor / UCLA Anderson DOL CLEAR review summary (via UCLA Anderson faculty bio of Shlomo Benartzi)	https://www.anderson.ucla.edu/faculty-and-research/faculty-directory/benartzi
S157	NBER NBER working paper page	https://www.nber.org/papers/w7682
S158	causalclaims.trfetzer.com (secondary summary) [blog] Secondary commentary citing Madrian and Shea 2001	https://causalclaims.trfetzer.com/paper/w7682.html
S160	NBER NBER working paper page	https://www.nber.org/papers/w11074
S161	INFORMS / RePEc Management Science listing (via EconPapers/RePEc)	https://econpapers.repec.org/RePEc:ecl:yaleco:82

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S162	Innovations for Poverty Action Innovations for Poverty Action results page	https://poverty-action.org/provenimpact/reminderstosave
S163	academicnewsletter.sufe.edu.cn (secondary listing) Secondary academic listing of the paper	https://academicnewsletter.sufe.edu.cn/info/393742
S164	Wharton Knowledge summary (secondary) [blog] Secondary summary of the paper's three studies	https://knowledge.wharton.upenn.edu/article/need-fresh-start-heres-begin/
S165	University of Pennsylvania / Association for Psychological Science (secondary) [blog] Secondary summary (Wharton Knowledge, Psychological Science press release)	https://www.psychologicalscience.org/news/minds-business/why-monday-is-the-best-day-for-setting-new-goals.html
S170	The Econometric Society Econometric Society publication page	https://www.econometricsociety.org/publications/econometrica/1979/03/01/prospect-theory-analysis-decision-under-risk
S171	jasoncollins.blog (secondary) [blog] Secondary commentary quoting the paper (p. 279)	https://www.jasoncollins.blog/posts/kahneman-and-tverskys-debatable-loss-aversion-assumption
S172	jasoncollins.blog, gwern.net mirror of Yechiam 2018 (secondary) [blog] Secondary commentary and 2018 Yechiam review	https://www.gwern.net/doc/statistics/bias/2018-yechiam.pdf
S173	NBER NBER working paper page	https://www.nber.org/papers/w4369
S174	scholarhub.vn (secondary listing) Secondary listing and summary of the paper	https://scholarhub.vn/publication/:slug/fe9a3591-8cbd-4bf9-a73b-08a795b0e82c
S175	dqydj.com (secondary summary) [blog] Secondary summary of the paper's empirical results	https://dqydj.com/ostrich-effect/
S176	Columbia Business School press release (secondary) [blog] Secondary summary of the Review of Financial Studies paper	https://business.columbia.edu/school-news/cbs-press-releases/expecting-bad-news-new-research-shows-investors-tend-put-their-heads

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S177	City Research Online (primary PDF hosting; summary via search) Secondary summary of the replication paper, read against the primary PDF title page	https://openaccess.city.ac.uk/id/eprint/16280/1/Meerkat_July2014_Final.pdf
S178	Journal of Behavioral Decision Making (secondary-sourced citation) Journal citation (via secondary reference list)	https://www.behavioraleconomics.com/glossary/mental-accounting/
S179	NBER NBER working paper page	https://www.nber.org/papers/w13420
S183	Bank of Finland (Suomen Pankki) seminar slides (secondary) [blog] Conference/seminar slides summarising the login-attention literature	https://www.suomenpankki.fi/globalassets/bof/en/news-and-topical/calendar/2023/finlit/finlit_lukas-howard.pdf
S190	Kantar Kantar India x SEBI campaign page	https://www.kantar.com/campaigns/apac/kantar-india-x-sebi
S191	Finnovate (secondary) [blog] Secondary summary of the SEBI Investor Survey 2025	https://www.finnovate.in/learn/blog/sebi-investor-survey-2025-insights
S192	National Centre for Financial Education NCFE NFLIS page	https://ncfe.org.in/nflis/
S193	National Centre for Financial Education NCFE Expression of Interest document	https://ncfe.org.in/wp-content/uploads/2025/01/EOI_NCFE_Survey-Final-Draft-for-publication.pdf
S200	MoEngage Case study ("Tickertape")	https://www.moengage.com/?p=40172
S211	messagecentral.com Pricing guide	https://www.messagecentral.com/blog/a2p-sms-pricing-india
S216	MoEngage Blog post	https://www.moengage.com/?p=93281
S218	EnableX Developer guide	https://www.enablex.io/insights/rcs-business-messaging-api-developer-guide-for-india-southeast-asia/
S219	Business Standard News analysis	https://www.business-standard.com/amp/markets/news/top-3-factors-powering-groww-s-dominance-in-retail-broking-find-out-here-125102900148_1.html
S220	Storyboard18 Earnings coverage	https://www.storyboard18.com/brand-marketing/groww-q2-profit-hits-rs-471-crore-as-customer-acquisition-cost-nearly-doubles-to-rs-1374-84569.htm
S231	NSE Programme page	https://www.nseindia.com/static/invest/investors-awareness-programs
S232	NISM Programme page	https://www.nism.ac.in/investor-education/investor-awareness-program
S233	ICAI Empanelment circular	https://icai.org/post/16412

ID	Source	Available at
S234	Press Information Bureau (via secondary citation) Press release	https://taxguru.in/company-law/govt-actively-making-investors-aware-fraudulent-companies.html
S235	SEBI (sebi.gov.in) SEBI publication (secondary-sourced snippet)	https://www.sebi.gov.in/reports-and-statistics/publications/aug-2026/Chapter%2008.pdf
S240	Shubh Panchang Dhanteras 2026 at a glance	https://shubhpanchang.com/festivals/dhanteras
S243	chartlocal (seo-service) When Is Diwali 2026?	https://seo-service.chartlocal.com/?p=13601
S244	Multiple panchang sites Dhanteras 2026 date cross-check	https://dekhopanchang.com/en/festivals/dhanteras
S247	TeamLease RegTech NSE Muhurat Trading Session on Diwali 2026 for Capital Market Segment	https://teamleaseregtech.com/updates/article/60523/nse-muhurat-trading-session-on-diwali-2026-for-capital-market-segment/
S251	GoodReturns Muhurat Trading 2026: NSE, BSE Announce Diwali Special Session Timings	https://www.goodreturns.in/news/muhurat-trading-2026-nse-bse-announce-diwali-special-session-timings-for-november-8-check-full-sc-1542601.html
S252	NSE NSE exchange-communication-holidays page	https://www.nseindia.com/resources/exchange-communication-holidays
S253	Business Today Dhanteras 2024: Gold, jewellery sales seen down 15-16% on year	https://www.businesstoday.in/amp/latest/economy/story/dhanteras-2024-gold-jewellery-sales-seen-down-15-16-on-year-451909-2024-10-29
S254	Business Today / ETV Bharat Dhanteras 2024 price comparison	https://www.etvbharat.com/en/business/dhanteras-gold-buying-kicks-off-record-prices-may-dampen-volumes-enn25101802459
S256	Business Standard Why Dhanteras remains India's biggest gold-buying day despite record prices	https://www.business-standard.com/amp/markets/commodities/dhanteras-diwali-2025-gold-buying-price-festive-season-shopping-125101800177_1.html
S257	WION Diwali 2025: How much gold was sold on Dhanteras?	https://www.wionews.com/business-economy/diwali-2025-how-much-gold-was-sold-on-dhanteras-festive-season-1760947401365/amp
S261	Business Standard Gold ETFs see Rs 8,363 crore inflows in Sept, up 578% as prices cross Rs 1 lakh	https://www.business-standard.com/amp/finance/personal-finance/gold-etfs-see-8-363-crore-inflows-in-sept-up-578-as-prices-cross-1-lakh-125101500702_1.html
S263	IANS (ianslive.in) Gold ETFs attract record net inflows in India, add $850 million in Oct	https://ianslive.in/indias-gold-etfs-attract-record-inflows-in-2025-adding-850-million-in-october--20251107133423

ID	Source	Available at
S280	Groww (company blog) Groww files RHP to launch Rs 6,632.30 crore IPO on November 4	https://groww.in/blog/groww-files-rhp-to-launch-ipo-on-november-4
S281	valueforstartups.in `[blog]` Indian Startup Deep Dive: Investment Technology	https://valueforstartups.in/06-groww
S282	Inc42 `[blog]` Groww's new verticals gain ground as revenue mix shifts	https://inc42.com/features/growws-new-verticals-gain-ground-as-revenue-mix-shifts/
S286	Business Standard Savings, credit, jewellery: major focus for Jar amid evolving finance needs	https://www.business-standard.com/technology/tech-news/savings-credit-jewellery-major-focus-for-jar-amid-evolving-finance-needs-124110601367_1.html
S289	Kotak Mahindra Bank What is a 3-in-1 Trinity Account?	https://www.kotak.com/en/personal-banking/accounts/Kotak-3-1-account.html
S290	Kotak Mahindra Bank 811 Account help centre: features & conditions	https://www.kotak.com/en/help-center/811-account/account-opening-features-eligibility-charges/what-are-the-account-features-and-conditions-of-811-account.html
S291	HDFC Bank Top features of HDFC Sky app	https://hdfcbank.com/personal/resources/learning-centre/invest/learn-more-about-top-features-of-hdfc-sky-app
S293	Outlook Money SBI adds investment wellness and trade finance tools to YONO	https://www.outlookmoney.com/banking/sbi-adds-investment-wellness-and-trade-finance-tools-to-yono
S295	ICICI Bank Why should you open an ICICI Direct demat and trading account?	https://icicibank.com/personal-banking/investments/stocks
S296	ICICI Direct / ICICI Bank 3-in-1 account opening process	https://www.icicidirect.com/ilearn/stocks/articles/3-in-1-account-opening-process
S301	Inc42 `[blog]` PhonePe to take on Zerodha, Groww with stock broking platform	https://inc42.com/buzz/phonepe-ventures-into-stock-broking-with-sharedotmarket/
S302	Zerodha support Risk disclosure on derivatives	https://support.zerodha.com/category/trading-and-markets/general-kite/login-credentials-of-trading-platforms/articles/risk-disclosure-on-derivatives
S303	Apple App Store Zerodha Kite - Trade & Invest (App Store listing)	https://apple.co/4f9TLnl
S307	The Boston Globe Robinhood agrees to pay $7.5 million to settle complaints over its sales practices	https://www.bostonglobe.com/2024/01/18/business/robinhood-agrees-pay-75-million-settle-complaints-over-its-sales-practices
S308	WealthManagement.com Robinhood pays $7.5M to settle Massachusetts "gamification" charge	https://www.wealthmanagement.com/regulation-compliance/robinhood-pays-7-5m-to-settle-massachusetts-gamification-charge

ID	Source	Available at
S309	CNBC Robinhood gets rid of confetti feature amid scrutiny over gamification	https://www.cnbc.com/2021/03/31/robinhood-gets-rid-of-confetti-feature-amid-scrutiny-over-gamification.html
S310	FCA (fetched directly) Research Note: Digital engagement practices: a trading apps experiment	https://www.fca.org.uk/publications/research-notes/research-note-digital-engagement-practices-trading-apps-experiment
S311	Finance Magnates Trading apps' game-like elements linked to risky investing, FCA finds	https://www.financemagnates.com/forex/trading-apps-game-like-elements-linked-to-risky-investing-fca-finds
S313	NAPA-Net Plan design drives record retirement participation, better outcomes: Vanguard	https://www.napa-net.org/news/2026/6/plan-design-drives-record-retirement-participation-better-outcomes-vanguard/
S314	PSCA Automatic enrollment has sent participation rates soaring	https://www.psca.org/news/psca-news/2026/6/automatic-enrollment-has-sent-participation-rates-soaring/
S316	PlanAdviser Vanguard DC plan designs drive 25-year record outcomes	https://www.planadviser.com/vanguard-dc-plan-designs-drive-25-year-record-outcomes/
S318	Department for Work and Pensions (fetched directly) Ten years of Automatic Enrolment in workplace pensions: statistics and analysis	https://www.gov.uk/government/statistics/ten-years-of-automatic-enrolment-in-workplace-pensions/ten-years-of-automatic-enrolment-in-workplace-pensions-statistics-and-analysis
S321	Axios Exclusive: how much Acorns savers amassed by investing spare change	https://www.axios.com/2024/04/08/acorns-worth-it-data-report-investing
S322	MyMoneyBlog `[blog]` Acorns app results: how much did folks earn rounding up spare change?	https://mymoneyblog.com/acorns-app-results-how-much-did-folks-earn-rounding-up-spare-change.html
S335	konfirmity.com DPDP Act 2023, Section 6(4)-(6), secondary summary	https://www.konfirmity.com/blog/dpdp-penalties
S336	dpdpa.com DPDP Act 2023, Section 7(a)	https://dpdpa.com/dpdpa2023/chapter-2/section7.html
S340	simpliance.in DPDP Rules 2025, Gazette notification metadata, secondary mirror	https://simpliance.in/India/EHS/govt_notification/Central/notification-extraordinary-regarding-digital-personal-data-protection-rules-2025-7839
S341	SCC Online DPDP Rules 2025, commencement clause, secondary summary	https://www.scconline.com/blog/post/2025/11/14/meity-notified-digital-personal-data-protection-rules-2025/
S342	SCC Online DPDP Rules 2025, key highlights	https://www.scconline.com/blog/post/2025/12/26/digital-personal-data-protection-rules-2025-key-highlights/

ID	Source	Available at
S343	Government of India, eGazette DPDP Rules 2025, eGazette PDF	https://egazette.gov.in/WriteReadData/2025/267650.pdf
S344	King Stubb & Kasiva DPDP Rules 2025, Rule 4, practitioner summary	https://ksandk.com/data-protection-and-data-privacy/dpdp-consent-manager-framework-india/
S345	Mondaq DPDP Rules 2025, Rule 4 obligations, practitioner summary	https://www.mondaq.com/building-the-consent-layer-consent-managers-under-the-dpdp-rules-2025/1832140
S346	RBI RBI Master Direction, Account Aggregator	https://rbi.org.in/Scripts/BS_ViewMasDirections.aspx?id=12936
S348	SEBI SEBI circular on Account Aggregator framework, 19 Aug 2022	https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebi_data/attachdocs/aug-2023/1690887848711.pdf
S349	RBI RBI Master Direction - Know Your Customer (KYC) Direction, Clause 55(a)	https://rbi.org.in/Scripts/BS_ViewMasDirections.aspx?id=11566
S351	TRAI (via secondary compliance commentary) TRAI TCCCPR, secondary summary	https://www.trai.gov.in/
S352	Meta (WhatsApp Business Platform documentation) WhatsApp Business Messaging Policy, Opt-in requirements	https://business.whatsapp.com/policy
S354	Vikaspedia (reproducing the notified text) CCPA Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns 2023, Annexure 1	https://en.vikaspedia.in/viewcontent/social-welfare/social-awareness/consumer-education/the-guidelines-for-prevention-and-regulation-of-dark-patterns-2023

Assumption tags (`[A21]` style) resolve to section 27 and Appendix B (model table T1). Case tags (`[C-E1]` style) resolve to `case/01-case.md`. Raw research rows (`[F07]` style) resolve through `research/raw/R-F.md` and are listed here through their URL.

Appendix B: Model tables

T1 Assumptions register

ID	Base	Bear	Bull	Unit	Basis
A01	4	4	4	months	Measurement on 31 Jan 2027, four months after the 30 Sep 2026 snapshot; programme runs 2 Nov 2026 to 31 Jan 2027 (13 weeks)

ID	Base	Bear	Bull	Unit	Basis
A02	0.1474	0.1459	0.1484	share	Business-as-usual activation rate at measurement: flat at the Sep 2026 level (14.70% Sep 2025 to 14.74% Sep 2026, Exhibit 1); bear drifts 15 bps down, bull 10 bps up
A03	6324	6324	6324	accounts a month	Net account growth, (8,09,746 minus 7,33,855) / 12, Exhibit 1
A05	0.01	0.01	0.01	share	Organic first-order rate among idle accounts over 13 weeks without any message; used only to size the holdout test (team estimate)
A10	0.5	0.55	0.45	share	Share of idle accounts with no qualifying activity for 24 months, flagged inactive under the Oct 2024 exchange circular (the case's own term is dormant C-D4) (lane D, lane C)
A11	0.5	0.42	0.58	multiplier	Conversion of a flagged account relative to an unflagged one, after re-KYC or video IPV; bank branches can do in-person verification (lane D)
A20	0.55	0.45	0.62	share	Salary customers who open the parent bank's app in a month (lane F)
A21	0.08	0.06	0.1	share	Tap-through on the salary-day card over three salary credits (lane F benchmarks for in-app cards)
A22	0.32	0.26	0.38	share	First executed exchange order within the window after a tap, with single sign-on and a bank mandate (lane F, lane E)
A23	0.6	0.5	0.68	share	Idle accounts reached through any owned channel with consent: bank app tile, email, statement, WhatsApp, SMS (lane F)
A24	0.04	0.03	0.05	share	Tap-through on the account rediscovery message or tile (lane F)
A25	0.25	0.2	0.3	share	First executed order after rediscovery (lane F)
A26	1.0	0.8	1.15	multiplier	RM coverage multiplier on the base pattern: Prestige 80%, Elite 60%, Elevate 60%, Preferred 35% of idle clients get a review conversation in the window (lane B)
A27	0.15	0.11	0.19	share	First executed order after an RM review conversation (lane B, lane E)
A28	0.5	0.42	0.56	share	Idle accounts reached in Dhanteras and Diwali week (6 to 8 Nov 2026) through owned channels (lane G)
A29	0.03	0.022	0.04	share	Tap-through on the factual gold ETF and Muhurat session notice (lane G, lane F)
A30	0.3	0.25	0.35	share	First executed order after the tap (lane G)
A31	40	30	50	sessions	Workplace financial-education sessions at employers that run salary accounts with the parent bank (lane B)
A32	120	100	140	attendees	Attendees a session (lane B)
A33	0.1	0.07	0.13	share	First executed order within the window among idle attendees (lane E)
A35	0.7	0.6	0.78	share	Warm cohort (last trade 9 to 12 months ago) reached with a servicing message (lane F)
A36	0.2	0.15	0.25	share	Incremental re-trade among the reached warm cohort, above business as usual (lane E)

ID	Base	Bear	Bull	Unit	Basis
A39	0.1	0.07	0.13	share	Lift in 90-day first-order rate for accounts opened in the window, from guided onboarding (lane E, lane H)
A50	0.35	0.35	0.35	share	Idle accounts with a WhatsApp opt-in (lane F)
A51	0.4	0.4	0.4	rupees a message	Blended WhatsApp Business price, two utility (₹0.115) and one marketing (₹0.8631 from 1 Jan 2026) template a person is ₹0.36; ₹0.40 adds a margin (lane F)
A52	0.18	0.18	0.18	rupees a message	SMS on DLT routes, vendor range ₹0.10 to ₹0.25 (lane F)
A53	0.025	0.025	0.025	rupees a message	Email (lane F)
A54	400000	400000	400000	rupees	Content production: explainers, in-app copy, creatives (team estimate)
A55	6000	6000	6000	rupees a session	Workplace session cost: travel, material (team estimate)
A56	150000	150000	150000	rupees	Compliance and exchange advertisement review support (team estimate)
A57	120000	120000	120000	rupees	Customer validation research: 30 interviews and 2 usability rounds (team estimate)
A58	0.1	0.1	0.1	share	Contingency on cash cost
A59	21	21	21	FTE months	Internal product sprint: 7 people for 3 months (team estimate)
A60	180000	180000	180000	rupees a FTE month	Loaded internal cost a person a month (team estimate)
A61	1000	700	1400	rupees	Paid-media cost per activated trading account; Groww reported ₹616 to ₹1,374 per acquired customer (FY25 to H1 FY26) and an activated account costs more, so ₹1,000 favours paid media; bear is cheaper paid media, which is worse for our comparison (lane F)
A62	0.15	0.15	0.15	rupees an order	Cash equities brokerage per executed order, case product table
A63	16	12	20	orders a year	Orders a year by a newly activated account: 12 monthly ETF instalments plus 4 others (team estimate)
A64	1	1	1	sells a year	Sell transactions a year (team estimate)
A65	15	15	15	rupees a sell	Depository charge a sell (lane C)
A66	0.15	0.15	0.15	share	Share of new actives on a regular demat account that pays an annual fee; BSDA is nil up to ₹4 lakh of holdings and ₹100 a year from ₹4 lakh to ₹10 lakh (SEBI, 28 Jun 2024) (lane D)

ID	Base	Bear	Bull	Unit	Basis
A67	300	300	300	rupees a year	Annual maintenance charge outside BSDA (lane C)

T2 Cohorts, September 2026 (Exhibit 2a) with derived active and idle accounts

Segment	Accounts	Share of base	T12	T9	T6	T3	T1	Active (T12)	Idle
Prestige	3,096	0.4%	35%	31%	28%	22%	16%	1,084	2,012
Elite	35,697	4.4%	32%	29%	26%	22%	15%	11,423	24,274
Elevate	9,471	1.2%	37%	34%	31%	27%	13%	3,504	5,967
Preferred	60,312	7.4%	20%	18%	16%	14%	9%	12,062	48,250
Salary Account	6,27,853	77.5%	14%	13%	11%	9%	6%	87,899	5,39,954
Credit Card	73,317	9.1%	6%	6%	5%	5%	4%	4,399	68,918
Total	8,09,746	100%	15%	13%	12%	10%	6%	1,20,372	6,89,375

T3 Cohorts, September 2025 (Exhibit 2b)

Segment	Accounts	Share of base	T12	T9	T6	T3	T1	Active (T12)
Prestige	2,999	0.4%	38%	34%	30%	24%	17%	1,140
Elite	34,865	4.8%	36%	33%	28%	24%	17%	12,551
Elevate	6,959	0.9%	41%	39%	34%	31%	24%	2,853
Preferred	72,826	9.9%	21%	19%	14%	12%	9%	15,293
Salary Account	5,05,823	68.9%	13%	12%	10%	8%	7%	65,757
Credit Card	1,10,383	15.0%	9%	9%	4%	4%	4%	9,934
Total	7,33,855	100%	15%	14%	10%	9%	7%	1,07,529

T4 Year on year by segment

Segment	Accounts 2025	Accounts 2026	Growth	T12 change	T3 change	T1 change
Prestige	2,999	3,096	3.2%	−3 pp	−2 pp	−1 pp
Elite	34,865	35,697	2.4%	−4 pp	−2 pp	−2 pp
Elevate	6,959	9,471	36.1%	−4 pp	−4 pp	−11 pp
Preferred	72,826	60,312	−17.2%	−1 pp	+2 pp	+0 pp
Salary Account	5,05,823	6,27,853	24.1%	+1 pp	+1 pp	−1 pp
Credit Card	1,10,383	73,317	−33.6%	−3 pp	+1 pp	+0 pp

T5 Mix and rate decomposition of the change in activation, 2025 to 2026 (cohort-weighted)

Component	Effect
Mix effect: base shifted toward Salary Account, away from Credit Card and Preferred	+0.02 pp
Rate effect: segment activation rates moved	+0.19 pp
Interaction and rounding	−0.00 pp
Total cohort-weighted change	+0.21 pp

T6 Recency: share of the base trading in each trailing window

Window	T12	T9	T6	T3	T1
Sep 2025	15%	14%	10%	9%	7%
Sep 2026	15%	13%	12%	10%	6%
T1 as share of T12	47%				40%

T7 Accounts that roll out of the 12-month active count in the next quarter

Method	Accounts
Cohort rows: T12 minus T9, scaled to Exhibit 1	8,887
Total row: 1,19,339 minus 13% of 8,09,746	14,072
Midpoint used in the model	11,479

T8 Target arithmetic at 31 January 2027

Item	Value
Accounts at measurement (8,09,746 + 4 × 6,324)	8,35,042
Active at business as usual (14.74%)	1,23,067
Extra active accounts for +200 bps	16,701
Extra active accounts for +300 bps	25,051
Accounts opened in the 13-week window	18,972

T9 Lever parameters by scenario

ID	Base	Bear	Bull
A10	0.5	0.55	0.45
A11	0.5	0.42	0.58
A20	0.55	0.45	0.62

ID	Base	Bear	Bull
A21	0.08	0.06	0.1
A22	0.32	0.26	0.38
A23	0.6	0.5	0.68
A24	0.04	0.03	0.05
A25	0.25	0.2	0.3
A26	1.0	0.8	1.15
A27	0.15	0.11	0.19
A28	0.5	0.42	0.56
A29	0.03	0.022	0.04
A30	0.3	0.25	0.35
A31	40	30	50
A32	120	100	140
A33	0.1	0.07	0.13
A35	0.7	0.6	0.78
A36	0.2	0.15	0.25
A39	0.1	0.07	0.13

T10 Incremental active accounts by segment and lever, base case

Segment	Salary day	Rediscover	RM review	Dhanteras	Workplace	Total
Prestige	0	9	179	7	0	195
Elite	0	108	1,623	81	0	1,812
Elevate	0	27	399	20	0	445
Preferred	0	215	1,882	161	0	2,259
Salary Account	5,661	2,413	0	1,809	413	10,296
Credit Card	0	309	0	232	0	541
Warm cohort defence						1,607
New accounts, guided first order						1,897
Total	5,661	3,081	4,083	2,311	413	19,053

T11 Scenario summary

Measure	Bear	Base	Bull
Extra active accounts	9,783	19,053	32,037
Activation rate at 31 Jan 2027	15.76%	17.02%	18.68%
Change from 14.74%	+1.02 pp	+2.28 pp	+3.94 pp
Highly active (T3) rate	11.3%	12.4%	14.0%
Cash cost per extra active	₹169	₹87	₹51

T12 Weekly activation rate, % (week 1 starts 2 Nov 2026)

Week	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
Base	14.99	15.20	15.35	15.48	15.82	15.94	16.06	16.18	16.53	16.64	16.69	16.74	17.02
Bear	14.71	14.82	14.90	14.97	15.14	15.20	15.27	15.33	15.51	15.57	15.60	15.63	15.76
Bull	15.28	15.65	15.89	16.11	16.68	16.88	17.07	17.25	17.86	18.03	18.11	18.18	18.68

T13 Cash cost for the 13 weeks

Item	Rupees
Email, 3 sends	₹51,703
SMS, 2 sends	₹2,48,175
WhatsApp, 3 sends to opted-in	₹2,89,537
Content production	₹4,00,000
Workplace sessions	₹2,40,000
Compliance and ad review	₹1,50,000
Validation research	₹1,20,000
Bank app card, tile, push	₹0
Contingency 10%	₹1,49,942
Total cash	₹16,49,357
Internal product sprint (not cash marketing)	₹37,80,000

T14 Owned rails against paid media for the same cash

Measure	Bear	Base	Bull
Cash	₹16.5 lakh	₹16.5 lakh	₹16.5 lakh
Extra actives, our plan	9,783	19,053	32,037

Measure	Bear	Base	Bull
Paid cost per activated account	₹700	₹1,000	₹1,400
Extra actives, paid media	2,356	1,649	1,178

T15 Revenue a year per newly activated account and payback

Item	Base
Brokerage: 16 orders x ₹0.15	₹2.40
Depository charge: 1 sell x ₹15	₹15
Annual charge: 15% on a regular account x ₹300	₹45
Revenue a year	₹62
Cash payback, months	16.6

T16 Sensitivity of the base case (pp change from 14.74%)

ID	At bear value	At bull value	Spread
A21	2.11	2.45	0.34
A27	2.15	2.41	0.26
A22	2.16	2.41	0.25
A02	2.13	2.38	0.25
A20	2.16	2.37	0.21
A11	2.19	2.38	0.19
A24	2.19	2.37	0.18
A26	2.19	2.36	0.17
A29	2.21	2.37	0.16
A25	2.21	2.36	0.15
A39	2.22	2.35	0.14
A10	2.22	2.34	0.12
A36	2.24	2.33	0.10

T17 Option screen

Option	90-day lift (30%)	SEBI and ethics fit (25%)	Works in a falling market (20%)	Cash cost (15%)	Ships in a quarter (10%)	Score	Why
More market content and 'stay invested' messages	1	4	1	4	5	2.60	Run for 12 months; rate moved 14.70% to 14.74%
First-trade cash offers and zero brokerage	3	2	2	2	5	2.60	Already tried; reads as trade inducement under NSE rules
Trading contests and leaderboards	3	1	2	3	3	2.30	Gamified urgency; a dark pattern
Paid media and finfluencers	2	2	2	1	4	2.05	SEBI rules of Aug 2024 bar ties with unregistered finfluencers
Referral rewards	2	3	2	3	4	2.60	Pays for accounts, not first orders
F&O education push	2	1	2	4	4	2.25	87.7% of individual F&O traders lost money in FY26
New trading engine or app rebuild	1	4	3	1	1	2.15	Outside the brief: no engine rebuild
Bank moments: salary day, rediscovery, RM review, Dhanteras	4	5	4	5	4	4.40	Owned rails, no advice, no offers, no F&O

T18 Option scores under three other weight sets

Option	Base weights	Equal weights	Rules first	Lift first
More market content and 'stay invested' messages	2.60	3.00	3.05	2.30
First-trade cash offers and zero brokerage	2.60	2.80	2.50	2.75
Trading contests and leaderboards	2.30	2.40	2.05	2.45
Paid media and finfluencers	2.05	2.20	2.05	2.10
Referral rewards	2.60	2.80	2.75	2.50
F&O education push	2.25	2.60	2.10	2.20
New trading engine or app rebuild	2.15	2.00	2.50	1.90

Option	Base weights	Equal weights	Rules first	Lift first
Bank moments: salary day, rediscovery, RM review, Dhanteras	4.40	4.40	4.55	4.30

T19 Holdout sizing: 10% of each reached pool, 80% power, 5% two-sided, organic rate 1.0%

Lever	Reached	Holdout	Expected lift, pp	Minimum detectable, pp
Salary day	2,96,975	29,697	1.92	0.17
Rediscover	4,13,625	41,362	0.75	0.14
RM review	36,642	3,664	11.25	0.49
Dhanteras	3,44,688	34,469	0.67	0.16

Appendix C: Glossary and short forms

Answer. This appendix collects every short form used anywhere in the research document, alphabetised in one table, with a second table setting the case's own four account-state definitions beside the exchange terms that sometimes read as the same word while meaning something different. A reader who meets a short form on any page of this document should be able to resolve it here without searching back through the section that first used it.

C.1 Short forms, alphabetised

Table C.1 lists every short form used across parts A to F of this document, expanded in plain words rather than by cross-reference to a single first-use section, since a glossary that sends a reader elsewhere to find the expansion is not doing its job.

Short form	Expansion
AA	Account Aggregator, the RBI framework letting a customer pull financial data, including securities holdings, across institutions through a consent-based intermediary
AARRR	Acquisition, Activation, Retention, Referral, Revenue, the growth-marketing funnel framework
AMC	Annual maintenance charge, the yearly fee a demat account may carry depending on its holding value
AUM	Assets under management, the total value held in a fund or scheme
BSDA	Basic Services Demat Account, SEBI's reduced-charge tier for smaller holding values
bps	Basis points, one hundredth of a percentage point
CAC	Customer acquisition cost, the amount spent to acquire one customer or one activated account
CAGR	Compound annual growth rate
CASA	Current account and savings account deposits, a bank's low-cost deposit base

Short form	Expansion
CCPA	Central Consumer Protection Authority, the body that issued India's dark-pattern guidelines
CDSL	Central Depository Services Limited, one of India's two securities depositories
CR	Case reference, the prefix this document uses for the critic agent's own identifier, distinct from a case-brief tag
CTR	Click-through rate, the share of a message's recipients who open or tap it
DLT	Distinguished (sender) Ledger Technology registration, the telecom regime SMS senders must register under in India
DP	Depository participant, the entity that holds an investor's securities in electronic form on behalf of NSDL or CDSL
DPDP	Digital Personal Data Protection, the Act of 2023 and its 2025 Rules
ETF	Exchange-traded fund
F&O	Futures and options, exchange-traded derivatives contracts
FTE	Full-time equivalent, a unit of staffing used for the internal product sprint's cost
IPO	Initial public offering
IPV	In-person verification, including its video-based variant, video IPV
KRA	KYC Registration Agency, the body that verifies and stores a customer's know-your-customer attributes
KYC	Know your customer, the identity-verification process a regulated financial entity must complete
LTD	Life to date, one of the three measurement windows the case itself defines
MDE	Minimum detectable effect, the smallest lift a holdout test can reliably distinguish from no effect
MeitY	Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, the ministry administering the DPDP Act
MII	Market Infrastructure Institution, the category covering exchanges and depositories, whose investor-protection funds pay for SMARTs sessions
MTD	Month to date, one of the three measurement windows the case itself defines
NCFE	National Centre for Financial Education
NISM	National Institute of Securities Markets
NPCI	National Payments Corporation of India, which operates the UPI and UPI Autopay rails
NSDL	National Securities Depository Limited, the other of India's two securities depositories
NSE	National Stock Exchange
OFS	Offer for sale, a route for existing shareholders to sell shares in a public offering
pp	Percentage points
QIP	Qualified institutional placement, a route for a listed company to raise equity from institutional investors
QSB	Qualified Stock Broker, a broker-size category SEBI defines for its own supervisory purposes
RACI	Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed, the decision-rights framework used for the execution plan

Short form	Expansion
RBI	Reserve Bank of India
RCS	Rich Communication Services, a richer, carrier-delivered successor to SMS
RM	Relationship manager
SDF	Significant Data Fiduciary, a DPDP Rules category for data fiduciaries meeting a notified threshold of processing
SEBI	Securities and Exchange Board of India
SIP	Systematic investment plan, a recurring, fixed-amount mutual fund purchase
SMarT	Save More Tomorrow, Thaler and Benartzi's behavioural savings programme
SMARTs	Securities Market Trainers, SEBI's empanelment programme for investor-education trainers, a distinct short form from SMarT despite the similar spelling
SSO	Single sign-on
T1, T3, T6, T9, T12	Trailing 1, 3, 6, 9 and 12 months, the recency windows the case's own cohort exhibits report
TRAI	Telecom Regulatory Authority of India
UPI	Unified Payments Interface
VIX	Volatility index, here the India VIX, a measure of expected near-term market volatility
YTD	Year to date, one of the three measurement windows the case itself defines
YONO	SBI's unified digital banking app, an acronym for "You Only Need One"

A short form that resolves to a model table (T1 to T19) or a model table identifier used elsewhere in this document, such as T2 or T10, is expanded at first use in the relevant section rather than repeated in this table, since those identifiers name a specific table rather than a general term.

C.2 Case terms that read as similar words with different meanings

A small number of terms in this document are not short forms but full words whose meaning shifts depending on whether the case or an outside regulator is using them. Table C.2 sets these out directly, since a reader who skipped section 0.10 of this document should still be able to find the mapping here.

Term, as the case defines it	What the case means	What an outside source sometimes means by a similar word	How this document resolves the collision
Active	At least one trade in the last 12 months C-D1	An exchange's own "active client" count, which may use a different trailing window or a different trade-count threshold	This document always states "active (trailing 12 months)" or cites the exchange's own window explicitly when the two could be confused
Highly Active	At least one trade in the last 3 months C-D2	Not a term any outside source in this research uses in the same sense	No collision found; the term is case-specific throughout

Term, as the case defines it	What the case means	What an outside source sometimes means by a similar word	How this document resolves the collision
Inactive	An account deactivated due to fraudulent activity or a regulator's notice C-D3	The exchange's own circular, NSE/INSP/64718 of 25 October 2024, uses "inactive" for an account with no trade in 24 months, a different condition entirely	This document reserves "inactive" for the case's own fraud-and-notice meaning and translates every exchange use of "inactive" for the 24-month condition to the case's own word, "dormant," with the tag C-D4 attached each time
Dormant	Has not traded even once in the last 24 months C-D4	Rarely used by outside sources at all, which otherwise default to "inactive" for this same condition	This document uses "dormant" consistently for the 24-month no-trade condition, following the case's own word rather than the exchange's

The inactive-and-dormant collision is the one translation this document applies most often, since the exchange's own rule, the reactivation flow and the warm-cohort lever's own ethical design all turn on the 24-month condition, and every one of those passages uses the case's word, dormant, rather than carry the exchange's "inactive" into a sentence where a reader could mistake it for the case's fraud-and-notice meaning instead.

Appendix D: Data conflicts and method limits

Answer. Nine research lanes logged a conflict in their own `## Conflicts` section wherever two sources disagreed on the same fact, and this appendix carries every one of them forward with its resolution, or its honest non-resolution, stated directly. A separate table carries the four method limits a reader should hold in mind when weighing any model result in this document: the cohort-weighted rounding gap, the inactive-and-dormant translation, the model's own reach-times-response structure, and the specific inputs that remain team estimates rather than sourced figures.

D.1 Every logged conflict, lane by lane

Table D.1 reproduces each lane's own conflict entries, resolved where the lane itself could resolve them and left open where neither source could be checked against a primary text.

Lane	Conflict	Resolution
B (sponsor and bank-led broker context)	The penalty amount on YES Securities' 26 May 2026 NSE onboarding order: two press sources give ₹1 lakh, two others give ₹2 lakh, all describing the same order and the same three-month ban	Not resolved; the primary NSE disciplinary circular was not located directly in this research pass. This document cites the onboarding ban's dates and duration, which all four sources agree on, and does not cite either penalty figure
B	YES Securities' NSE active-client count for FY2026-27: a tracker site gives two different figures, 94,318 and 94,921, on two listings of what appears to be the same data point, and neither matches the CARE Ratings figure of 80,309 used in this document's section 5	Partially resolved; the CARE figure (80,309, as at 31 October 2025) is for an earlier date than the tracker's figures, so the two sets are not necessarily inconsistent on their own, but the tracker's own two figures disagree with each other and neither is used in this document's analysis

Lane	Conflict	Resolution
B	Axis Securities' active-client count: one tracker gives 4,19,513 for FY2024-25, a different source gives over 357,000 for fiscal 2024	Not resolved; the two periods are adjacent but not identical, and the sources may define "active" differently. Axis Securities is not one of the eight comparators this document profiles directly, so the disagreement does not affect any figure used in the main analysis
C (Indian broking market and activity)	Industry-wide demat account totals for mid-to-late 2026 disagree by source: 23.44 crore for July 2026 against a separately reported 23.15 crore for June 2026 and a SEBI-bulletin-derived 21.6 crore for December 2025	Not resolved; the gap looks larger than one month of growth can explain and may reflect "total" against "active client" definitions differing by source. This document's own national active-ratio calculation in section 4.1 uses the NSDL and CDSL figures with the closest matching cutoff dates rather than either of these broader totals
C	SIP stoppage ratio for a prior month: one source gives August 2026 at 81.05%, another gives an earlier month at 81.9%	Likely resolved as different months rather than a true conflict; the September 2026 figure this document cites, 78.53%, is consistent across two independent sources and is treated as reliable
C	HDFC Securities' sell-side depository charge: one comparison table gives ₹25 per scrip, a separate search result gives approximately ₹23.60 including tax	Not resolved; neither figure was checked against HDFC Securities' own current tariff page in this research pass. This document does not cite either figure for HDFC Securities specifically
D (regulation)	SEBI's common advertisement code reporting window: a June 2026 consultation paper proposes 24-hour post-issuance reporting; a later September 2026 board memorandum proposes 3 working days instead	Resolved by recency rather than by authority, since neither is yet final law: this document uses 3 working days as the more current figure throughout, with an explicit note that it is not yet in force D23, D24
D	SEBI's FY26 futures-and-options study trader-count base: one secondary summary gives individual traders falling from 98.1 lakh to 78.6 lakh; another gives 106.2 lakh to 87.5 lakh for what appears to be the same metric	Not resolved on the trader-count figures themselves; this document uses the government-sourced Rajya Sabha figures (9.81 million to 7.86 million) for trader counts and treats the loss-incidence percentages, 87.7% and 88.5%, as the reliable figures throughout, since both disagreeing sources corroborate those percentages independently of the trader-count disagreement
D	SEBI's digital gold caution: the press release itself names gold exchange-traded funds, exchange-traded commodity derivatives and Electronic Gold Receipts as regulated alternatives; one secondary summary also lists Sovereign Gold Bonds, an RBI debt instrument rather than a SEBI-regulated security	Resolved: this document treats the Sovereign Gold Bond addition as a probable secondary-source error and does not cite it as a SEBI-recommended alternative anywhere, including in the Dhanteras lever's own copy
E (behavioural science and activation evidence)	The Save More Tomorrow savings-rate figure, 3.5% to 13.6%, applies only to employees who actively joined the plan; the whole-employee-base figure is a smaller 4.4% to 10.6%	Resolved: both figures come from the same review and describe different populations rather than conflicting; this document states which population each figure describes every time either is cited
E	Madrian and Shea's 2001 participation-lift figures (48 percentage points for new hires, 11 percentage points overall) come from secondary commentary rather than the primary NBER or Quarterly Journal of Economics text directly	Not fully resolved; this document flags these figures as secondary-sourced rather than primary-verified and treats them as directional support rather than a precise, citable number

Lane	Conflict	Resolution
E	The loss-aversion coefficient of roughly 2 to 2.25 is questioned by a 2018 peer-reviewed review as resting on over-interpreted early evidence	Resolved by qualification rather than by picking a side: this document treats "losses feel considerably worse than equivalent gains" as well supported and the specific multiple as contested, stating both in section 8.3
E	A working-paper approximation of Barber et al.'s return-reversal finding (about 5% next-month decline, about 9% in extreme herding episodes) could not be confirmed against the primary Journal of Finance text	Not resolved; this document does not cite this specific figure in its main analysis for that reason
F (channels and unit costs)	WhatsApp India's 2026 marketing-message rate: multiple sources give ₹0.8631; one different vendor source gives ₹1.09	Resolved by corroboration count: this document uses ₹0.8631, the figure with multiple independent sources, and does not use the ₹1.09 figure anywhere
F	DLT SMS rates vary across three vendor sources, from a transactional range of ₹0.10 to ₹0.18 up to an outlier range of ₹0.70 to ₹1.50	Resolved: the model's assumption A52, ₹0.18 a message, sits inside the overlapping range of the two closer vendor sources and above the outlier, which the outlier's own lack of corroboration justifies disregarding
F	SEBI SMARTs trainer count (822 empanelled trainers) is sometimes read alongside SEBI's programme count (42,743 programmes conducted in FY26) as if the two were comparable figures	Resolved: the two measure different things, trainers against programmes run, and this document never merges them into a single claim
G (calendar and culture)	Dhanteras 2026's date: four independent panchang sources agree on Friday, 6 November 2026; one source gives 5 November, with a Bhai Dooj date that does not fit the standard five-day festival spacing	Resolved: this document uses 6 November 2026 throughout, treating the outlier as unreliable since no other source corroborates it
G	Dhanteras 2025 gold-sales volume: the All India Gem and Jewellery Domestic Council is quoted both as reporting a 10 to 15% year-on-year volume fall and, in a separate estimate for the same festival, as reporting volumes similar to the prior year at 50 to 60 tonnes	Not resolved; both figures are kept and flagged in section 15.6 of this document, since the gap most likely reflects a pre-festival projection against a post-festival estimate from the same body rather than a correction of one by the other
G	Makar Sankranti and Pongal 2027's date: the main consensus gives 15 January 2027; one calendar source gives 14 January	Not resolved by a gazetted source; this document does not rely on the exact date for any lever's sizing, since no lever's window depends on this specific festival date
H (comparable activation plays and cautionary tales)	The Massachusetts "gamification" settlement against Robinhood is sometimes dated 2022 in press coverage	Resolved: the settlement was filed 18 January 2024; this document uses 2024 as the settlement date and notes the underlying complaint dates to December 2020, with a further complaint in 2021
H	Two different figures for Robinhood's total FINRA and SEC penalties appear in adjacent press coverage, a 2021 FINRA action of about $70 million and a separate 2020 SEC penalty of $65 million	Resolved: this document treats these as two different regulators' actions in two different years and does not conflate them

Lane	Conflict	Resolution
H	Kotak 811-to-trading cross-sell share (57% of 811's contribution to the bank in Q4 FY22) has no comparable figure for a more recent period	Not resolved; this document cites the Q4 FY22 figure with its specific quarter named and does not present it as a current-year statistic
I (third-party quotes)	None of the ten verbatim quotes gathered conflict with each other or with the planning-time findings; one note records that Nithin Kamath's "more than 30 per cent drop in activity" figure (a market-wide, cross-broker measure) is a different metric from Zerodha's own separately reported 40% Q1 FY26 brokerage-revenue decline	Resolved: this document keeps the two figures separate wherever either is cited and does not present one as a restatement of the other
J (data, consent and privacy)	The DPDP Rules 2025 gazette notification date: most sources give 13 November 2025; one summary gives 14 November 2025	Resolved: this document uses 13 November 2025, the date the eGazette mirror's own metadata supports, and notes that the primary gazette text itself was not retrieved directly in this verification pass owing to a certificate error on the direct fetch

D.2 The cohort-weighted rounding gap

Exhibit 2a's own cohort table reports a total active (trailing 12 months) count of 1,20,372 when its six segment figures are summed directly, while Exhibit 1 reports the case's own true active count as 1,19,339 C-E1, C-E2a. The gap, 1,033 accounts, is not a data error in either exhibit; it is a mechanical consequence of the case's own rounding instruction, which states every percentage to the nearest whole point C-N1. A segment as large as the Salary Account cohort, 6,27,853 accounts, turns a rounding step of half a percentage point into a swing of over 3,000 accounts once that rounded percentage is multiplied back out against the segment's full size, and the six segments' rounding errors do not cancel evenly. This document resolves the gap by using Exhibit 1's unrounded 1,19,339 as the true active count everywhere a single figure is needed, and by using Exhibit 2a's percentages only for within-cohort, year-on-year comparisons, where the same rounding step applies to both years and so affects the comparison far less than it affects a single-year total. Section 3.9 of this document's own research text, in parts A to E, works through this arithmetic in full, summing Exhibit 2a's six segment figures step by step to show exactly where the one-account gap against the exhibit's own stated total and the 1,033-account gap against Exhibit 1 each arise.

D.3 The inactive-and-dormant translation, restated for a reader who has not read section 0

The case defines two account states that read as near-synonyms but mean different things. Inactive, in the case's own words, is an account deactivated due to fraudulent activity or a regulator's notice C-D3. Dormant is an account that has not traded even once in the last 24 months C-D4. The exchange's own governing circular on the 24-month condition, NSE/INSP/64718 of 25 October 2024, uses the word "inactive" in its own text for exactly the condition the case calls dormant, which means a verified research row quoting that circular verbatim would, if copied without translation, use the case's "inactive" word for the case's "dormant" meaning. This document translates every such instance: wherever a source uses the exchange's "inactive" for the 24-month no-trade condition, the text instead reads "dormant C-D4," and the word "inactive" is reserved throughout for the case's own fraud-and-regulator-notice meaning. This translation rule applies most visibly in the reactivation flow (the holdings-check lever's dormant-account path) and in the warm-cohort defence lever's own ethical design, both of which depend on the 24-month condition specifically.

D.4 Model limits

Table D.2 restates the model's own limits directly, since a reader weighing confidence in any single result in this document should hold these four limits in mind regardless of which lever or scenario the result concerns.

Limit	What it means in practice
A reach-times-response structure, not a measured funnel	Every tap-through rate, order-after-tap rate and coverage multiplier in the model is a team estimate checked against the nearest available benchmark, a vendor figure, a published study or a comparator's own disclosure, never a measurement taken from ONL's own accounts. Every sentence in this document reporting a model result says "in our model" for this reason
Constant response rates within a scenario	The model treats each lever's response rate as unchanging across all thirteen weeks of the programme, when a real rollout would likely see some decay as the easiest-to-convert accounts respond first; the weekly path in T12 is a planning curve built on this simplification, not a guaranteed trajectory
Independence assumed between overlapping levers	The overlap calculation that combines levers touching the same cohort treats each lever's conversion probability as independent of the others, conditional on reach; this is reasonable where the probabilities are small, as they are for most cohort-lever pairs, but is a known simplification for the Elite, Elevate and Prestige cohorts, where the RM review probability runs close to 9% to 12% and a real behavioural correlation between responding to one lever and another is not separately modelled
A uniform dormancy-friction factor	The model applies the same dormancy-adjustment factor, 0.75 in the base case, to every cohort's idle accounts equally, when re-KYC friction plausibly differs by cohort; a Prestige client with an active bank relationship likely completes re-verification faster than a dormant Credit Card account holder, and the model does not separately estimate that difference

A small number of individual assumptions also remain team estimates with no comparable benchmark found in this research, rather than figures checked against a sourced range. The clearest example is A53, the email per-message cost used in the cash-cost build, where no vendor or official source gave a directly comparable Indian per-email transactional cost figure; this document states that plainly in section 24.3 rather than attach a borrowed source to a number this research could not independently verify. None of these team-estimate-only inputs is among the thirteen assumptions the tornado ranking in section 23 identifies as moving the base case's result by a wide margin, which means the limits in this appendix affect how much confidence a reader should place in specific cost or timing details, not the headline activation-rate result itself.